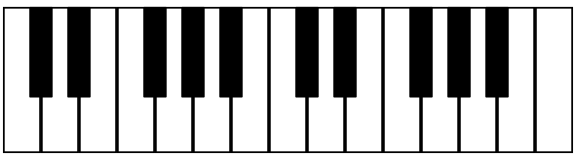
Read at Sight

A graded sight-reading course for piano

Volume 2 - Moving Hands



Middle C

Your hands leave home: shifts, stretches, new keys and minor keys, with legato, staccato and dynamics to bring the music to life.

Exercises generated to graded rules; pieces are original or public domain.

How to use this book

What is new in Volume 2

In Volume 1 each exercise stayed in one hand position. Now the hands move. A finger number in the middle of an exercise means: shift your hand now, so that finger lands on that note. You will also read slurs, staccato dots and dynamics, and play in G major, F major and three minor keys. Start this book when you can read both clefs in C and G positions, hands together, with eighth notes, rests and ties.

The five rules

1. Never stop: keep the beat going, even after a wrong note. 2. Count out loud and use a metronome at the speed shown. 3. Keep your eyes on the music, not your hands. 4. Read the shape: up, down, or the same, and by how much. 5. Play each exercise once, tick its box, and move on. Come back only after a few weeks.

Before every exercise: 10 seconds

Check the clef and time signature. Find the first note and its finger number. Scan for the highest and lowest note, and for any bar that repeats an earlier one. Then count one bar in and play.

How each unit is laid out

A unit opens with what is new, a keyboard picture of the hand position, and reading tips. Then come Parts A, B and C, which grow slightly harder. Pieces come next, and the unit ends with a checkpoint that tells you when to move on.

A daily routine (15-20 minutes)

Warm up by playing the five notes of the hand position up and down, saying their names (2 minutes). Read 6-10 new exercises, one pass each (10 minutes). Play one piece, aiming for steady and musical (5 minutes).

Contents

Each unit adds exactly one new idea to everything before it.

Unit 1 Moving the Hand 4
Hand shifts between C and G positions; a finger number marks every move

Unit 2 Stretching 16
Reaching one key beyond the position with the thumb or little finger

Unit 3 Dotted Quarter Notes 28
The dotted quarter note followed by an eighth: 'long-short'

Unit 4 Legato and Staccato 40
Slurs (smooth and connected) and staccato dots (short and detached)

Unit 5 Loud and Soft 54
Dynamics: p, mp, mf, f; getting louder and softer

Unit 6 G Major 67
Key signature of one sharp (F-sharp); G and D positions

Unit 7 F Major 79
Key signature of one flat (B-flat); F and C positions

Unit 8 A Minor 92
Minor keys; A minor, the relative minor of C major

Unit 9 E Minor and D Minor 104
The relative minors of G major (E minor) and F major (D minor)

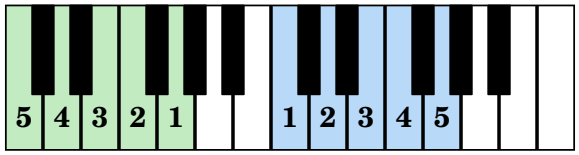
Unit 10 Review 118
Everything in Volume 2 together

Unit 1

Moving the Hand

New: Hand shifts between C and G positions; a finger number marks every move

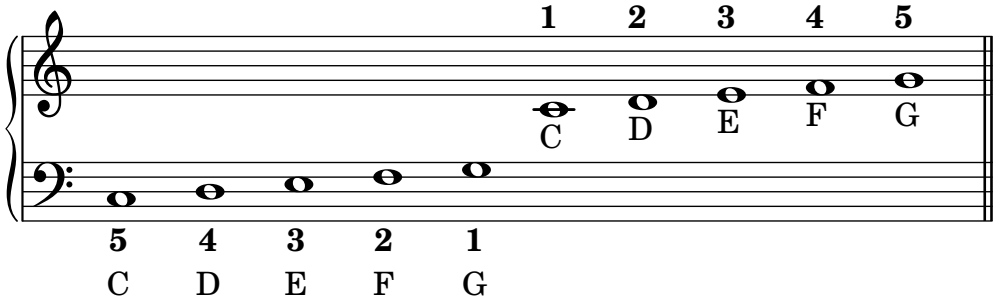
So far each exercise kept the hand in one place. Real music moves. In this unit each hand moves between two homes, C position and G position. A finger number in the middle of a line is your signal: move the hand so that finger lands on that note.

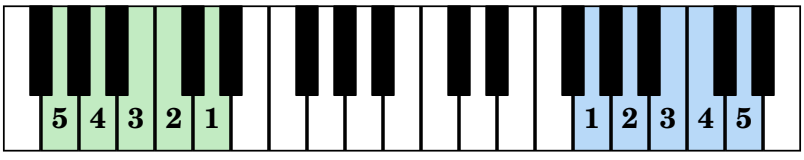


Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

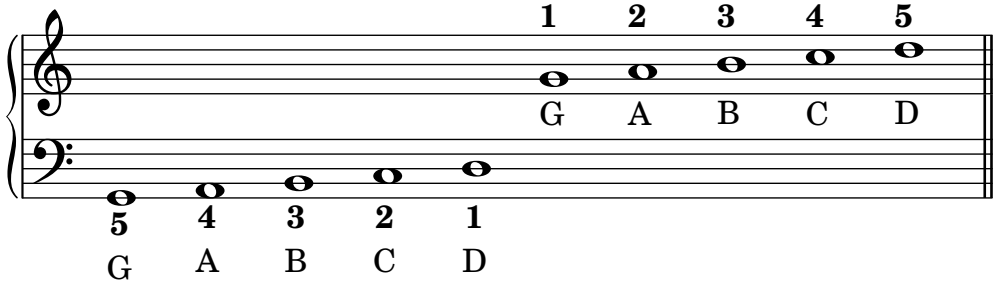




Middle C

Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Shift signals

A finger number appears on the first note after every move. A 1 on G in the right hand means the thumb goes to G: you are now in G position.

Move early

Move the hand during the note before the shift, or during a rest, so you arrive in time. The beat does not wait for the hand.

Where the positions meet

The right hand's two positions overlap on G: finger 5 in C position, finger 1 in G position. The left hand's overlap on C and D.

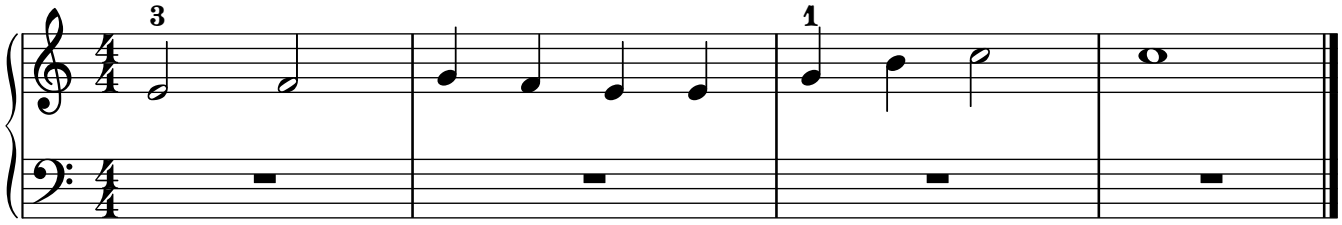
Reading tips

1. In your 10-second scan, find every finger number. Each one after the first is a shift.
2. Look at the note under each finger number and picture where your hand goes before you start.
3. Keep your eyes on the music while you move. Feel the distance rather than looking down.
4. If a shift goes wrong, keep counting and rejoin on the next note you can.

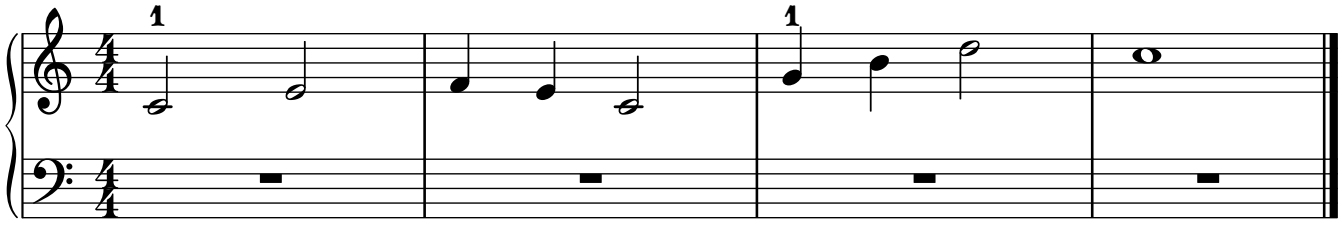
Part A: Right hand moves between C and G ♩ = 60

The right hand moves between C position and G position. Watch for finger numbers. Metronome 60.

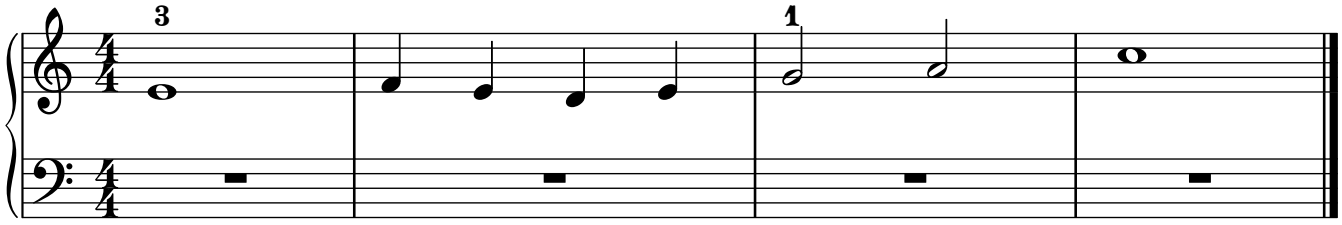
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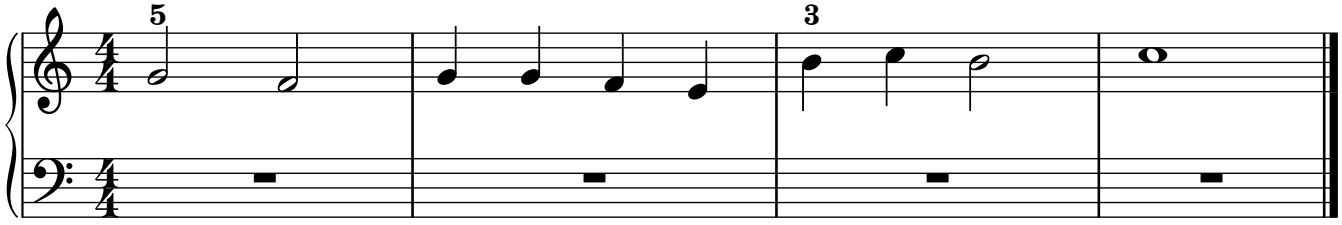
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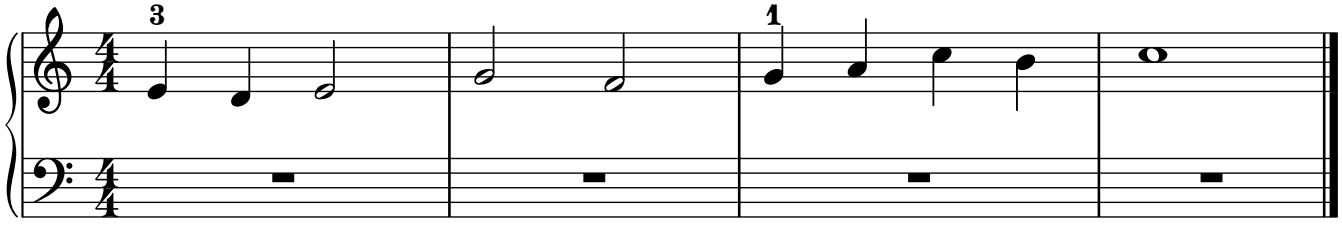
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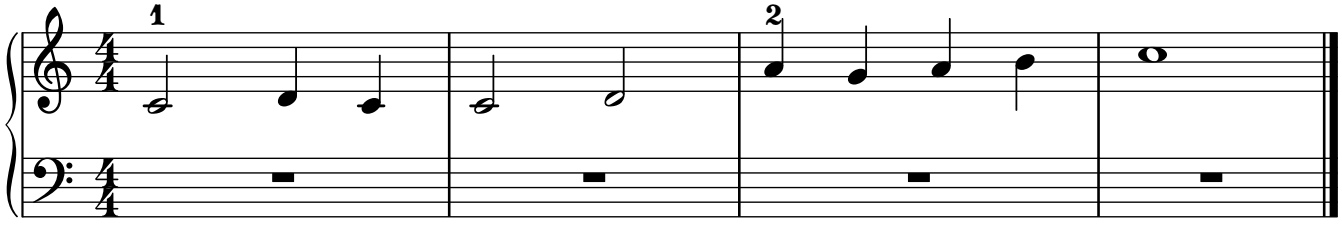
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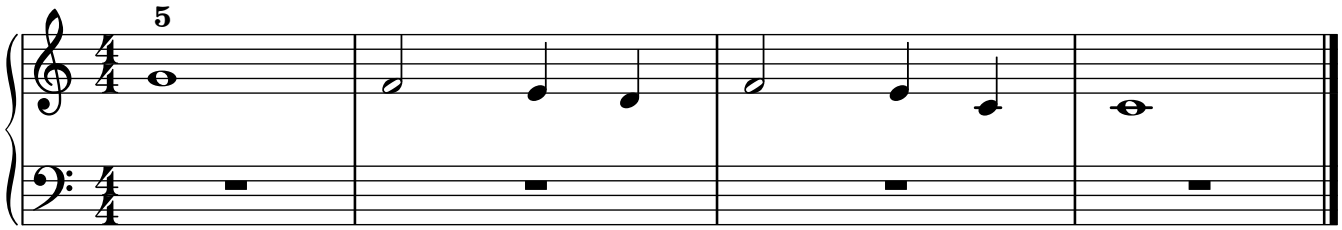


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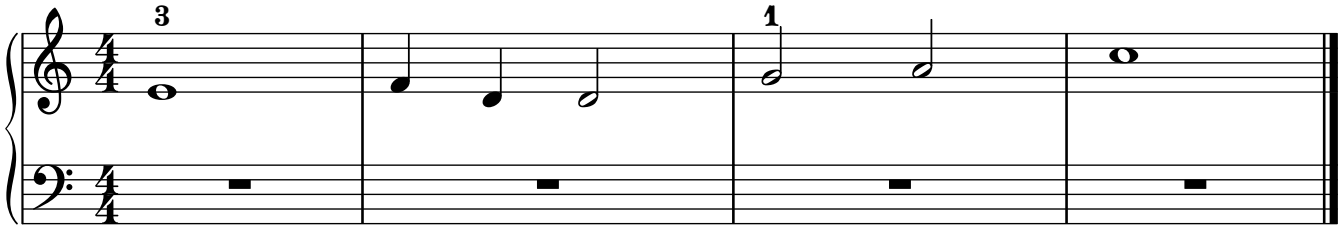
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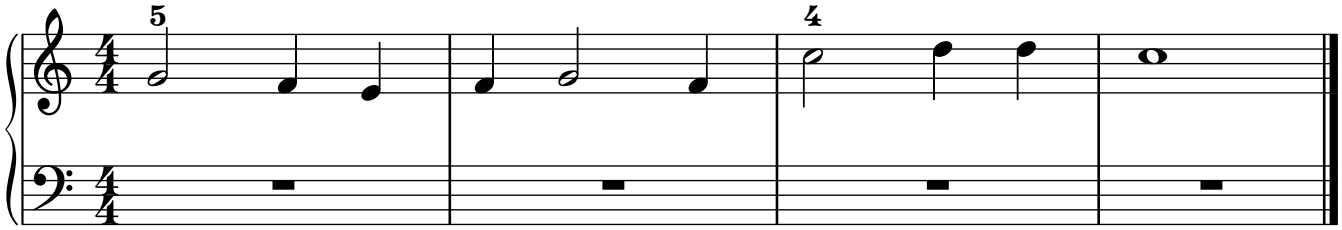
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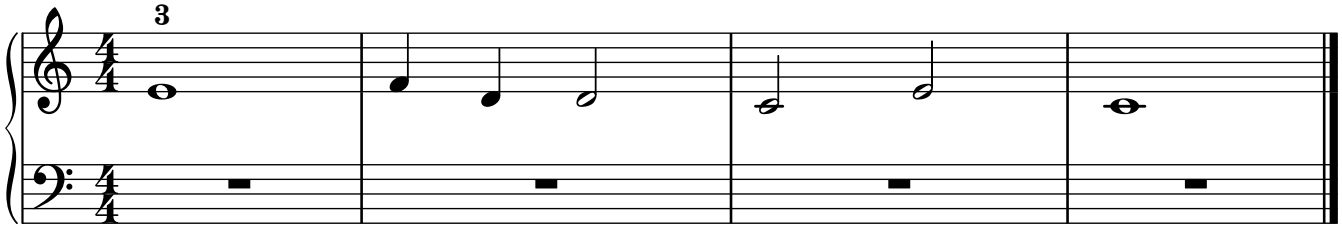


☐ **1.8**



☐ **1.9**



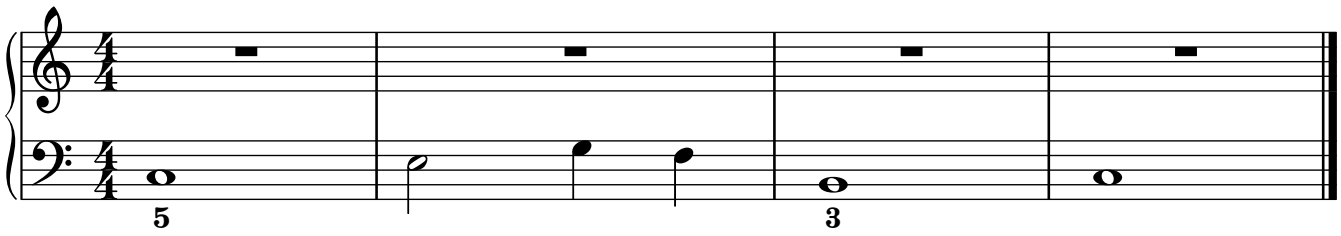
☐ **1.10**



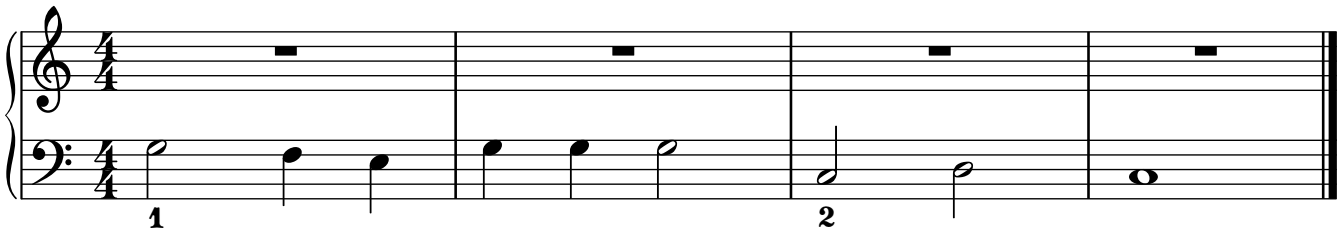
Part B: Left hand moves between C and G ♩= 60

The left hand moves between C position (C in the second space) and G position (G on the bottom line).

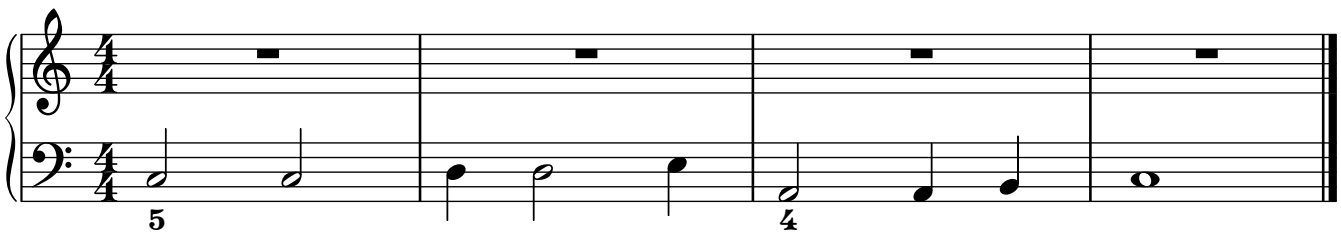
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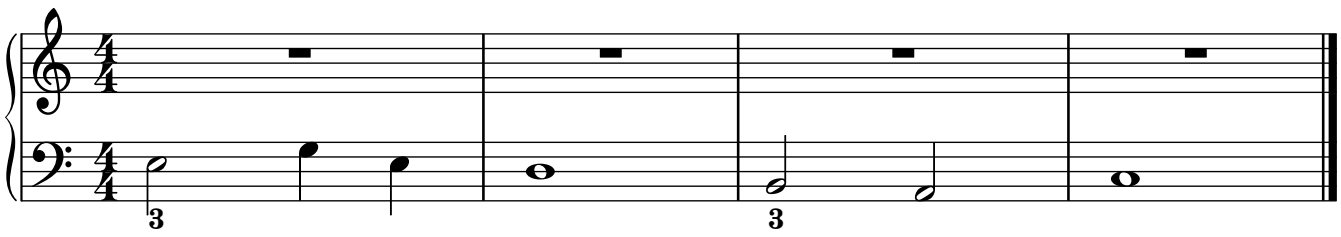
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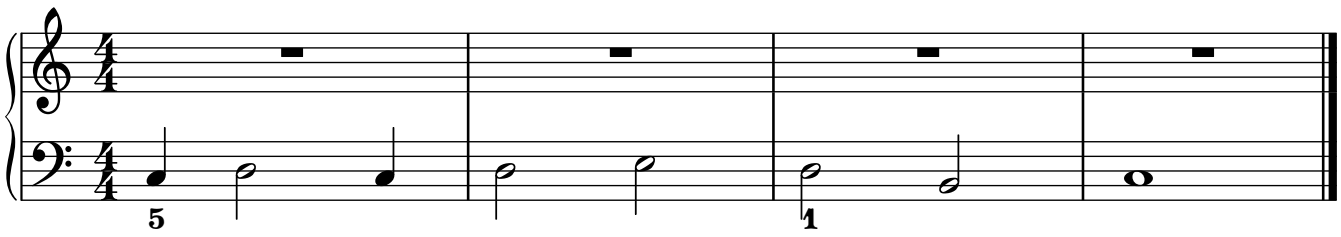
☐ **1.13**



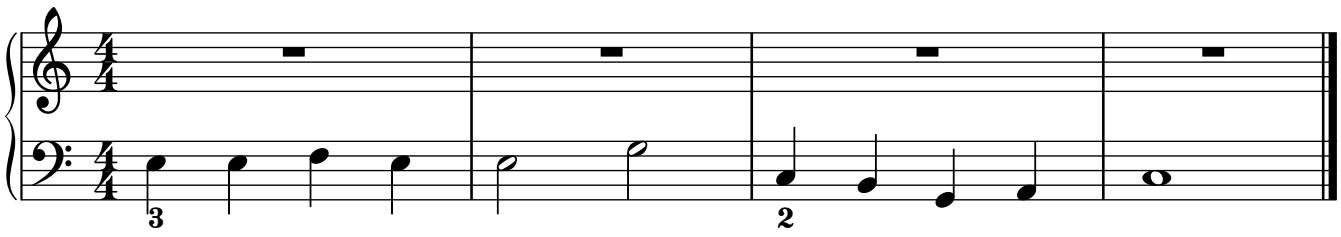
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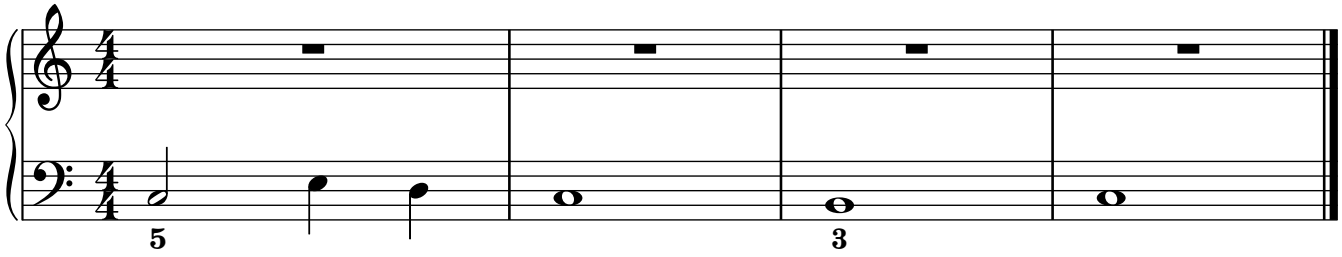
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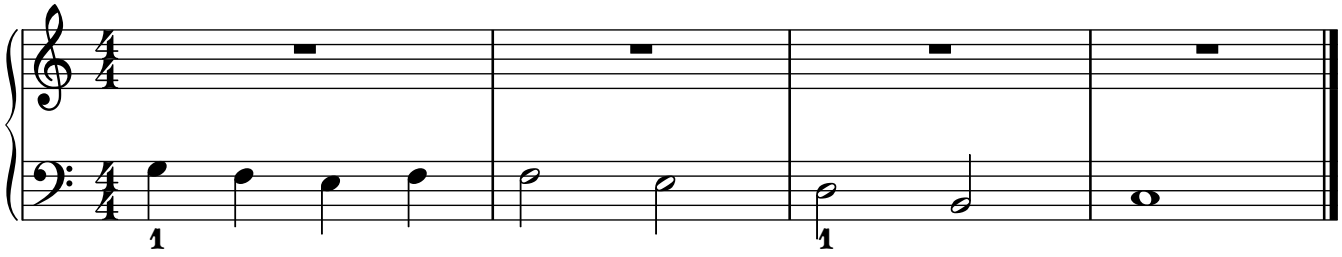
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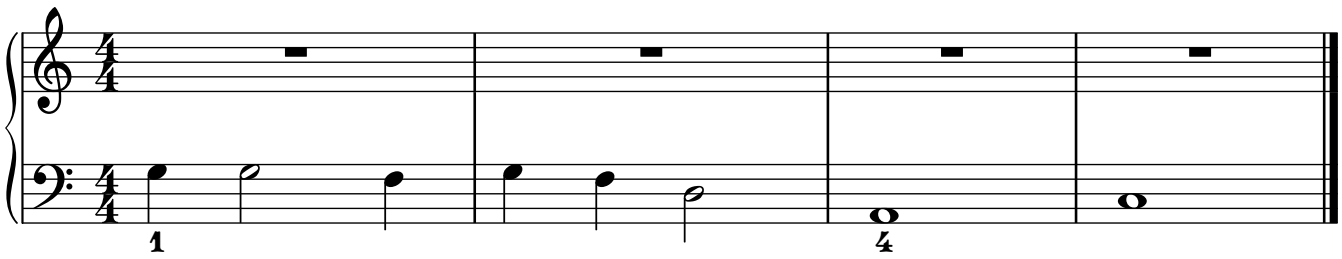
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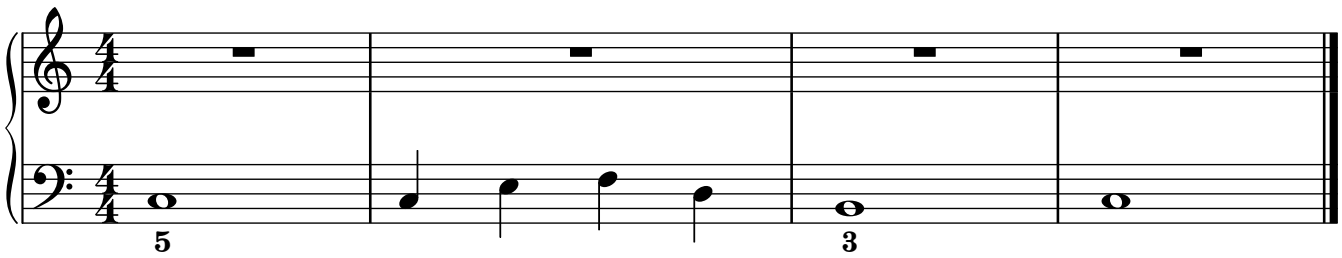
☐ **1.18**



☐ **1.19**



☐ **1.20**

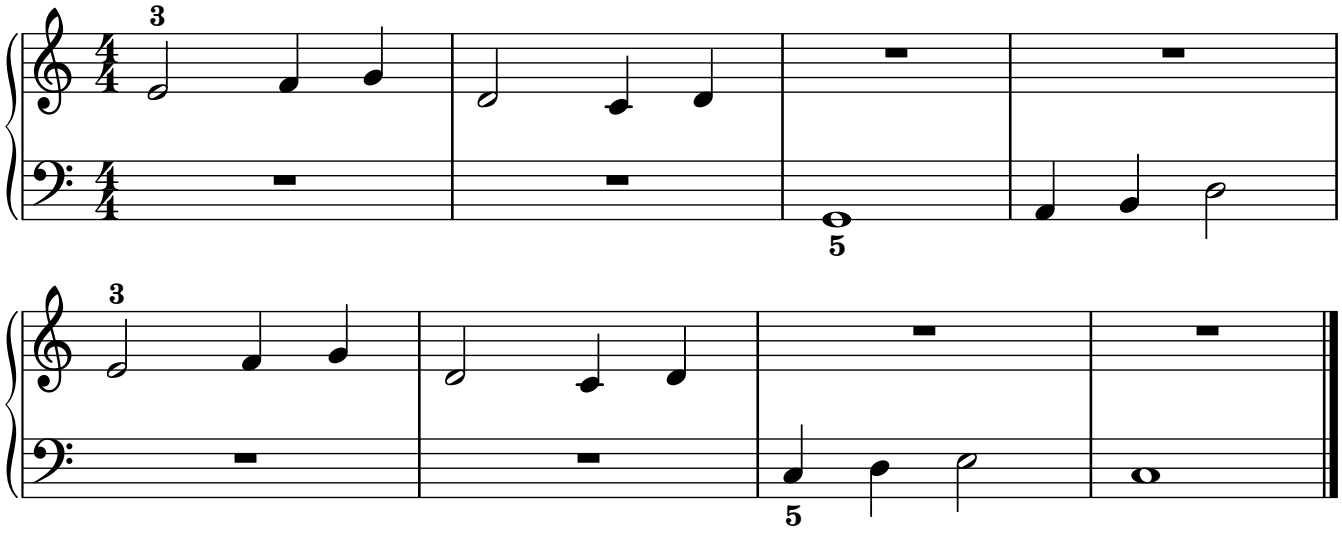


Part C: Both hands on the move

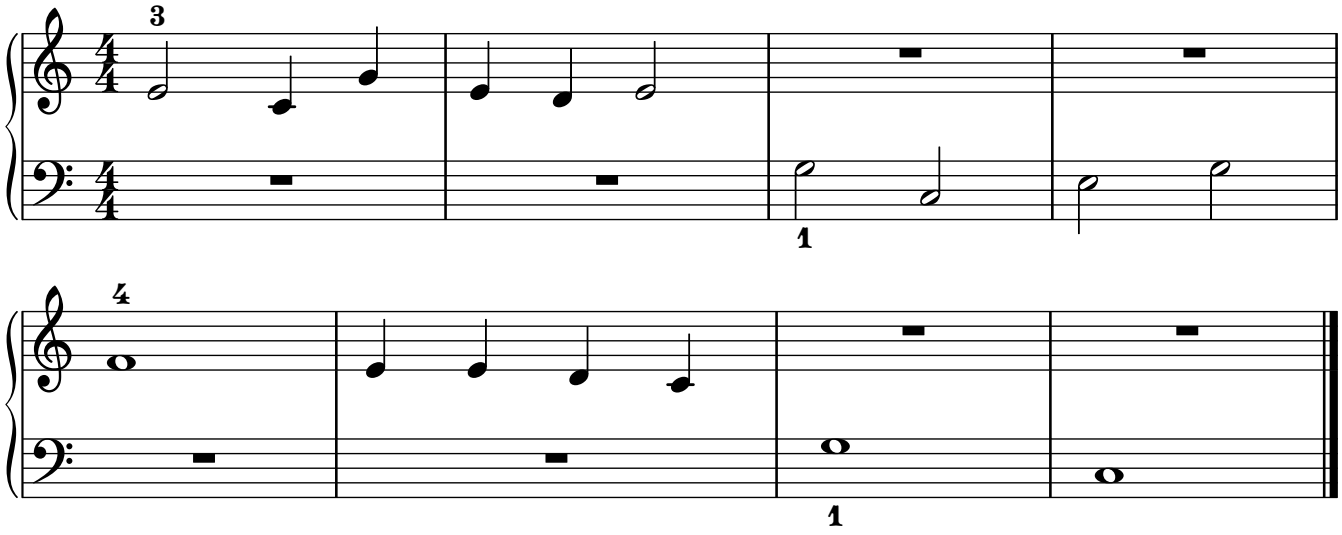
♩ = 66

Eight-bar phrases with the hands taking turns, each moving between its two positions.

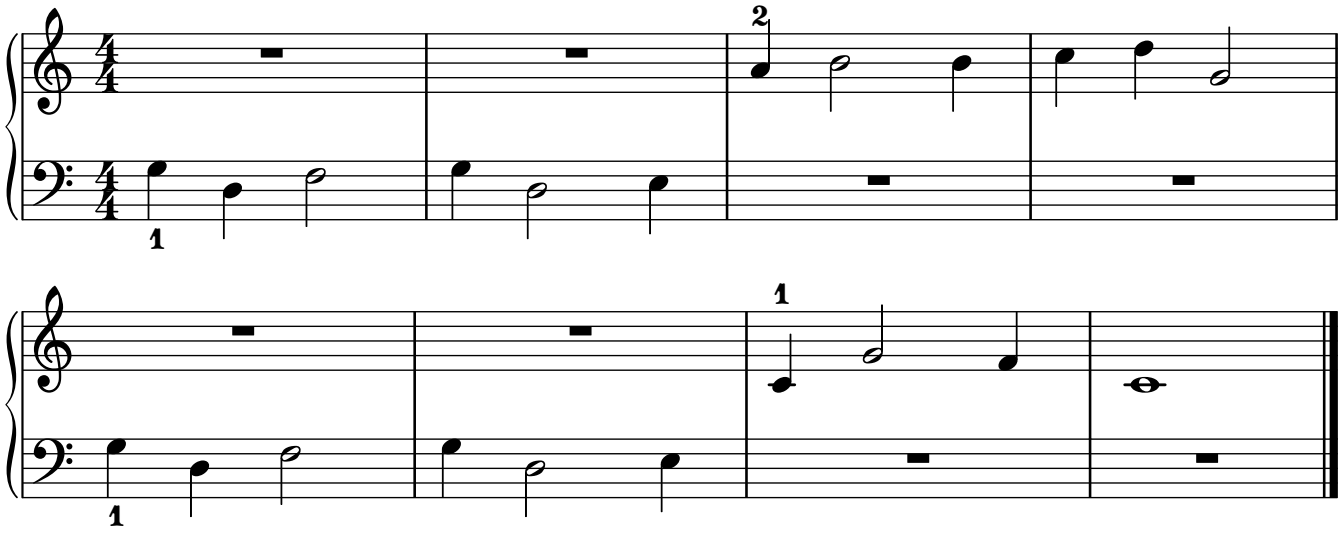
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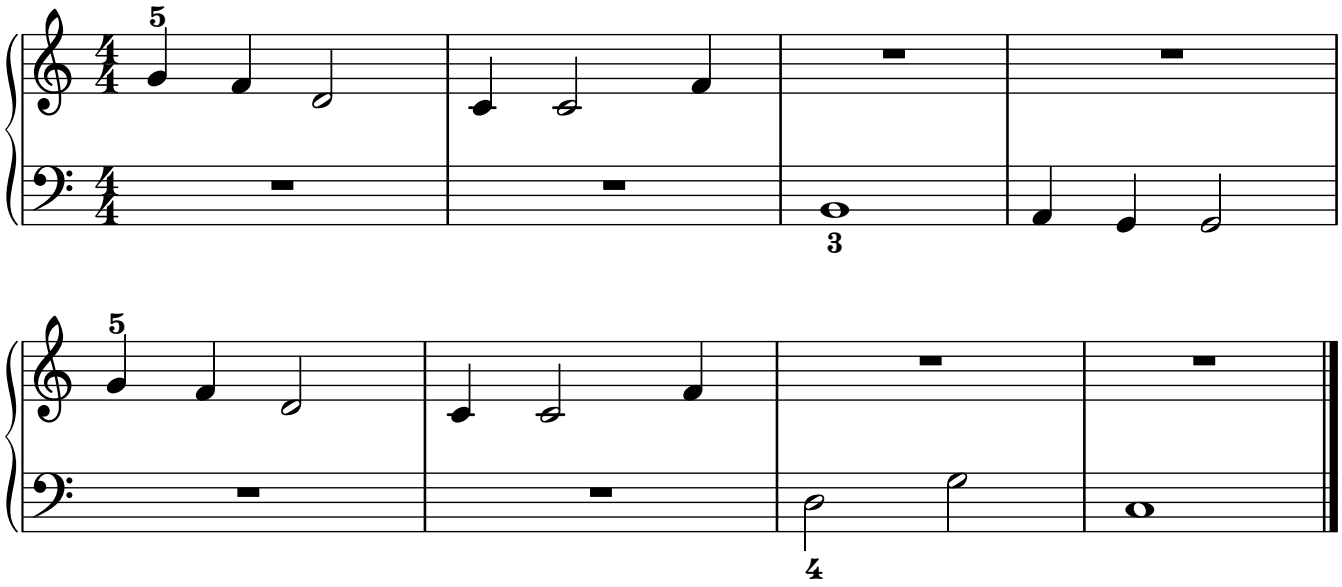
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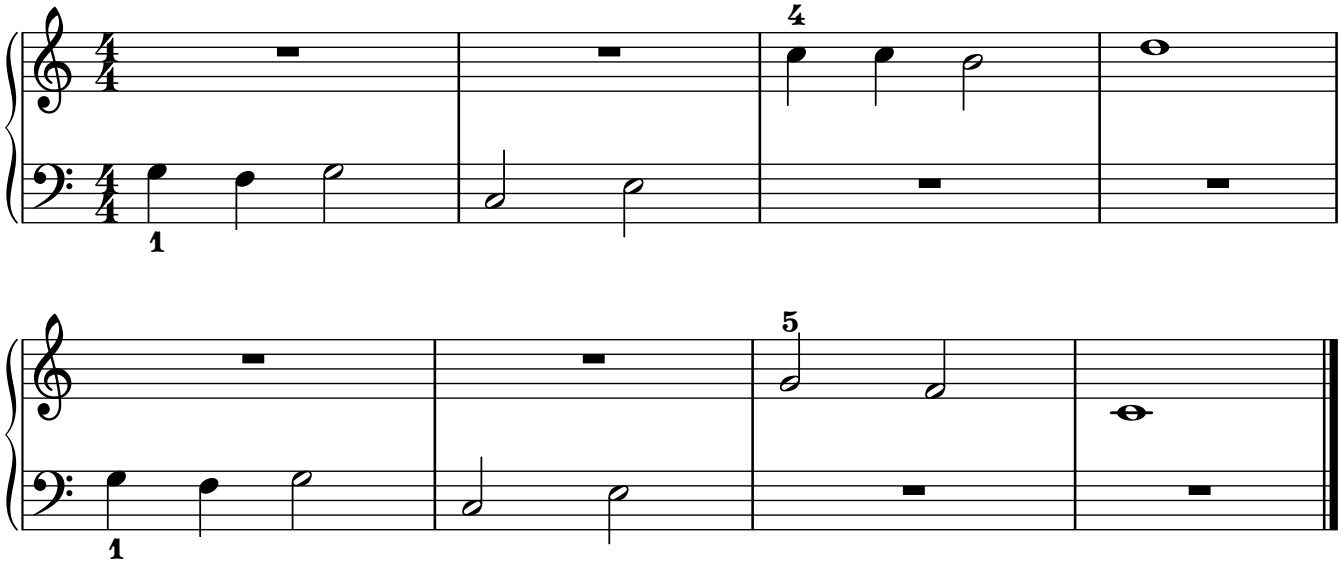


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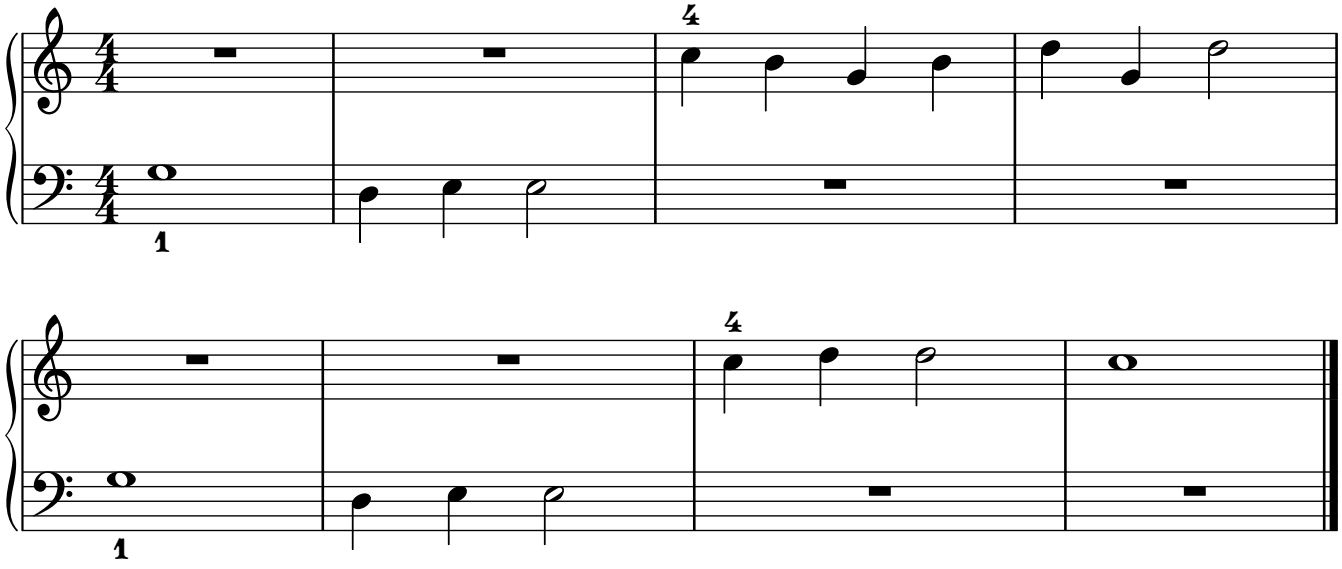


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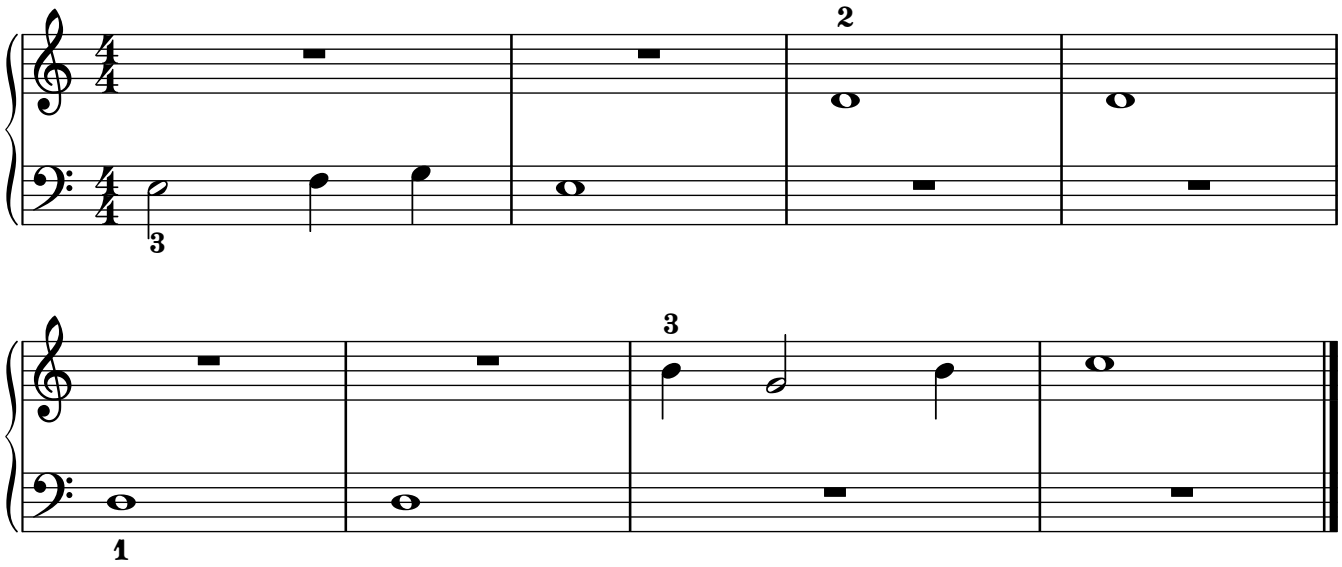
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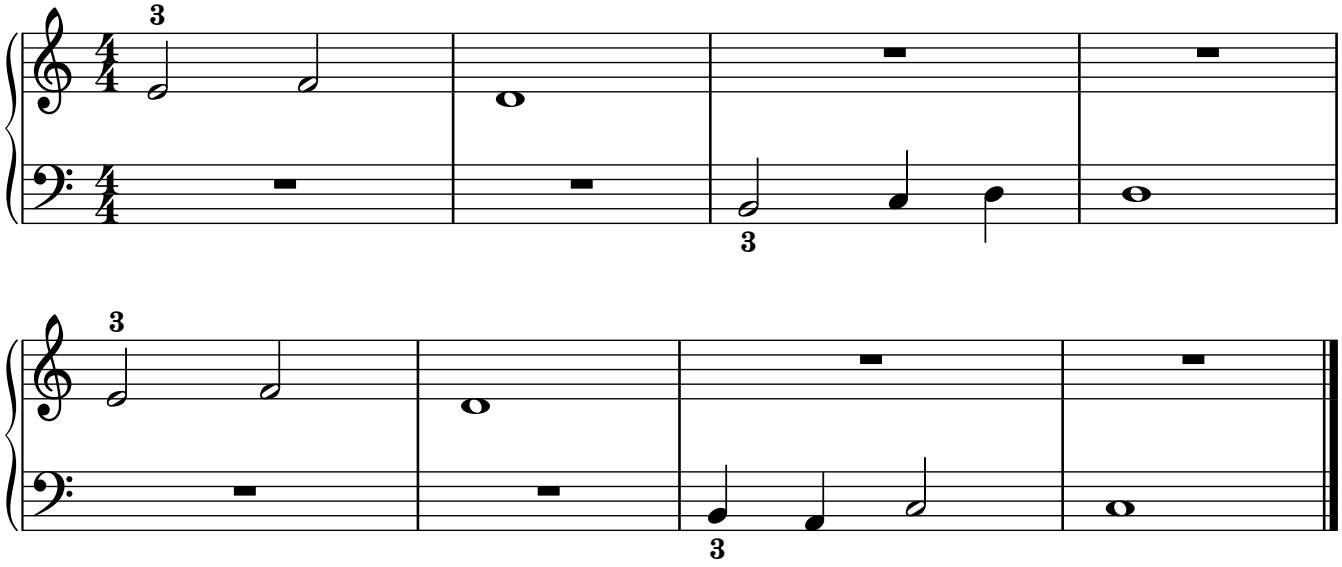
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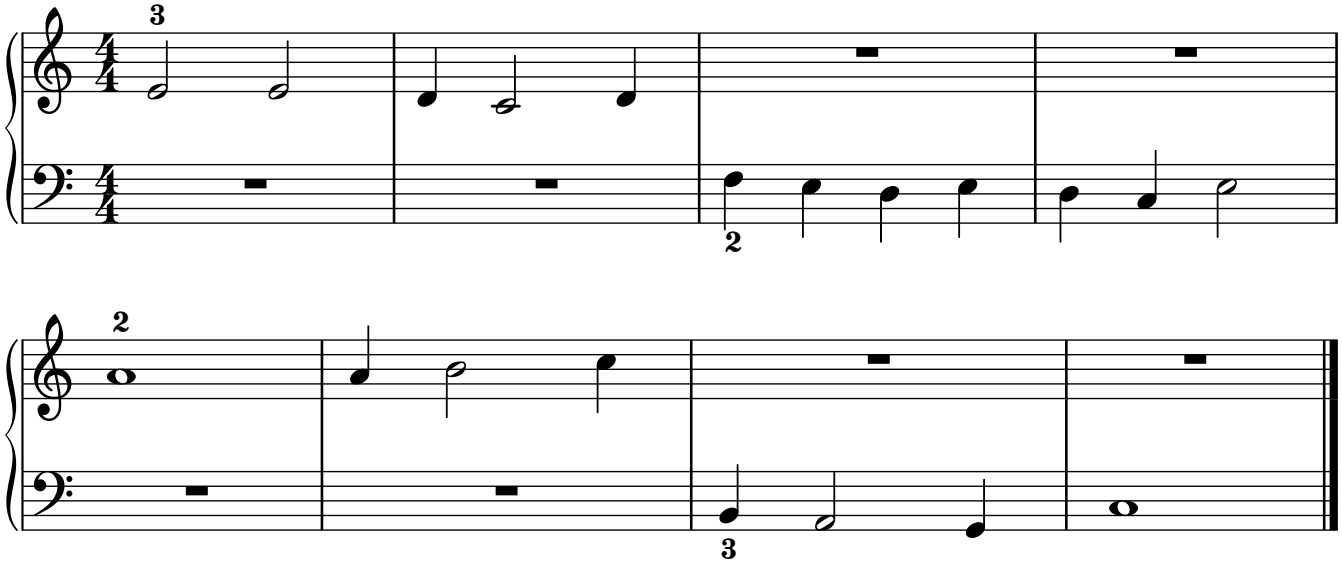


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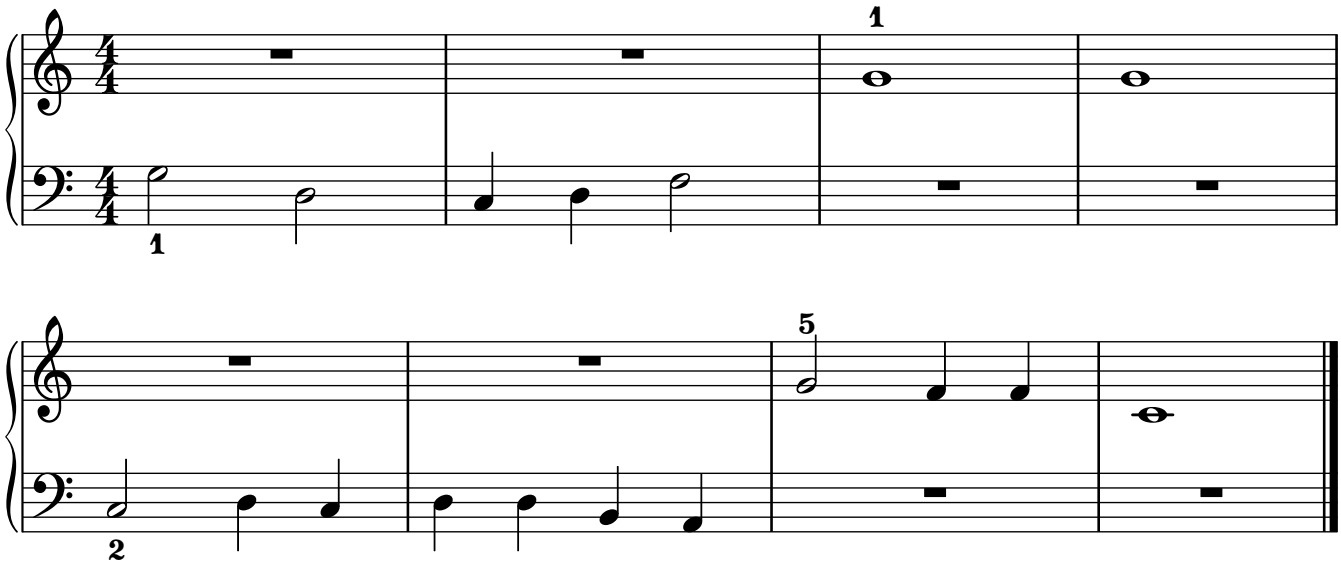


☐ **1.28**



☐ **1.29**



1.30
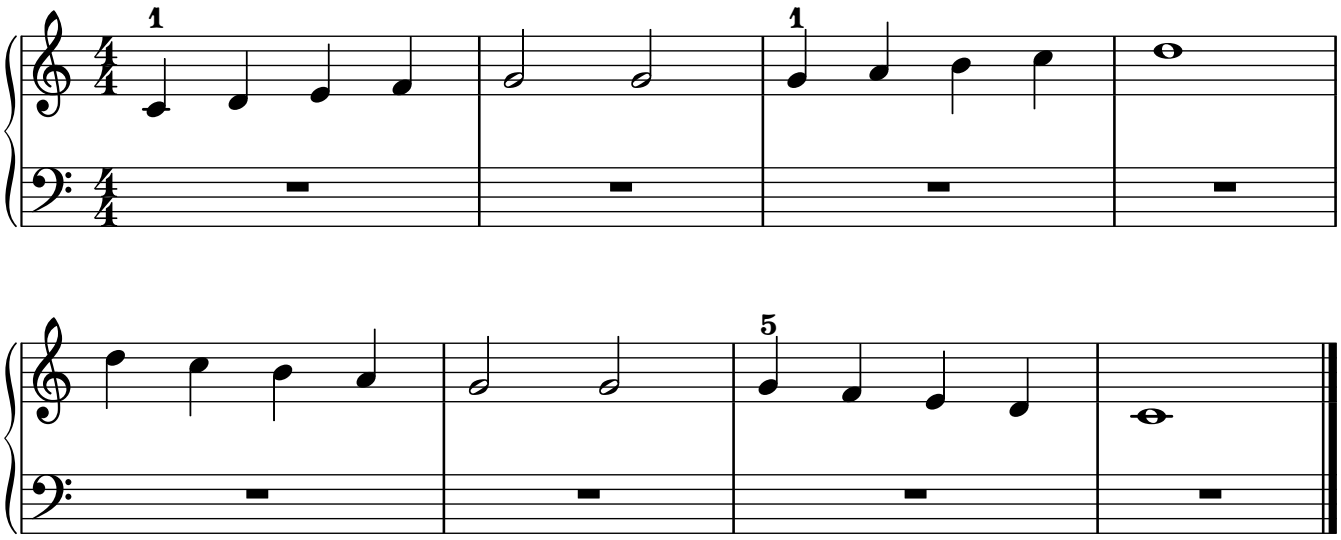


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Climbing the Stairs ♩ = 72

Original
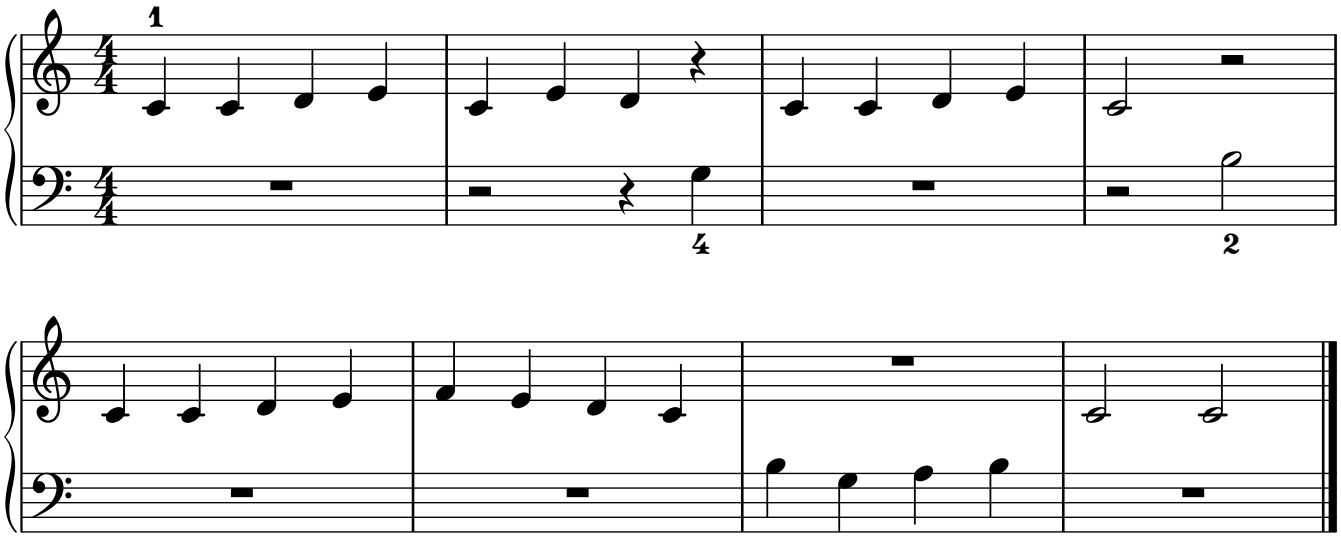
The right hand walks up through C position, shifts so the thumb takes G in bar 3, and walks on to D. It comes back down with another shift in bar 7.



Yankee Doodle ♩ = 84

Traditional American
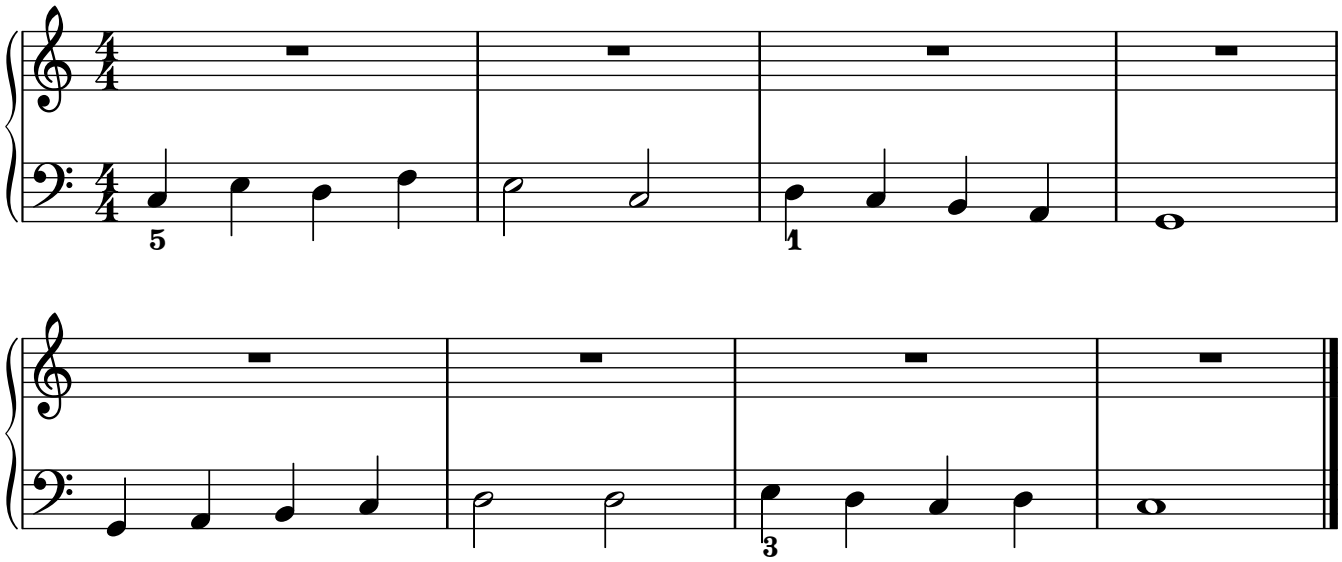
The tune dips below middle C three times. Those notes are written in the bass staff: play them with the left hand in middle C position (thumb on middle C).



Two Homes for the Left Hand ♩ = 72

Original
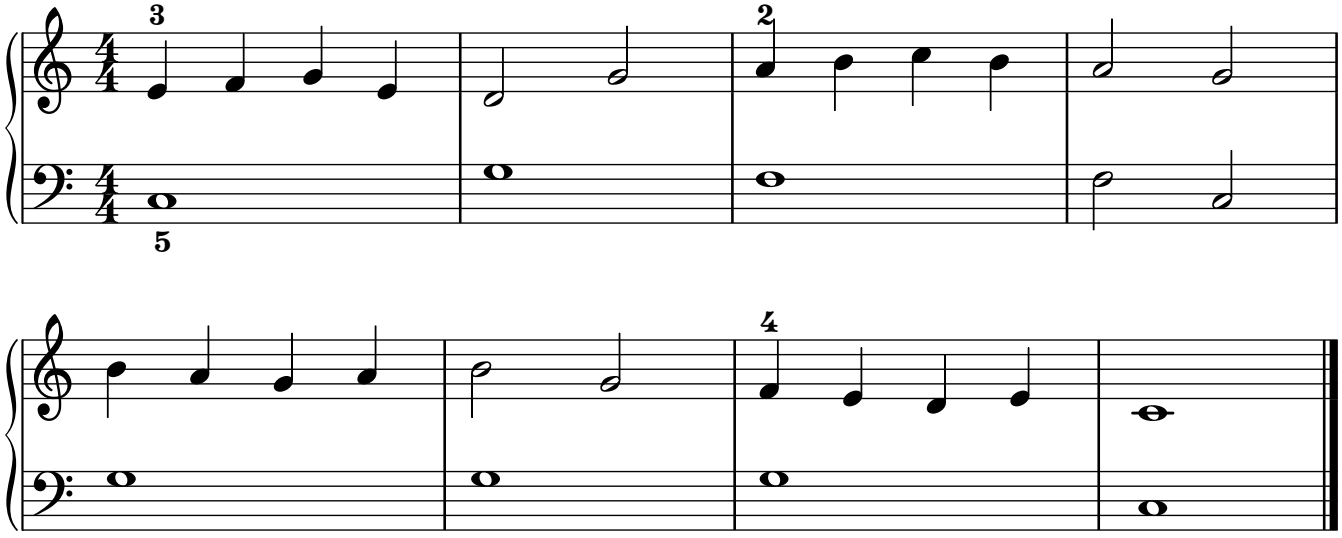
The left hand starts in C position, shifts down to G position in bar 3 (thumb on D), and moves back to C position in bar 7.



Over the Hill ♩ = 72

Original

Hands together. The right hand shifts up to G position in bar 3 and back in bar 7. A new bass note appears in bars 3-4: F, under finger 2.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 2?

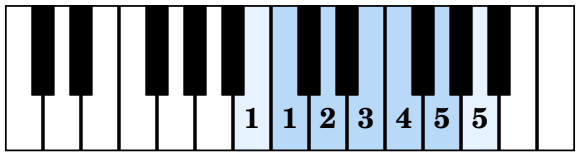
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if every shift lands on time, without looking down for more than an instant.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 2.

Unit 2

Stretching

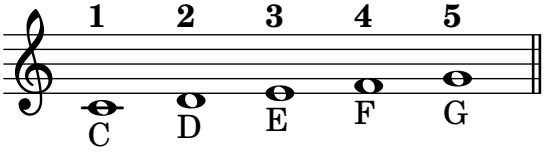
New: Reaching one key beyond the position with the thumb or little finger

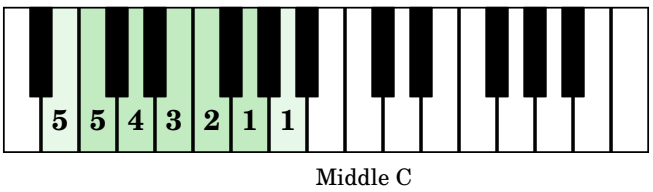
Sometimes a melody goes just one note beyond the hand position. Instead of moving the whole hand, stretch: the thumb slides one key below the position, or the little finger reaches one key above it, and then the hand settles back. The pale keys in the picture are the stretch notes.



Right hand C position: finger numbers on the keys (pale keys: stretches)

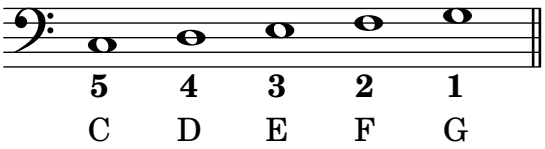
Your five notes





Left hand C position: finger numbers on the keys (pale keys: stretches)

Your five notes



What is new

Stretch or shift?

A stretch is for a single note just outside the position, after which the hand comes back. A shift moves the whole hand to a new home.

Right-hand stretches

From C position the thumb slides down to B, and finger 5 reaches up to A.

Left-hand stretches

From C position finger 5 reaches down to B, and the thumb slides up to A.

Stay relaxed

Open the hand for the stretch, then let it close again. Don't hold it stretched.

Reading tips

1. In your 10-second scan, find the highest and lowest notes. If one is just outside the position, plan a stretch.

2. A stretch note is only ever one key outside the position, so it is always played by finger 1 or finger 5.

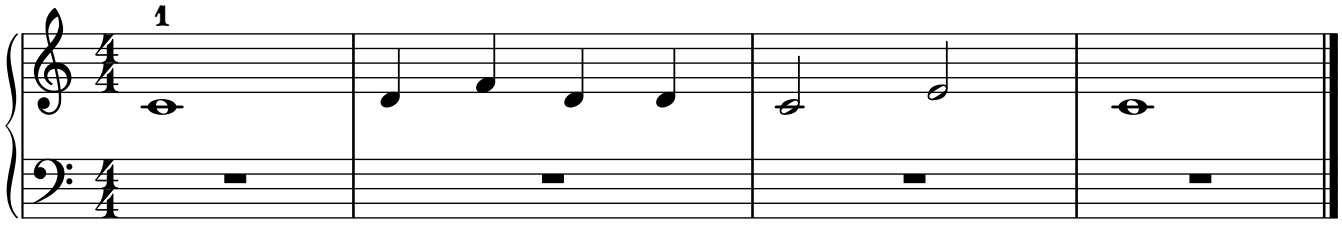
3. On the staff, a stretch note sits just beyond the notes under fingers 1 and 5.

4. Keep the beat steady; a stretch should not cost any time.

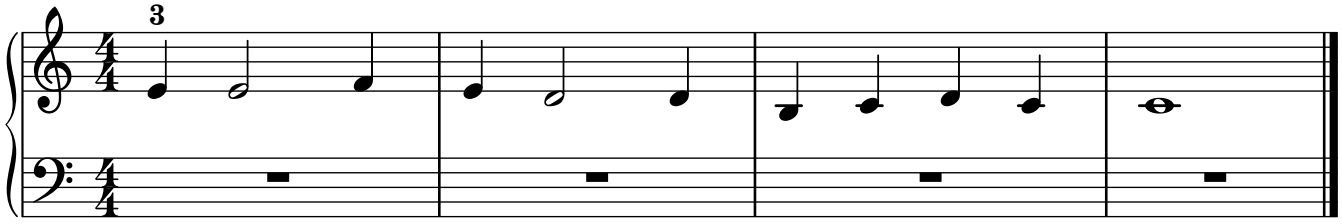
Part A: Right-hand stretches ♩ = 60

Right hand in C position, with stretches to B (thumb) and A (finger 5). Metronome 60.

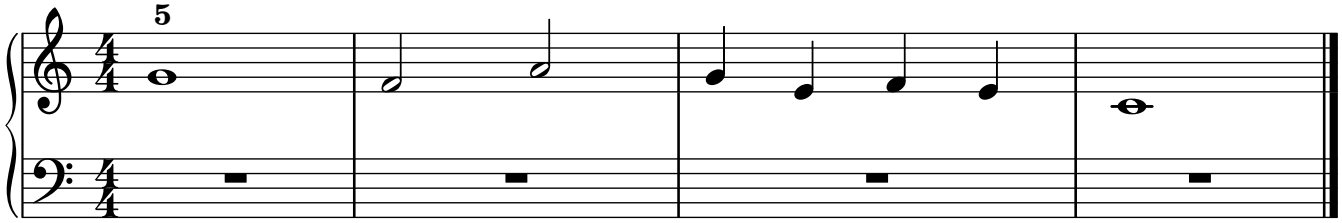
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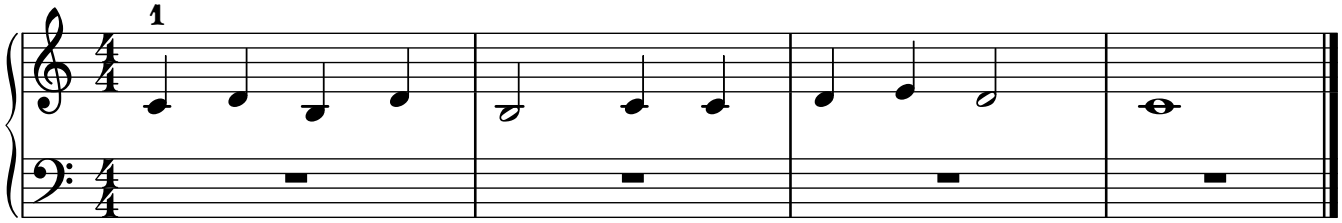
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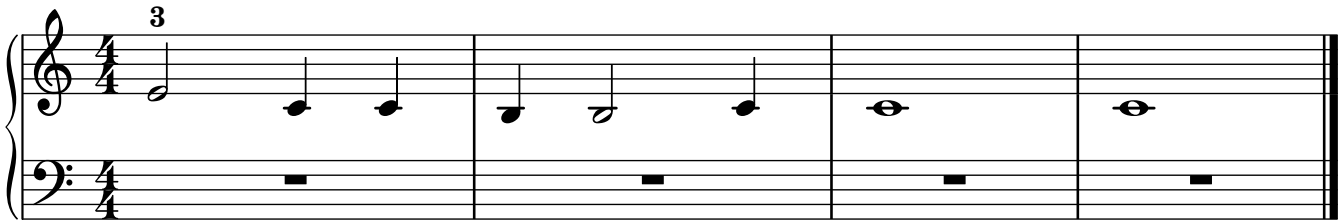
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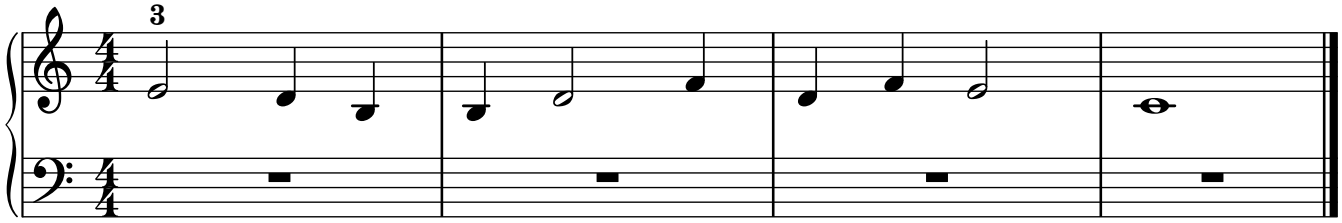
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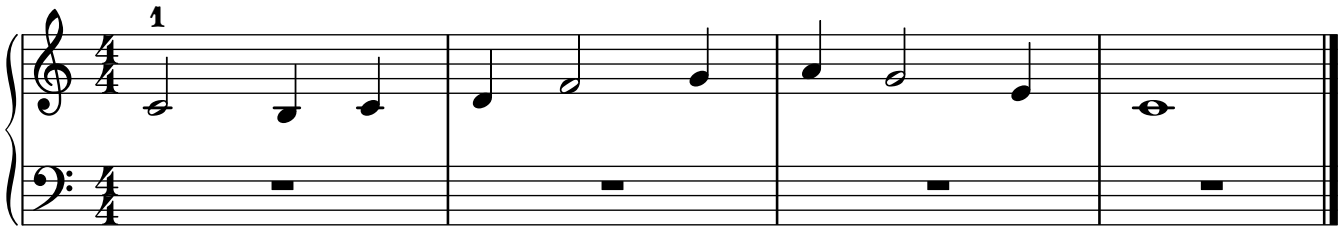
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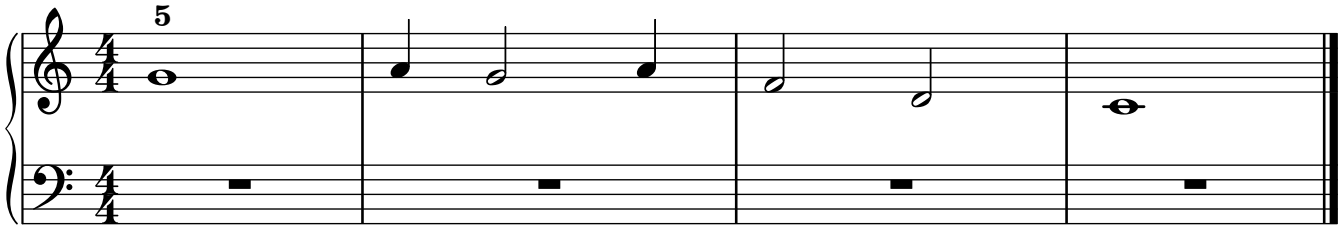


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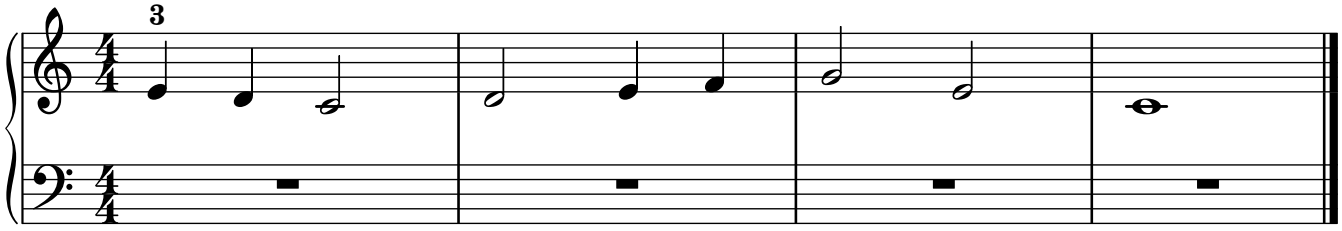
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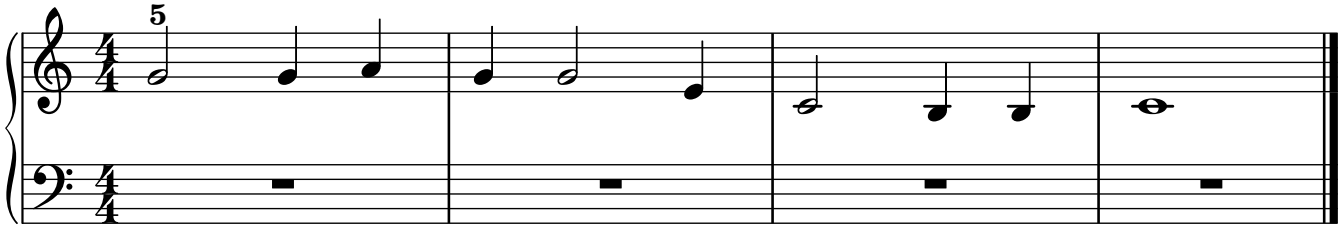
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☐ **2.9**



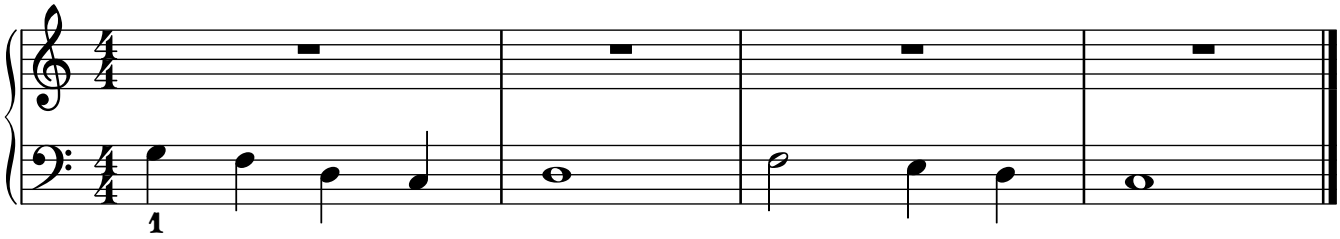
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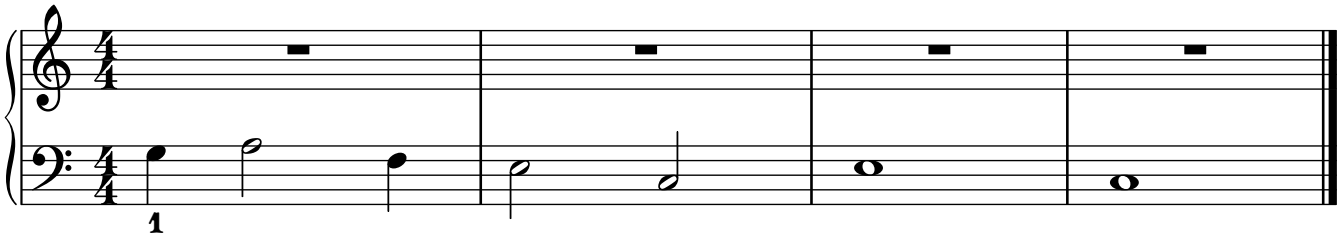
Part B: Left-hand stretches ♩ = 60

Left hand in C position, with stretches to B (finger 5) and A (thumb).

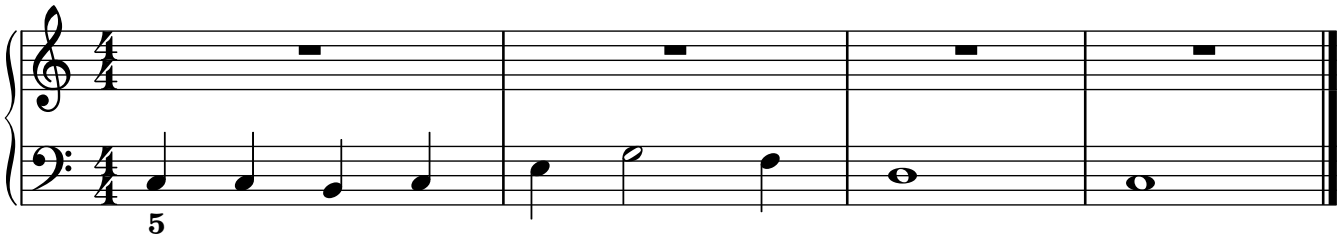
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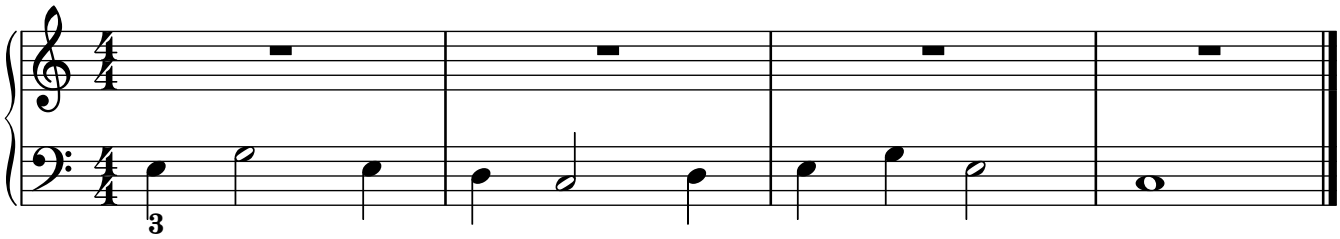
☐ **2.12**



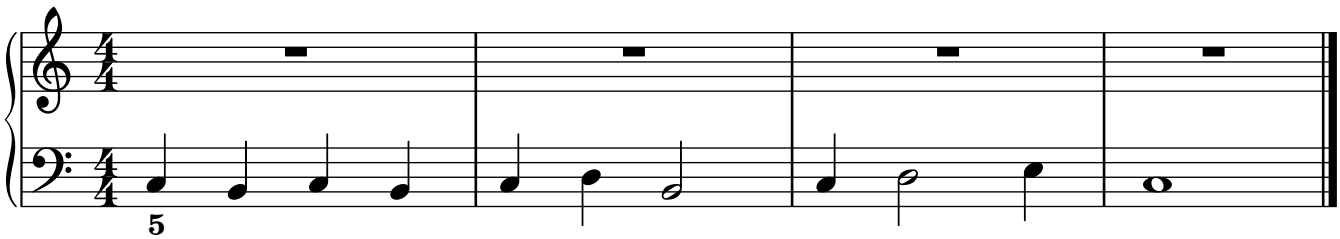
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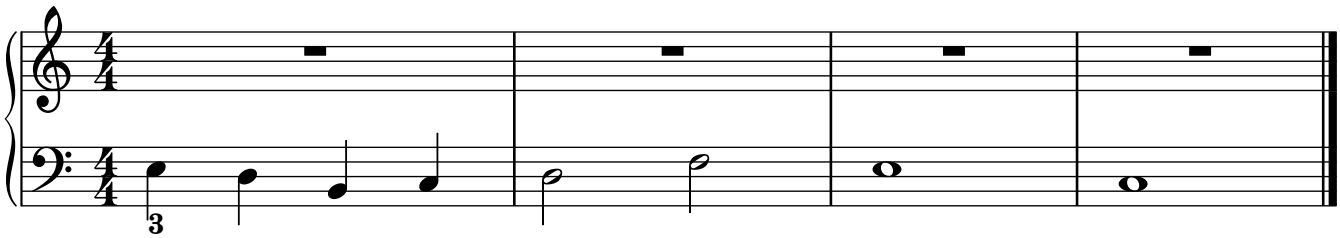
☐ **2.14**



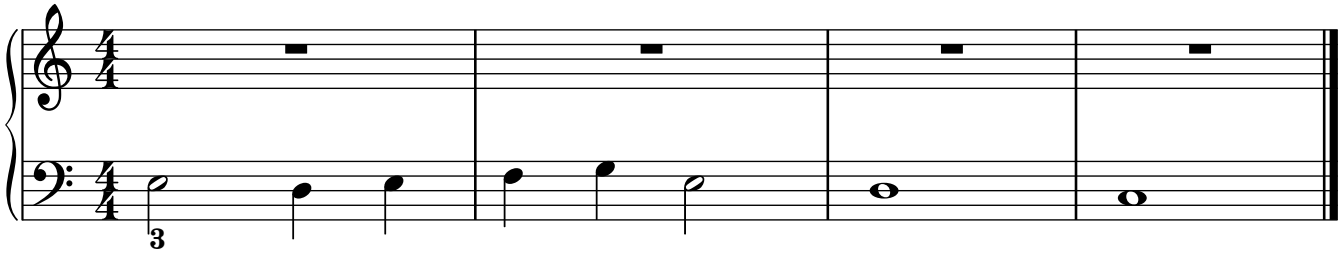
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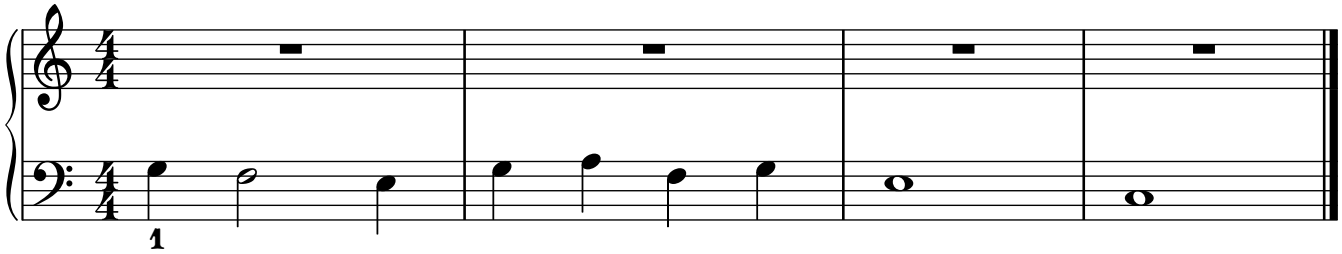
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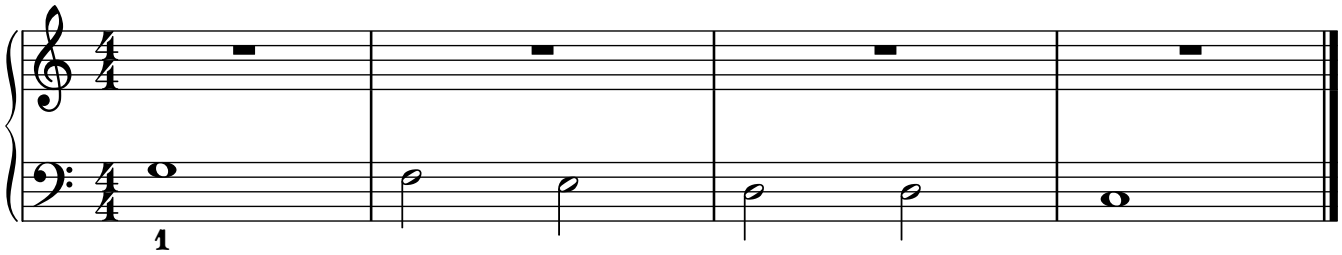
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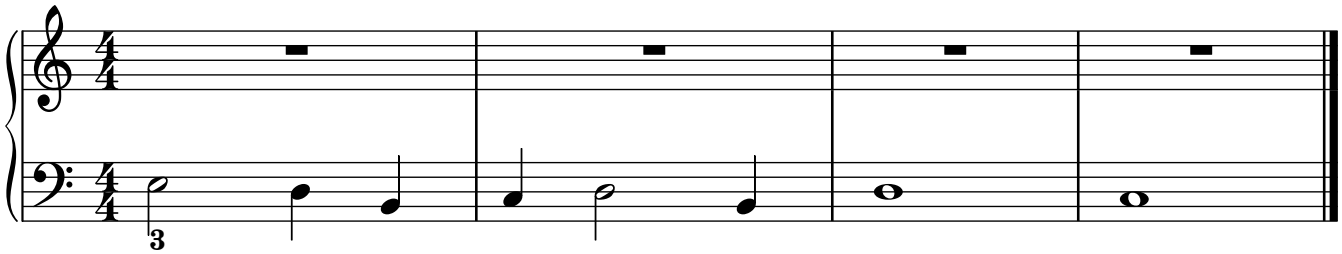
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☐ **2.19**
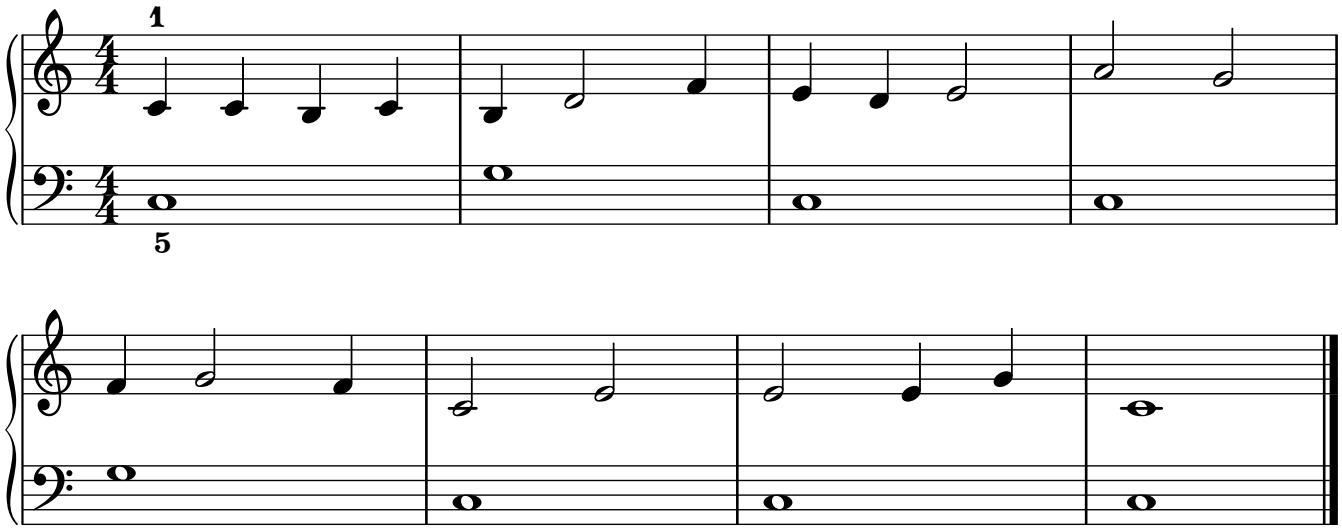


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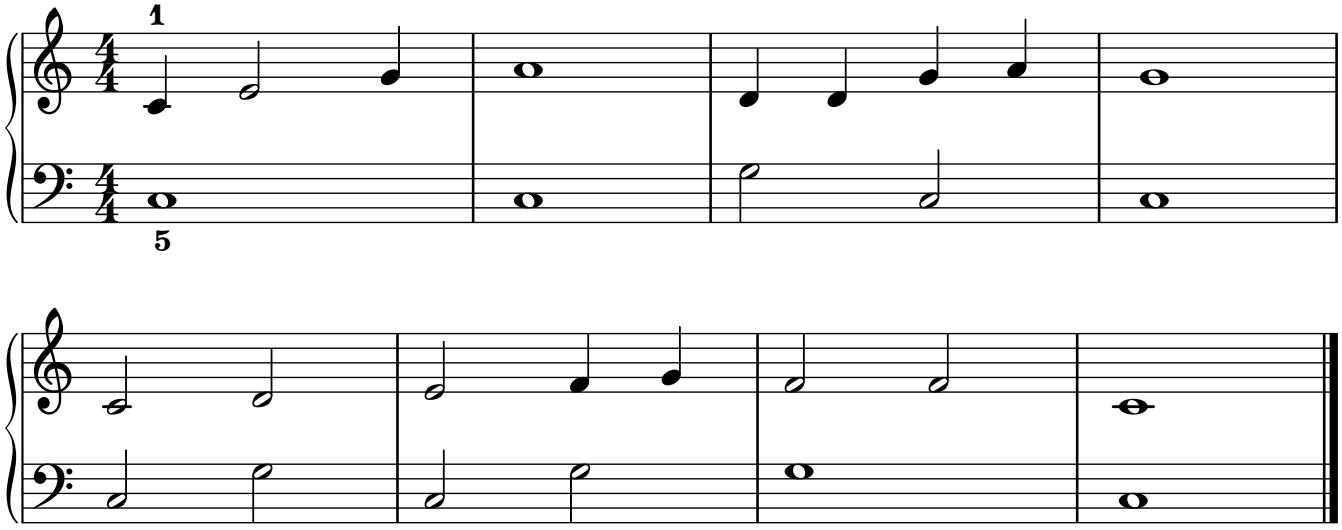


Part C: Stretches, hands together ♩ = 60

Hands together: stretches in the right hand, the bass on C or G.
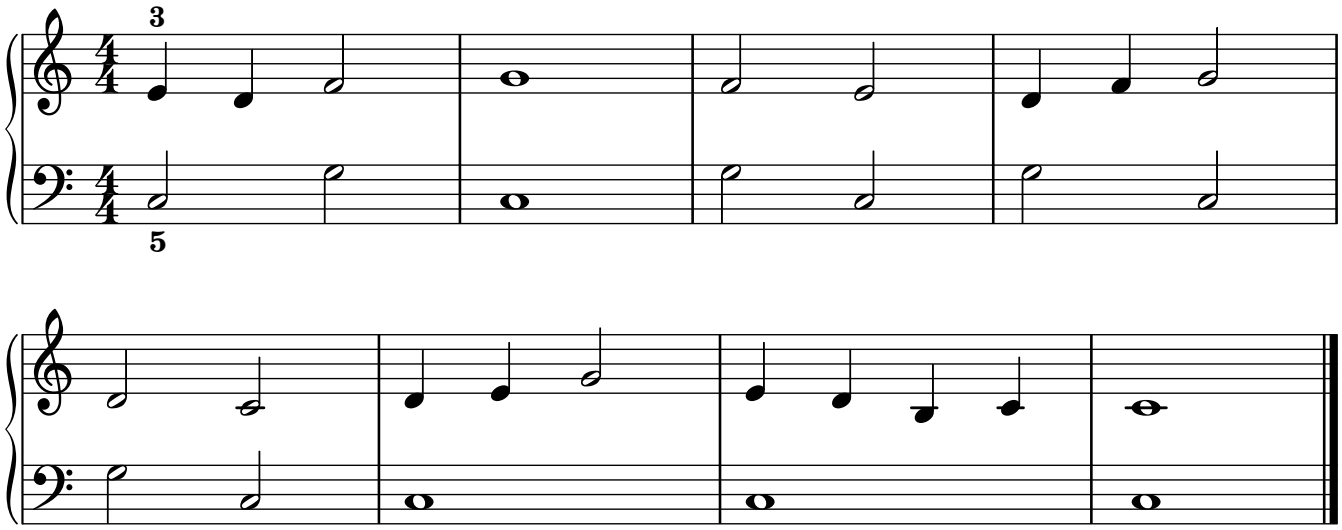
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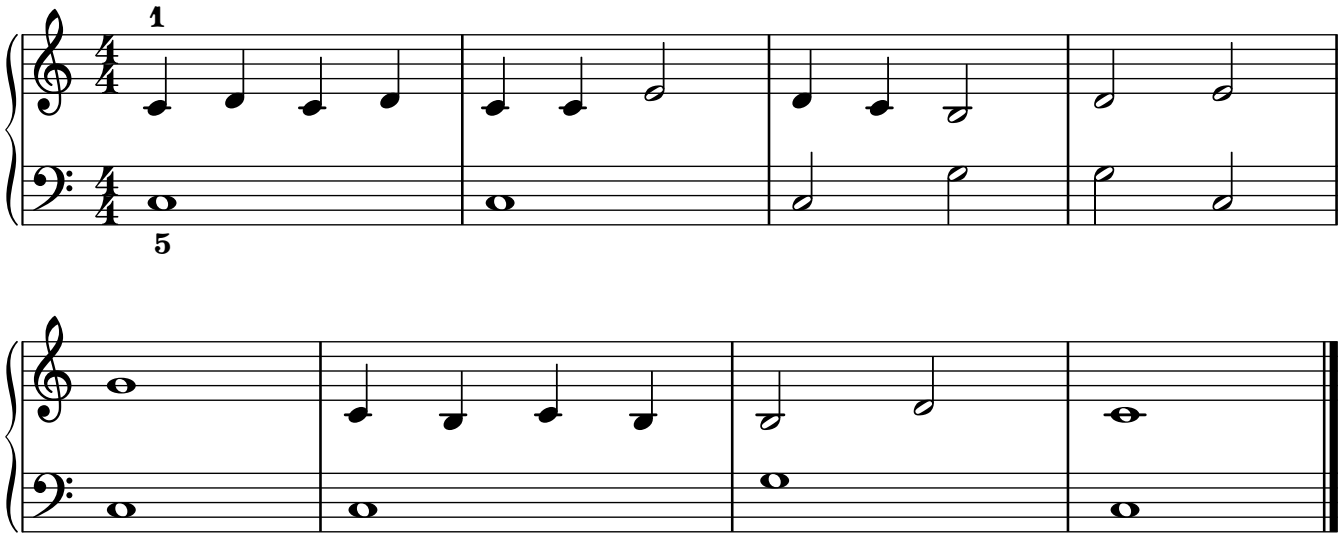


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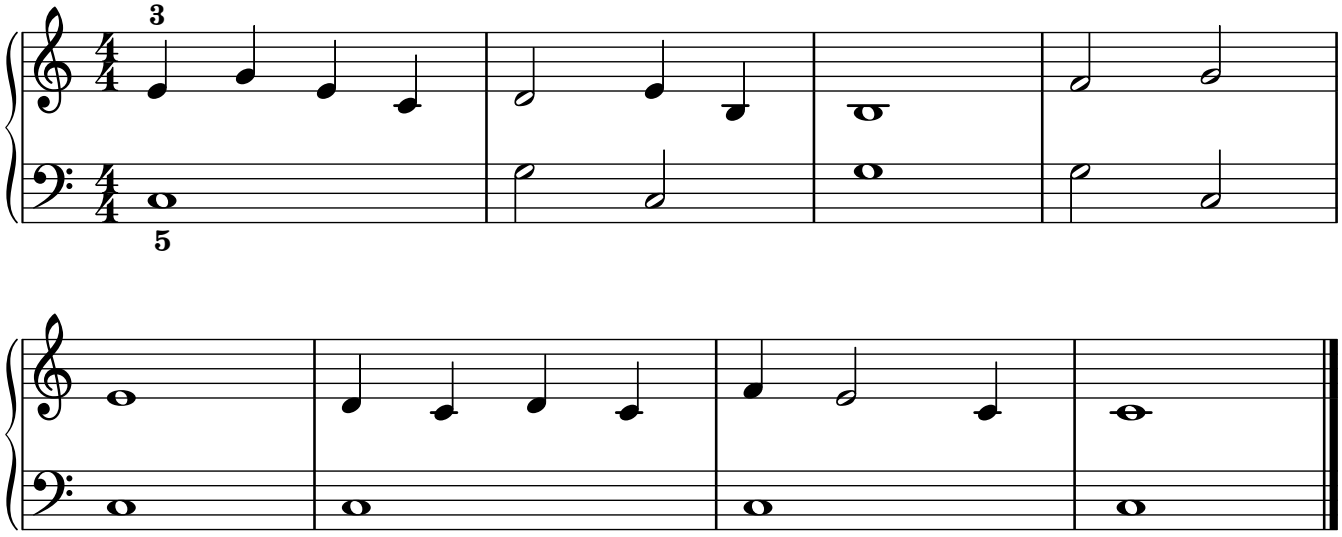
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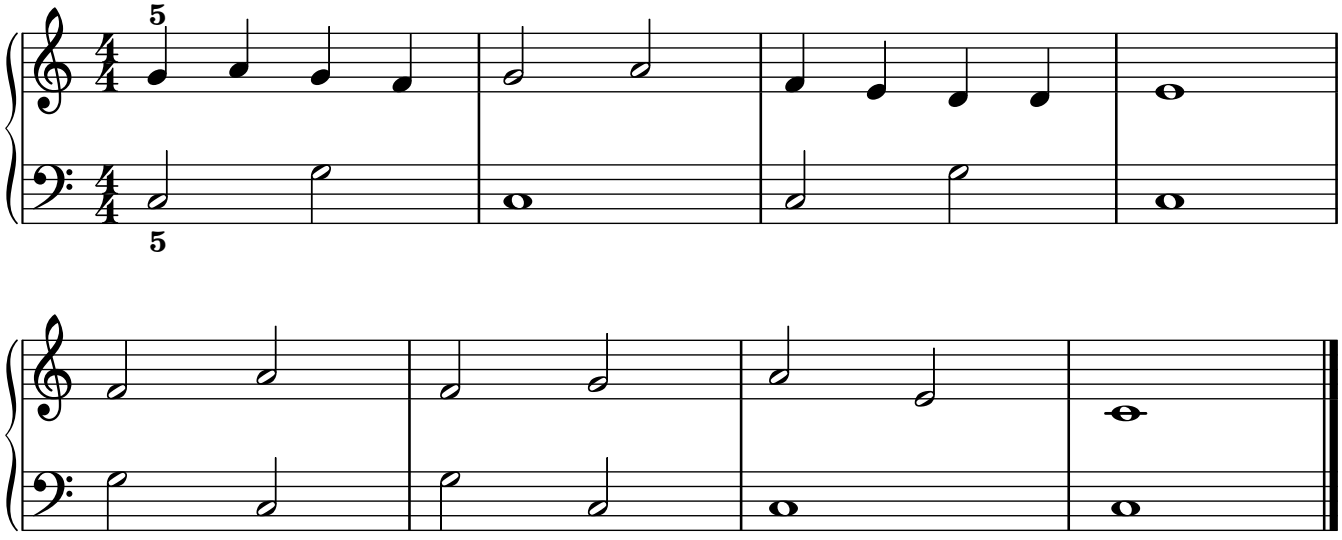


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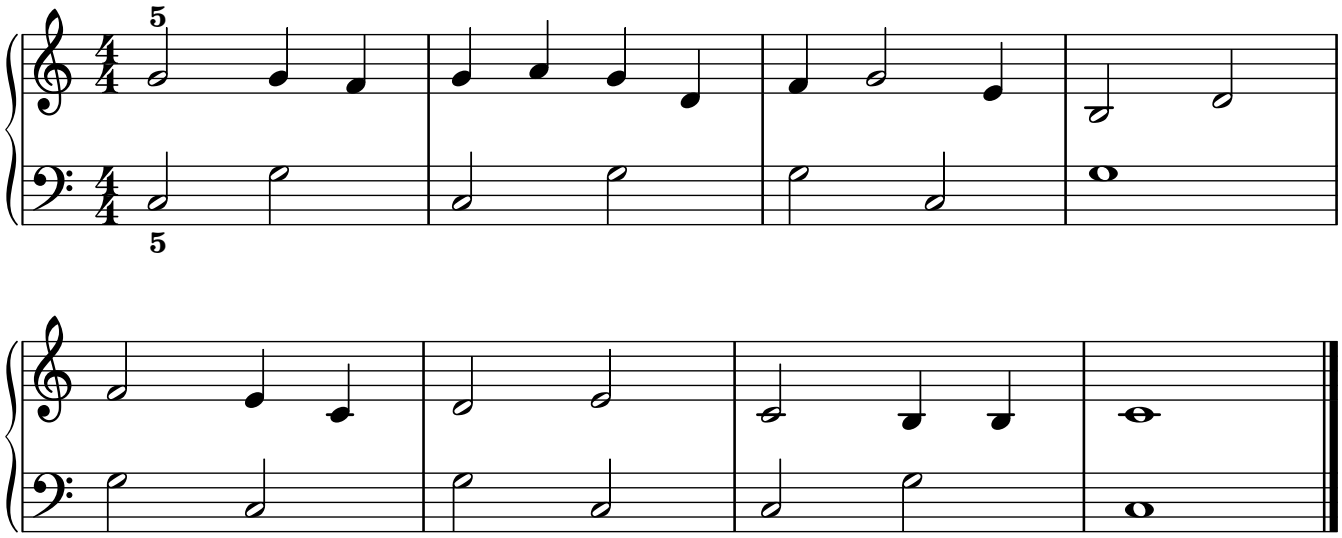


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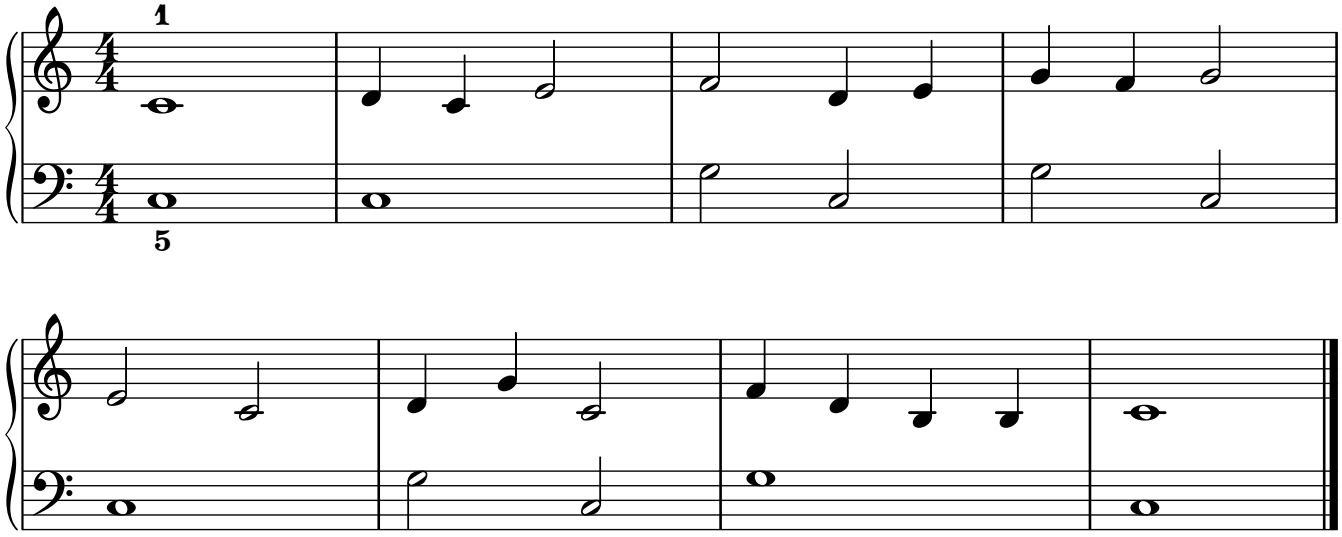


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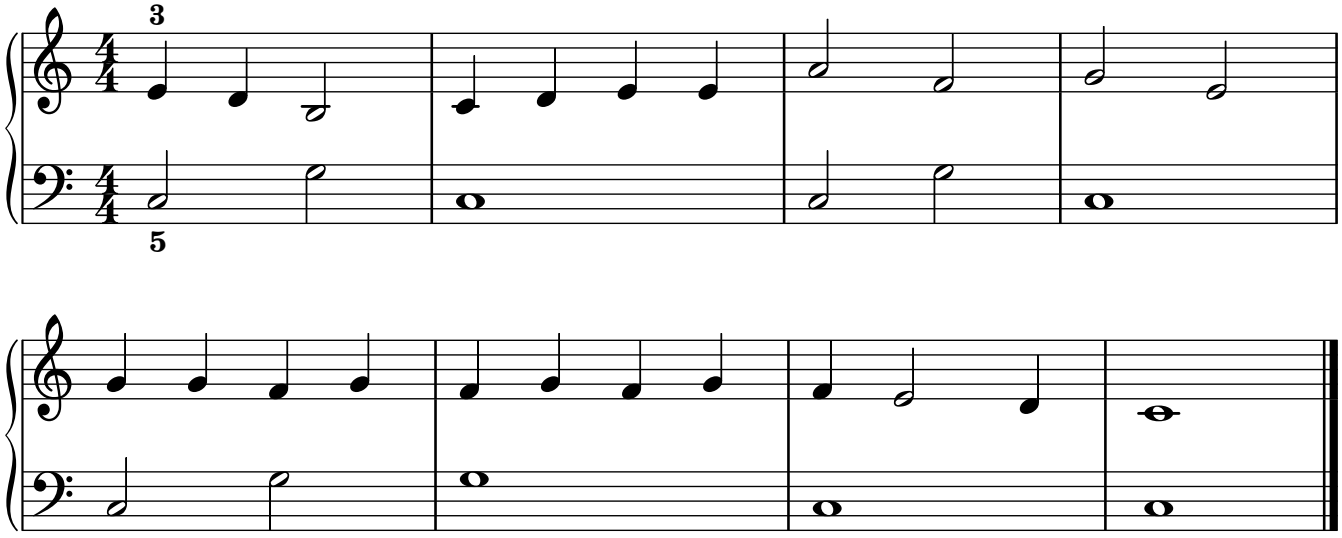


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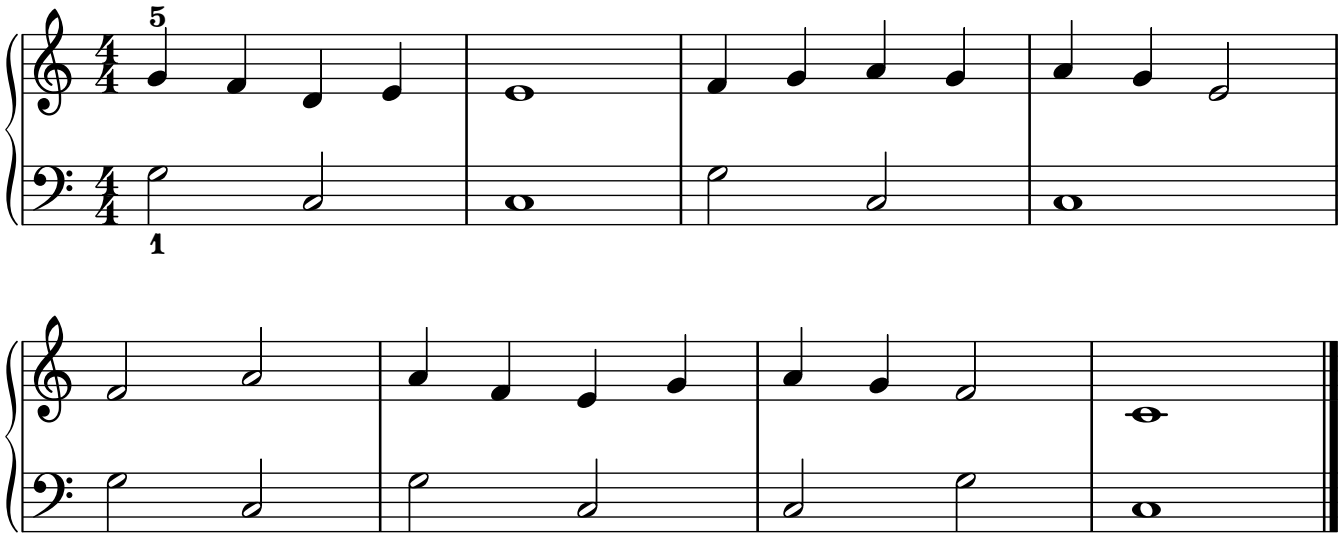


☐ **2.28**



☐ **2.29**



2.30
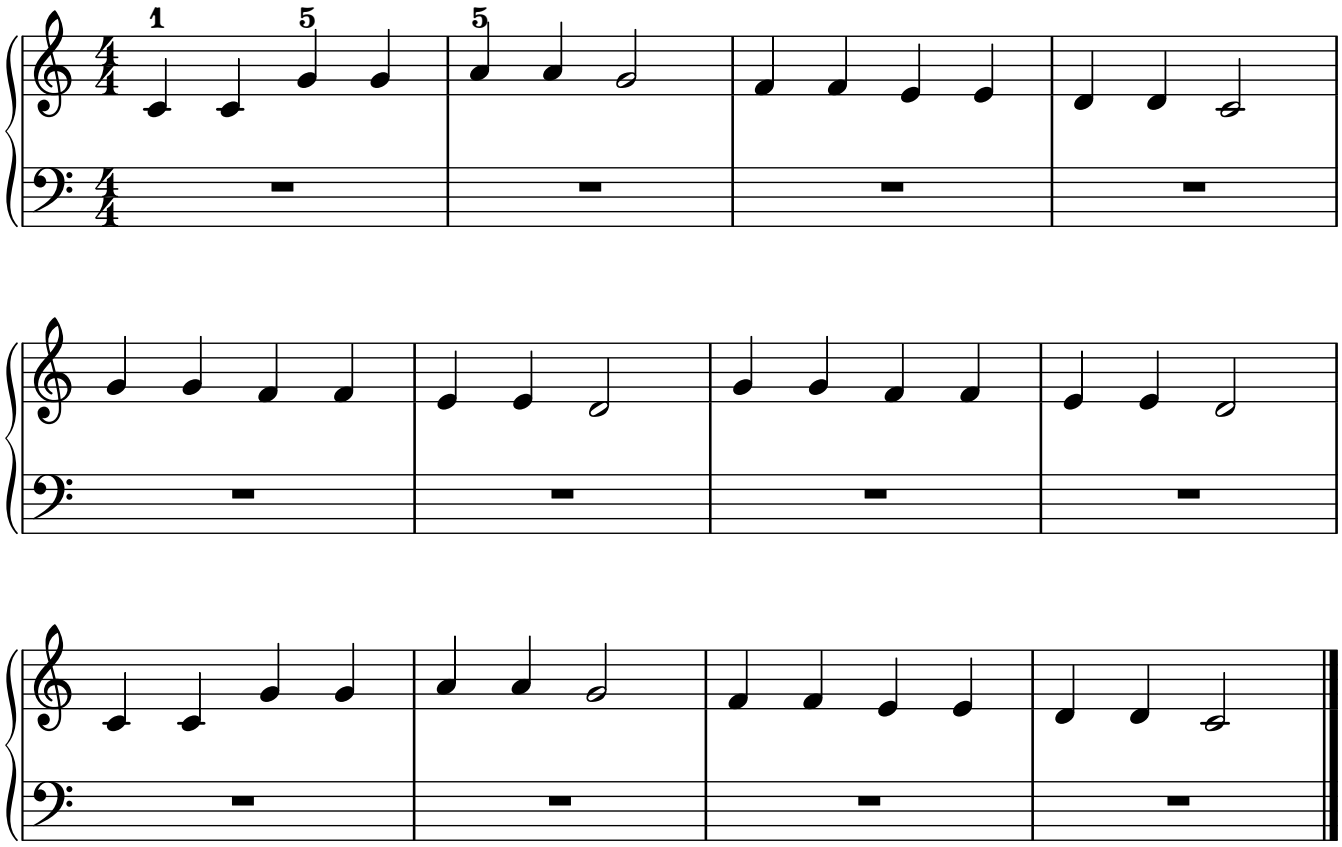


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star ♩ = 80

Traditional (French melody 'Ah! vous dirai-je, maman')
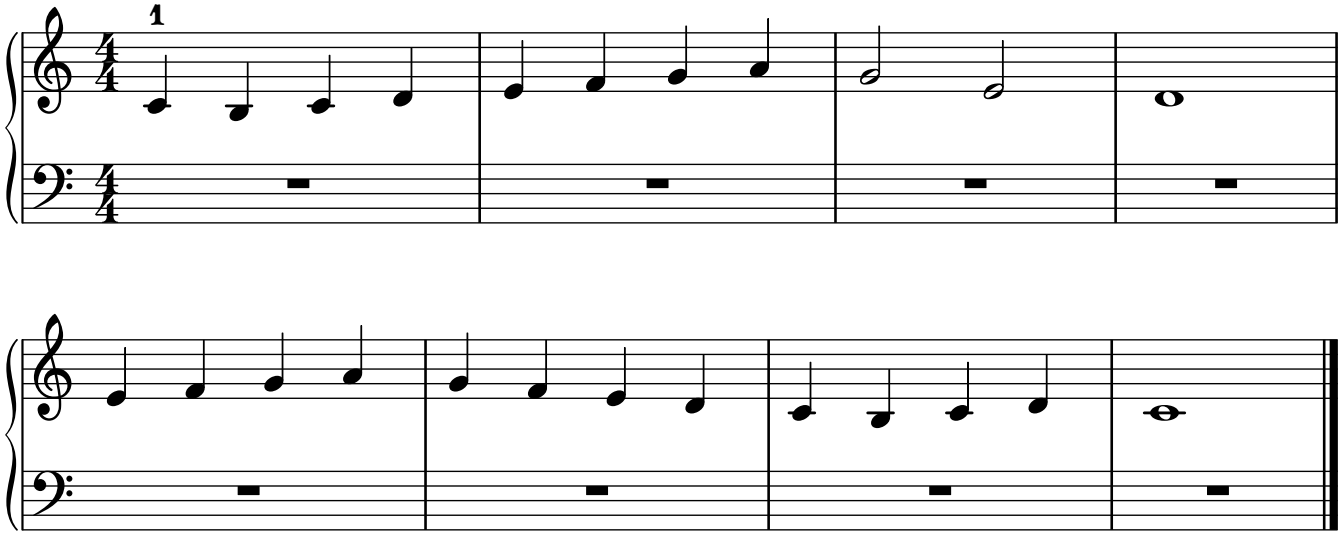
Finger 5 stretches up to A in bars 2 and 10, then comes straight back to G. Twelve bars on three lines.



Stretch and Return ♩ = 72

Original
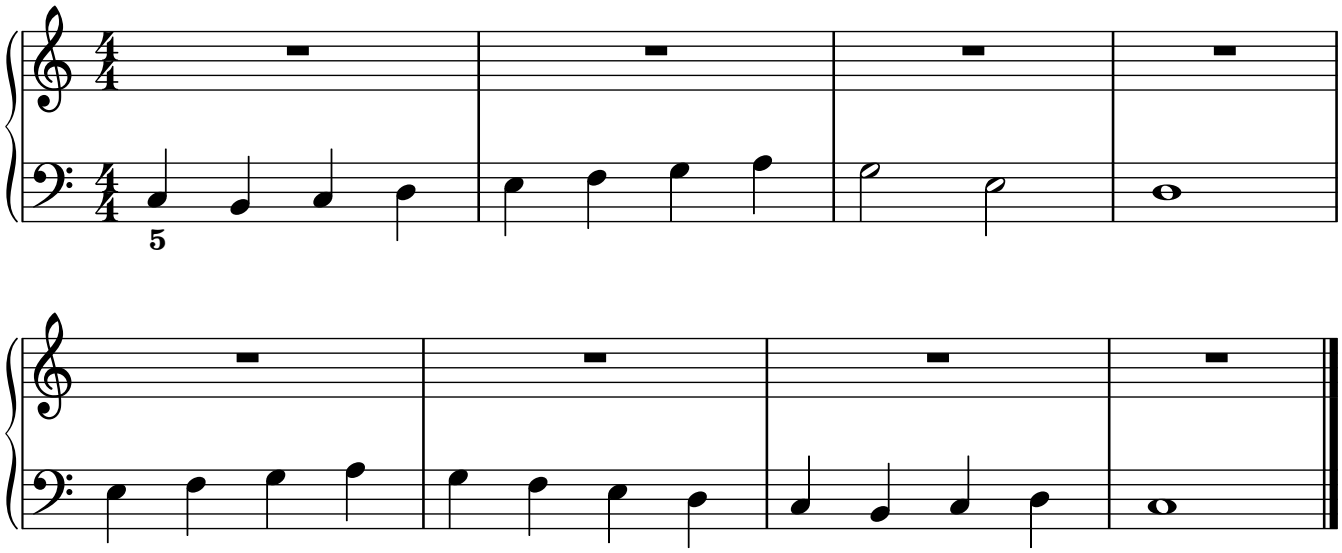
The thumb slides down to B in bars 1 and 7; finger 5 reaches up to A in bars 2 and 5.



Left-Hand Stretch ♩= 72

Original
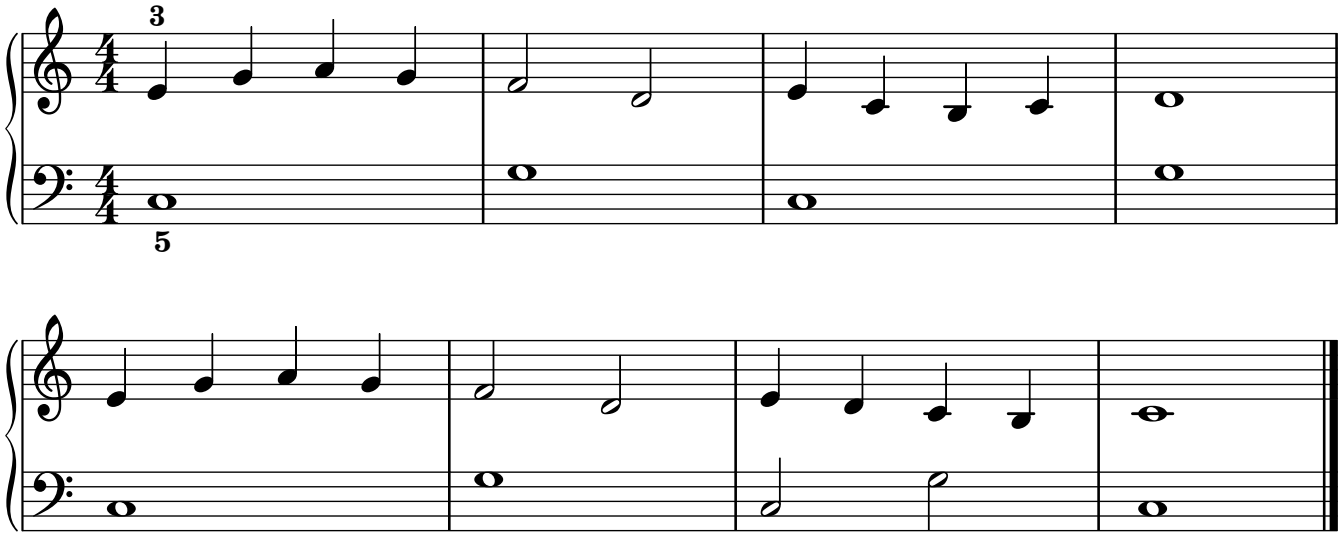
The same tune as 'Stretch and Return', one octave lower. Finger 5 reaches down to B; the thumb slides up to A.



Stretching Together ♩= 72

Original

Hands together. The right hand stretches up to A in bars 1 and 5 and down to B in bars 3 and 7.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 3?

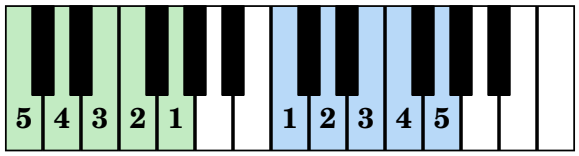
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if the stretch notes come in time and the hand returns to its position afterwards.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 3.

Unit 3

Dotted Quarter Notes

New: The dotted quarter note followed by an eighth: 'long-short'

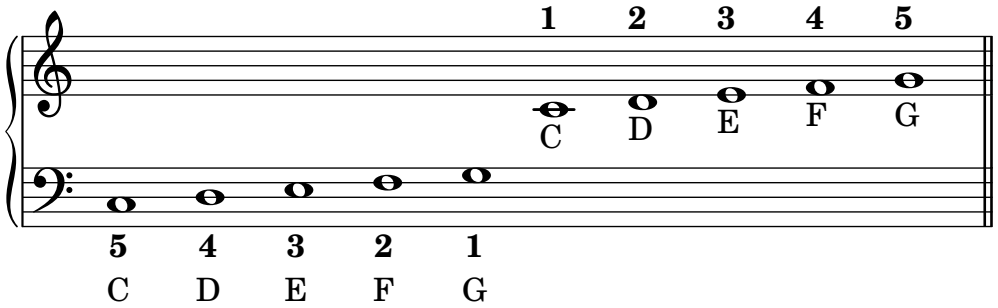
A dot after a note adds half of its value. You already know the dotted half note (3 beats). Now meet the dotted quarter note: one and a half beats, almost always followed by a single eighth note that completes the second beat.



Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

The dotted quarter

A quarter note (1 beat) plus its dot (half a beat) makes one and a half beats.

Long-short

A dotted quarter and an eighth together fill two beats. Count '1 and 2 and': the dotted quarter lasts through '1 and 2', and the eighth comes on the second 'and'.

How it sounds

A lilting long-short, like the end of the first line of 'Ode to Joy'.

Reading tips

1. When you scan, count in eighths ('1 and 2 and') and notice that the dotted quarter covers '1 and 2'.

2. Don't shorten the dotted quarter. The eighth comes late, just before the next beat.

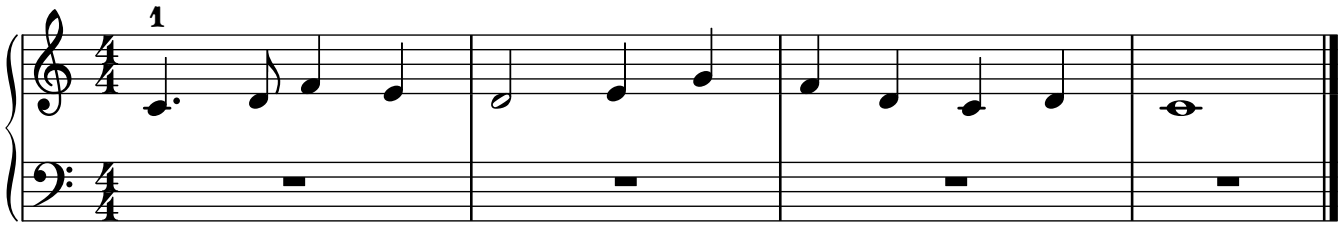
3. A dotted quarter in the middle of a bar crosses a beat. Keep counting through it.

4. Use the metronome, and keep it slow.

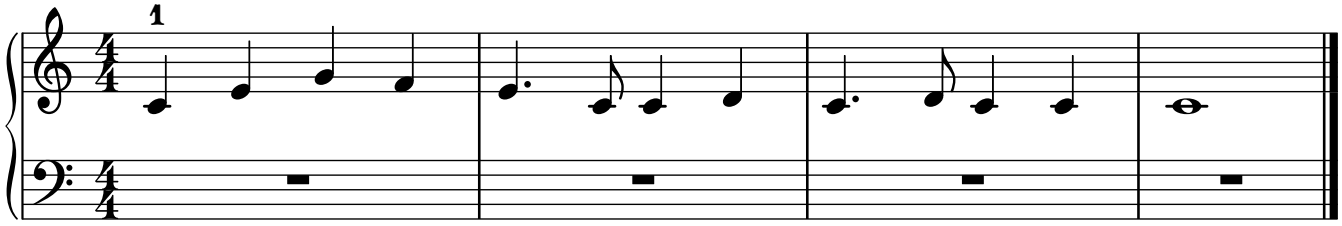
Part A: Dotted rhythms, right hand ♩ = 60

Dotted quarter and eighth patterns in the right hand. Metronome 60.

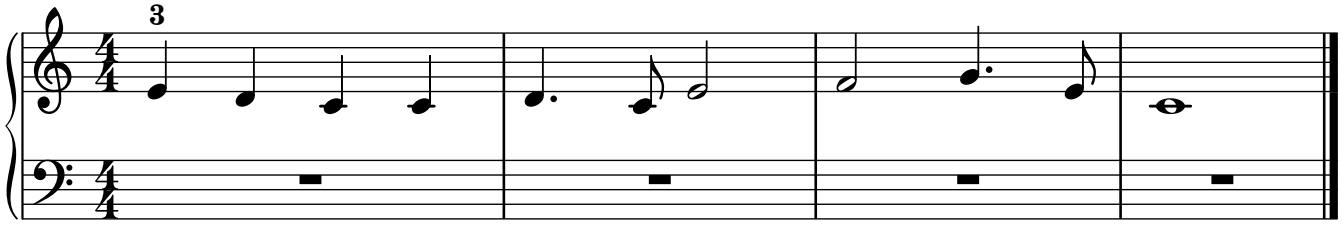
☐ **3.1**



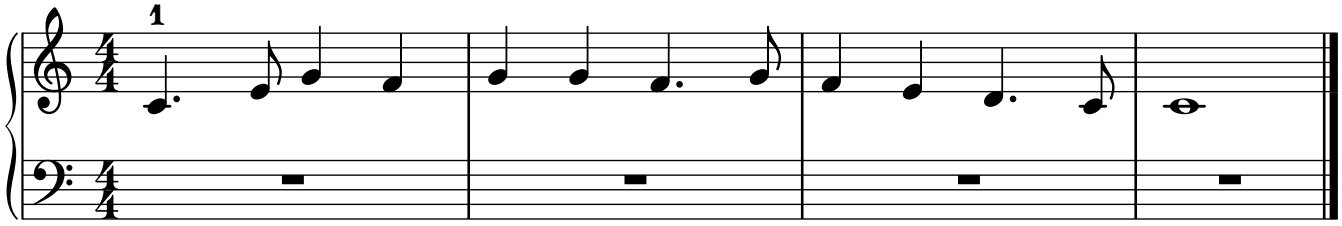
☐ **3.2**



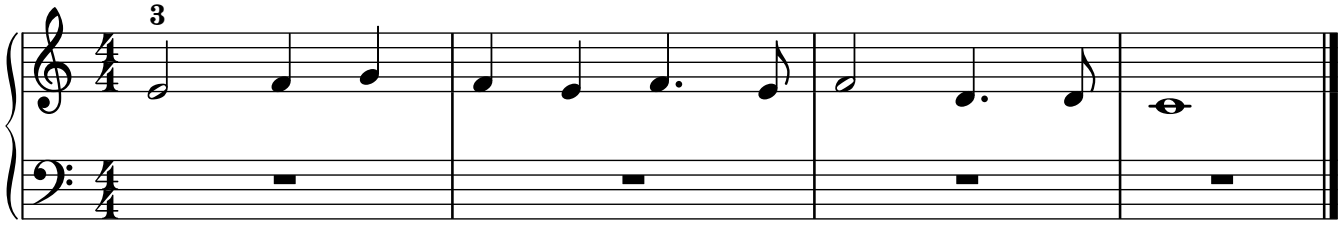
☐ **3.3**



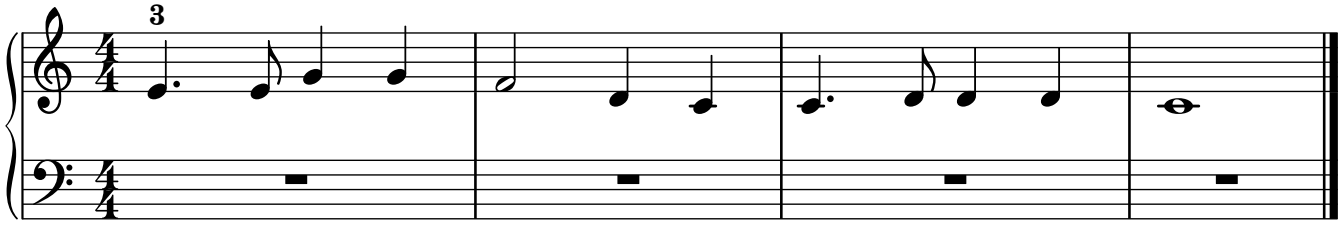
☐ **3.4**



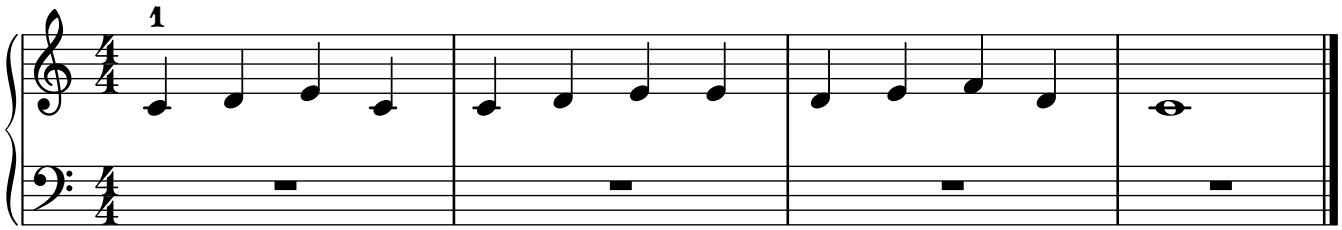
☐ **3.5**



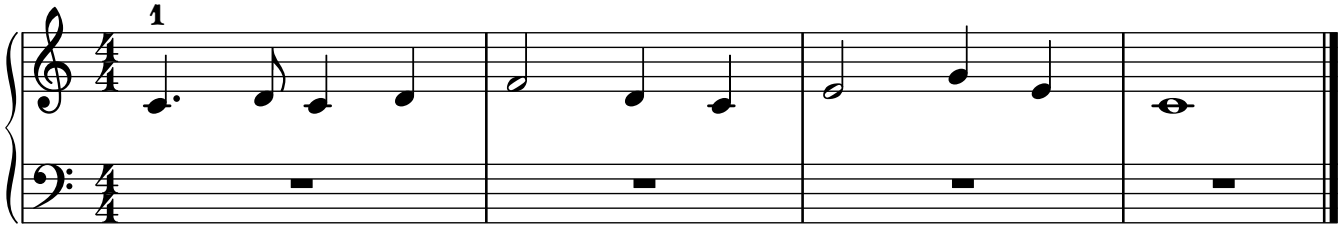
☐ **3.6**



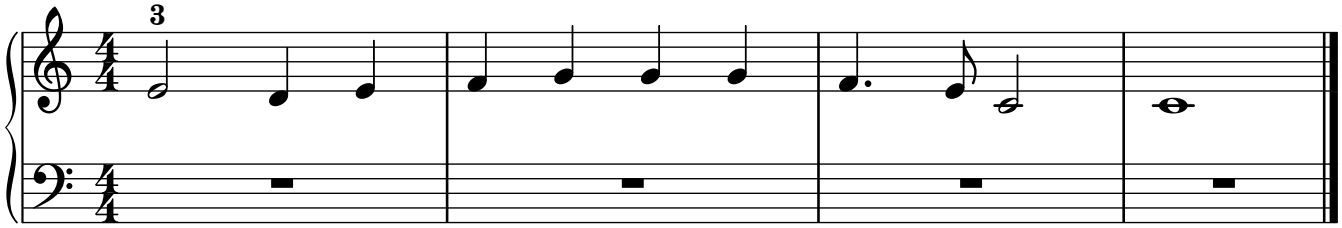
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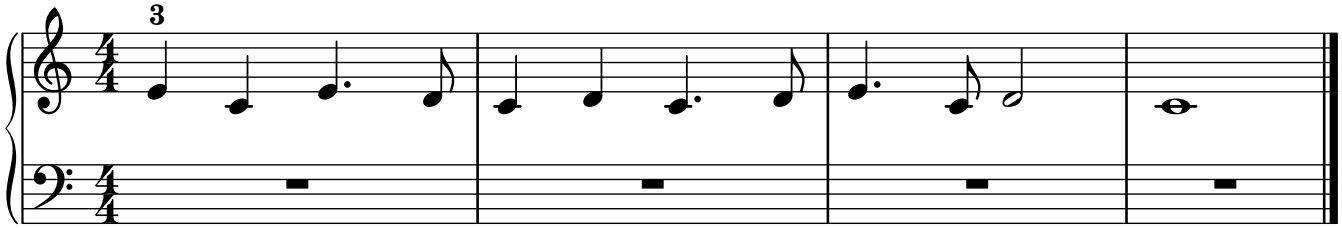
☐ **3.8**



☐ **3.9**



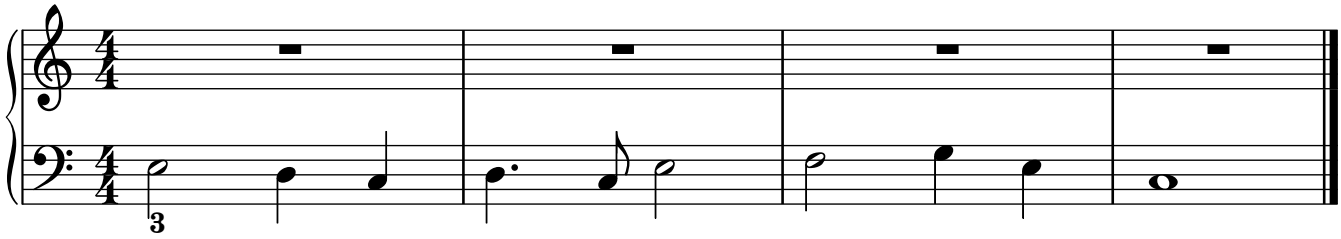
☐ **3.10**



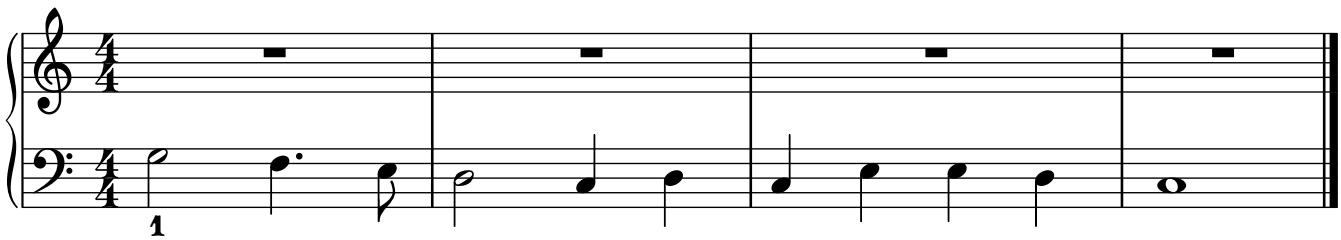
Part B: Dotted rhythms, left hand ♩ = 60

The same rhythms in the left hand.

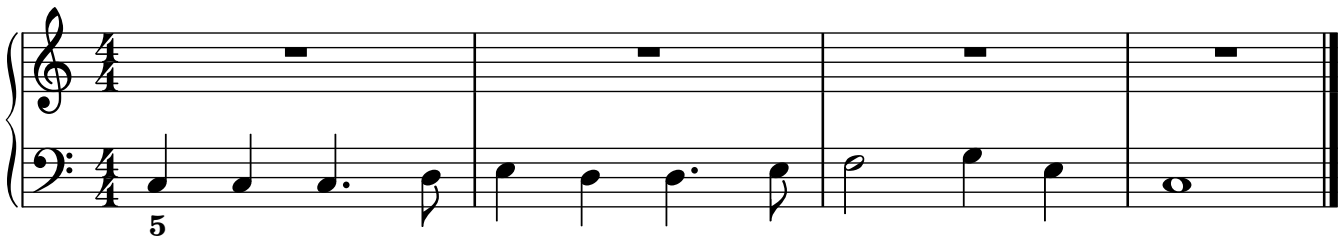
☐ **3.11**



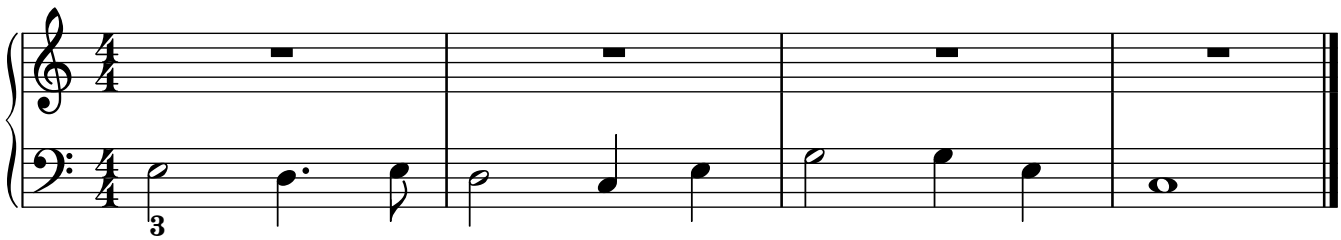
☐ **3.12**



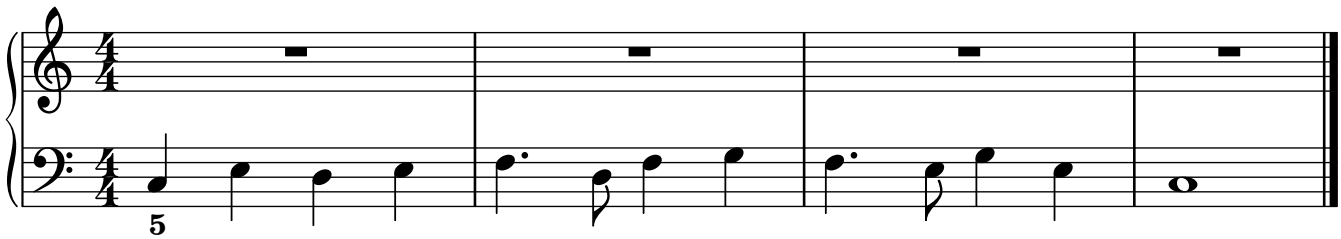
☐ **3.13**



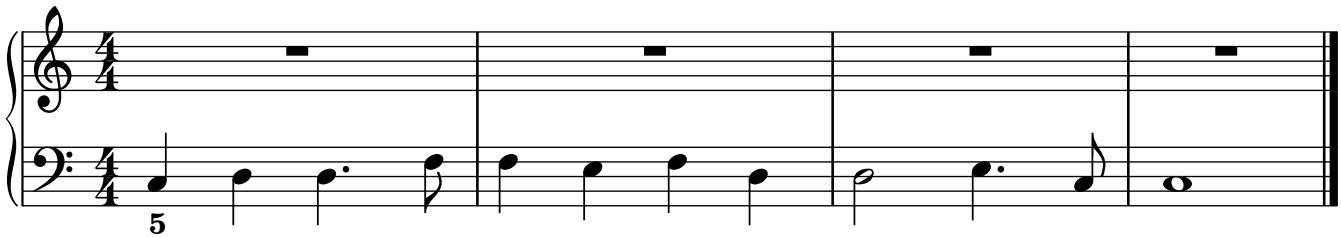
☐ **3.14**



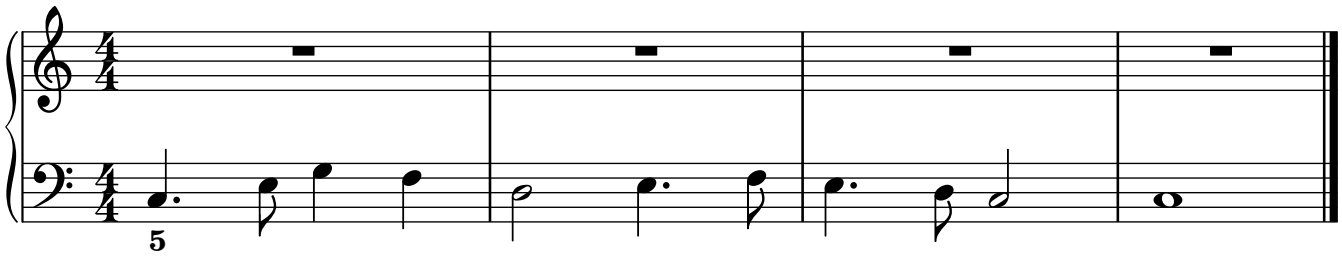
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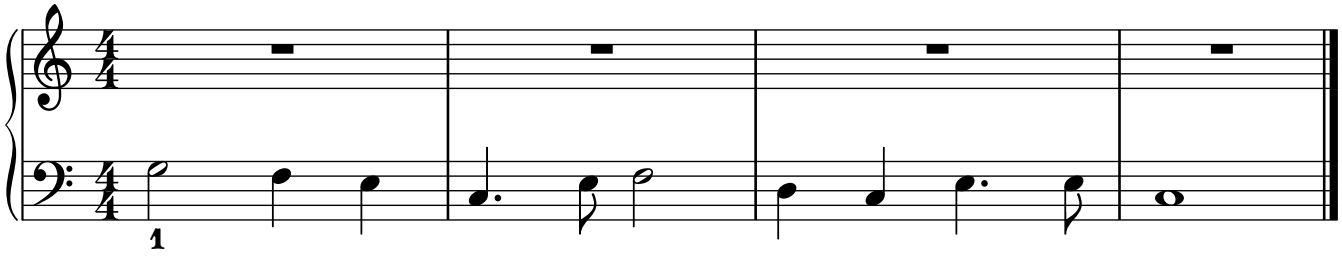
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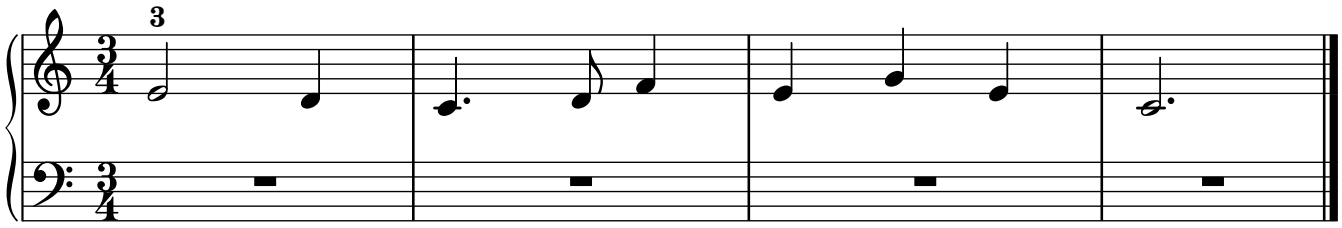


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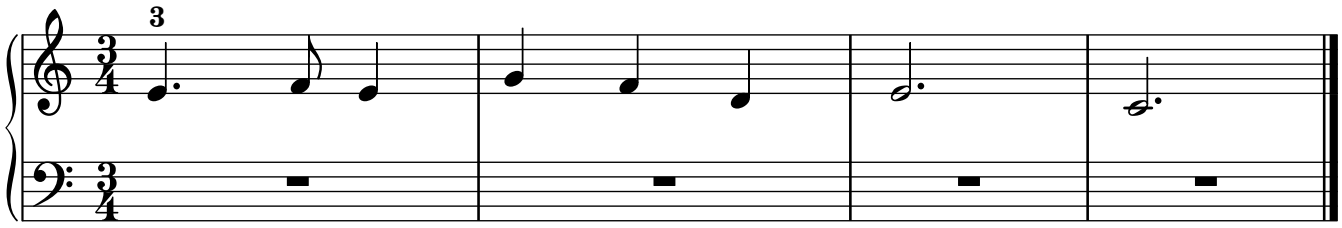
Part C: Dotted rhythms in 3/4 ♩ = 72

Dotted rhythms in 3/4.

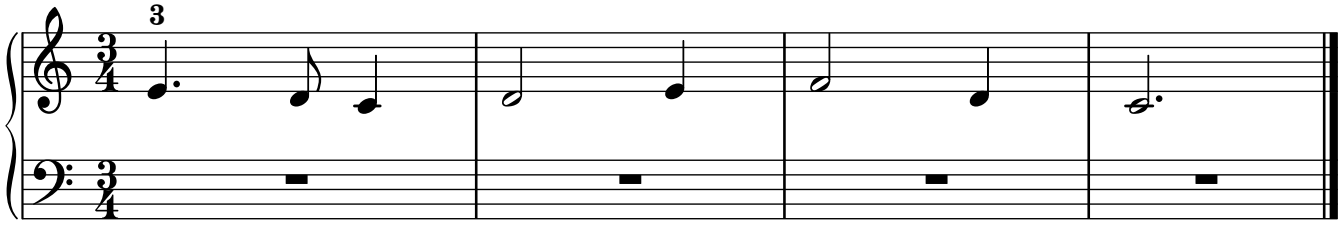
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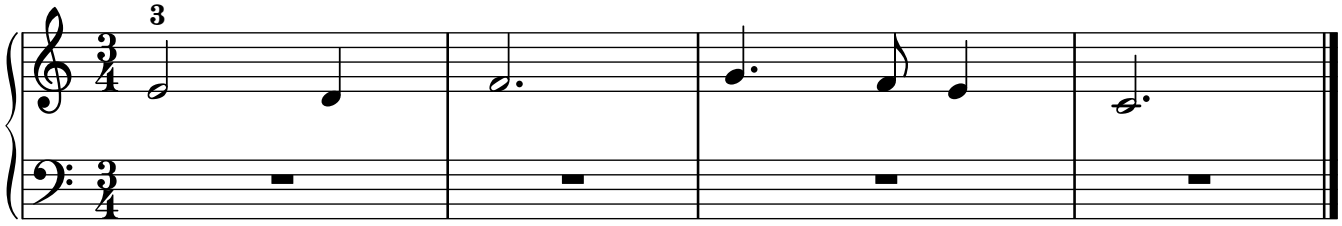
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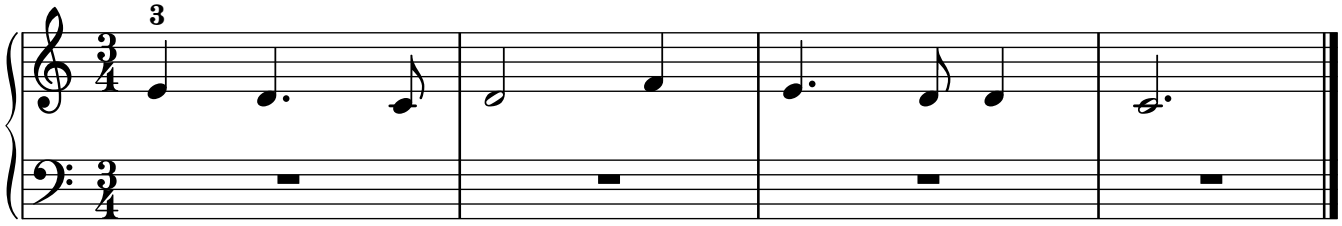
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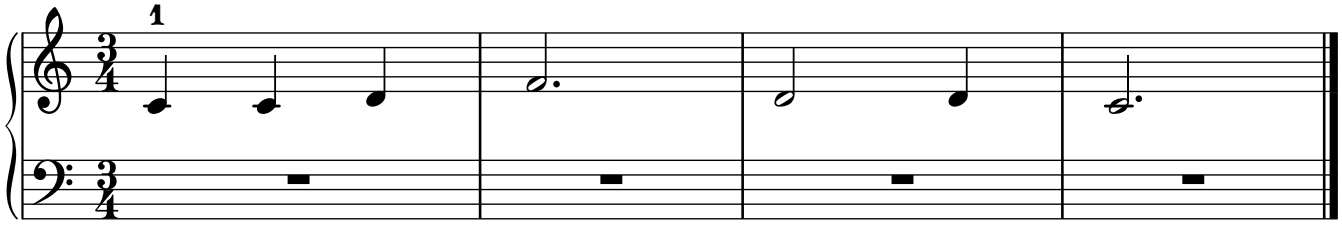
☐ **3.22**



☐ **3.23**
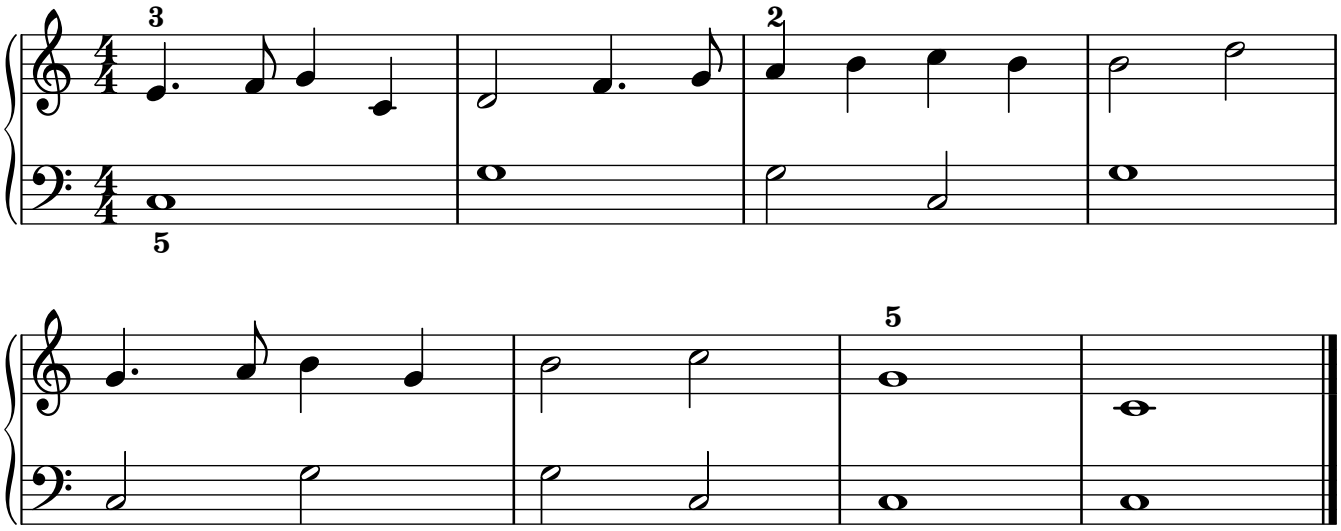


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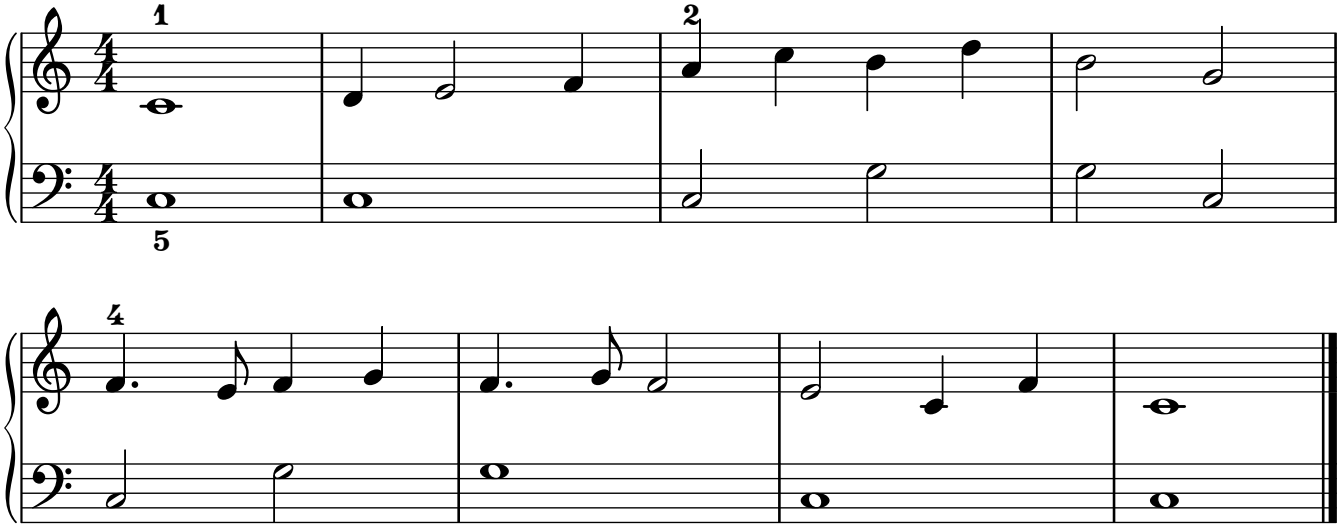
Part D: Hands together, with shifts ♩= 60

Hands together, with the right hand moving between C and G positions.
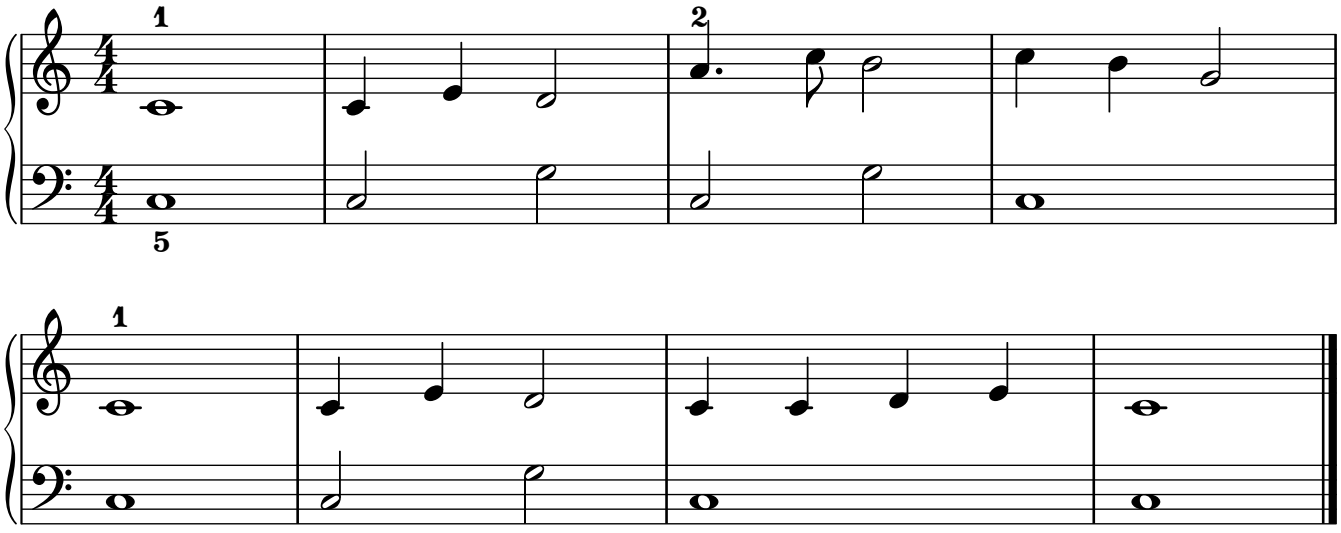
☐ **3.25**
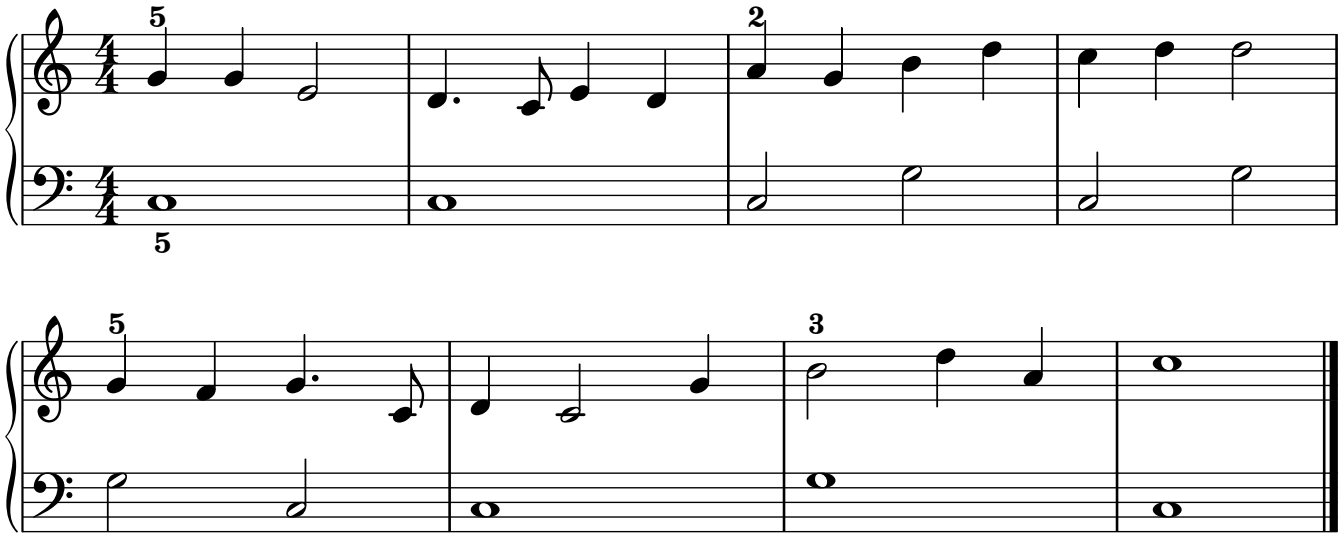


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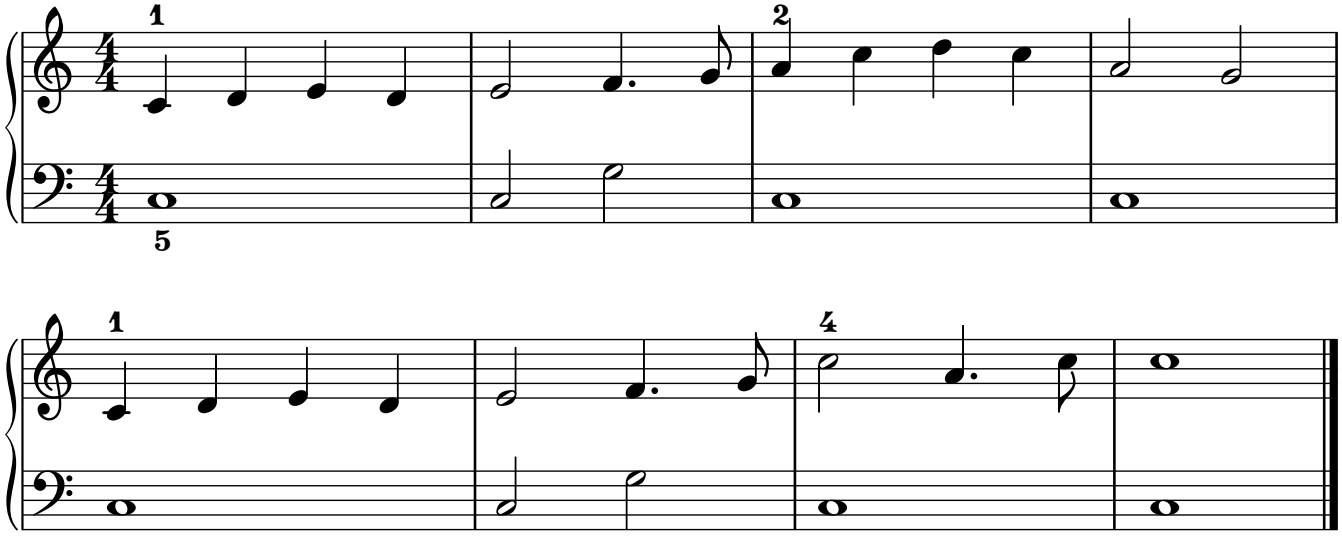


☐ **3.27**
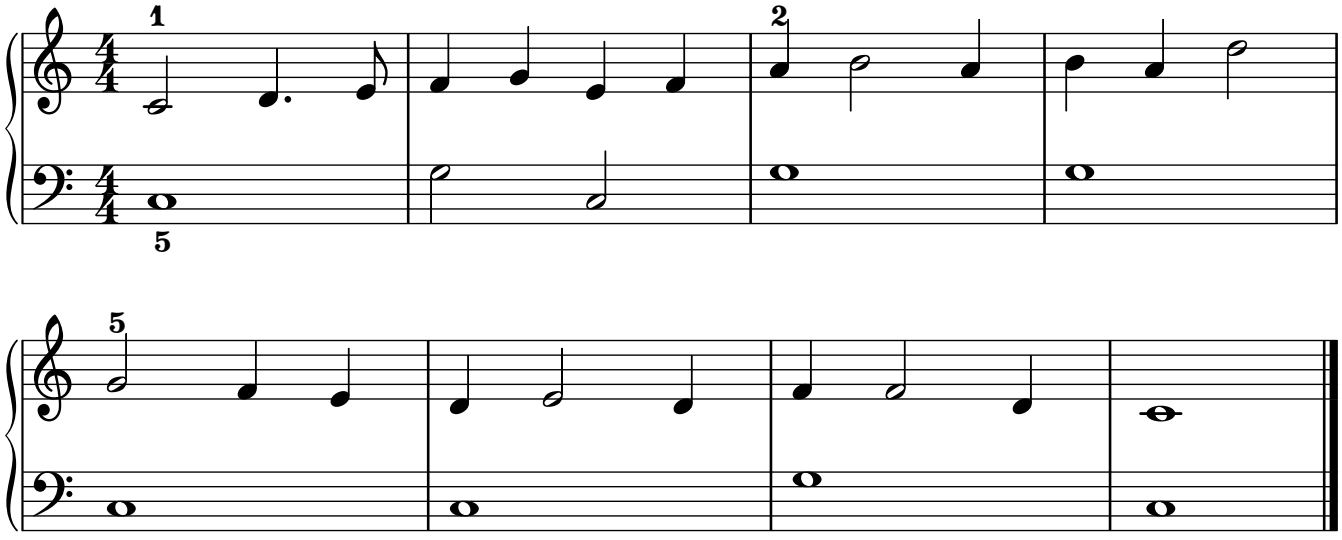


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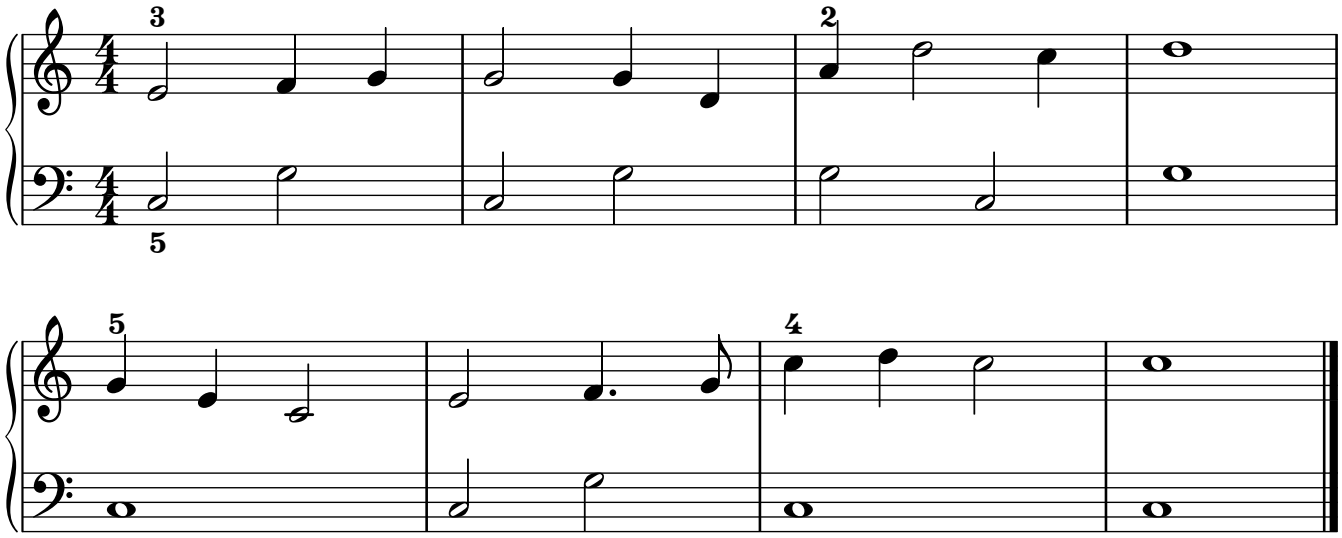


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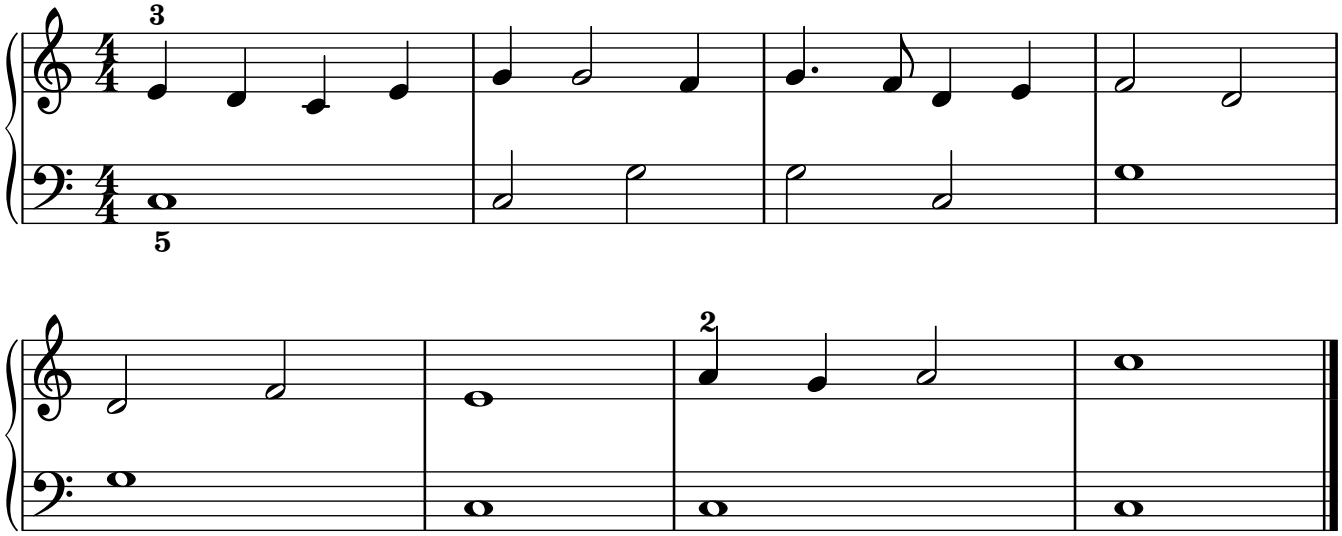


3.30



3.31



3.32
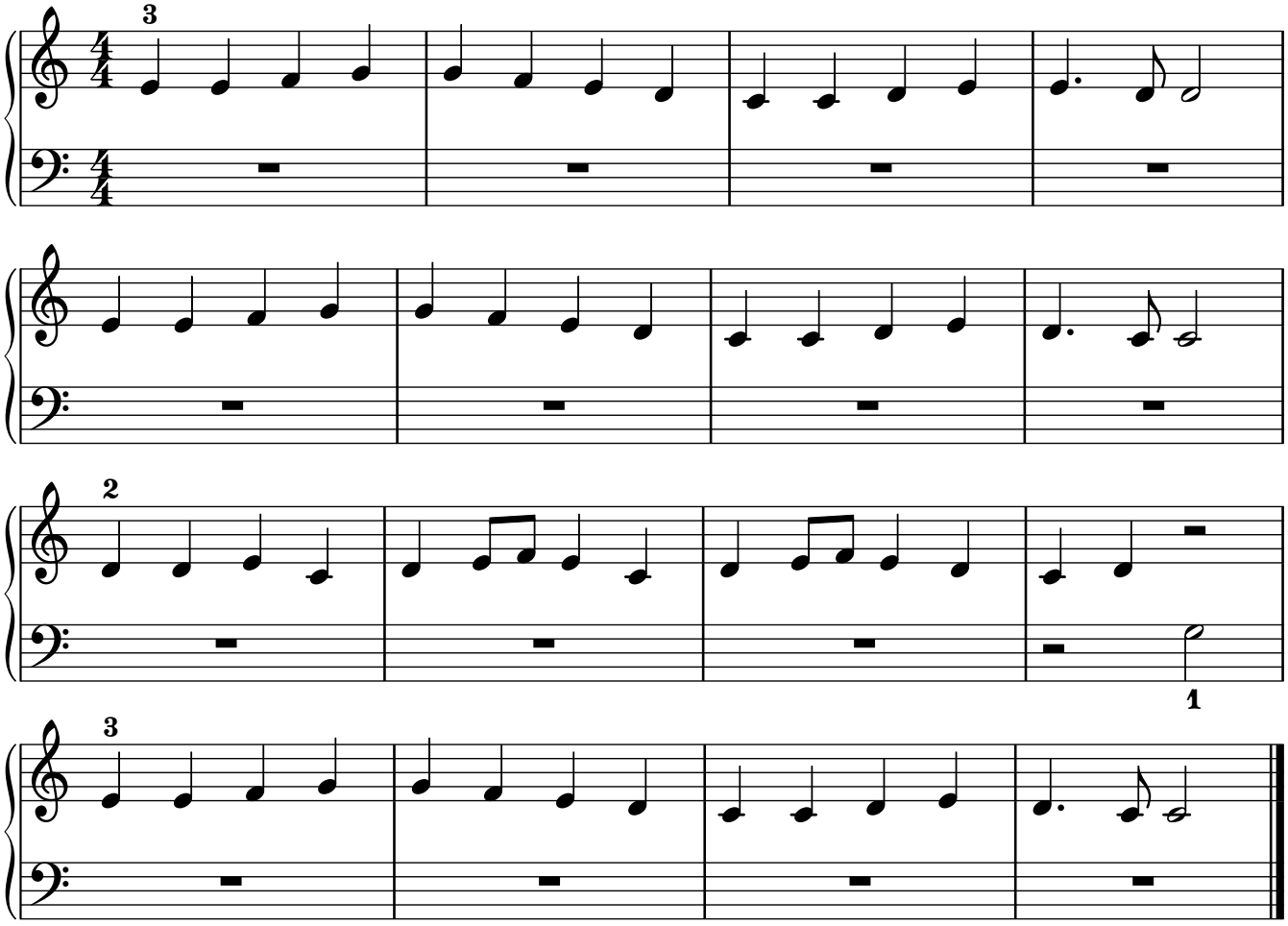


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Ode to Joy (real rhythm) ♩ = 80

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824)
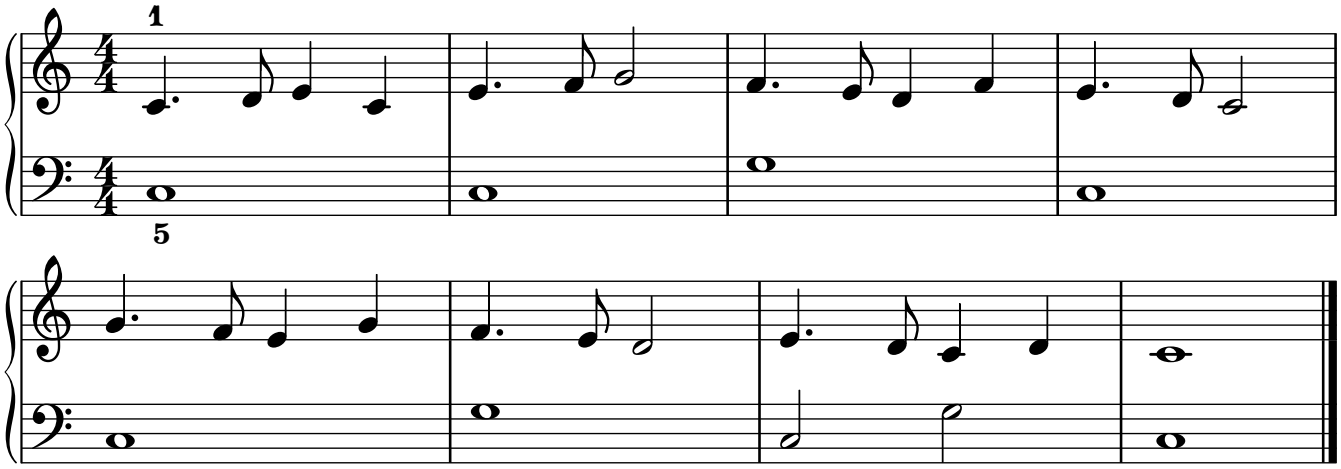
Now in its real rhythm, with the middle section. Bars 4, 8 and 16 have the dotted quarter. In bar 12 the left hand plays the low G with its thumb.



Dotted March ♩ = 76

Original
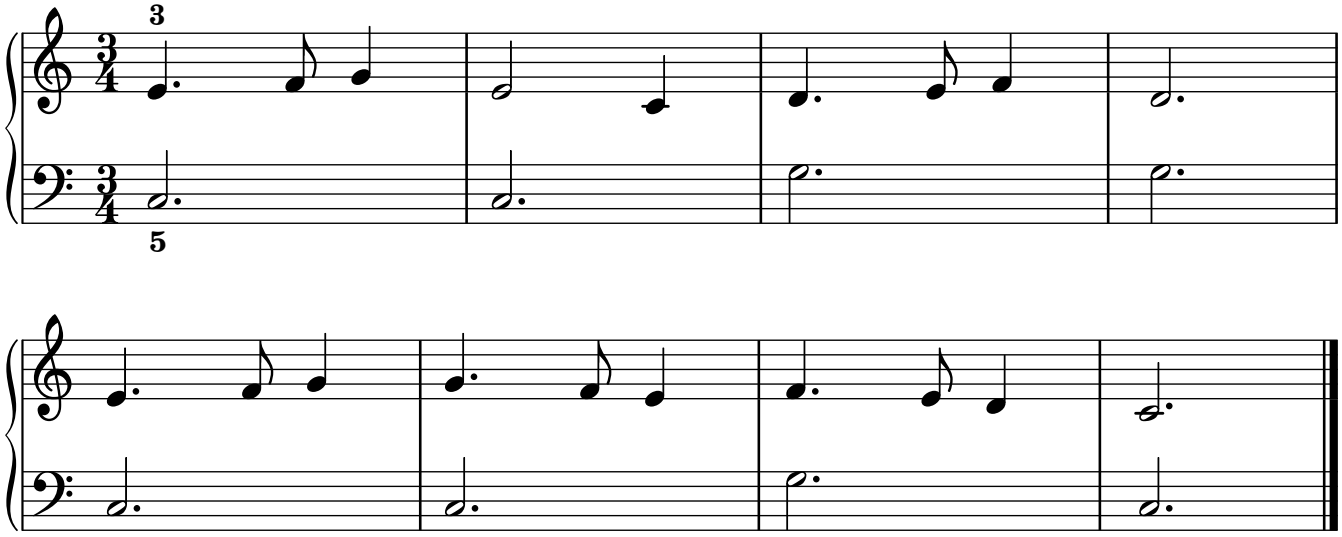
Every bar starts with long-short. March steadily, and give each dotted quarter its full length.



Waltz with a Dot ♩ = 80

Original

In 3/4 the long-short falls on beats 1 and 2. Count '1 and 2 and 3 and'.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

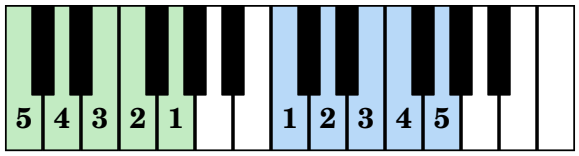
- Play five Part D exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if every dotted quarter is held for its full length and the eighth after it is not rushed.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4.

Unit 4

Legato and Staccato

New: Slurs (smooth and connected) and staccato dots (short and detached)

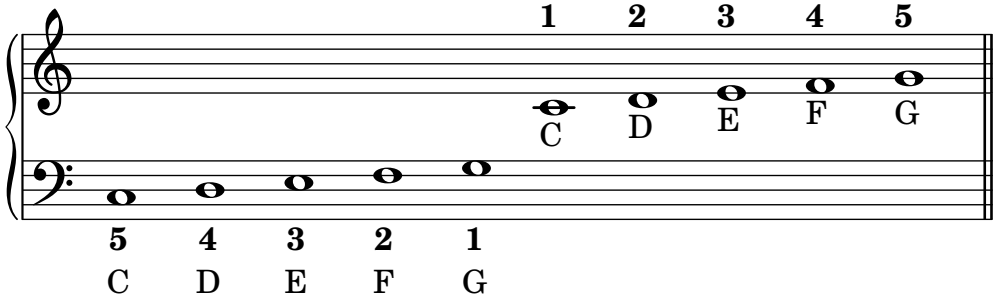
Notes can be joined smoothly or played short and separate. A curved line over or under a group of different notes is a slur: play them legato, smoothly connected. A dot above or below a note means staccato: short and detached, with a little silence after it.

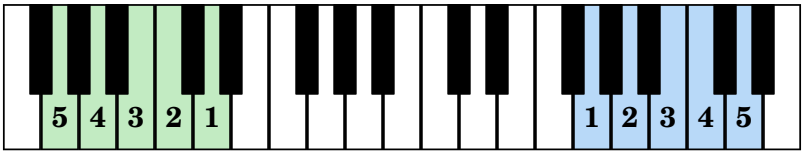


Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

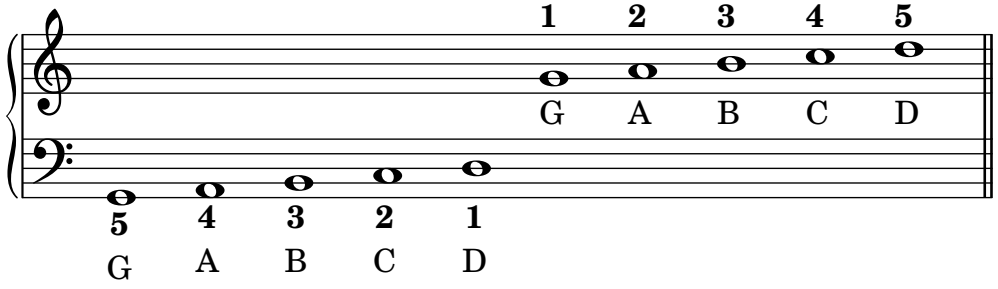




Middle C

Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Slur

A curved line joining different notes. Play legato: hold each key until the next one goes down, so there is no gap. Lift the hand gently at the end of the slur.

Slur or tie?

A tie joins two notes of the same pitch: play once and hold. A slur joins different notes: play them all, smoothly.

Staccato

A dot above or below the notehead. Play the note short, as if the key were hot, but keep the beat: the note still takes its full share of time.

No marking

With no slur or dot, play the notes in an ordinary, slightly separated way.

Reading tips

1. During the 10-second scan, notice where slurs begin and end, and which notes have dots.

2. Staccato is about the sound, not the speed. Don't rush staccato notes.

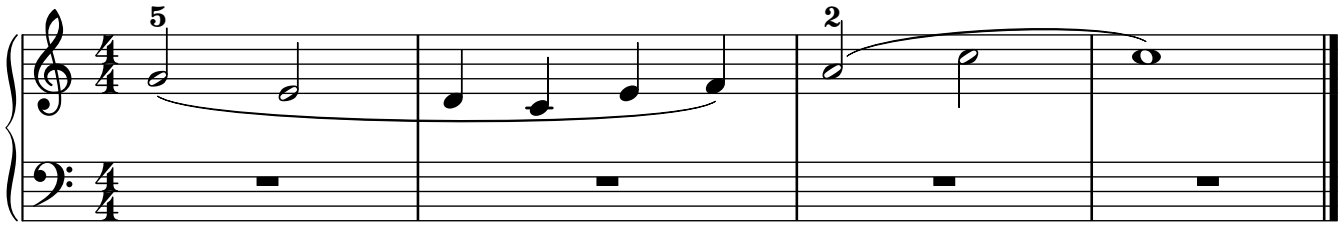
3. At the end of a slur, lift the hand. That small breath shapes the phrase.

4. Reading the marks matters, but keeping the beat matters more. If you miss a marking, keep going.

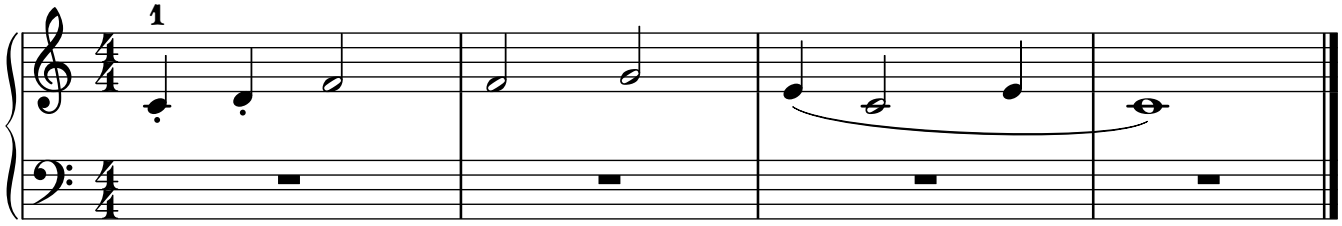
Part A: Slurs and dots, right hand ♩= 66

Slurs and staccato in the right hand, with some shifts. Metronome 66.

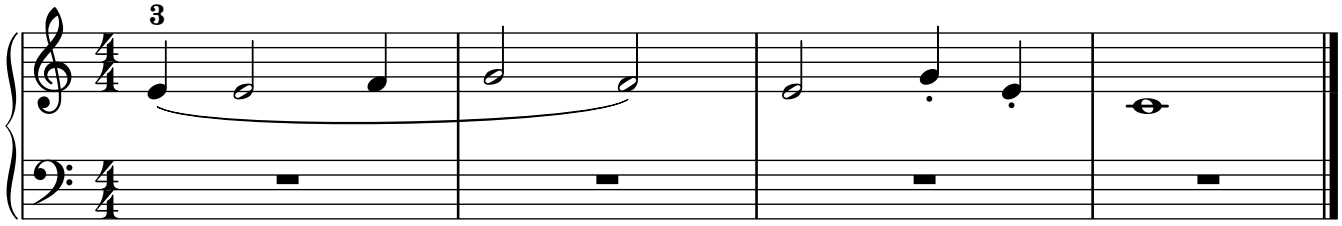
☐ **4.1**



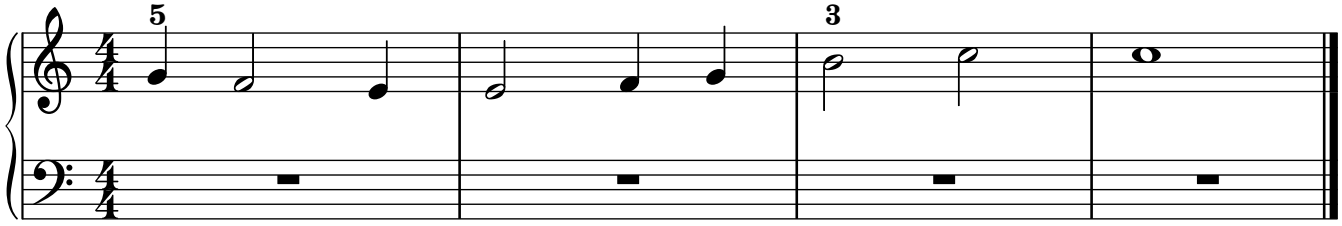
☐ **4.2**



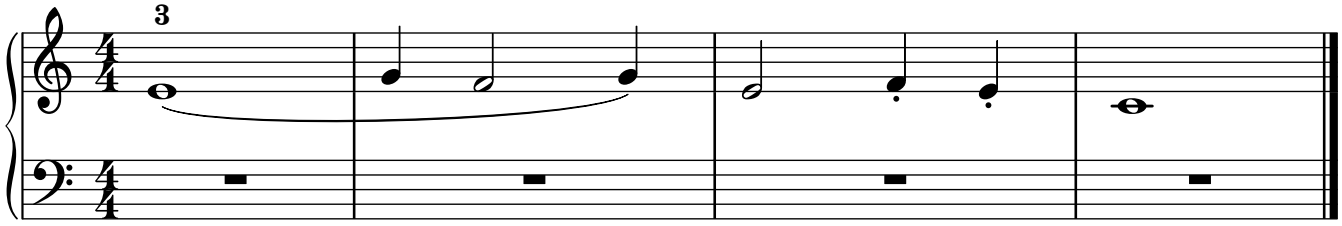
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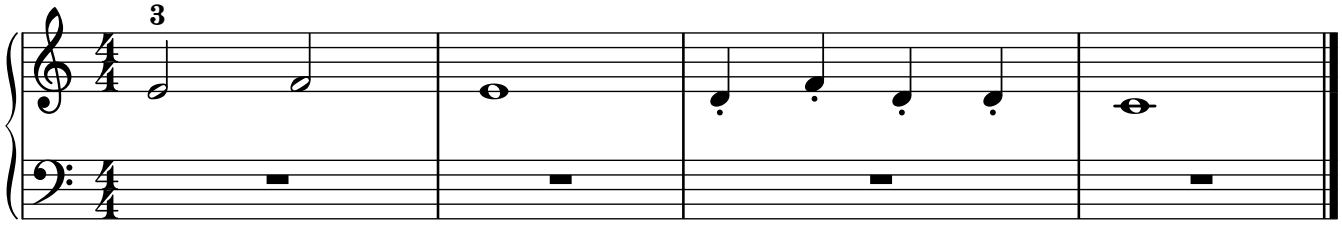
☐ **4.4**



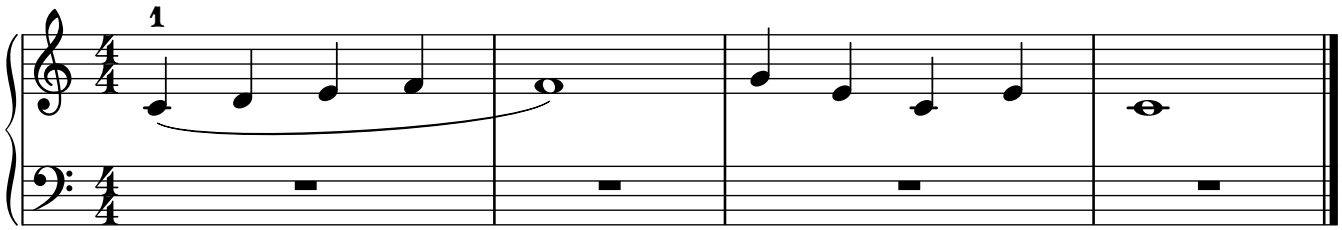
☐ **4.5**



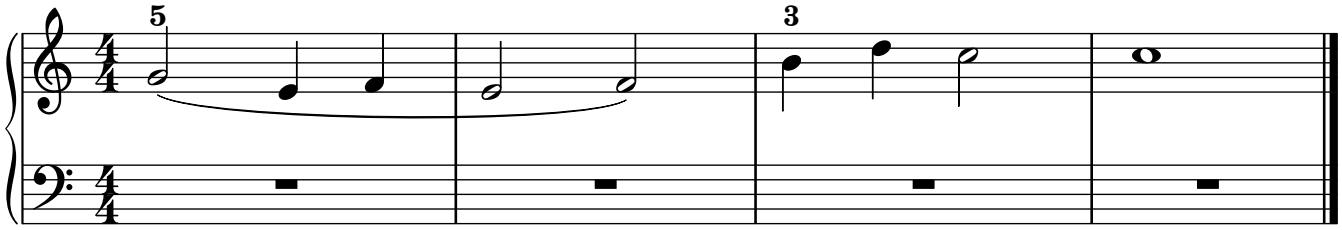
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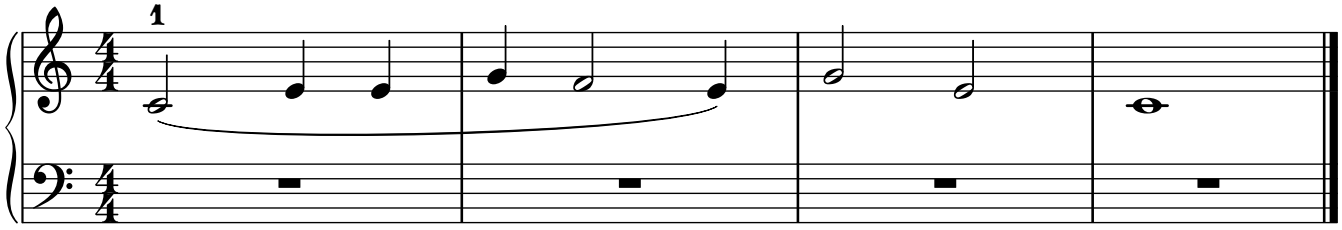
☐ **4.7**



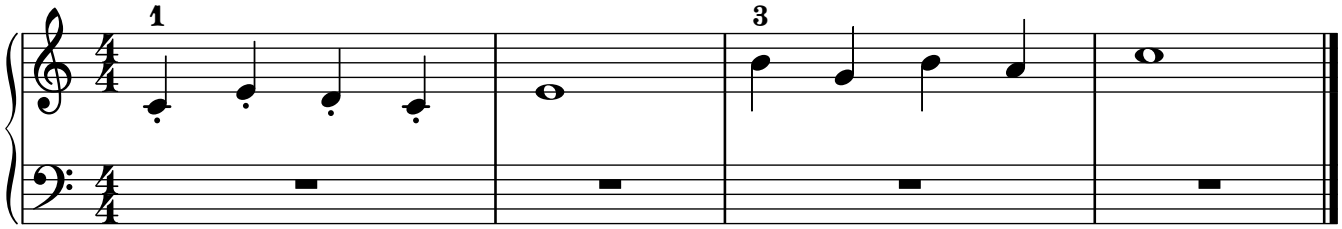
☐ **4.8**



☐ **4.9**



☐ **4.10**

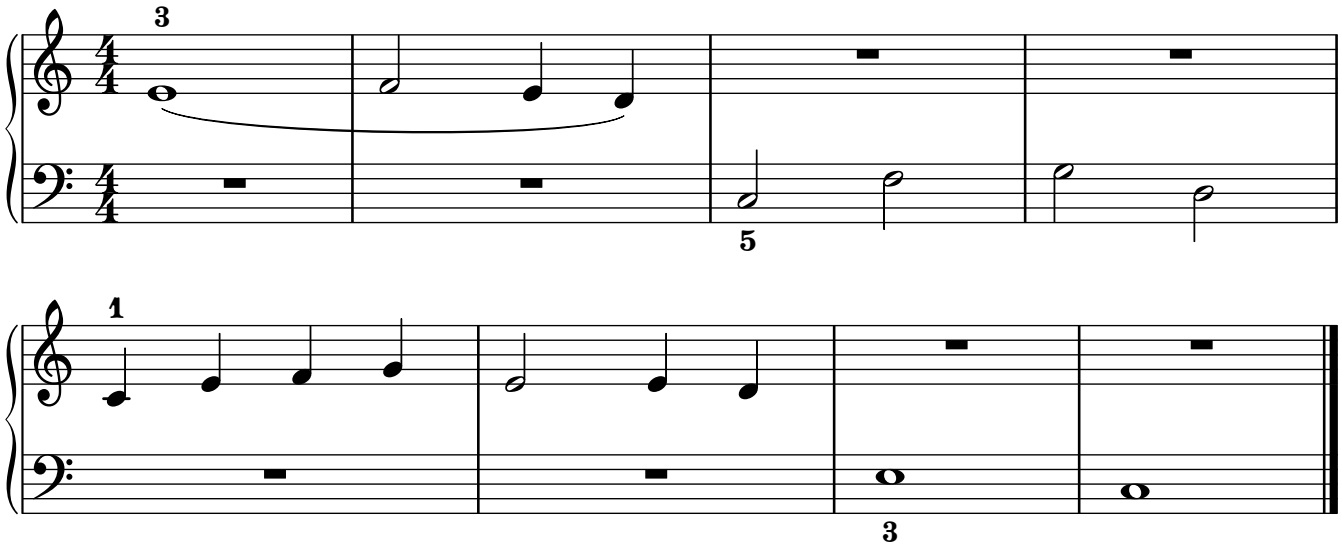


Part B: Slurs and dots, hands taking turns
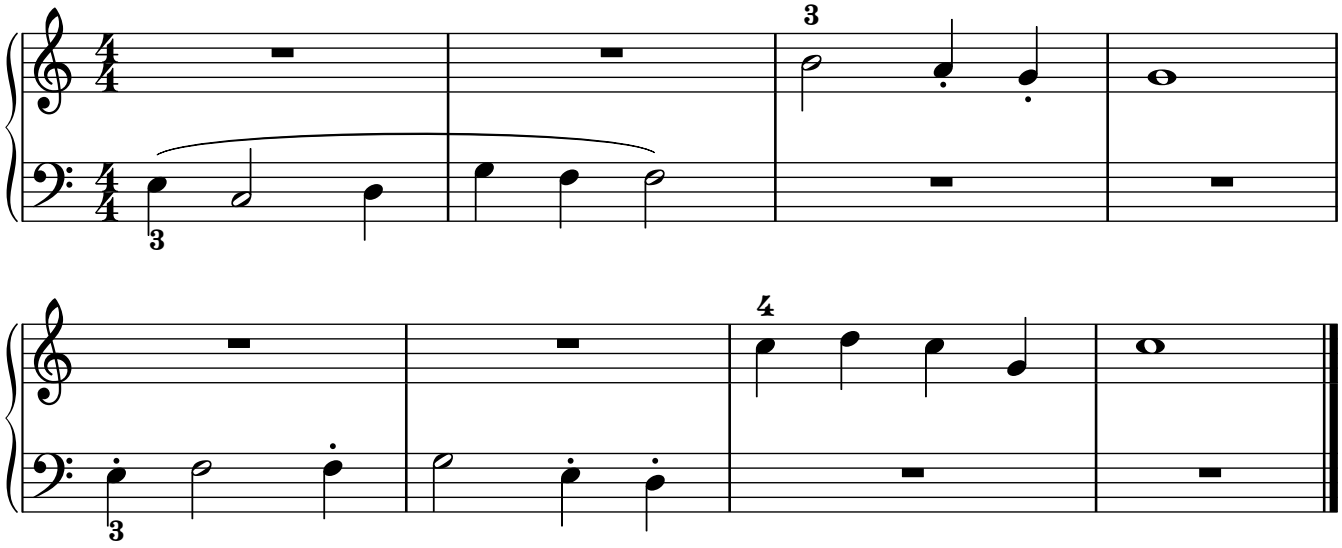
♩ = 66

The hands take turns; each two-bar phrase is legato, staccato or plain.

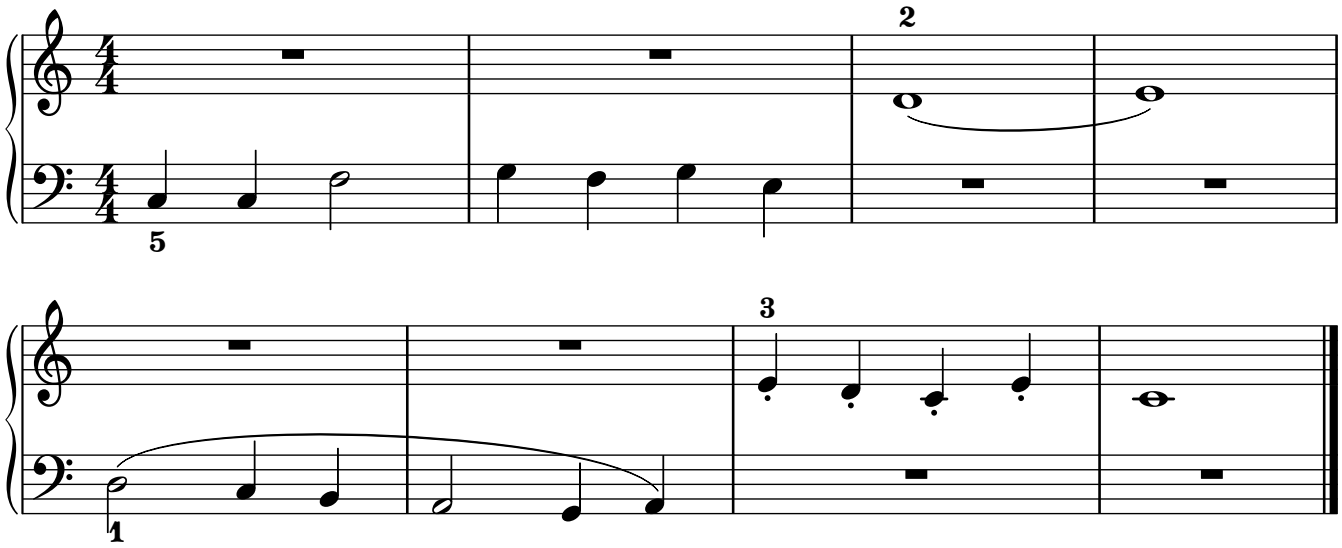
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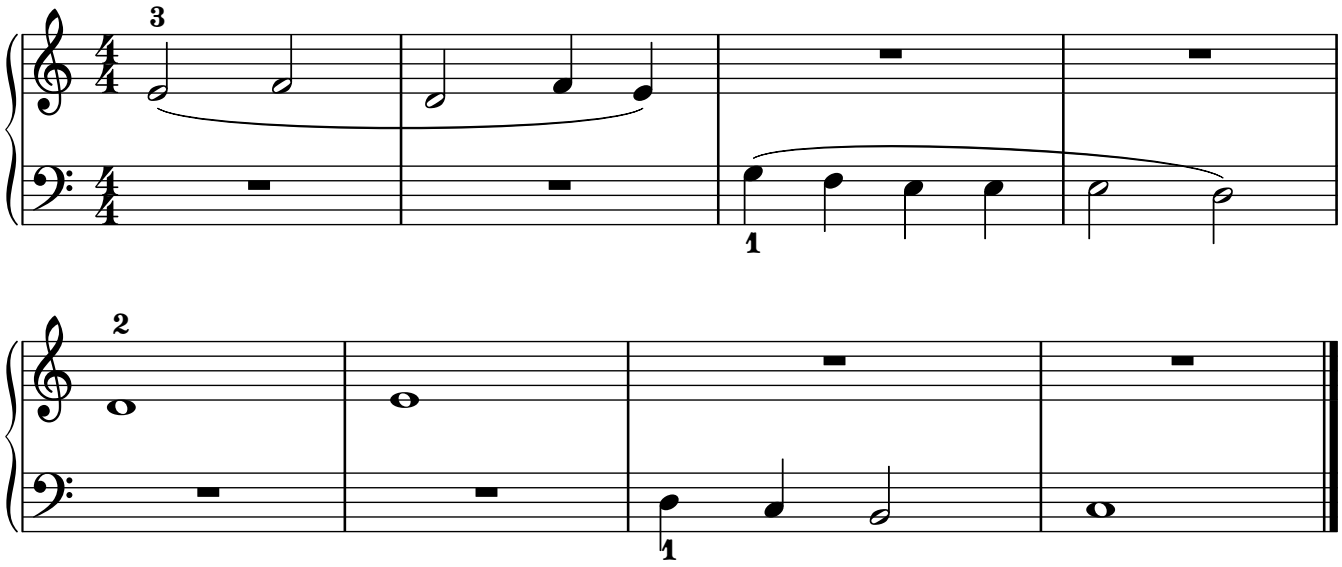


☐ **4.12**



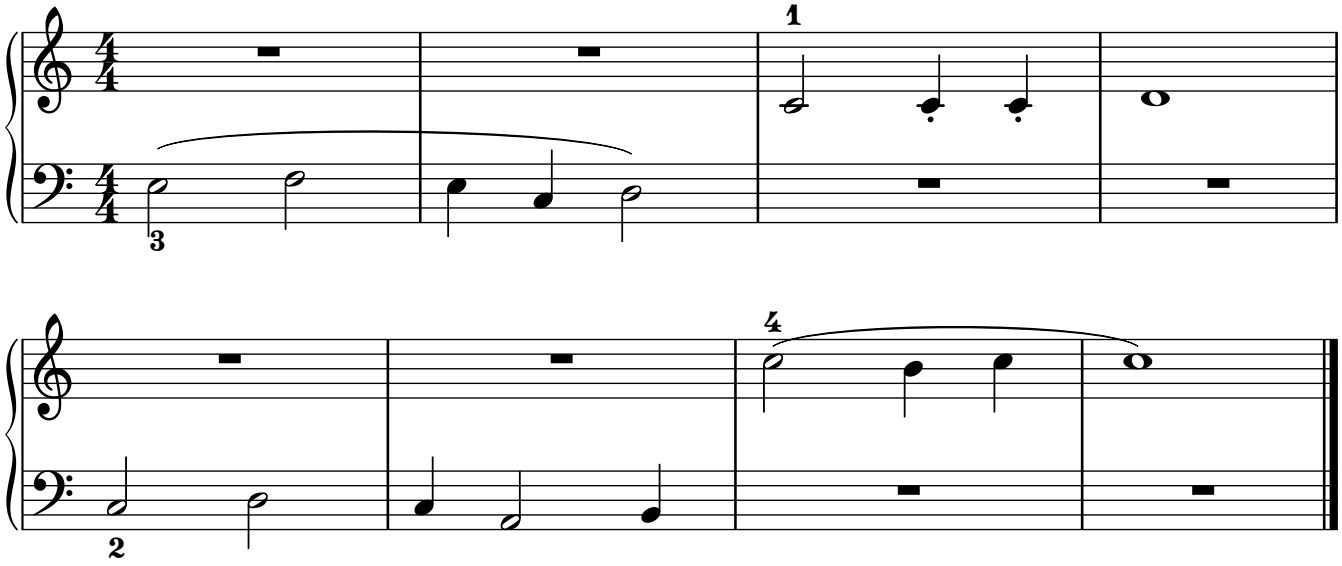
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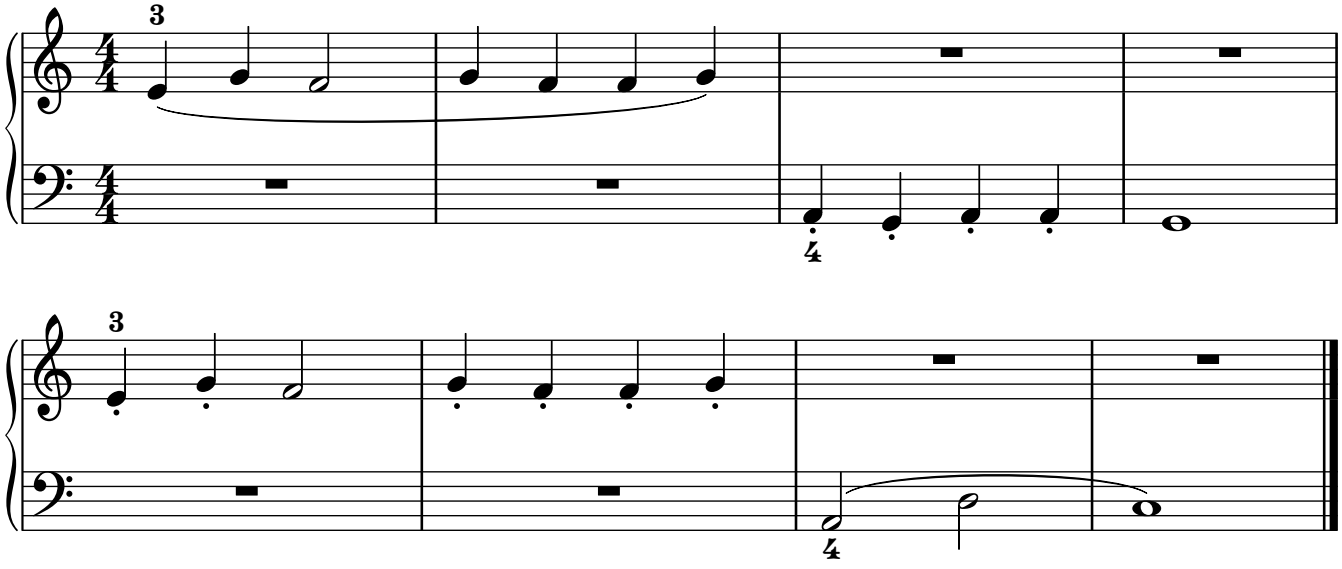


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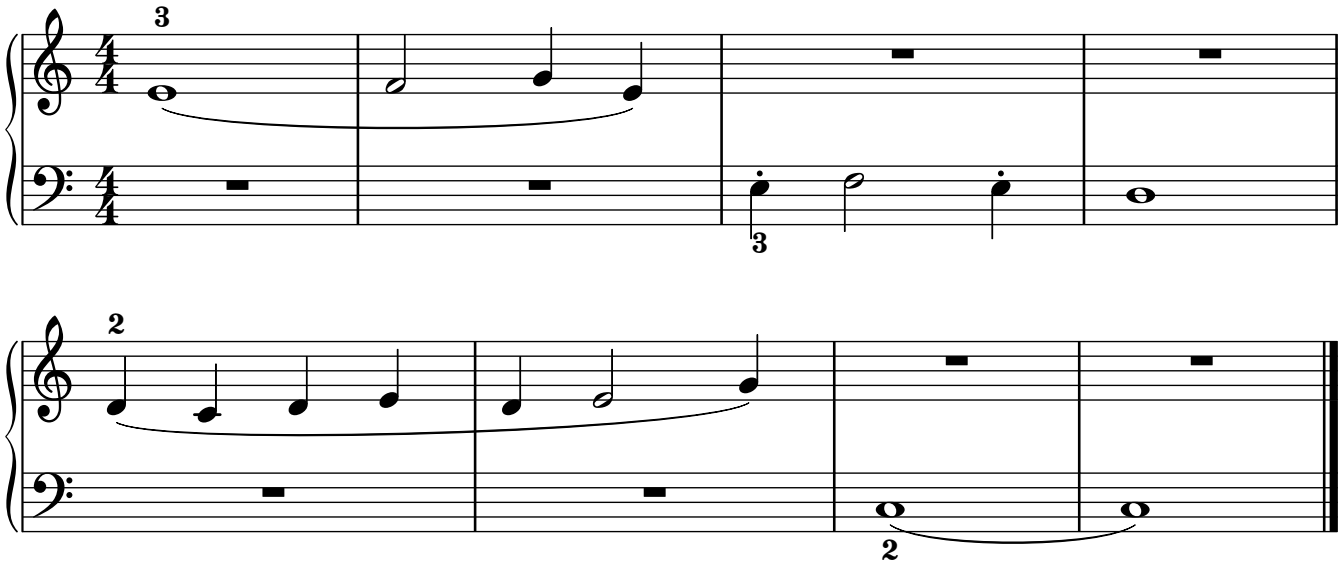
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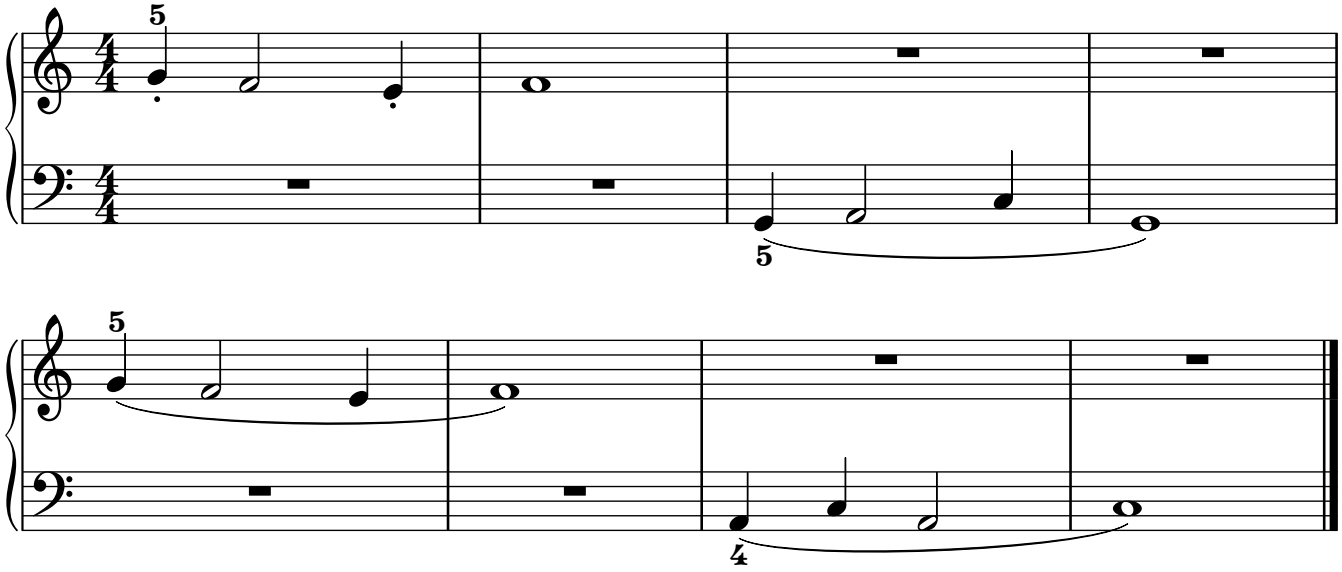
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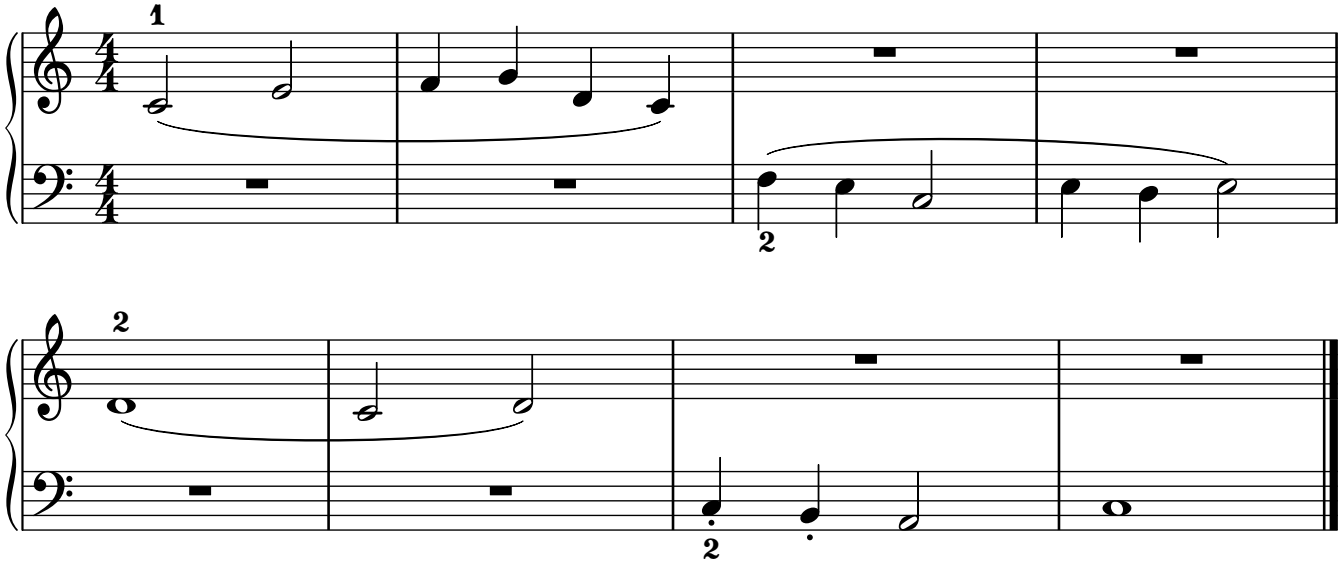
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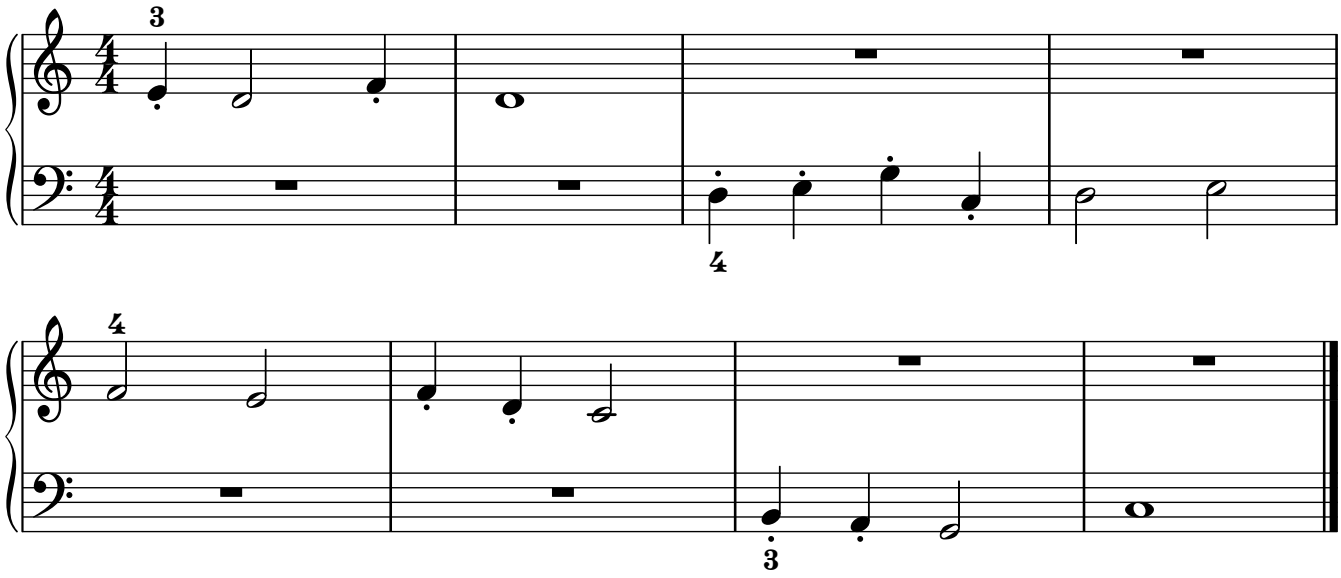
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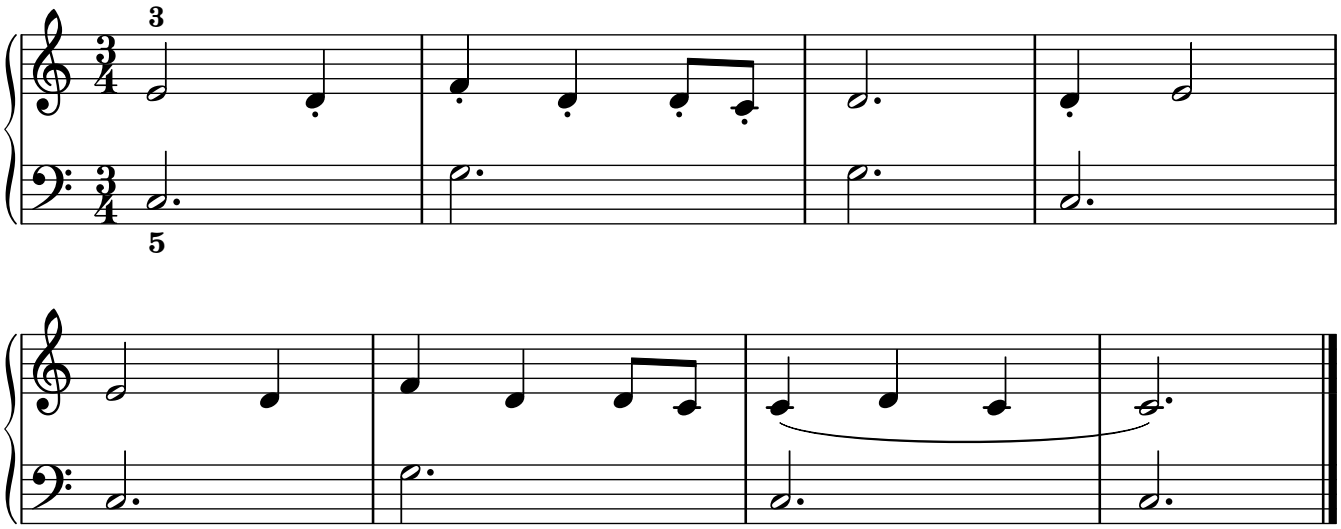


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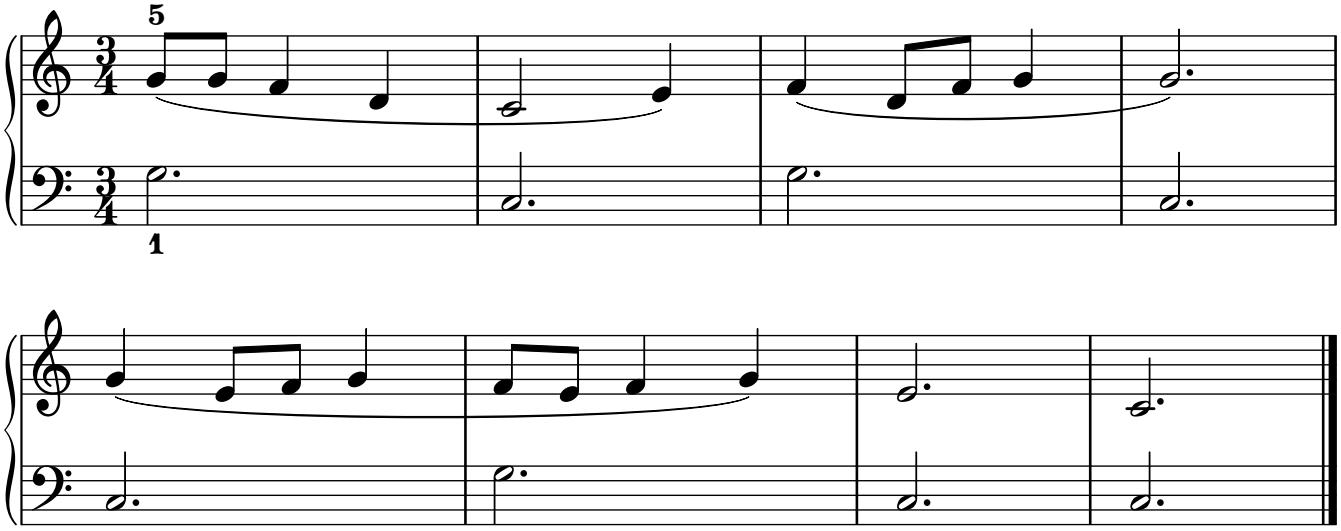


Part C: Hands together in 3/4 ♩ = 72

Hands together in 3/4; the marks are in the right hand.
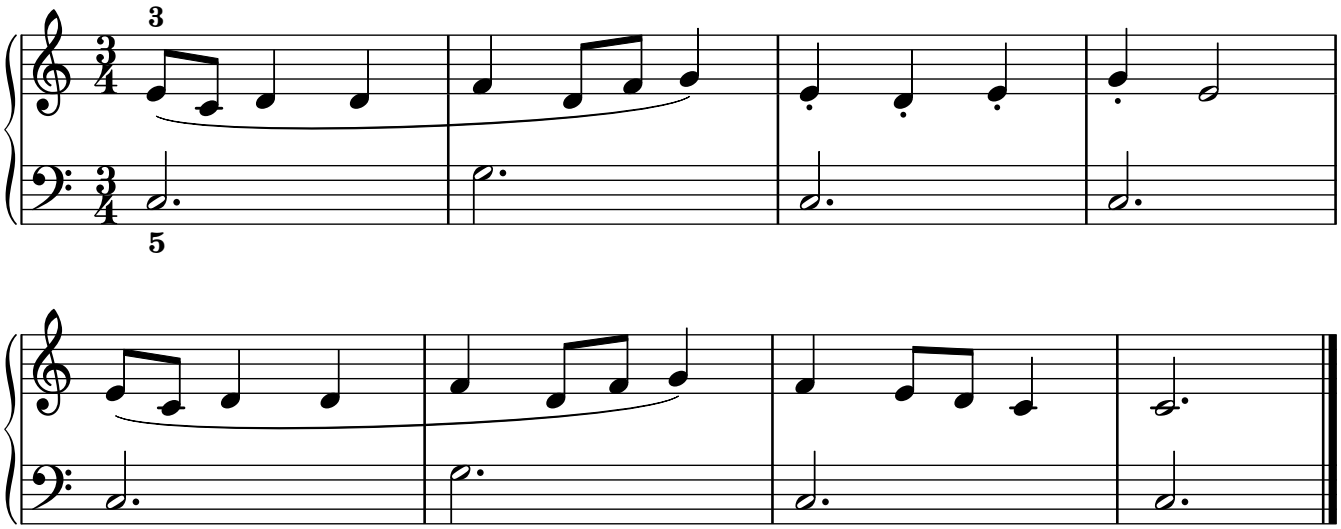
☐ **4.21**
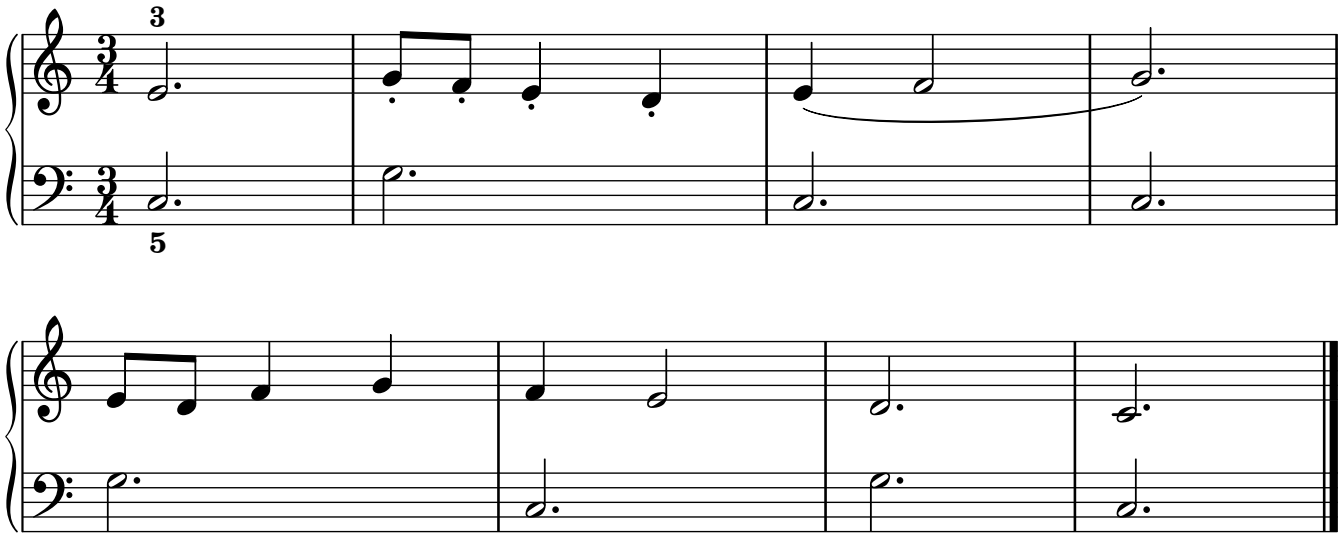


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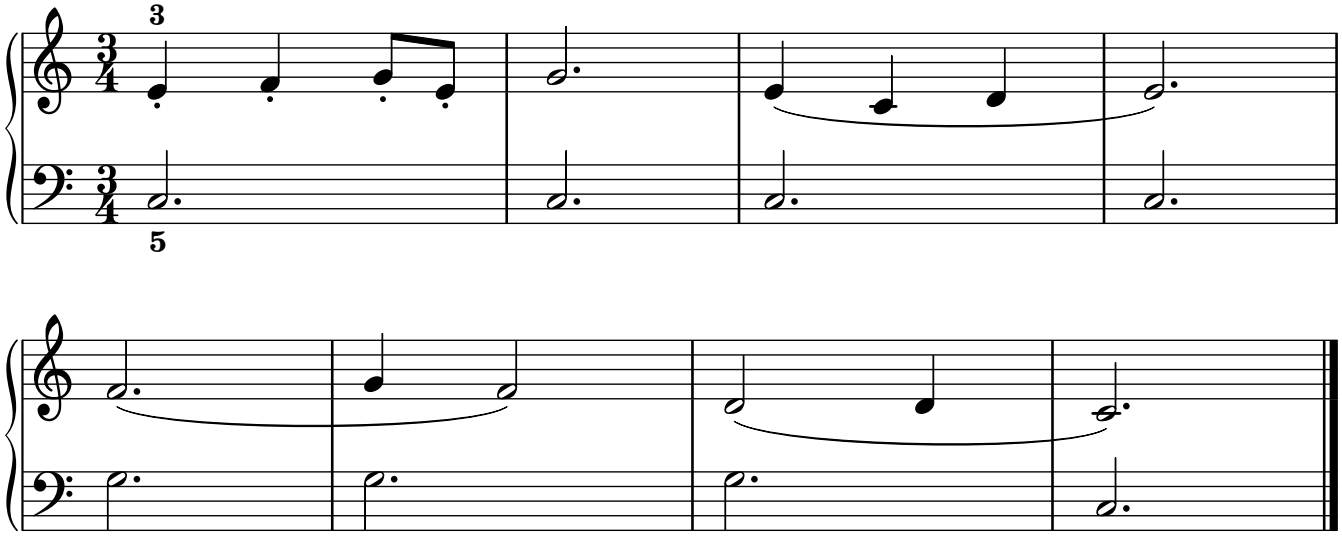


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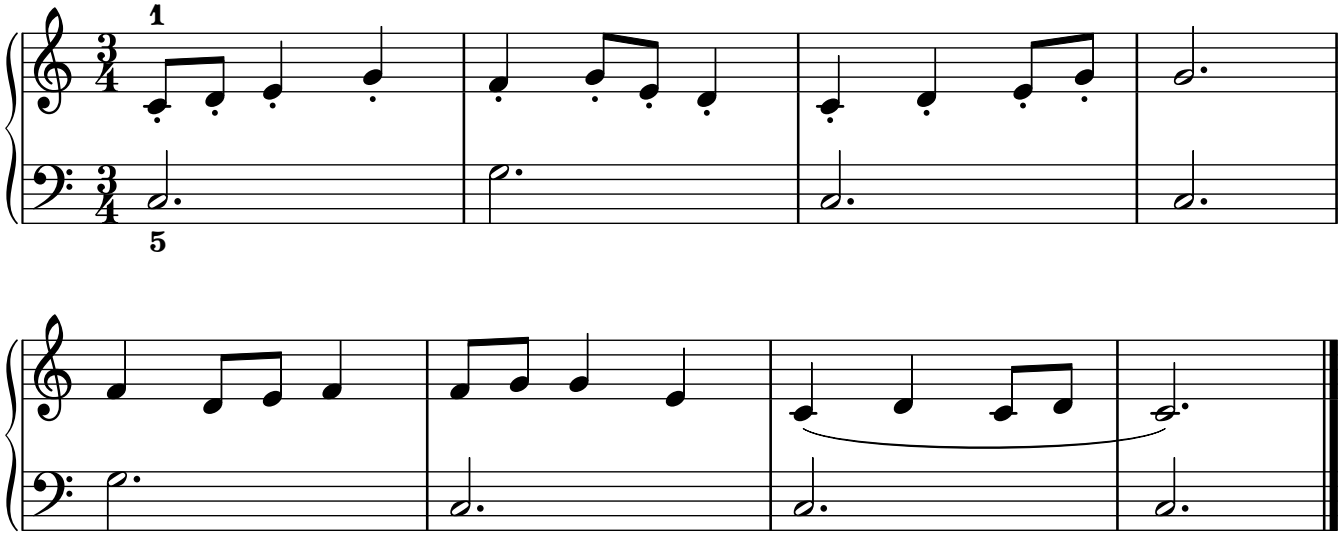


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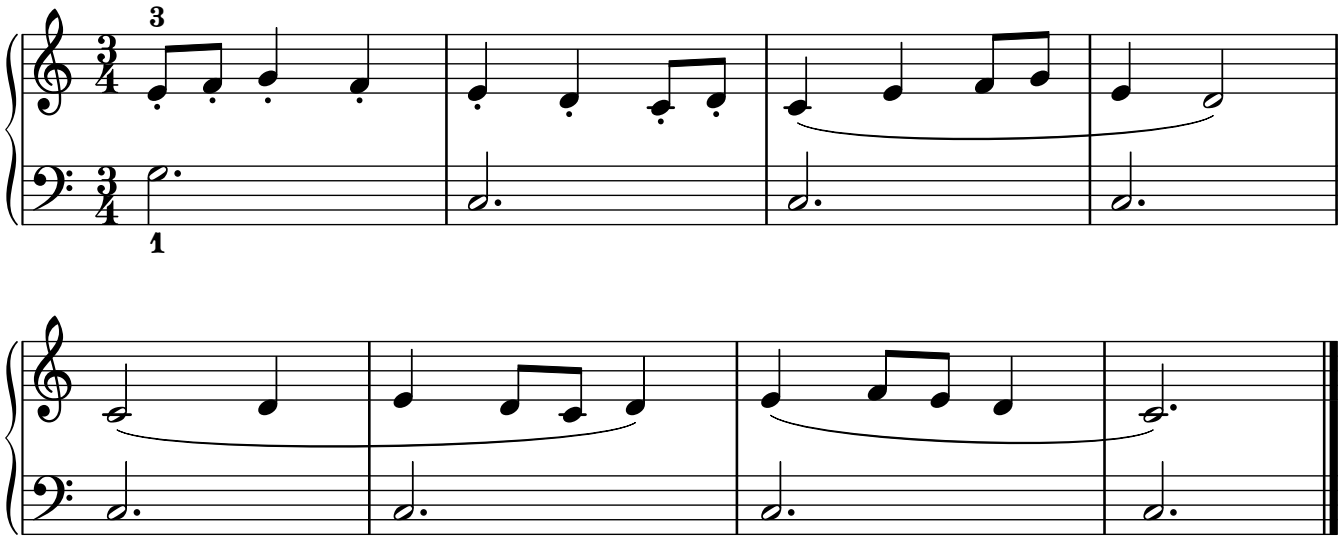


4.25
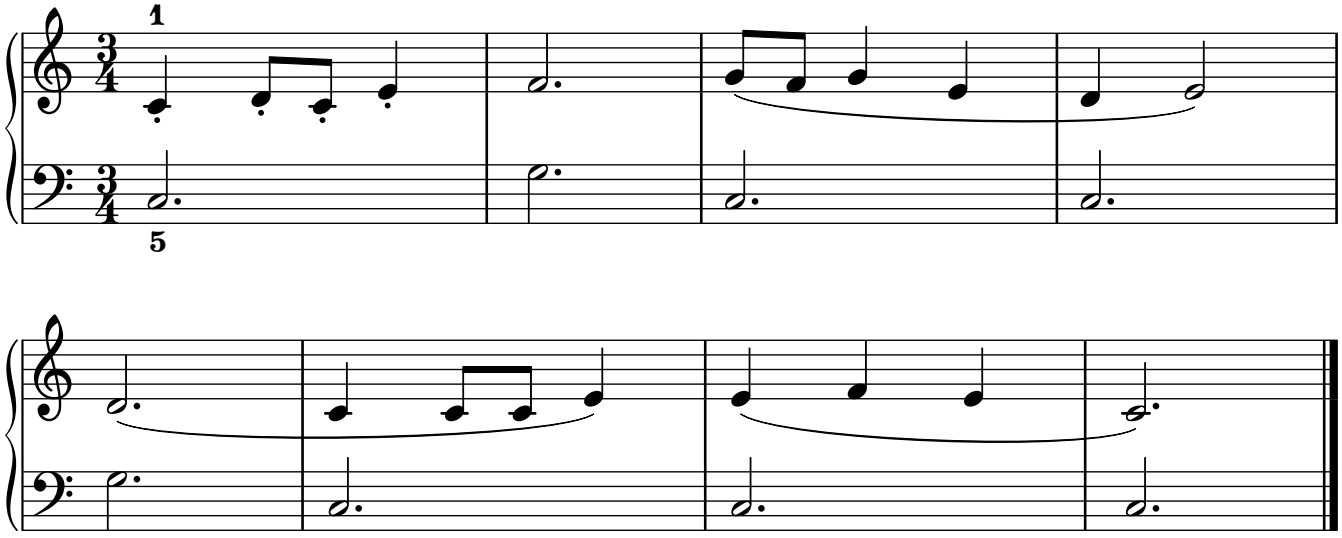


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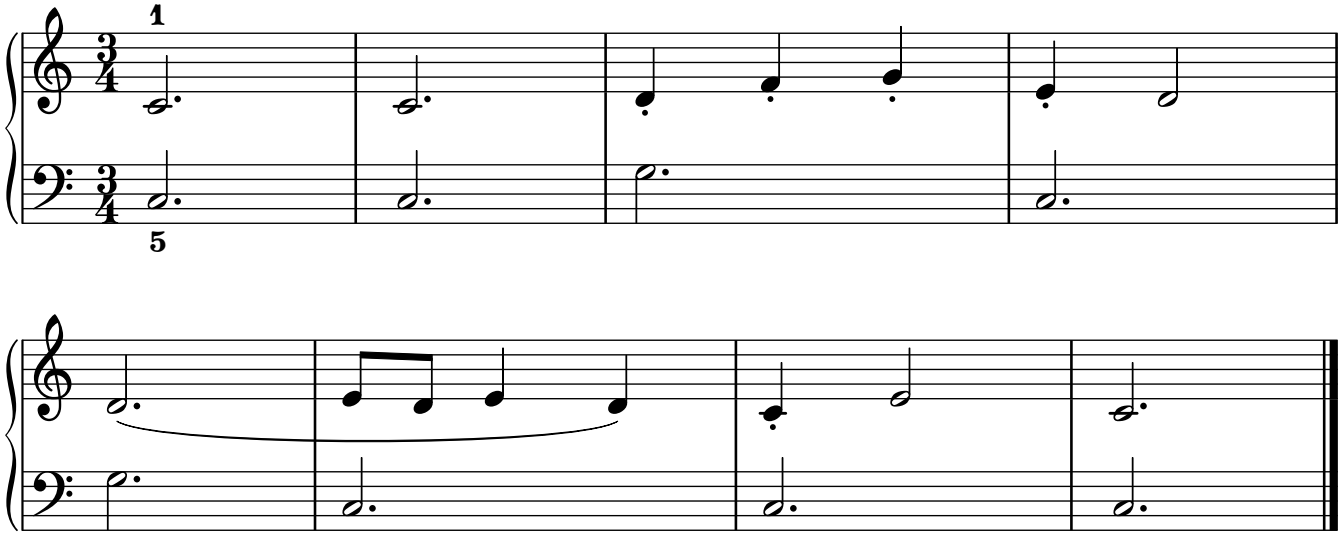


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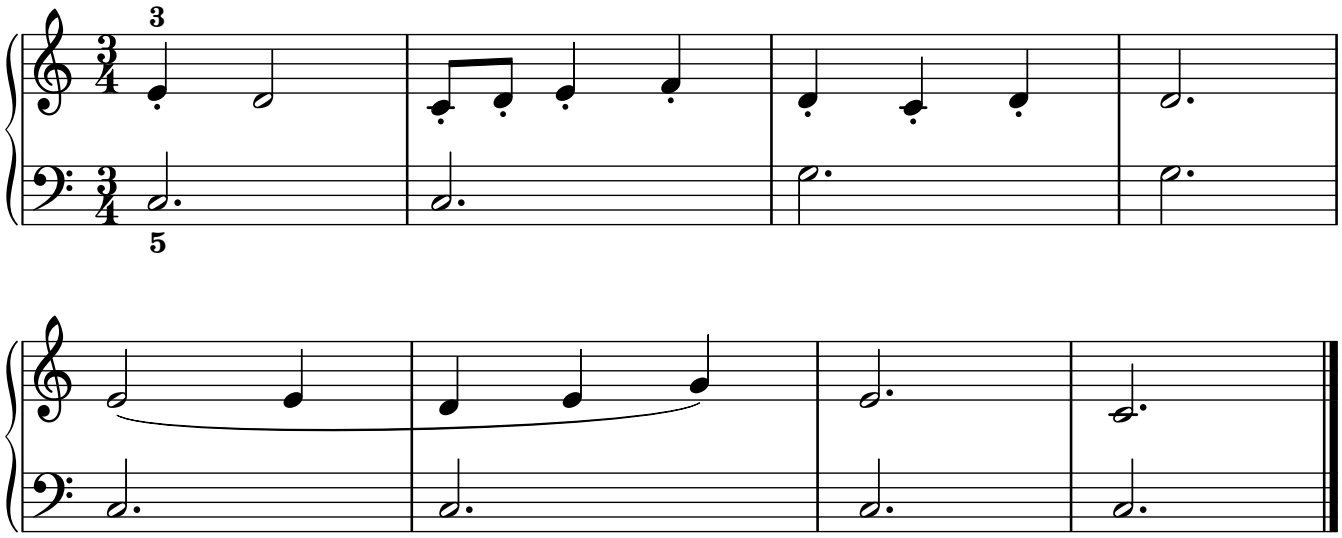


4.28



4.29



4.30



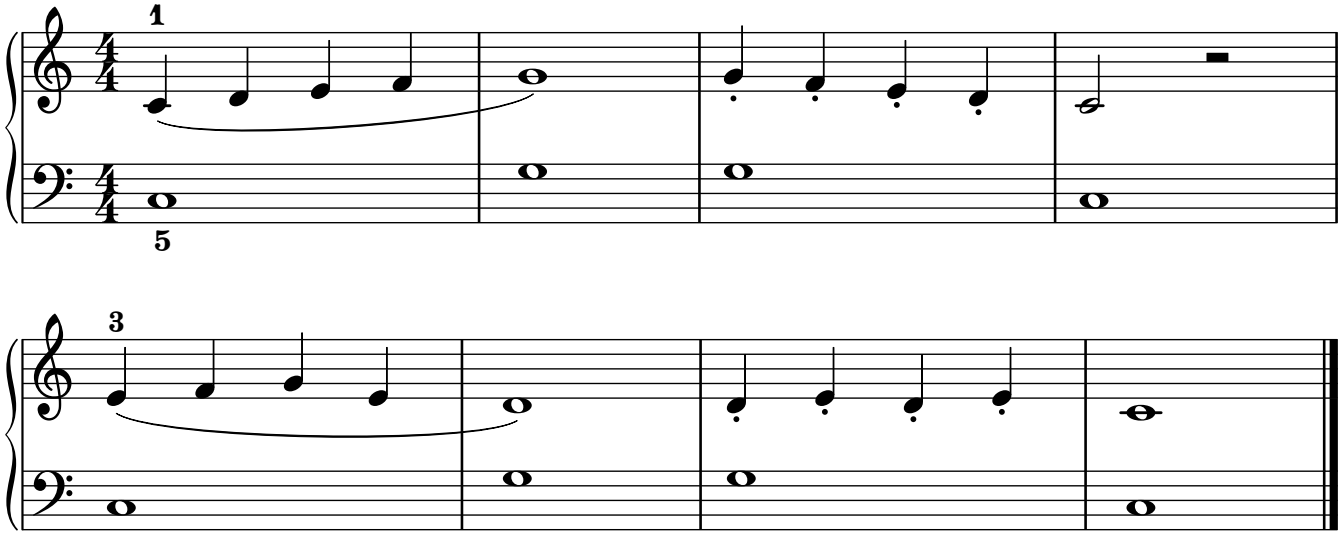
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Smooth and Bouncy ♩ = 76

Original
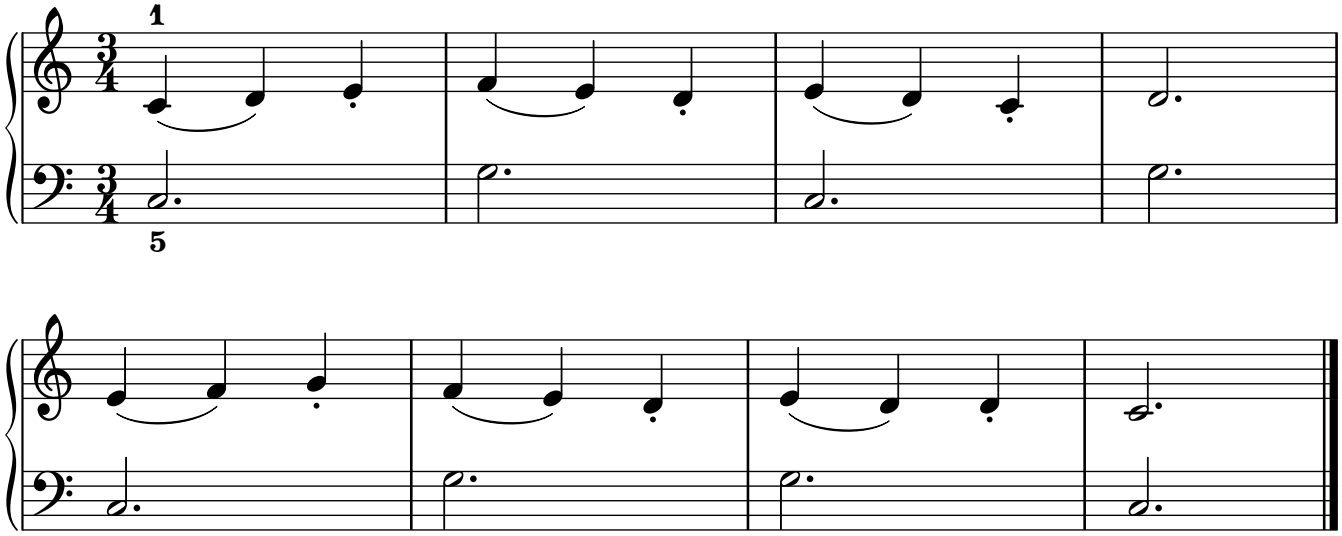
Two bars smooth, two bars bouncy, and again. Make the difference clear.



Little Minuet ♩ = 84

Original

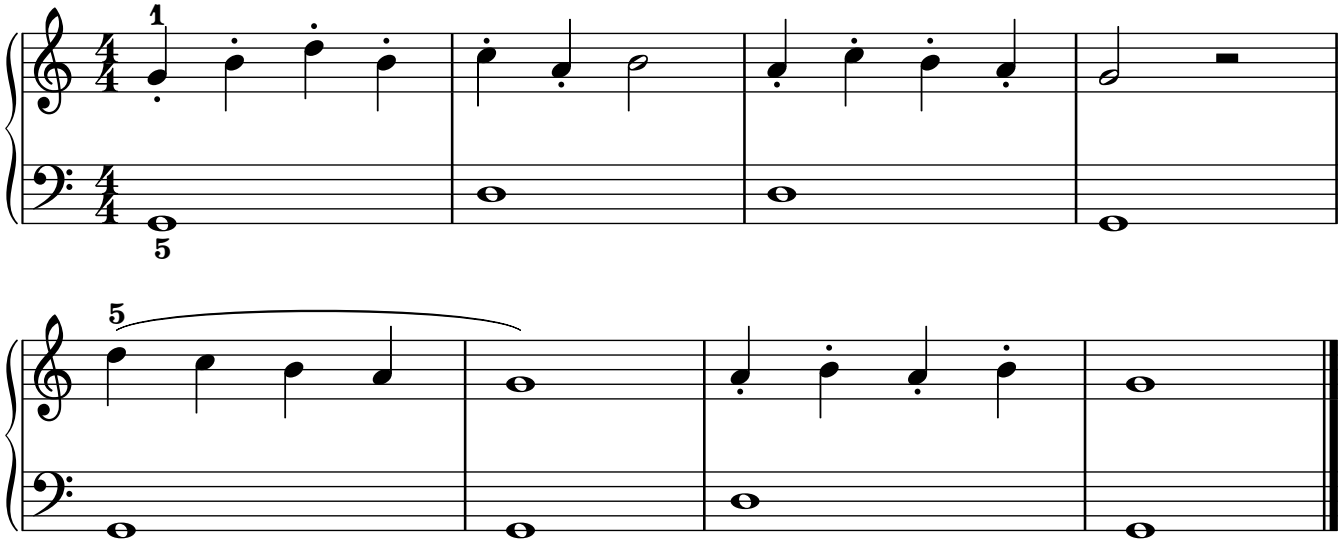
Slurred pairs: play the first note of each pair a little stronger and the second lighter, then a short staccato.



Raindrops ♩ = 80

Original
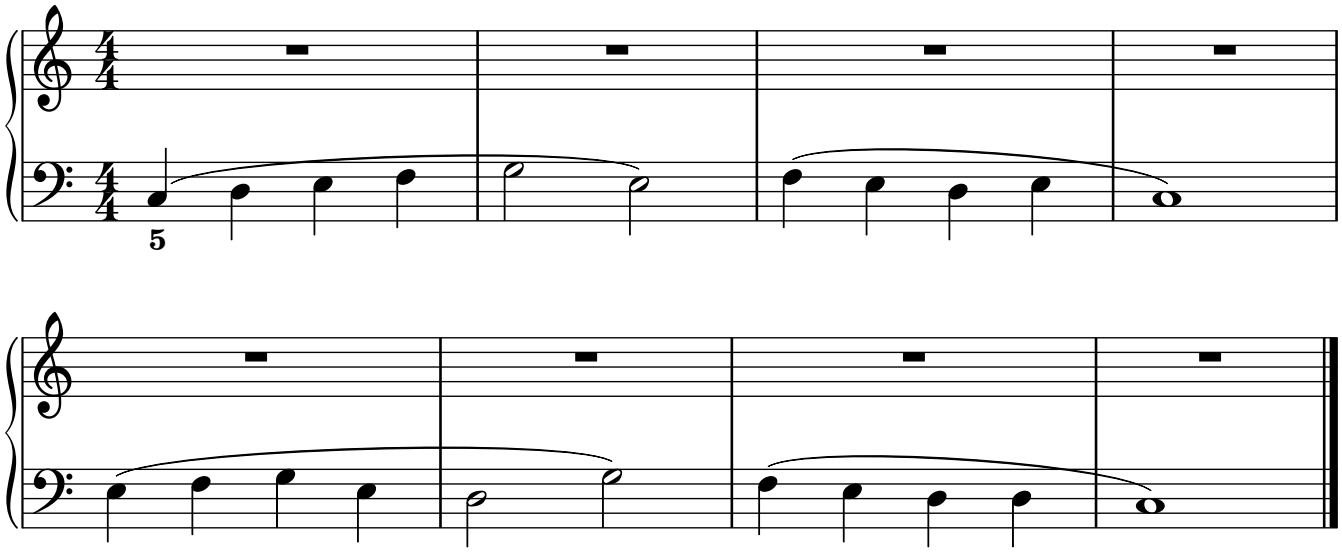
In G position. Light staccato raindrops, then a smooth slurred phrase in bars 5-6.



Legato Song ♩ = 72

Original

For the left hand alone: four slurred phrases. Connect every note inside a slur, and lift at its end.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 5?

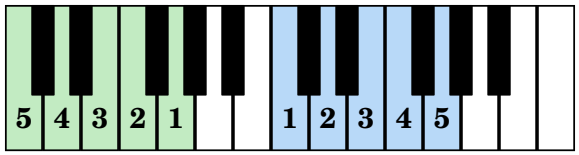
- Play five Part B or C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if a listener could hear which phrases were legato and which staccato.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 5.

Unit 5

Loud and Soft

New: Dynamics: p, mp, mf, f; getting louder and softer

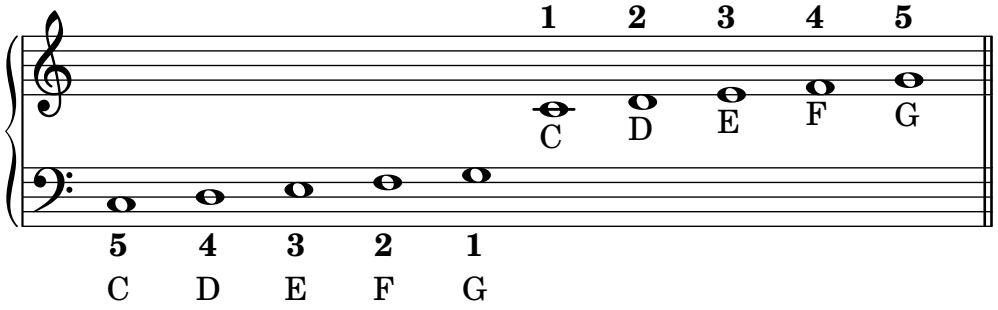
Music has loud and soft. Dynamics are the letters and signs that tell you how loudly to play. They are written below the staff, and each one lasts until the next.

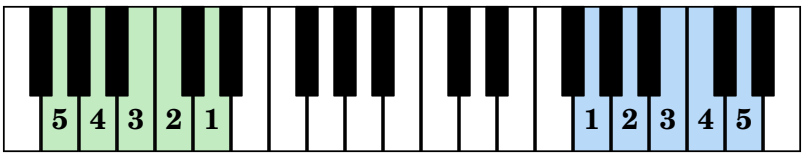


Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

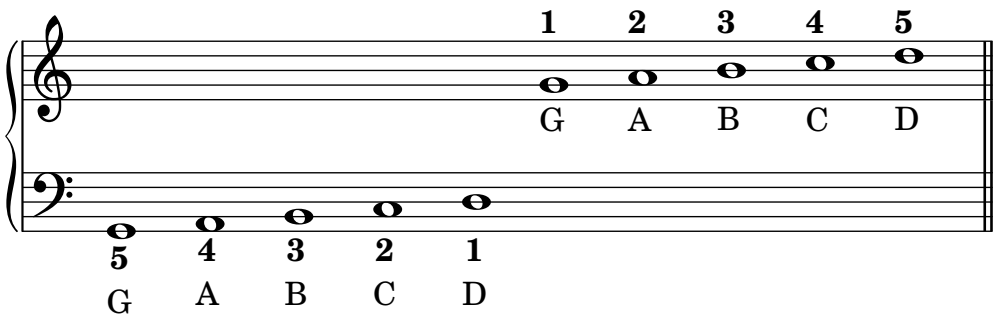




Middle C

Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

p and f

p (piano) means soft; f (forte) means loud.

mp and mf

mp (mezzo piano) is medium soft; mf (mezzo forte) is medium loud. From soft to loud: p, mp, mf, f.

Hairpins

A widening wedge means get gradually louder (crescendo). A narrowing wedge means get gradually softer (diminuendo). Each leads to the next dynamic mark.

How to play louder

Use more arm weight and a quicker key stroke, not a harder finger. Soft playing still needs a full, clear sound.

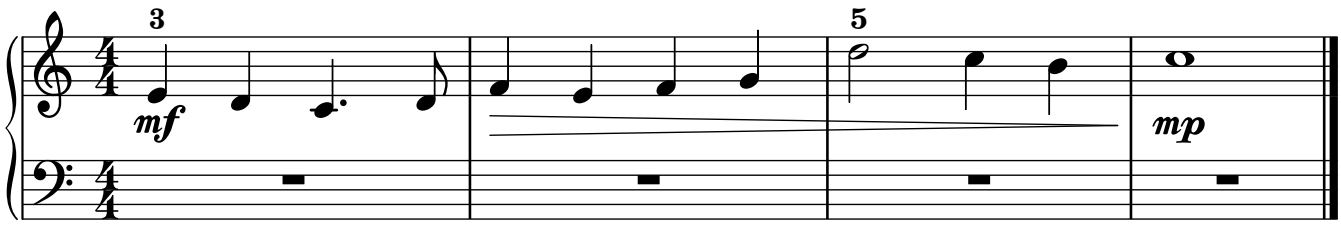
Reading tips

1. Find the first dynamic before you start, and set your sound before the first note.
2. A dynamic lasts until the next one. Keep it steady until the music asks for a change.
3. Make a crescendo gradual: start soft enough that there is room to grow.
4. Never let a dynamic change the tempo. Loud is not faster, and soft is not slower.

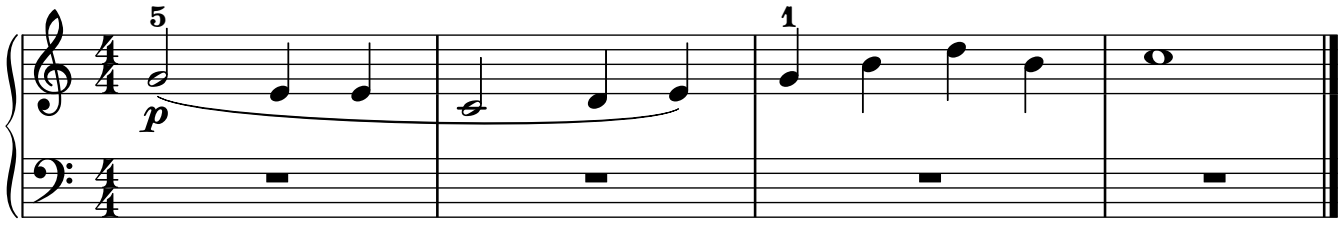
Part A: Dynamics, right hand ♩= 66

Dynamics in the right hand, with slurs, dots and shifts. Metronome 66.

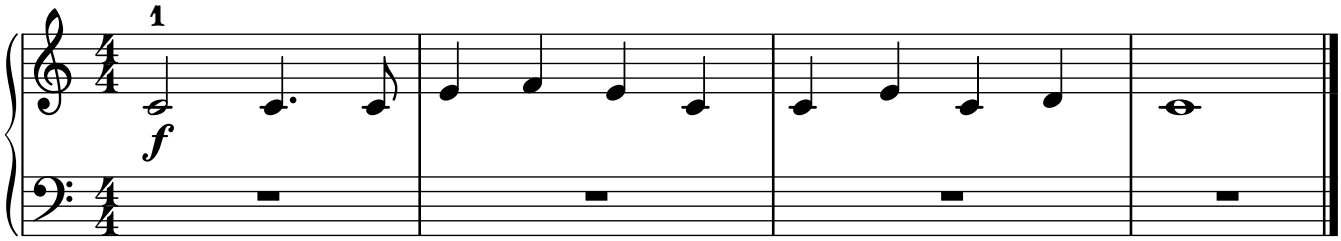
☐ **5.1**



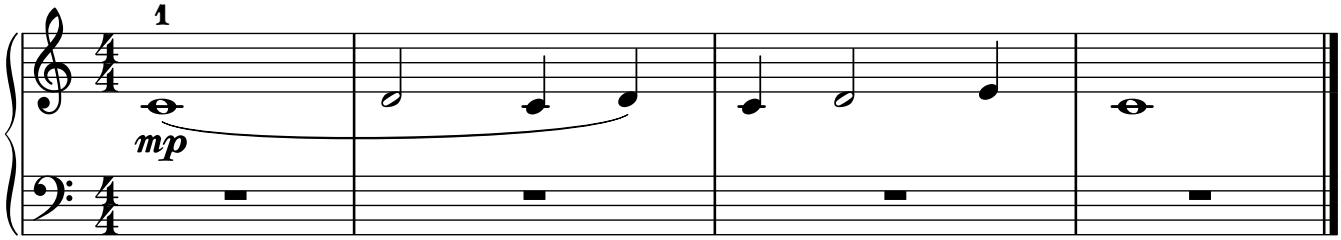
☐ **5.2**



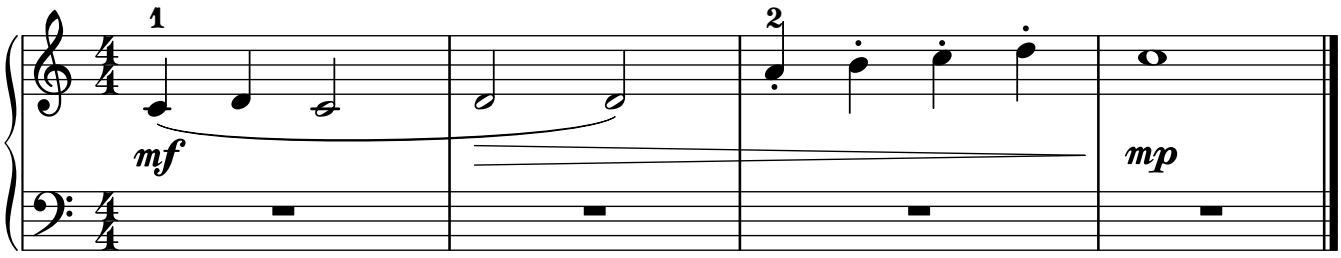
☐ **5.3**
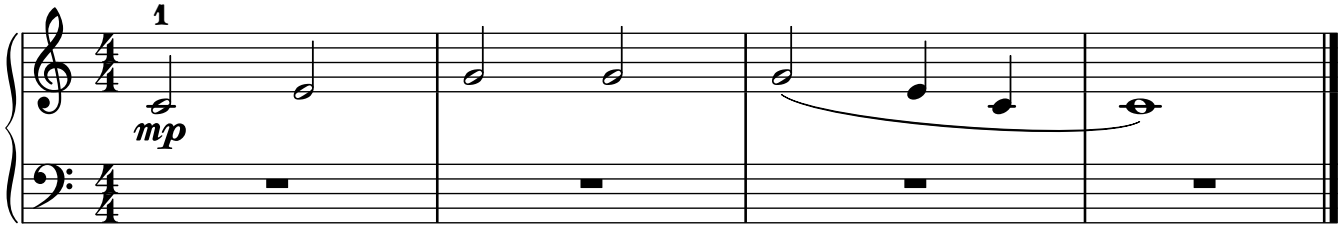


☐ **5.4**



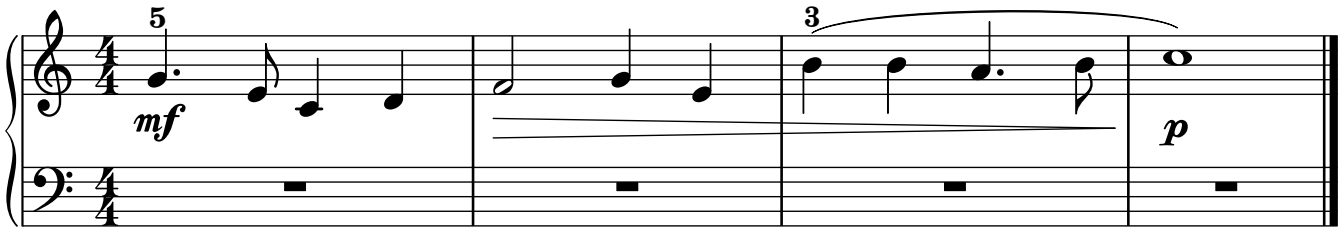
☐ **5.5**



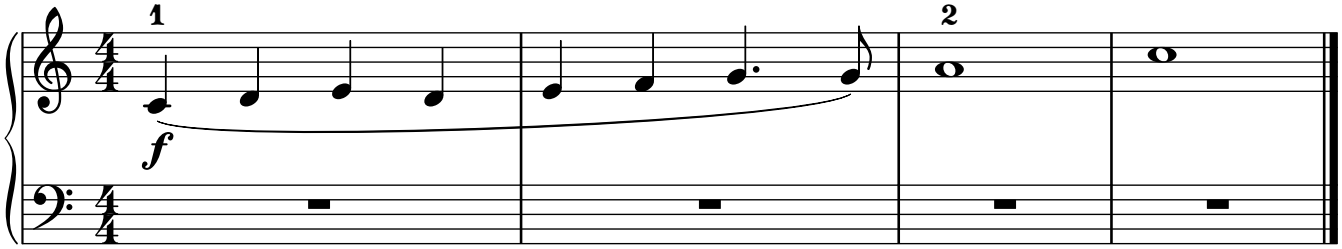
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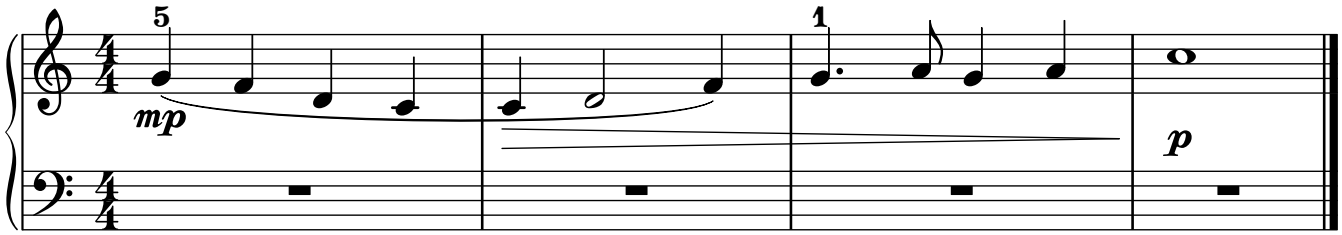
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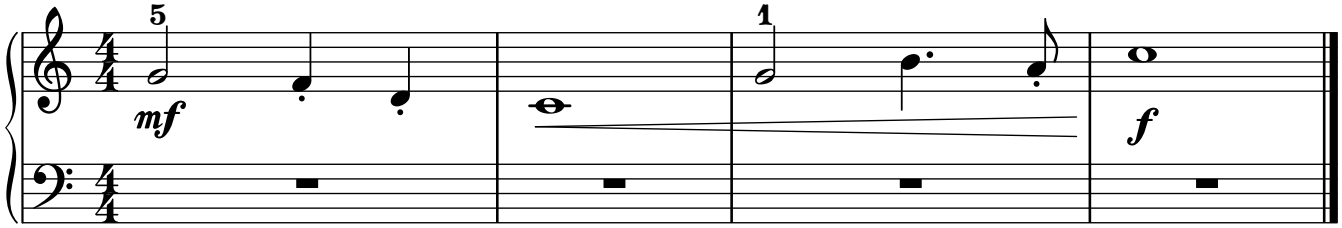
5.8



5.9



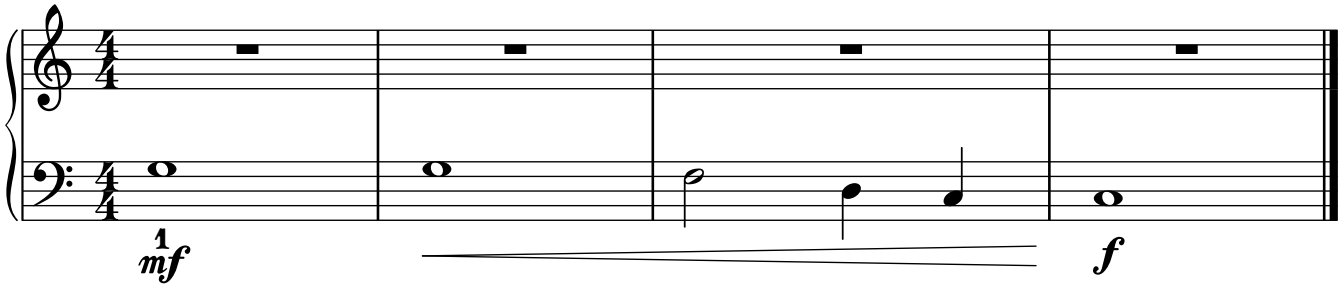
5.10



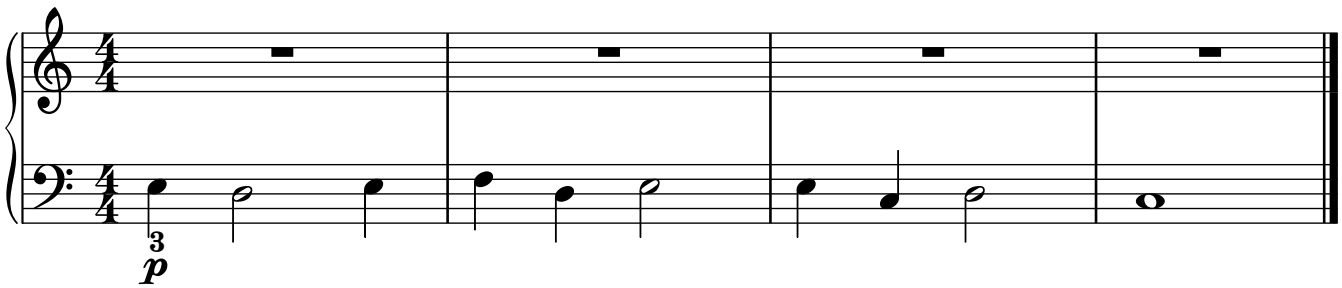
Part B: Dynamics, left hand ♩ = 66

Dynamics in the left hand.

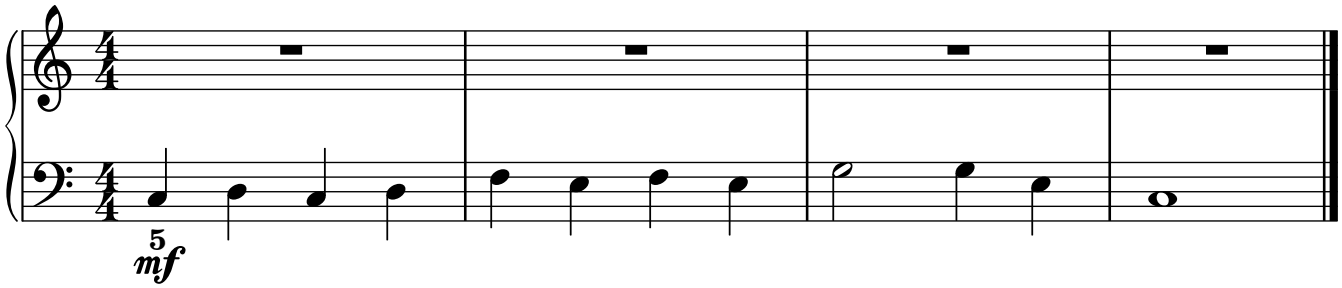
☐ **5.11**



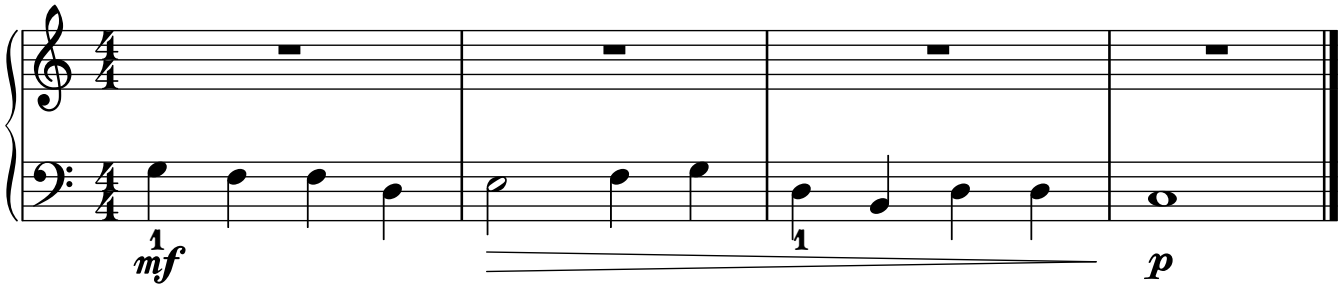
☐ **5.12**
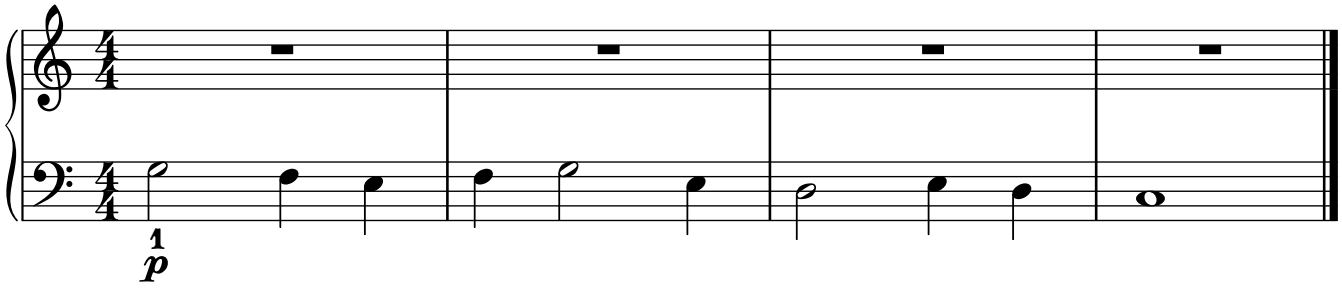


☐ **5.13**



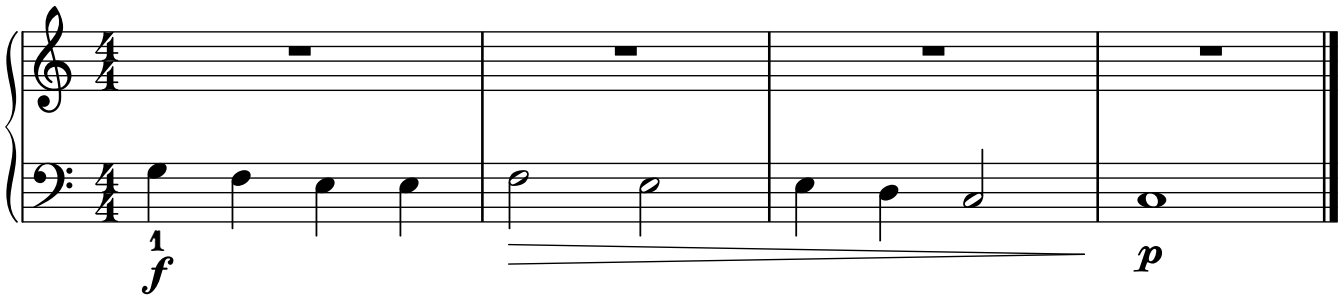
☐ **5.14**



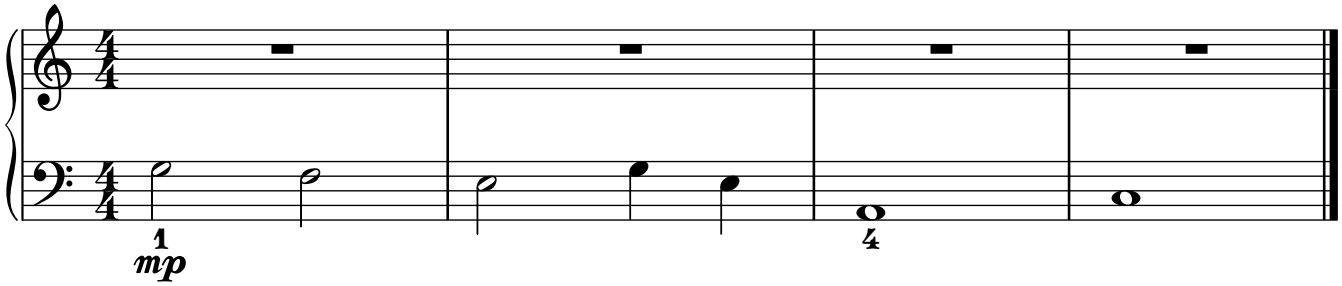
☐ **5.15**



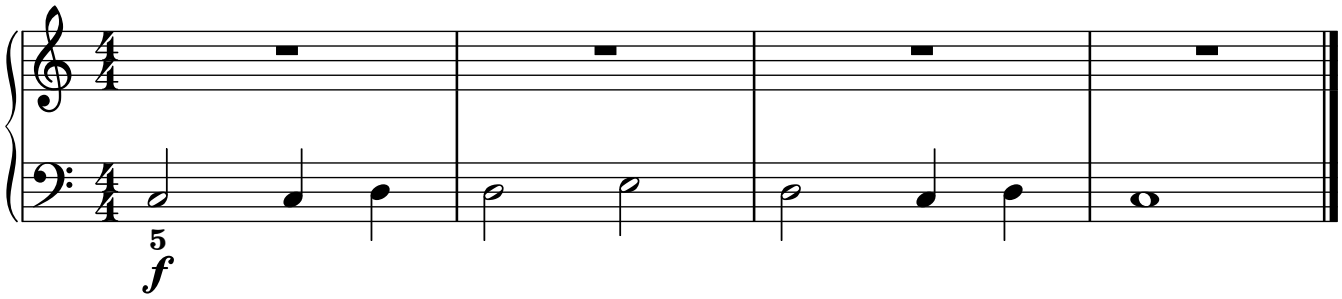
5.16



5.17
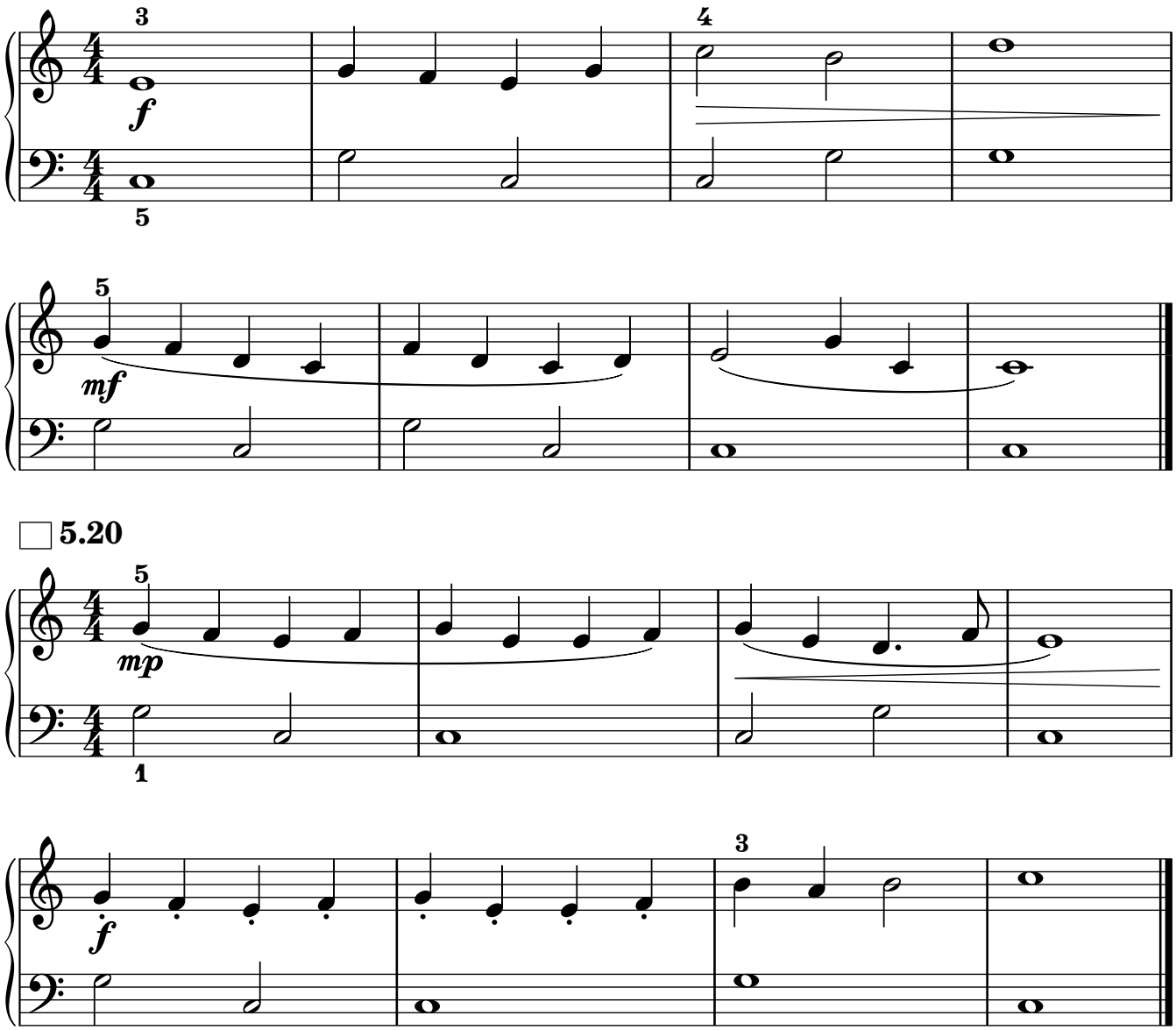


5.18



Part C: Shaping a phrase, hands together ♩ = 66
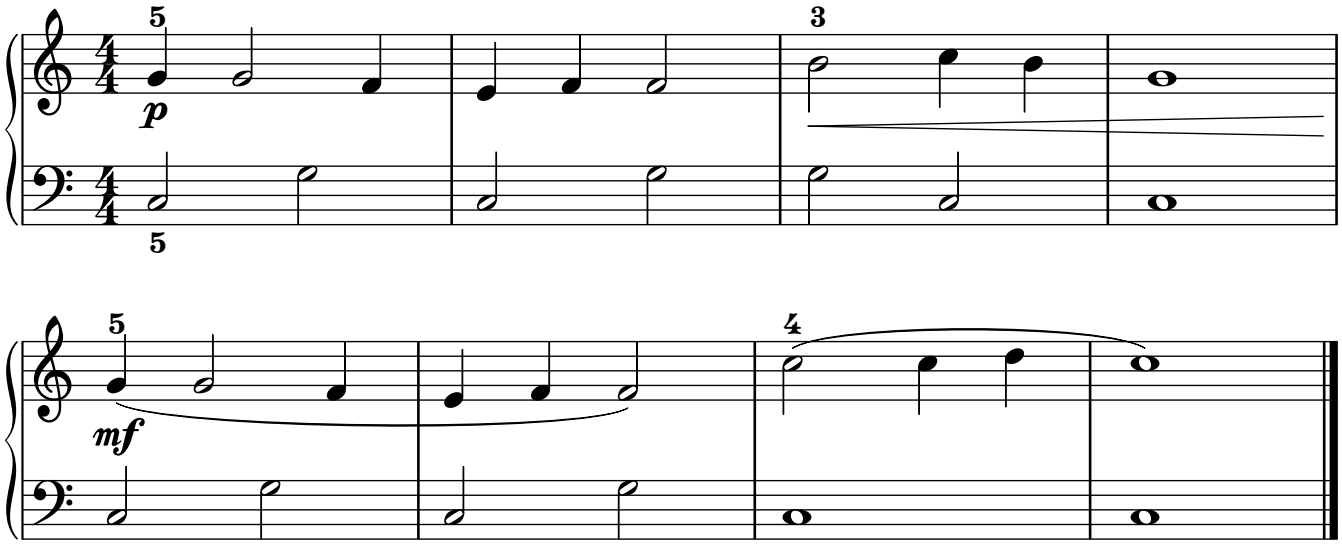
Shaping eight-bar phrases, hands together: one level, a hairpin, then a new level.

☐ **5.19**
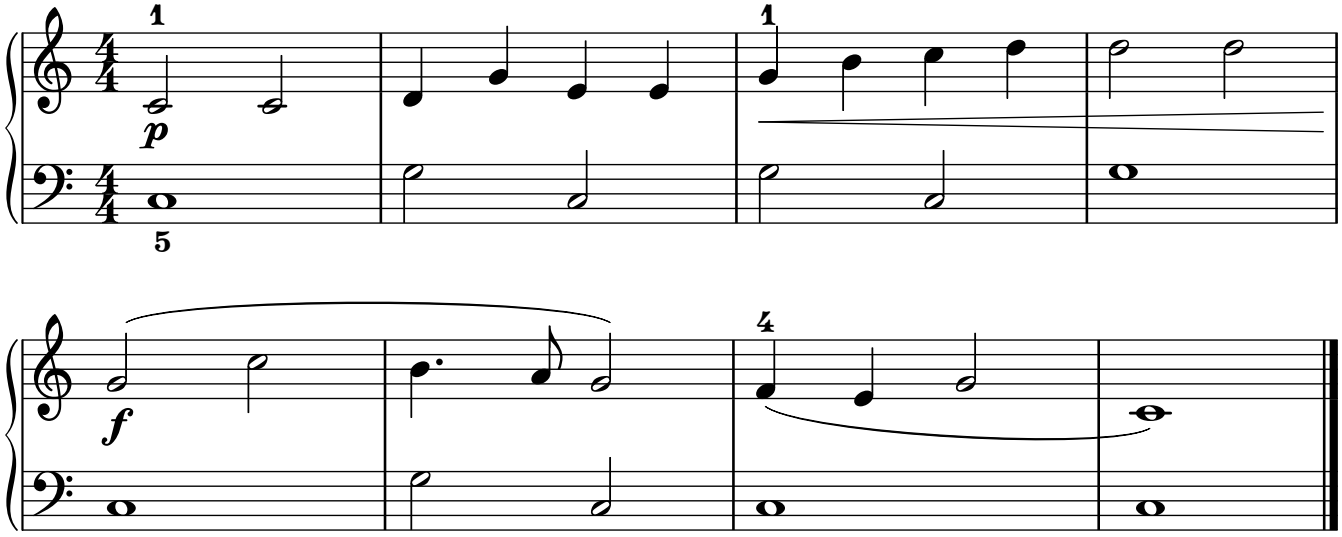


☐ **5.20**
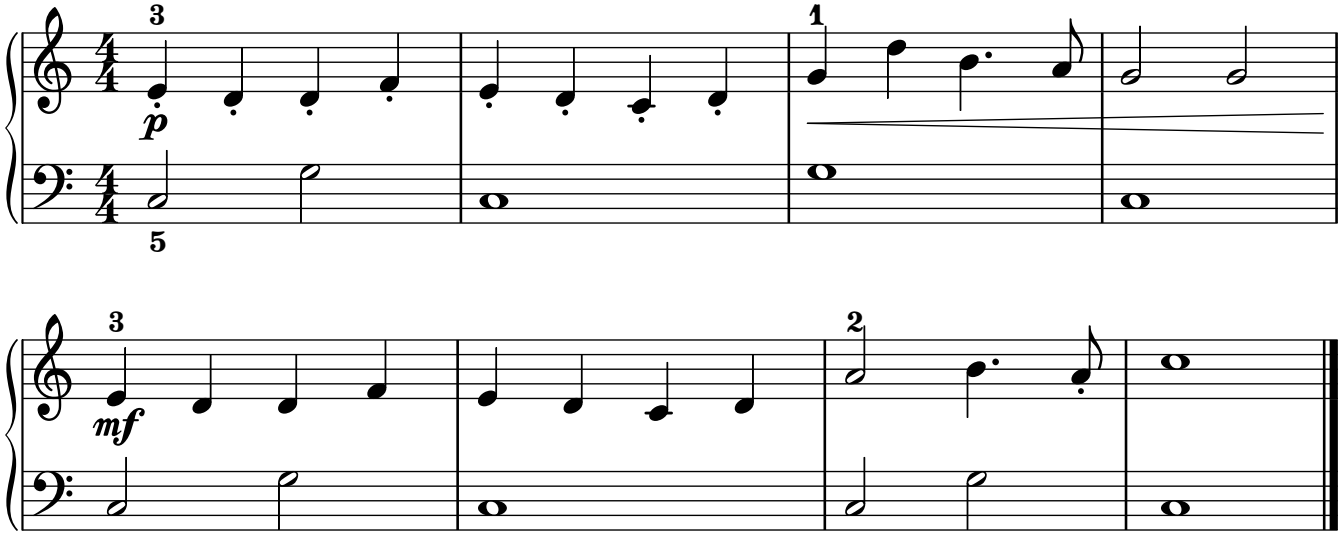
5.21
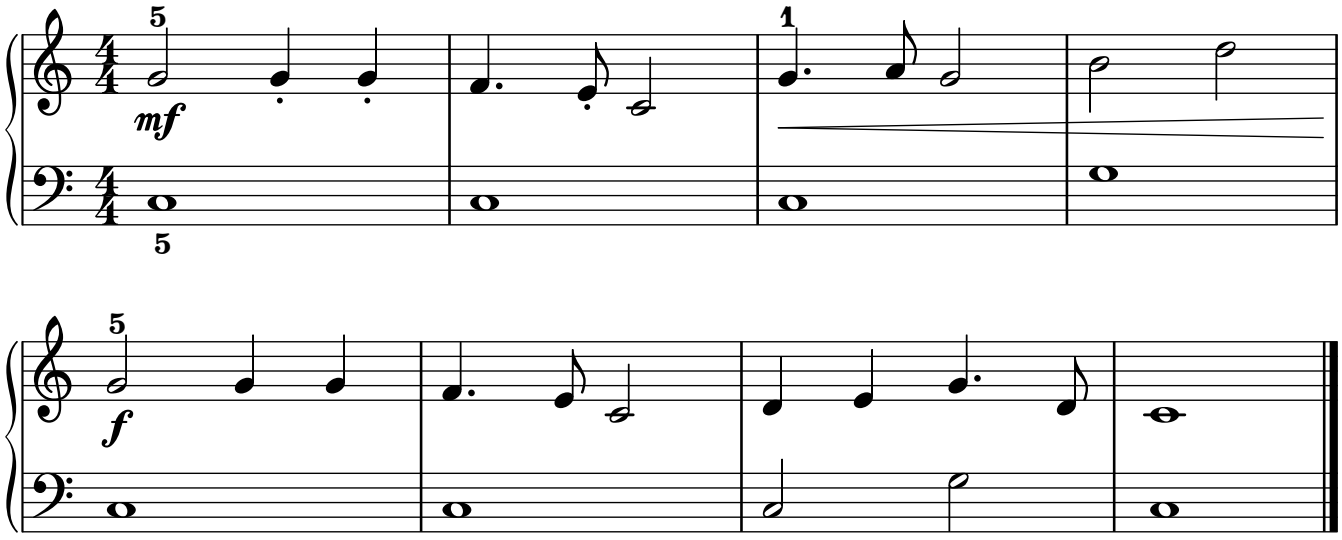


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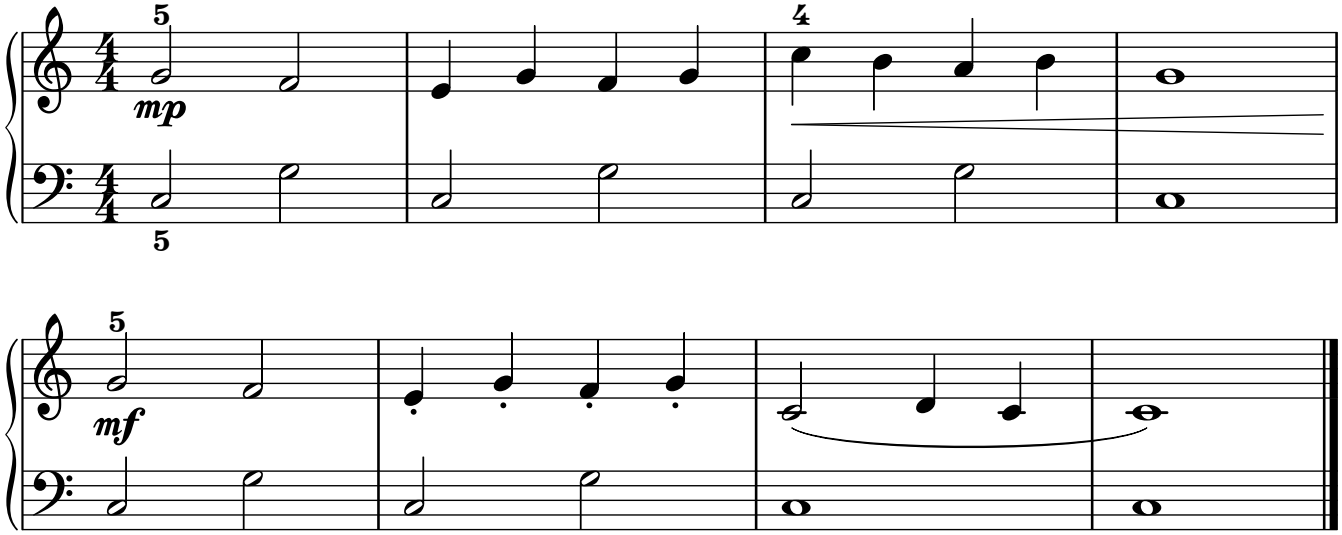


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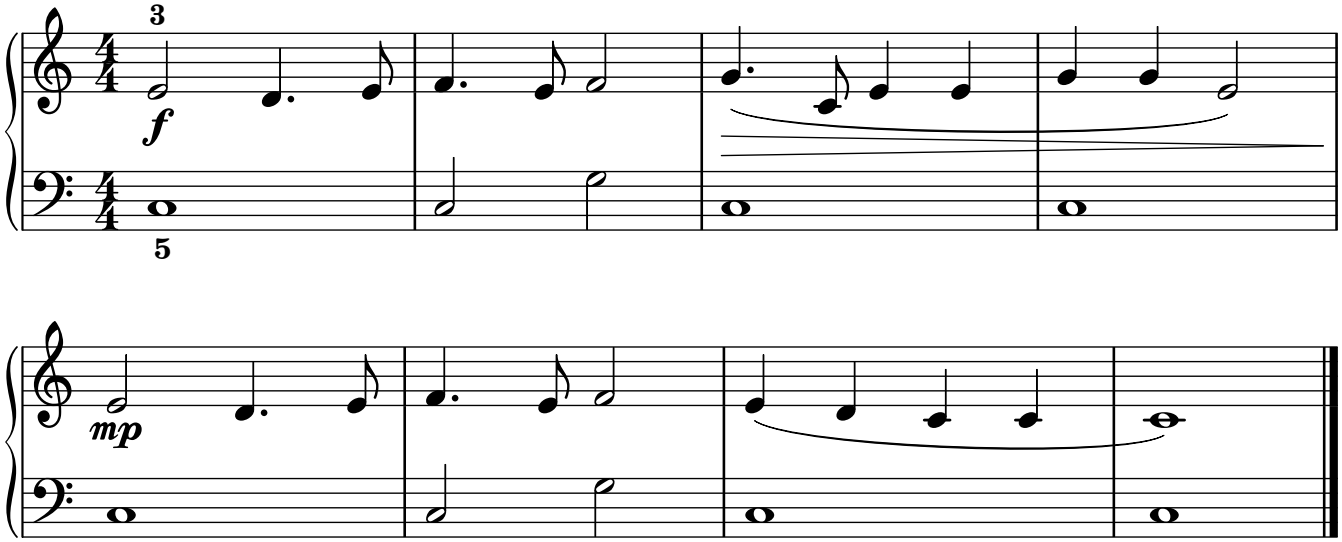


5.24



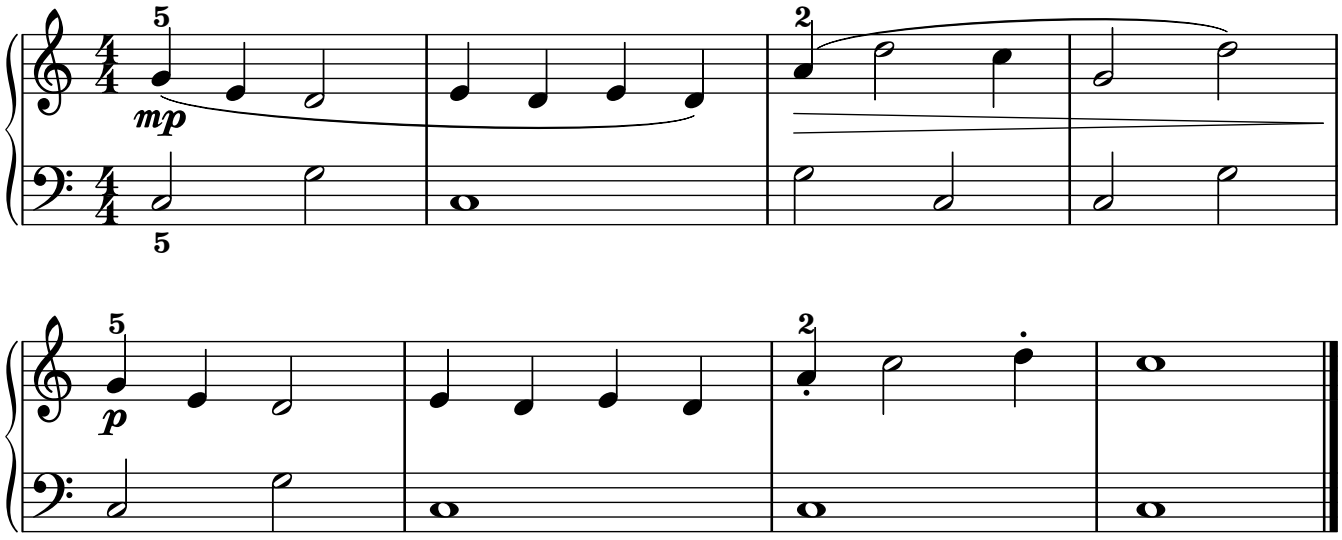
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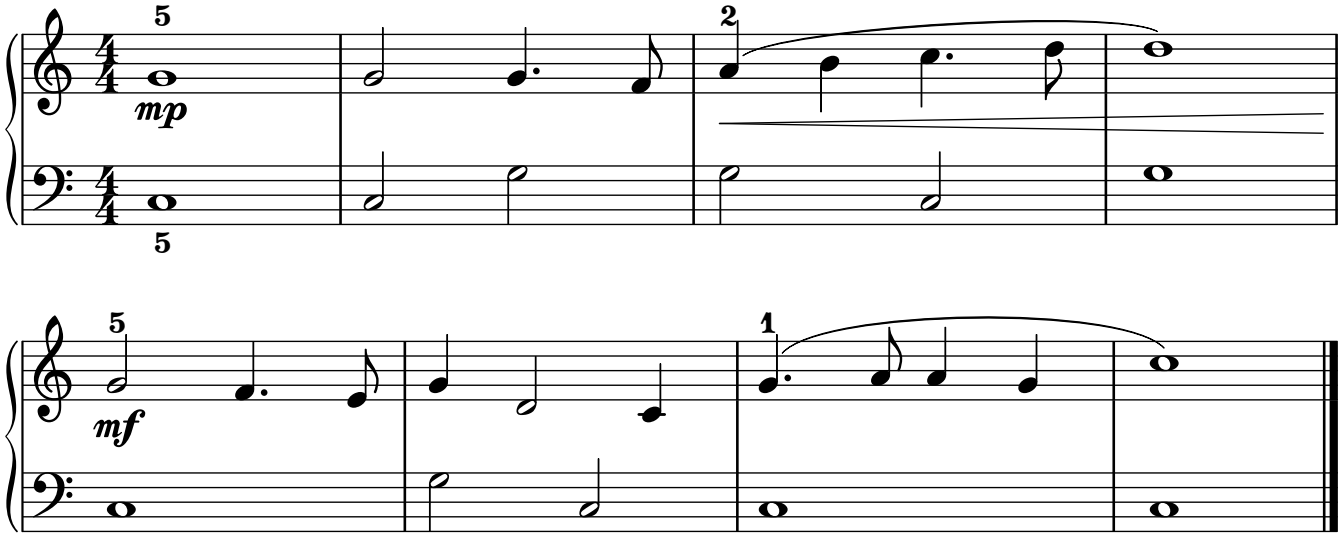


5.26



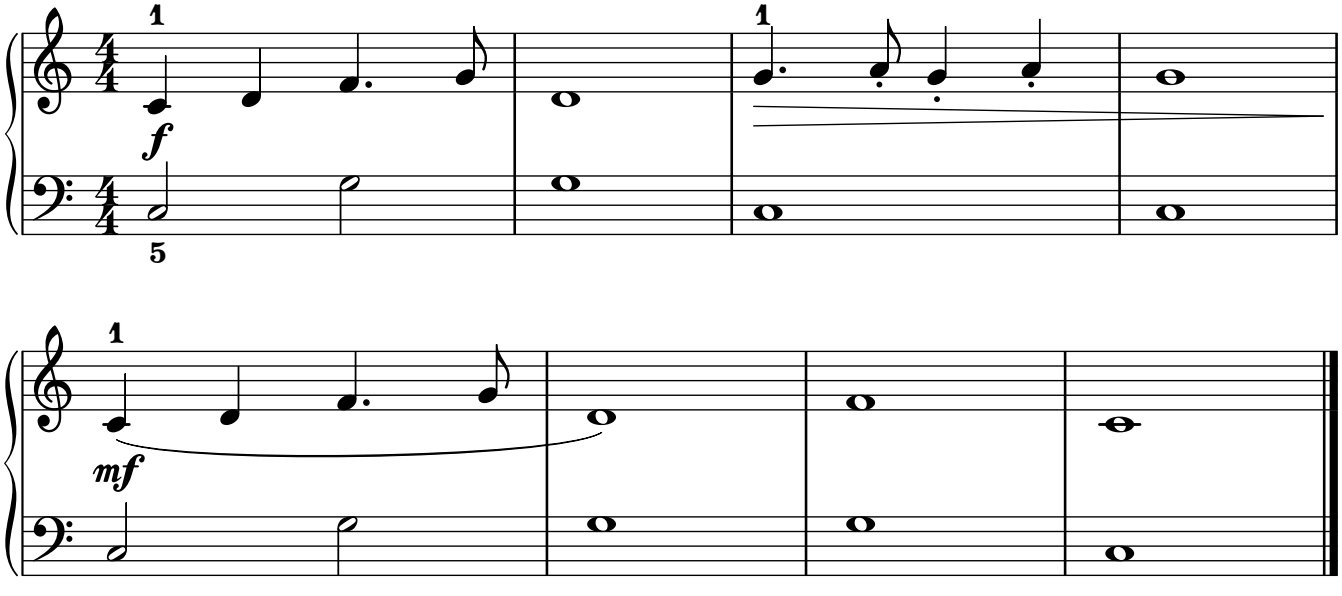
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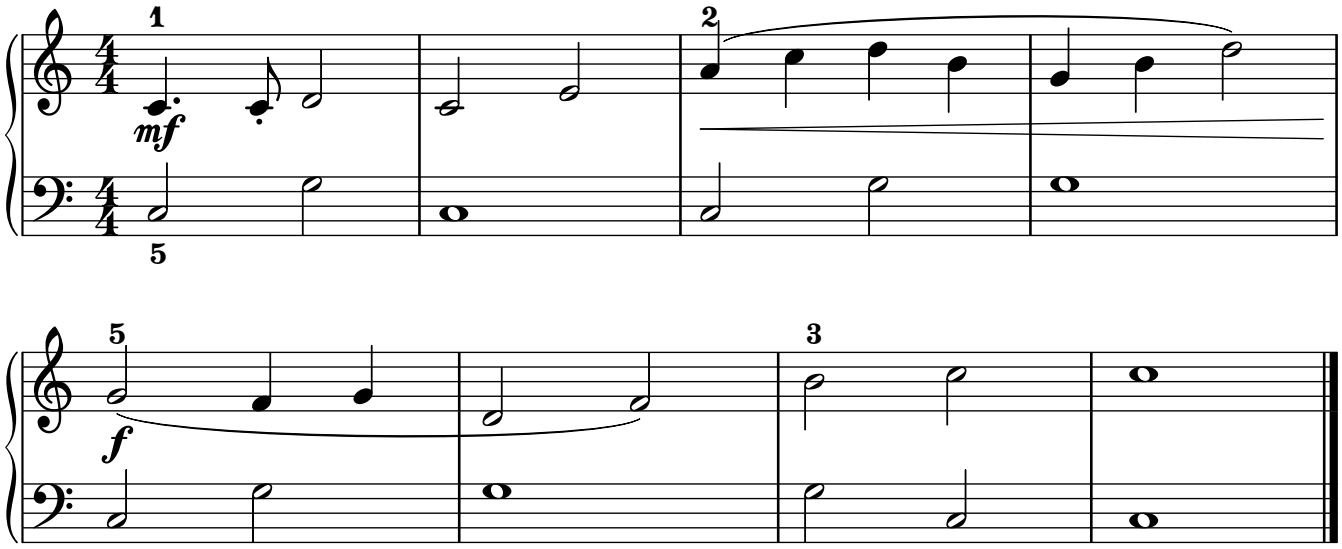


5.28



5.29



5.30
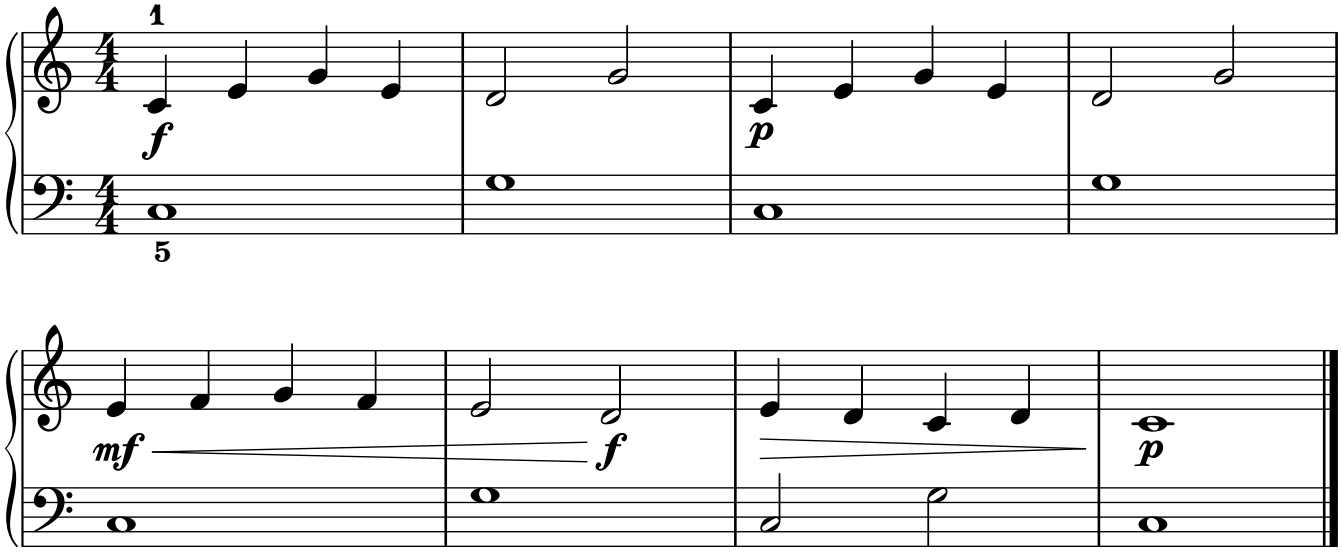


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Echo Valley ♩ = 76

Original

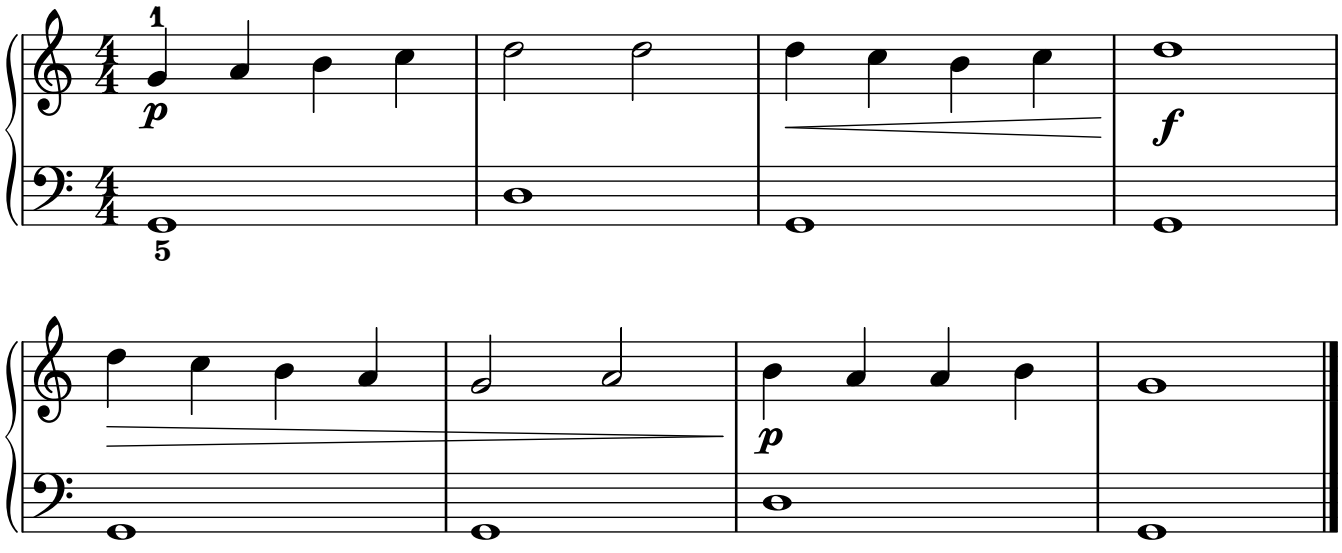
A loud call answered by a soft echo, then a crescendo to forte and a diminuendo to the end.



Storm and Calm ♩ = 72

Original
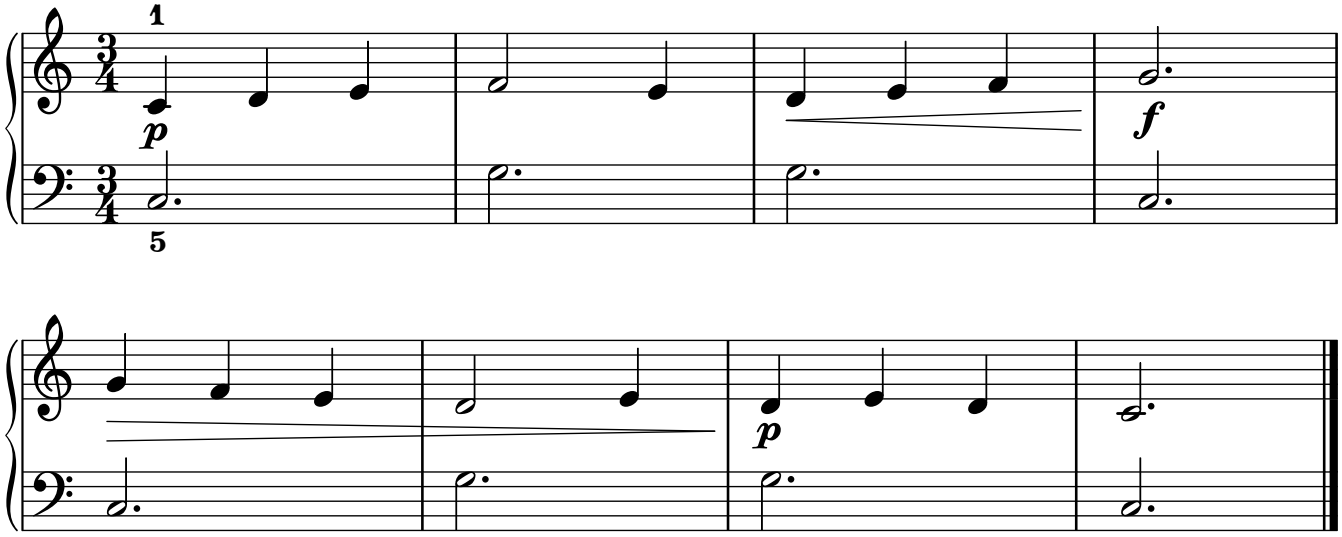
In G position. The storm builds to forte in bar 4, then calms down again.



Waltz in Waves ♩ = 84

Original

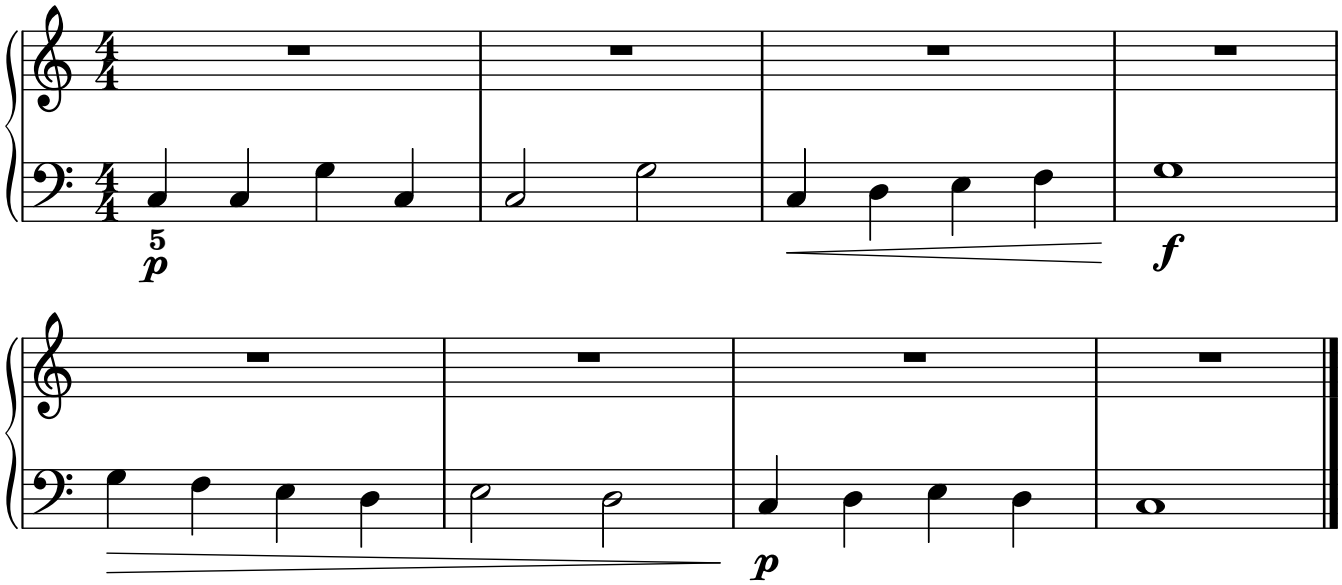
Each half of the waltz swells like a wave: grow towards bar 4, then fade towards the end.



Distant Drums ♩ = 72

Original

For the left hand alone: drums approach (crescendo) and fade away (diminuendo).



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 6?

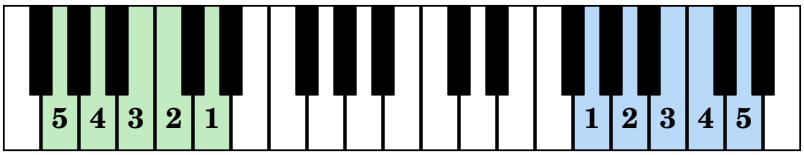
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if a listener could hear every dynamic level and each crescendo or diminuendo.
- Pass if the tempo stays steady through every dynamic change, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 6.

Unit 6

G Major

New: Key signature of one sharp (F-sharp); G and D positions

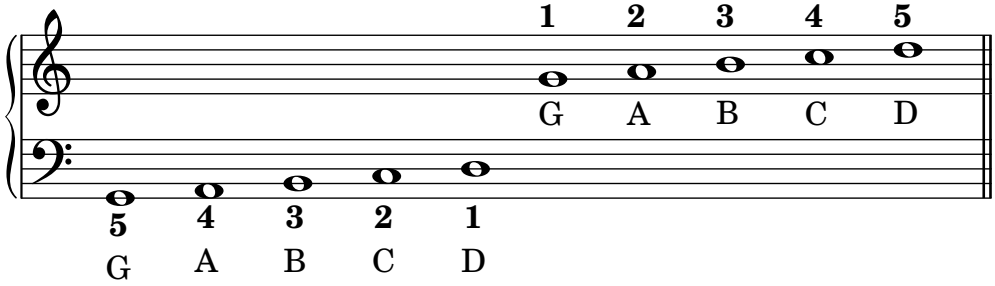
G major has one sharp in its key signature: F-sharp. Every F in the piece is played as F-sharp, on the black key. In this unit the hands use G position (which has no F at all) and D position (D E F-sharp G A). Both belong to G major.

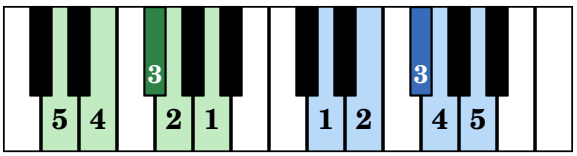


Middle C

Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

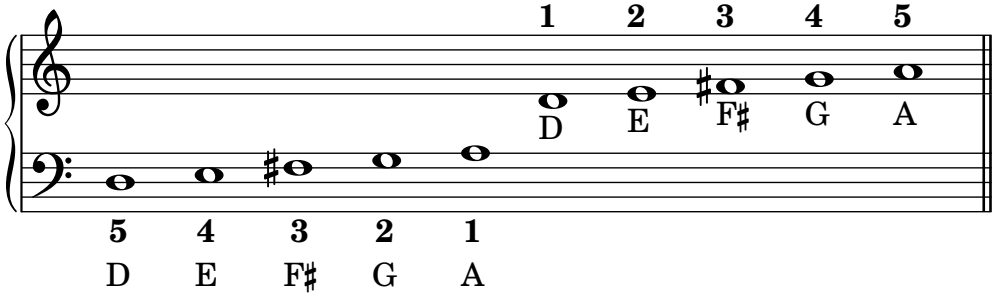




Middle C

Left hand D position and Right hand D position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

The key signature of G major

One sharp, on the top line of the treble staff and the fourth line of the bass staff. Both lines are F, so every F is F-sharp.

Home note

Pieces in G major usually end on G, and the bass often plays G and D.

Two positions

G position is G A B C D. D position is D E F-sharp G A, with finger 3 on the black key. The right hand's two positions overlap on G and A.

Moving between them

From G position down to D position the thumb moves from G to D, a 4th lower; the finger numbers show each move.

Reading tips

1. Check the key signature first. One sharp means G major (or E minor, which comes in Unit 9).

2. In D position, finger 3 lives on F-sharp. Put it there before you play.

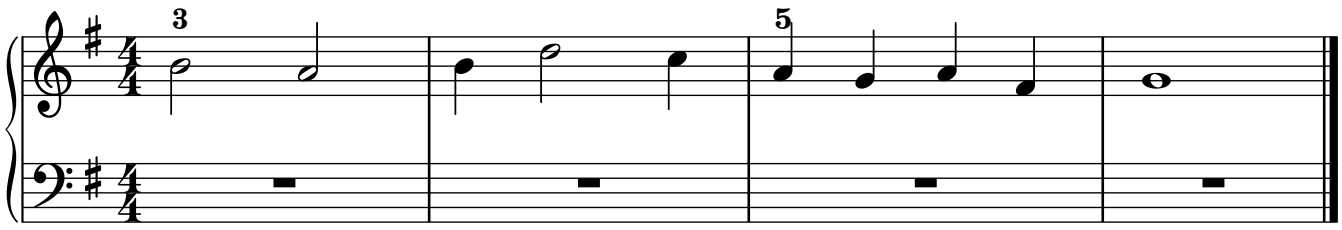
3. Look for the shift signs (finger numbers), just as in Unit 1.

4. Keep going even if you miss an F-sharp.

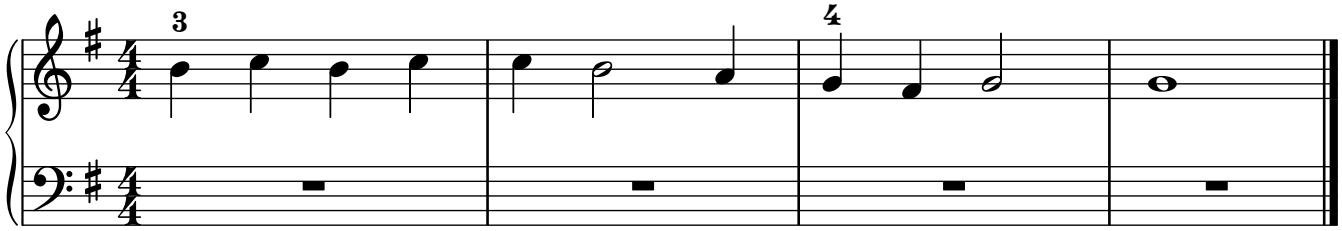
Part A: Right hand in G major ♩ = 60

Right hand in G major, moving between G and D positions. Metronome 60.

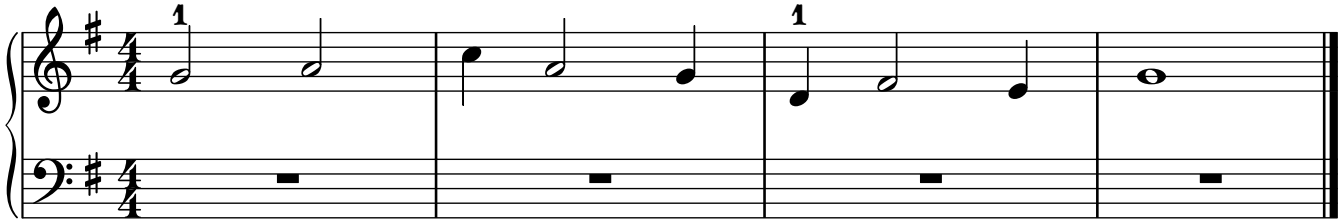
☐ **6.1**



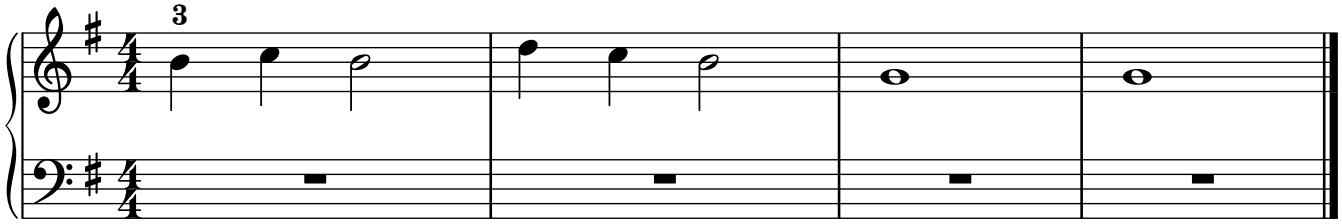
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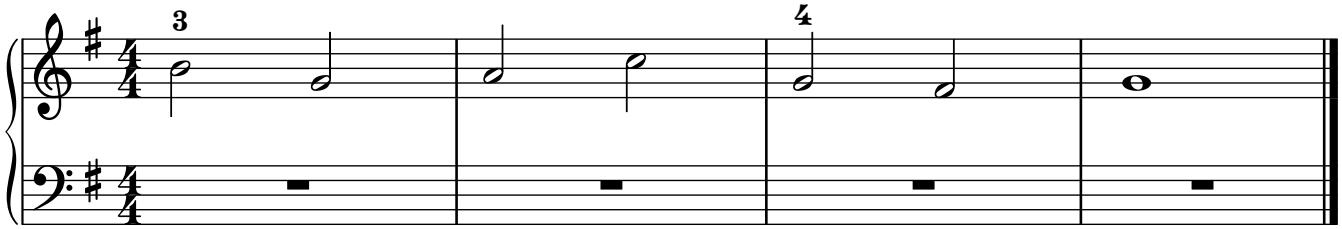
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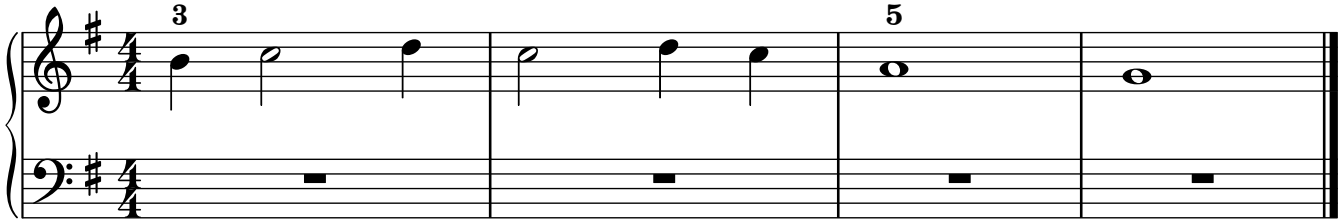
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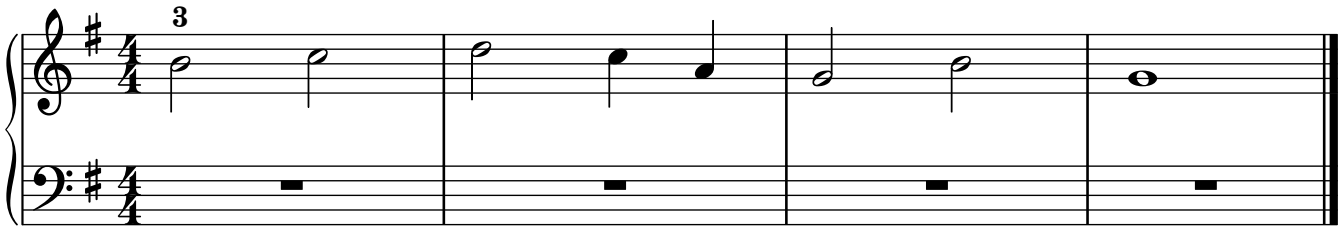
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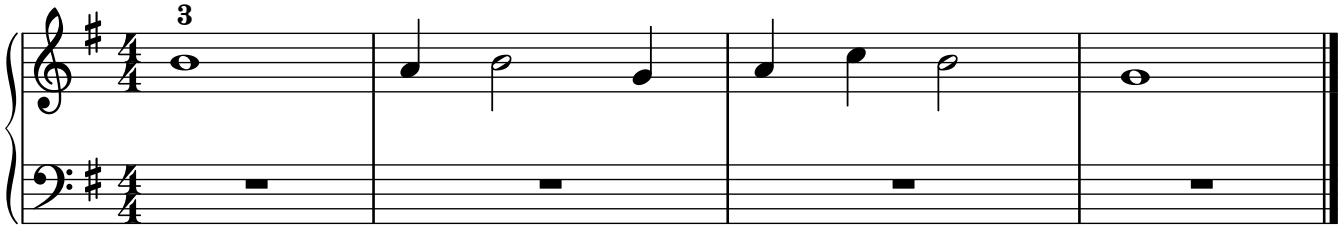
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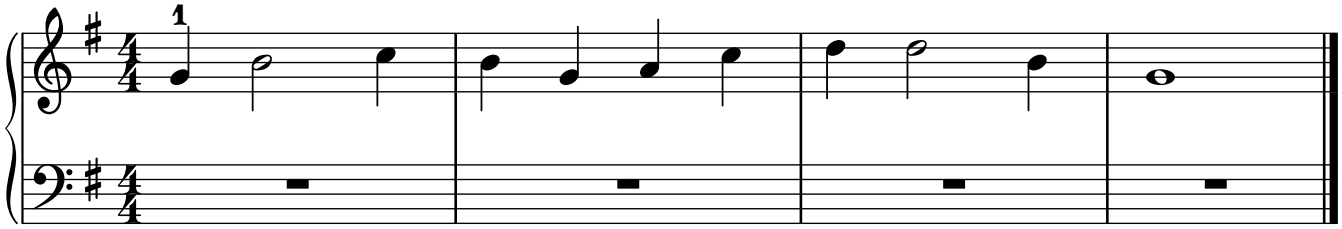
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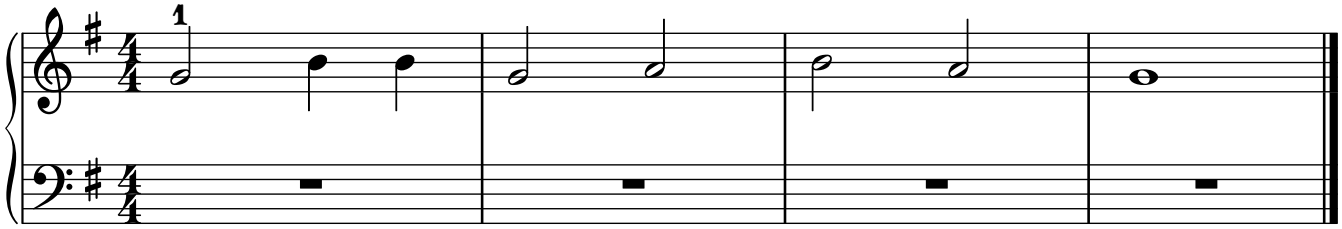
☐ **6.8**



☐ **6.9**



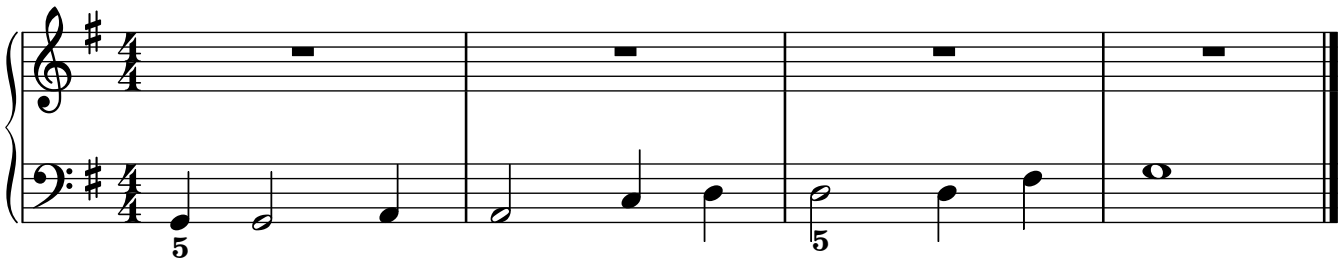
☐ **6.10**



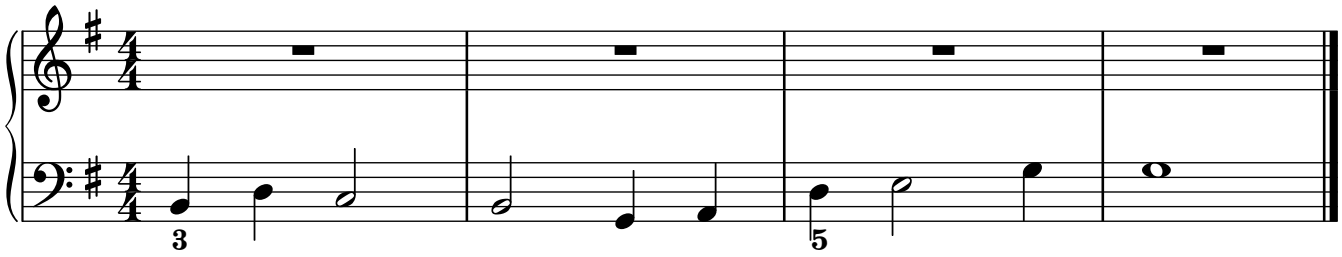
Part B: Left hand in G major ♩ = 60

Left hand in G major: G position (G on the bottom line) and D position (D on the middle line).

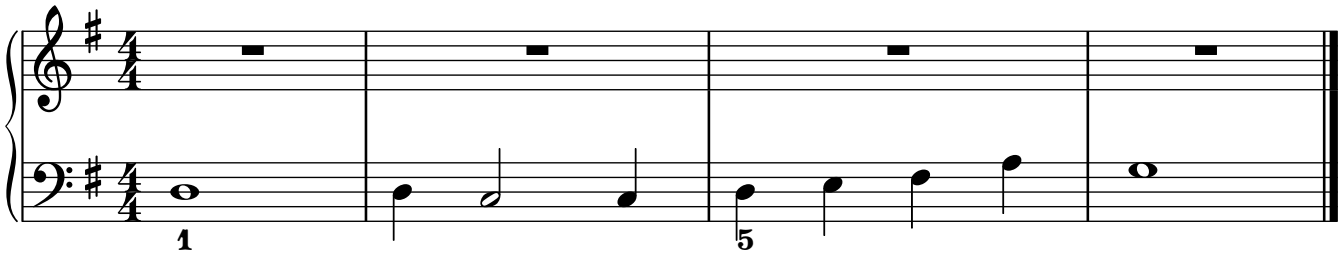
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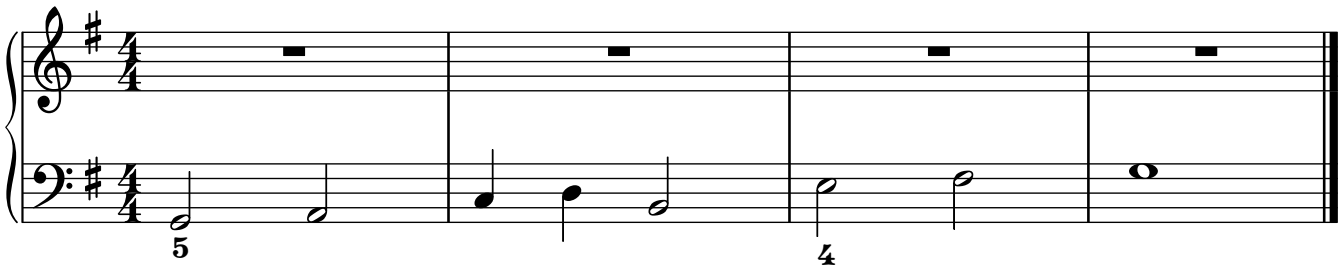


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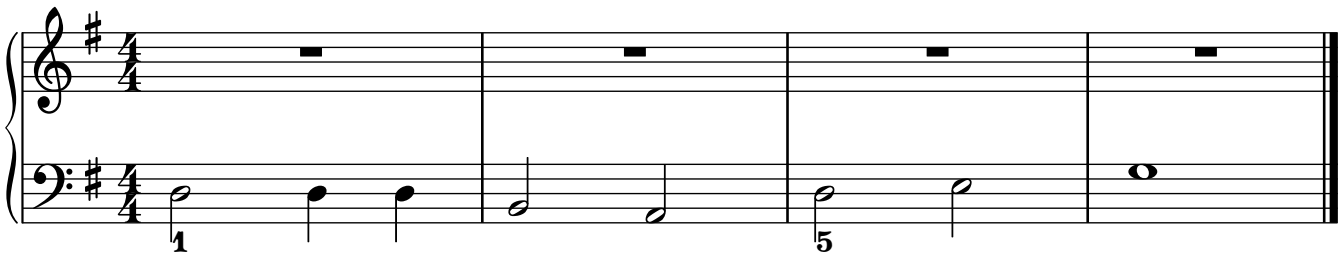
☐ **6.13**



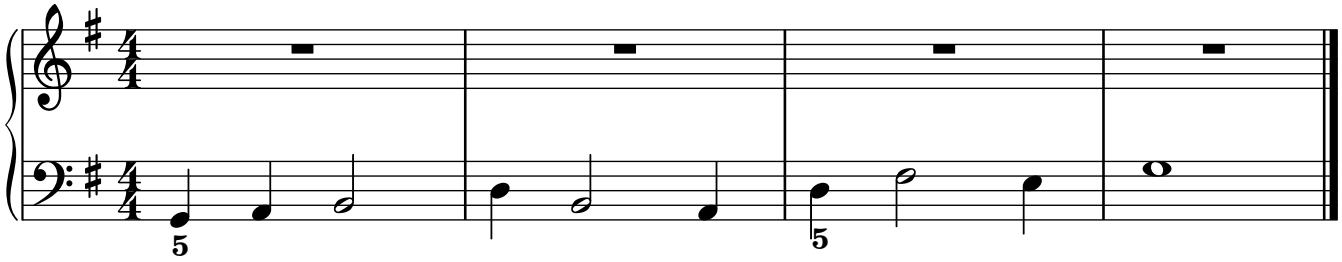
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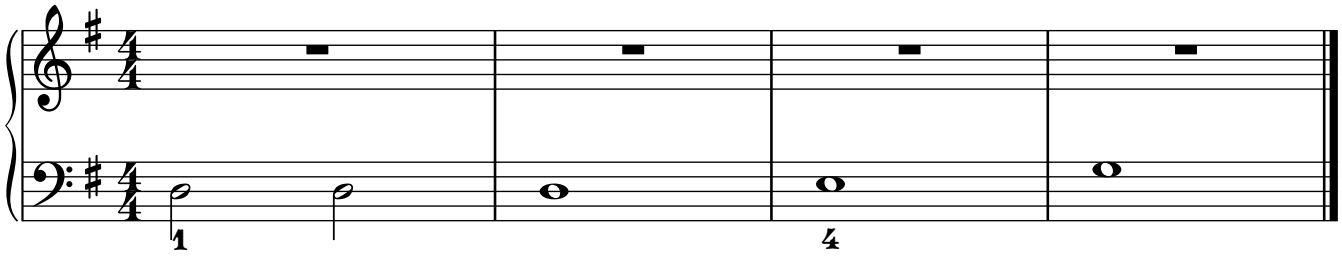
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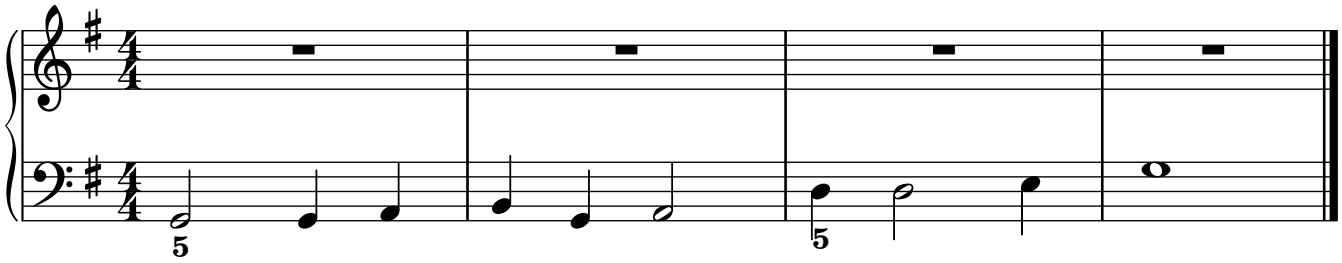


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6.17
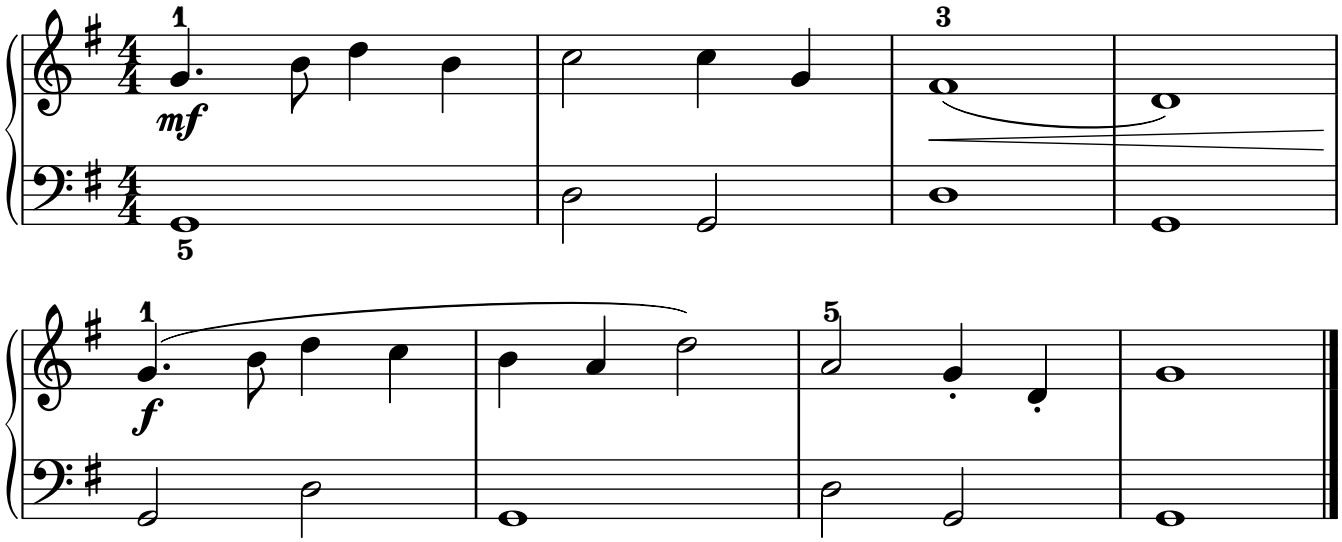


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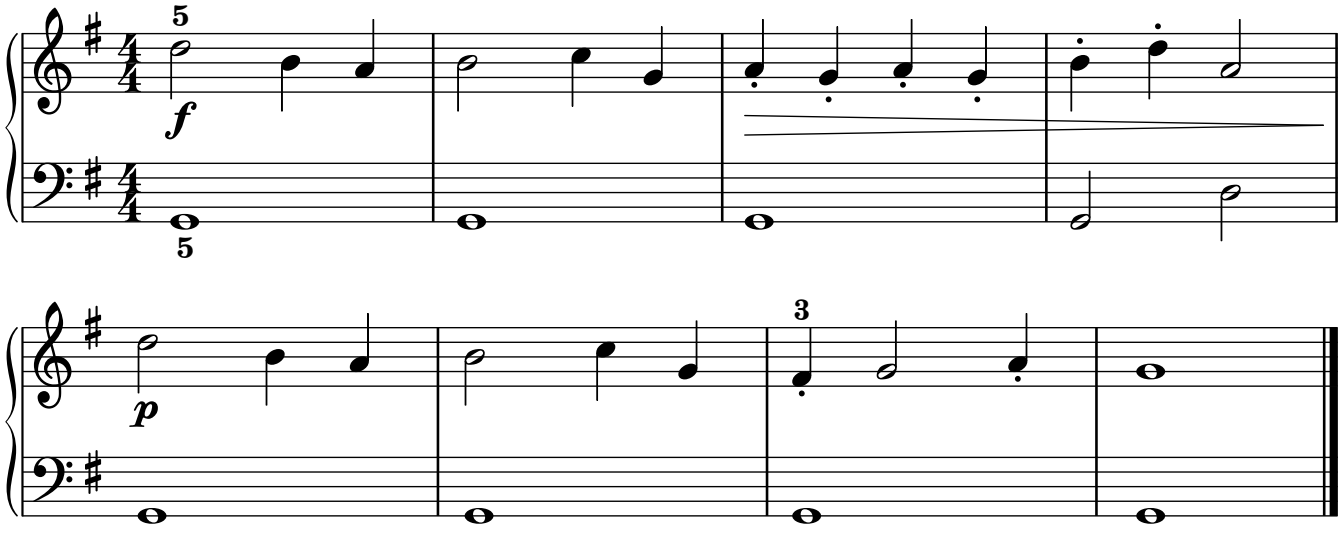


Part C: G major, hands together ♩ = 66

Hands together in G major, with dynamics and articulation.
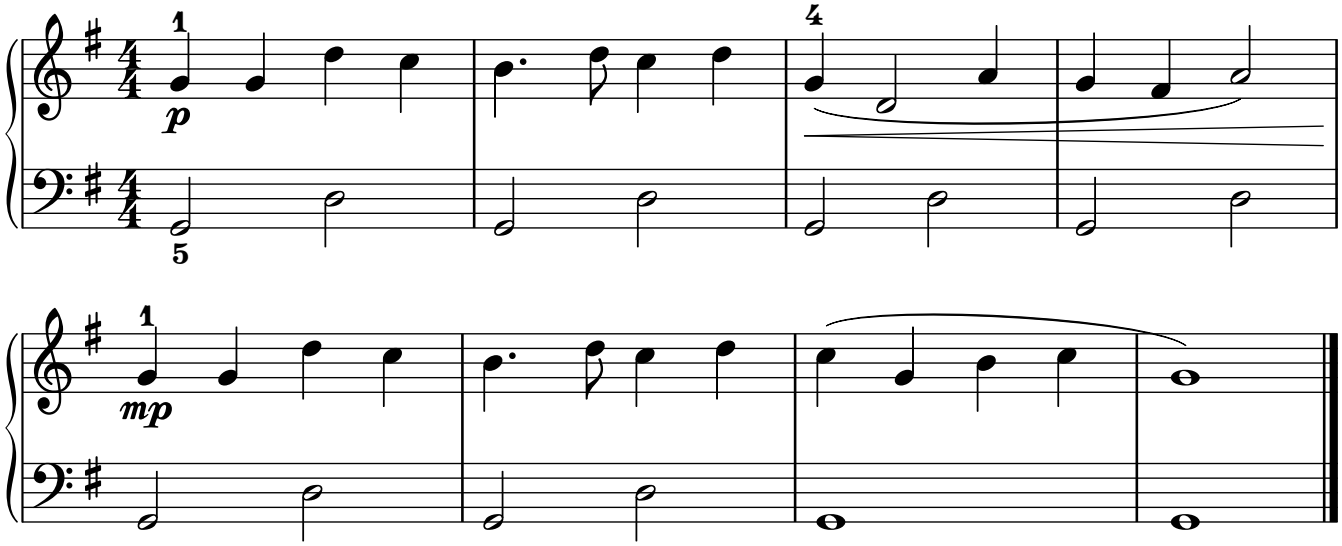
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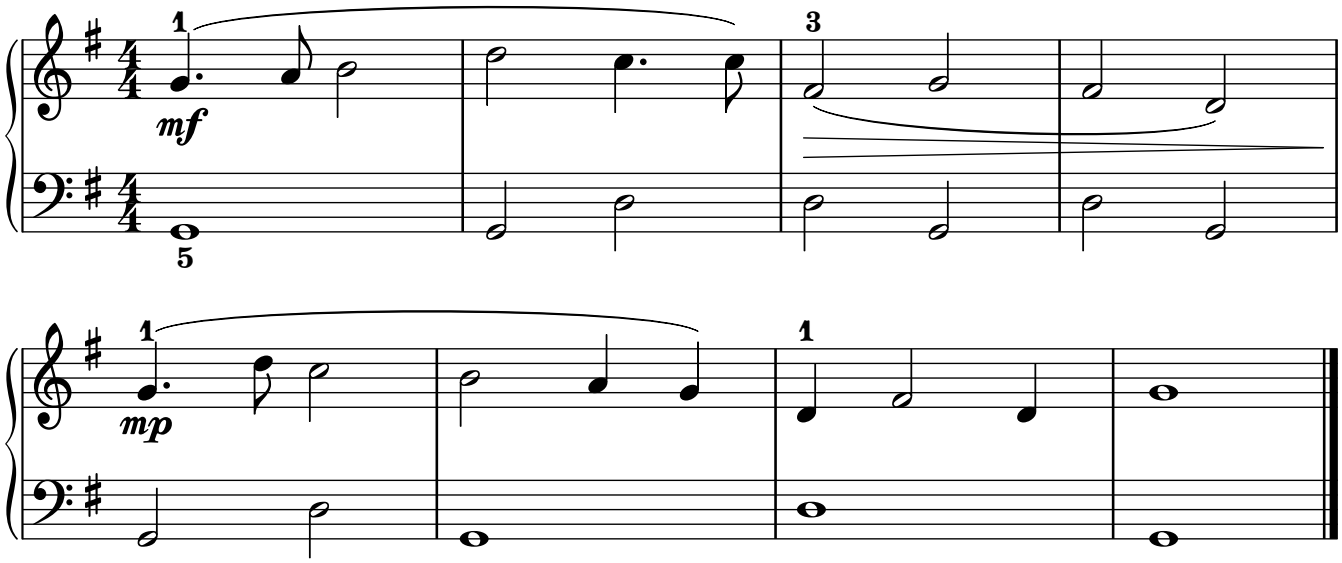


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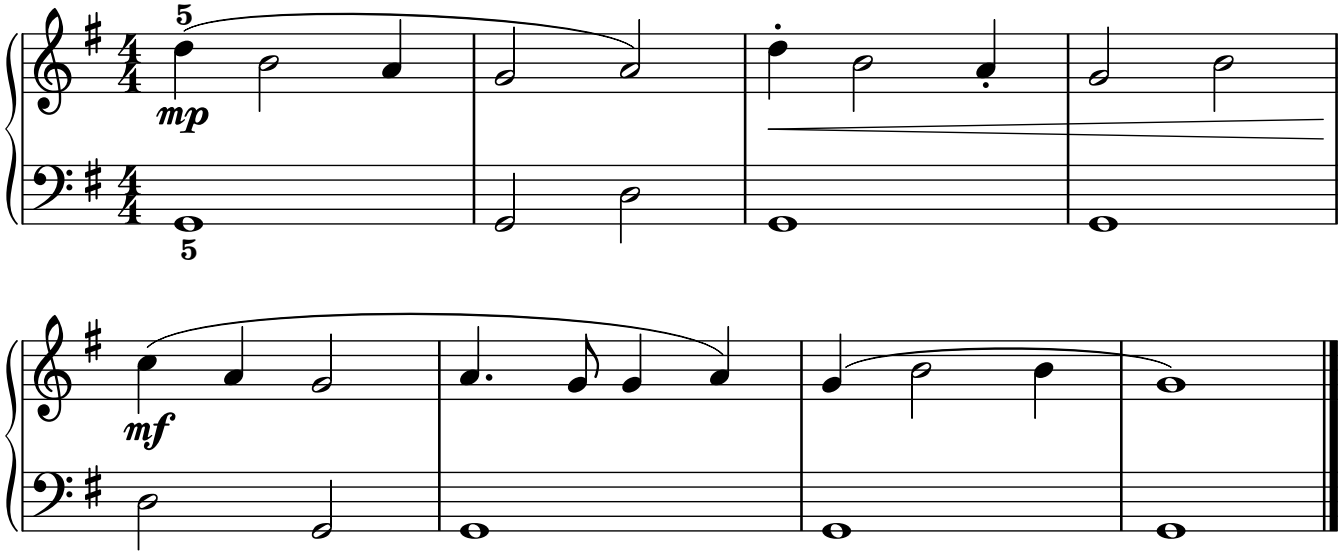


☐ **6.21**



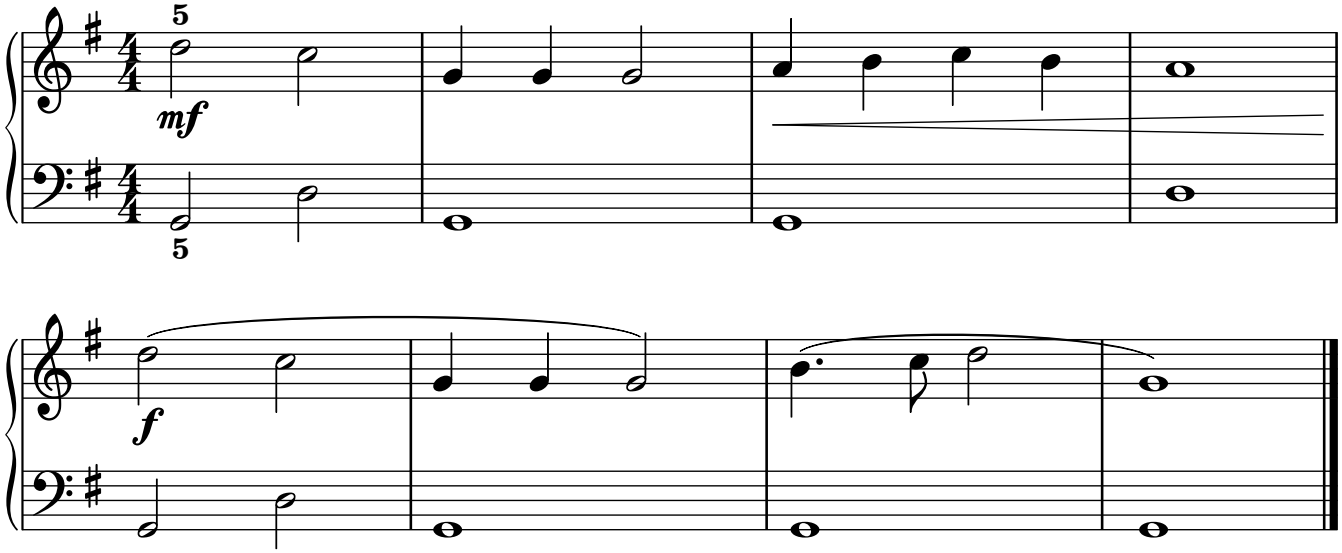
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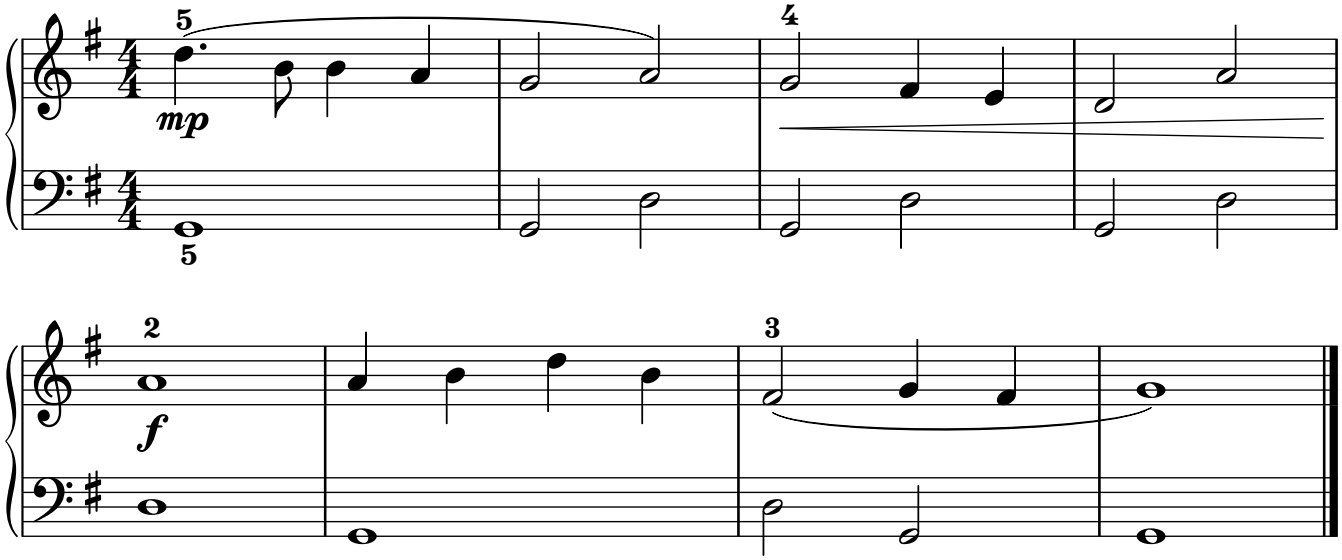


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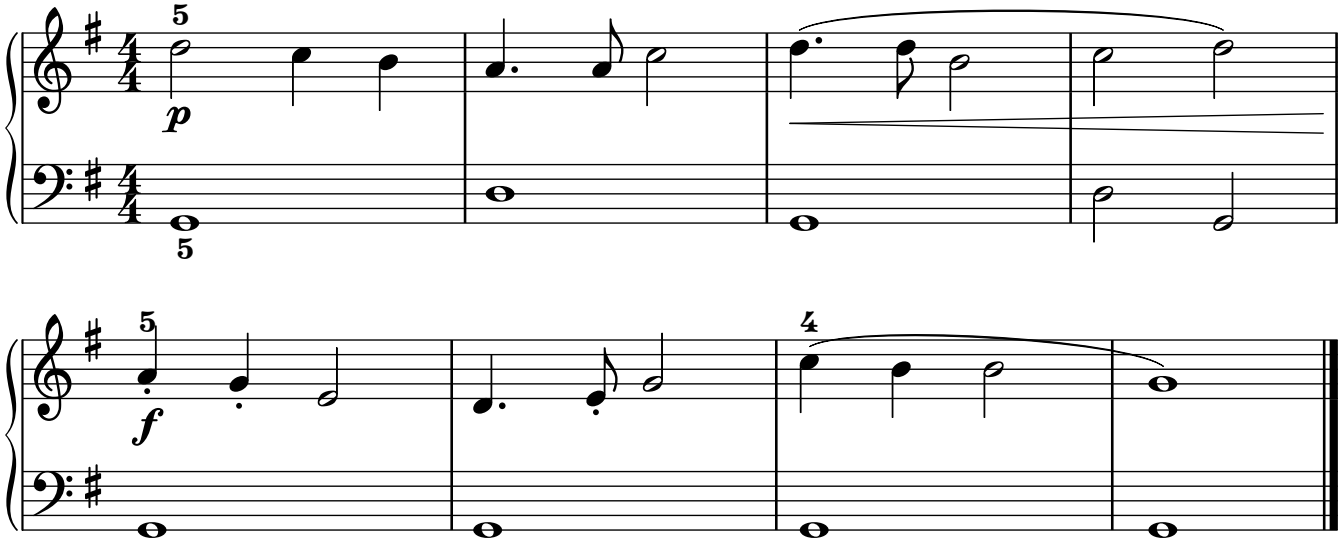


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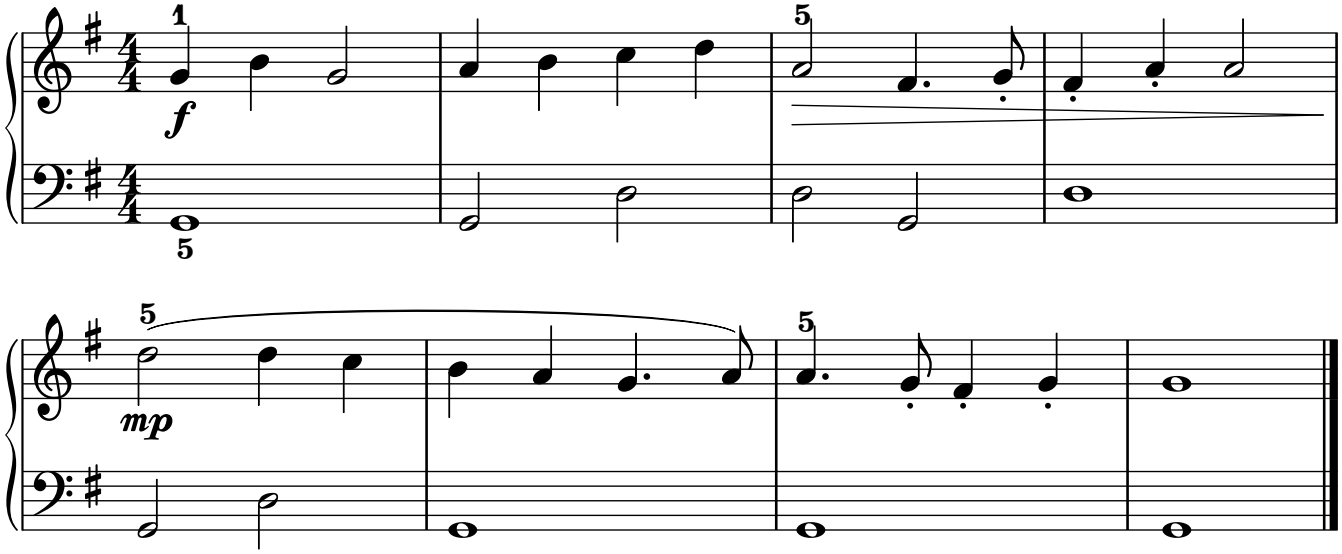


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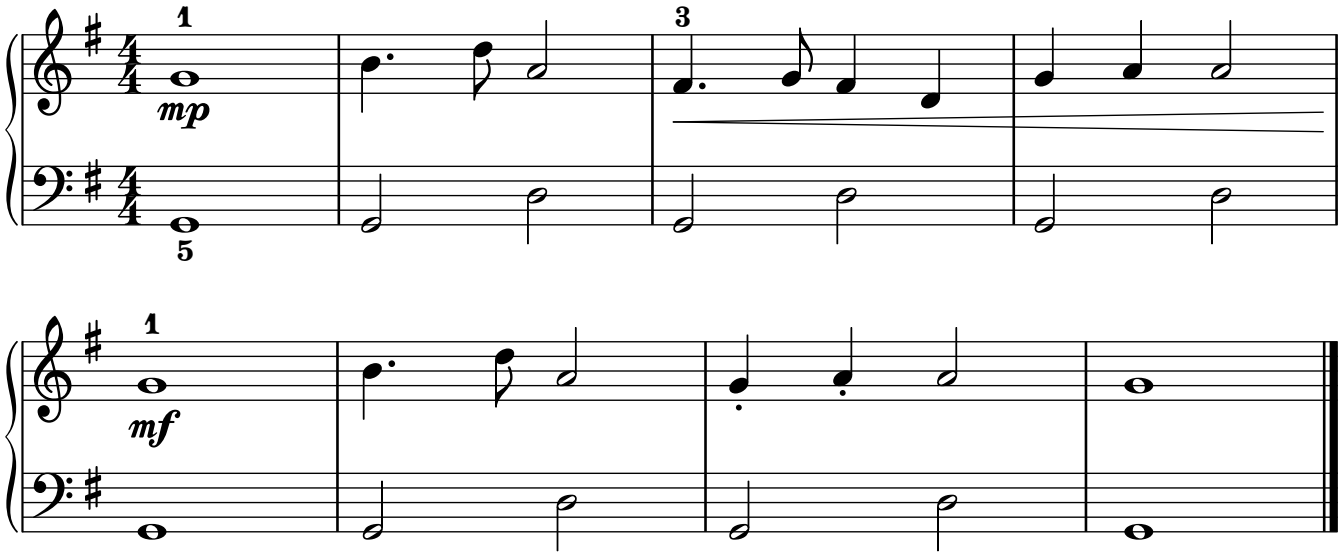


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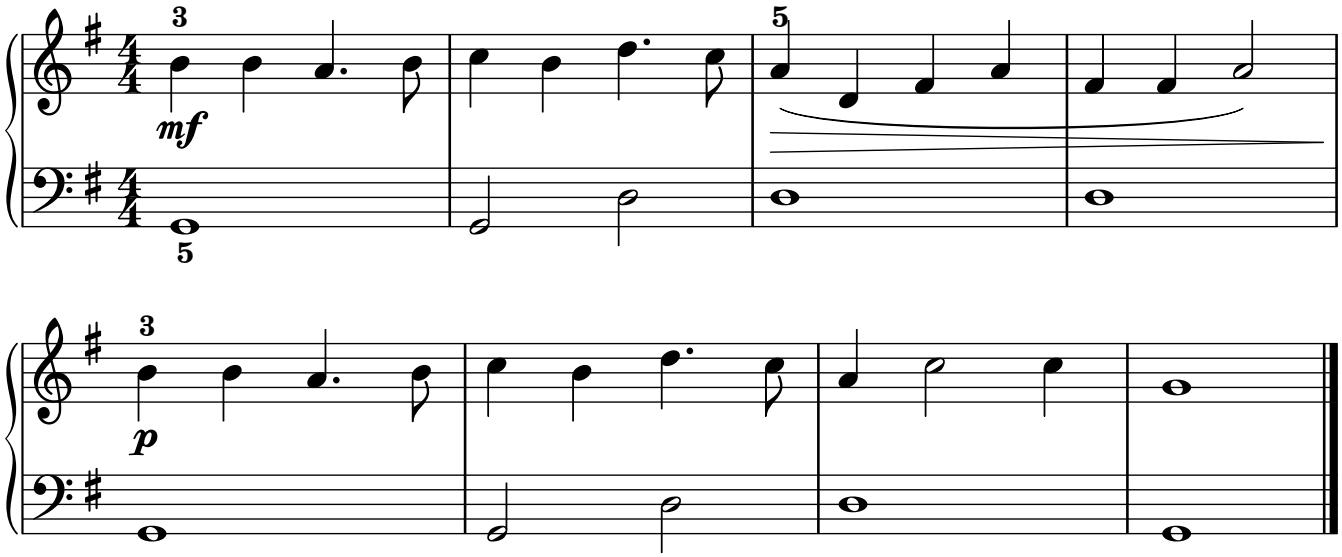


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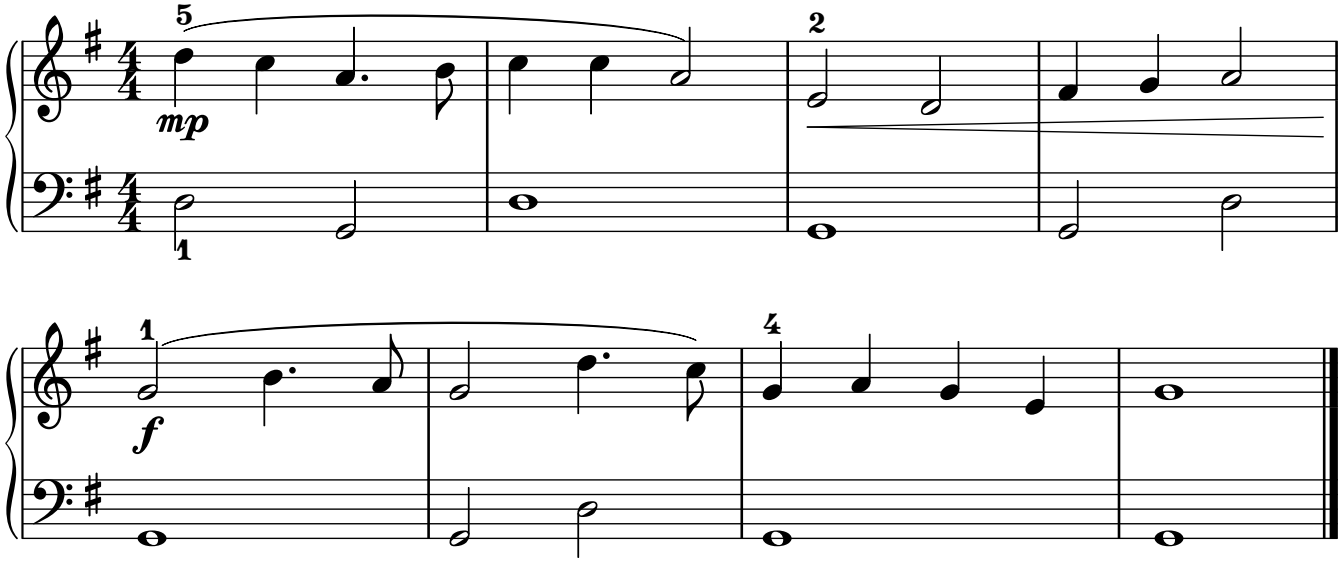


6.28



6.29



6.30
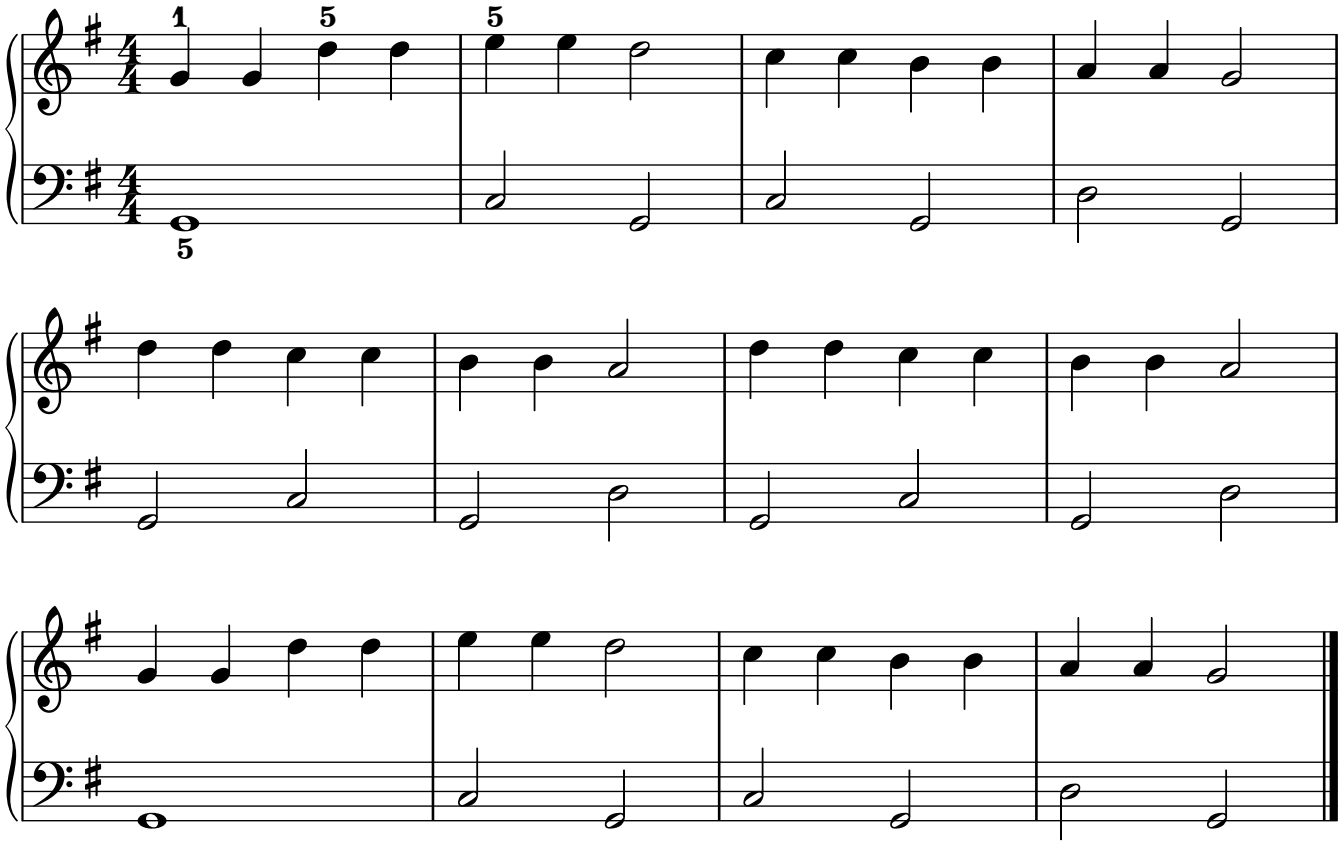


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Twinkle, Twinkle in G ♩ = 80

Traditional (French melody 'Ah! vous dirai-je, maman')
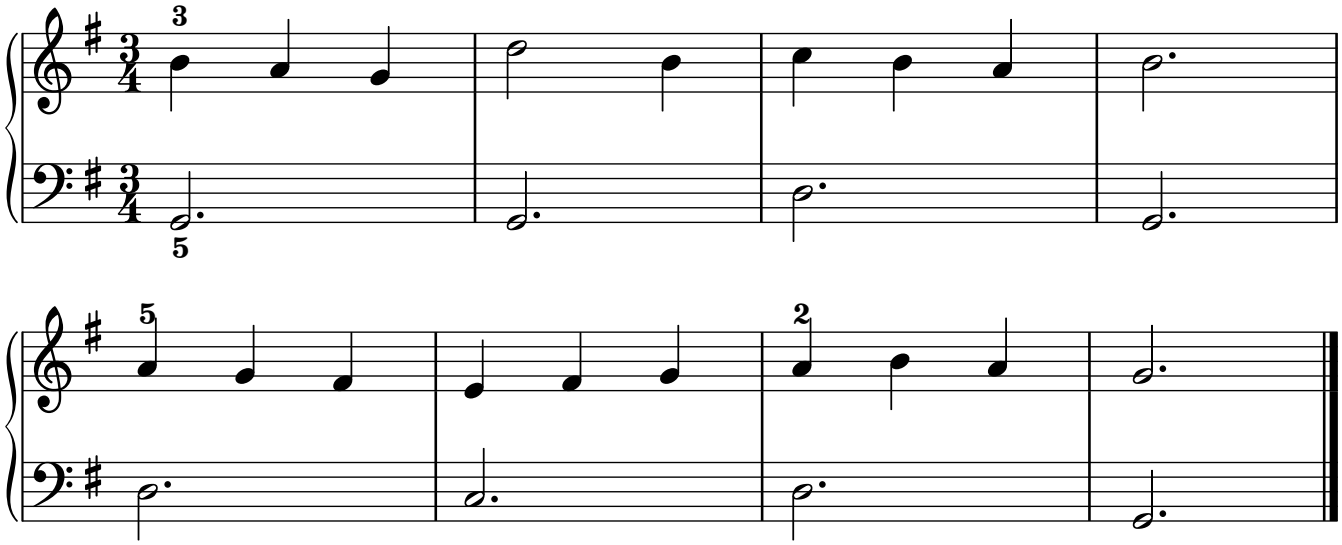
The little finger stretches up to E in bars 2 and 10. The left hand adds C (finger 2) and D (finger 1) to its G.



Country Dance in G ♩ = 84

Original
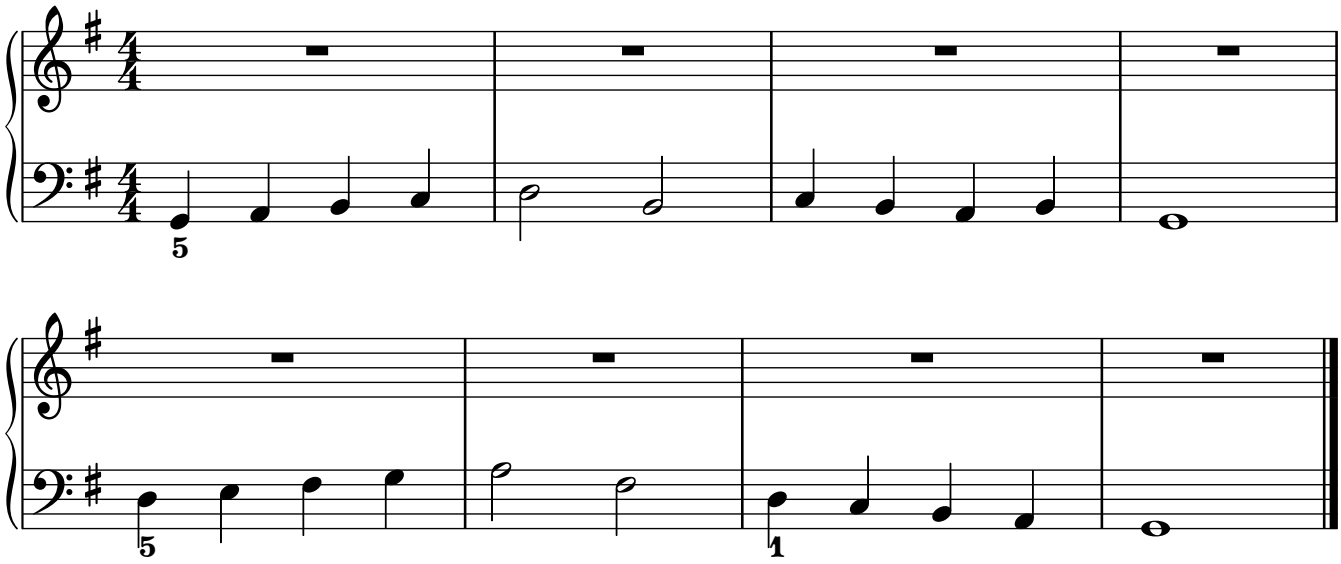
In bar 5 the right hand shifts down to D position, bringing finger 3 onto F-sharp; in bar 7 it moves back to G position.



Left-Hand Walk in G ♩ = 72

Original

For the left hand alone. It shifts up to D position in bar 5 (F-sharp under finger 3) and back to G position in bar 7.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 7?

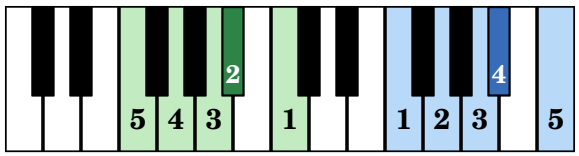
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if every F is played as F-sharp without hesitation.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 7.

Unit 7

F Major

New: Key signature of one flat (B-flat); F and C positions

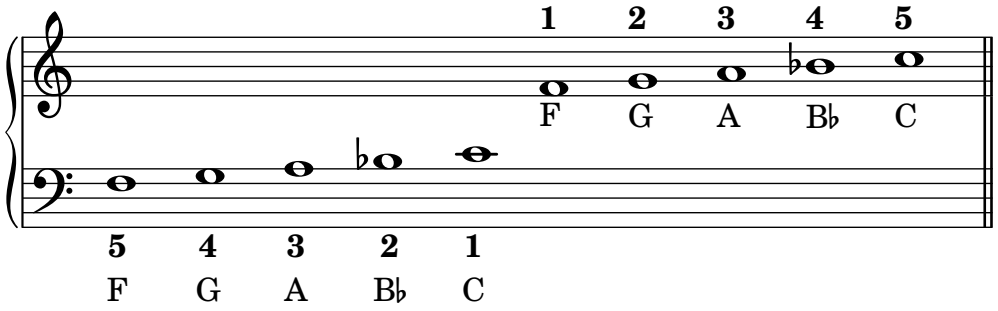
F major has one flat in its key signature: B-flat. Every B is played as B-flat. The hands use F position (F G A B-flat C) and C position (C D E F G). Both belong to F major.

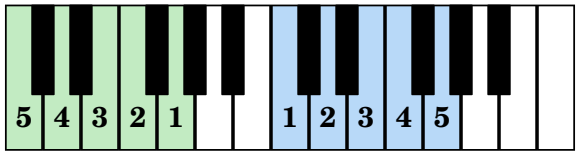


Middle C

Left hand F position and Right hand F position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

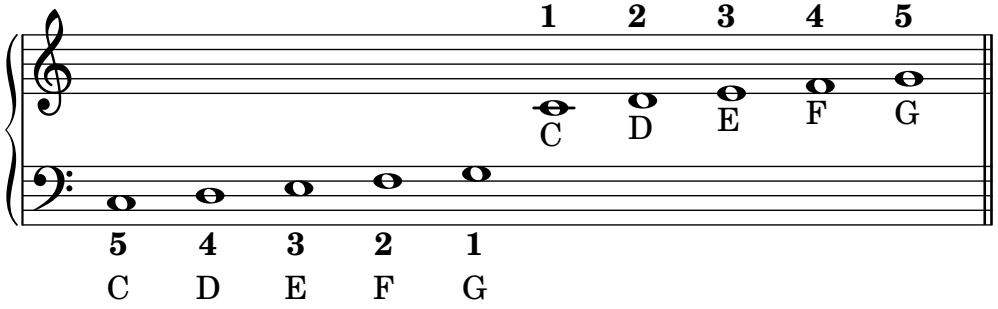




Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

The key signature of F major

One flat, on the middle line of the treble staff and the second line of the bass staff. Both lines are B, so every B is B-flat.

F position

F G A B-flat C. The black key is finger 4 in the right hand and finger 2 in the left hand.

Where the positions meet

The right hand's F and C positions overlap on F and G; the left hand's overlap on F and G too.

Home note

Pieces in F major usually end on F, and the bass often plays F and C.

Reading tips

1. One flat in the key signature means F major (or D minor, which comes in Unit 9).

2. In F position, put finger 4 (right hand) or finger 2 (left hand) on B-flat before you start.

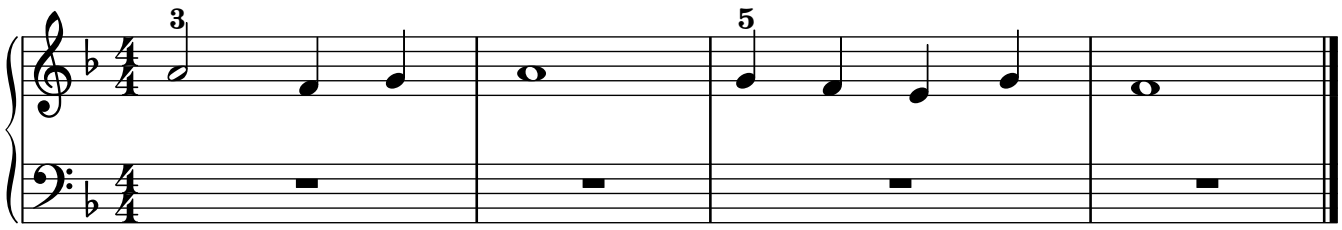
3. C position has no B at all, so after a shift into it there is nothing to remember.

4. Keep going even if you miss a B-flat.

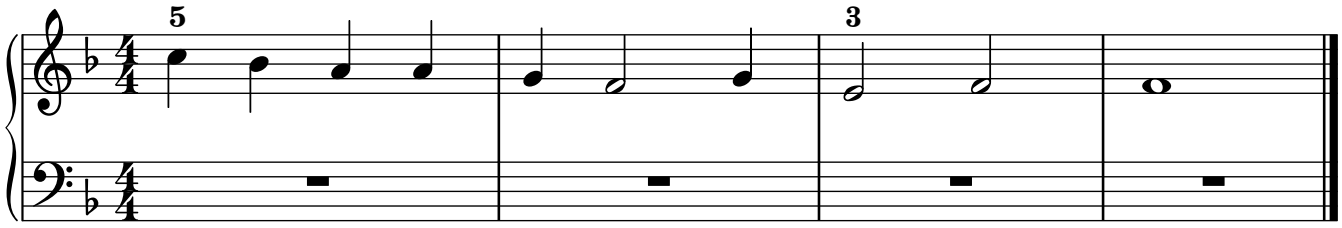
Part A: Right hand in F major ♩ = 60

Right hand in F major, moving between F and C positions. Metronome 60.

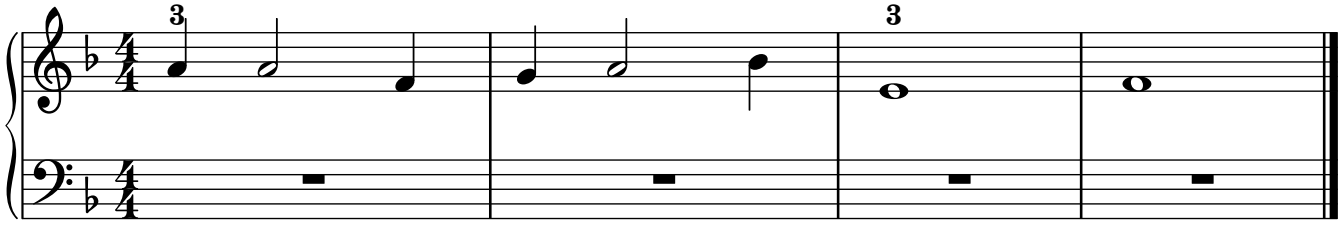
☐ **7.1**



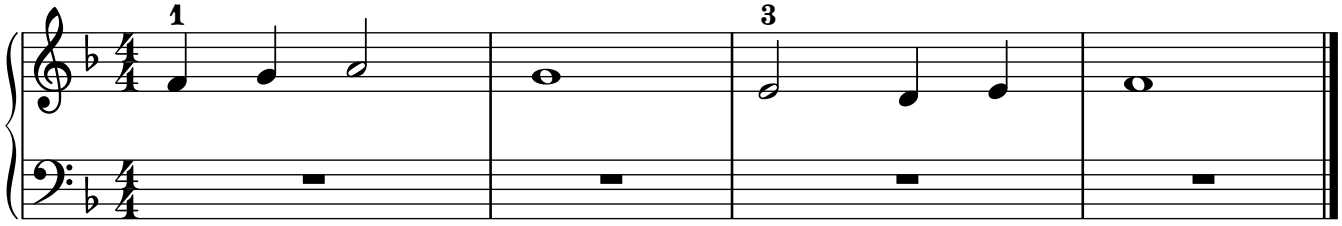
☐ **7.2**
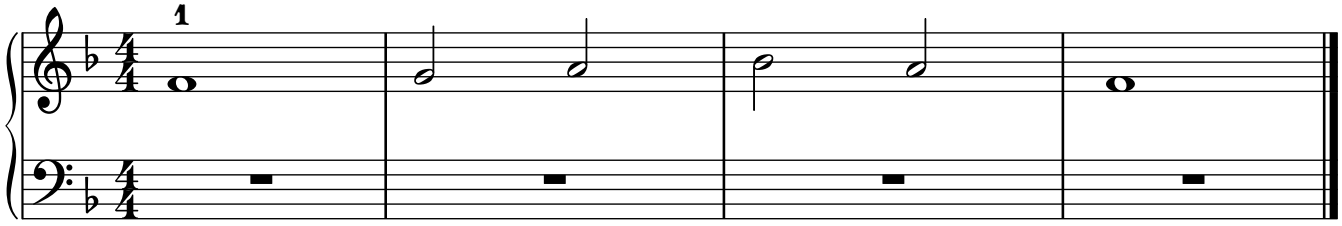


☐ **7.3**
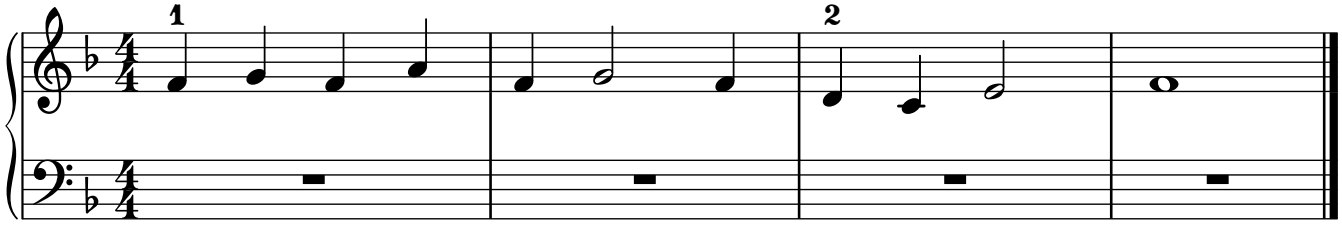


☐ **7.4**



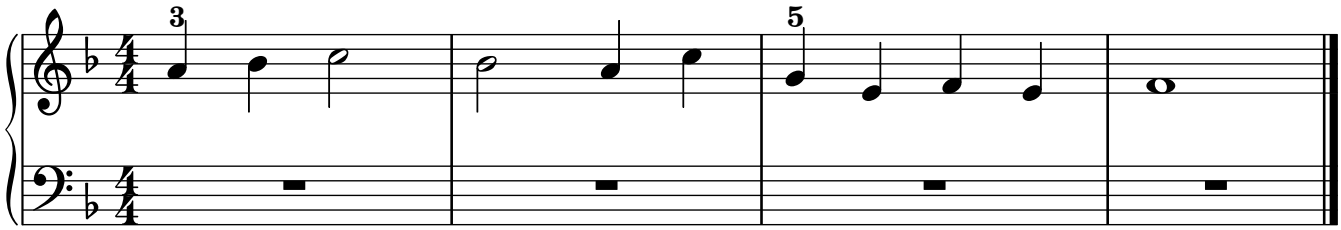
☐ **7.5**



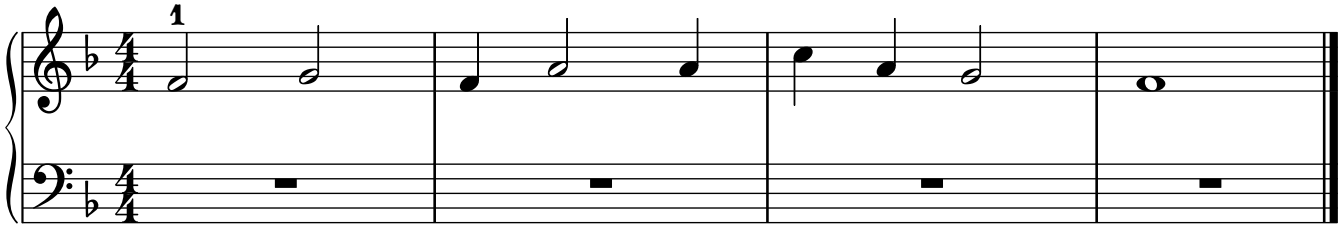
☐ **7.6**



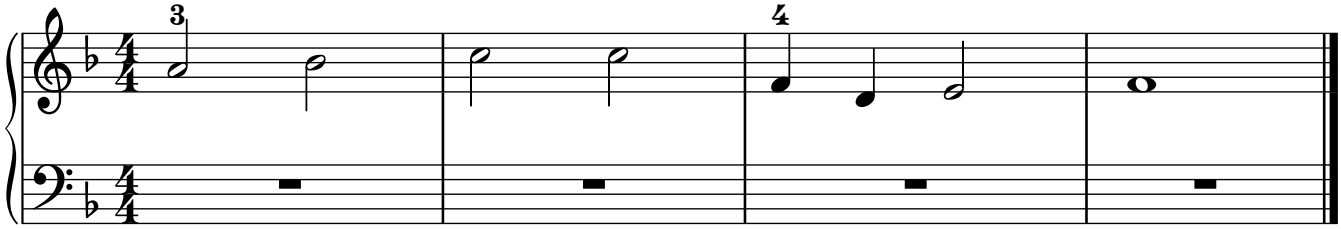
☐ **7.7**



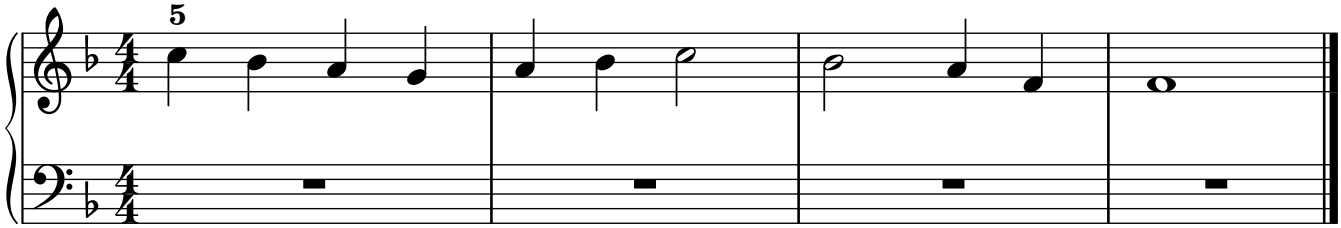
☐ **7.8**



☐ **7.9**



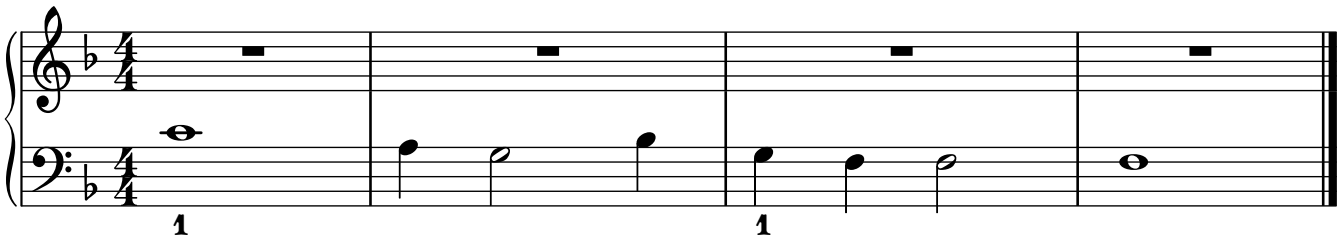
☐ **7.10**



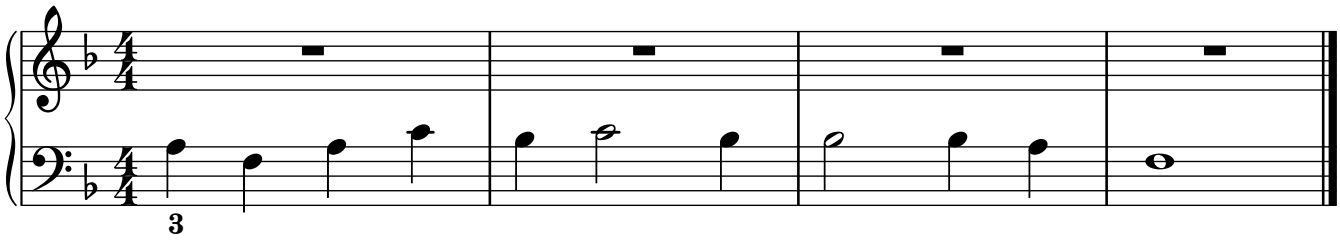
Part B: Left hand in F major ♩= 60

Left hand in F major: F position (F on the fourth line) and C position.

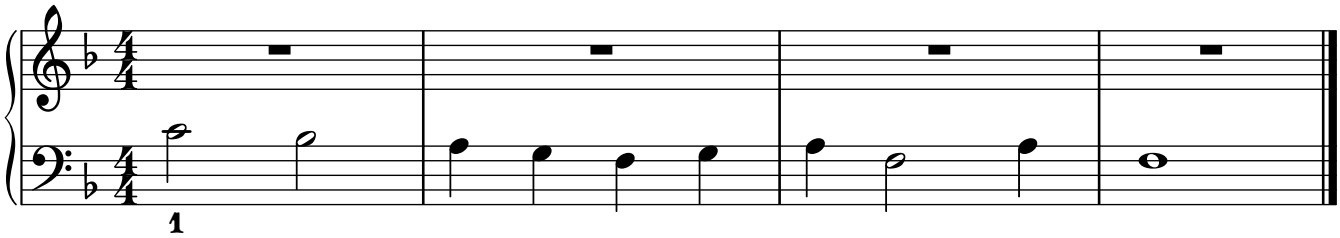
☐ **7.11**



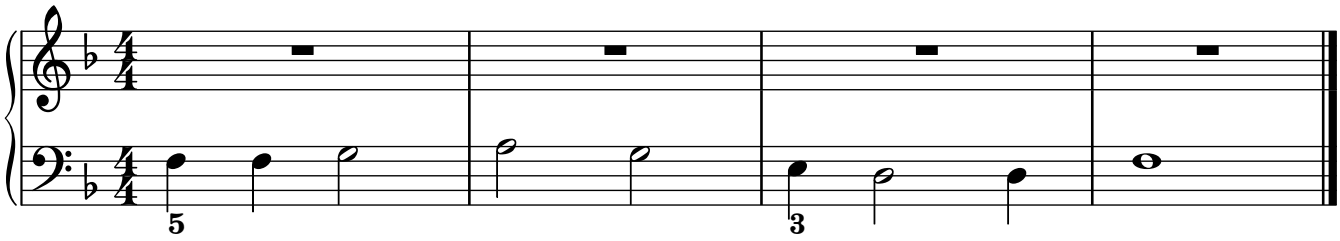
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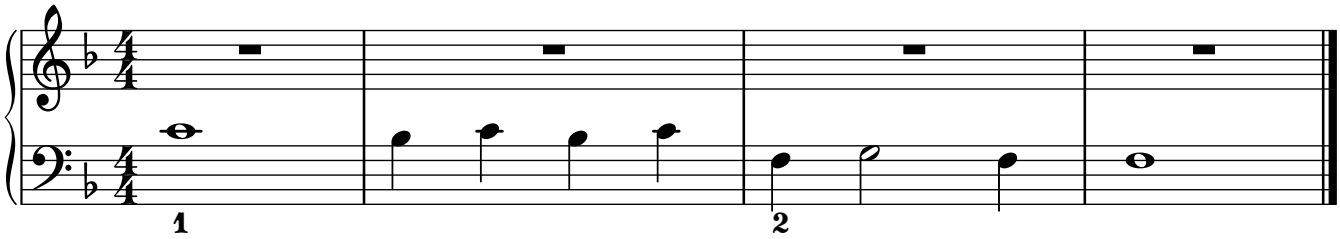
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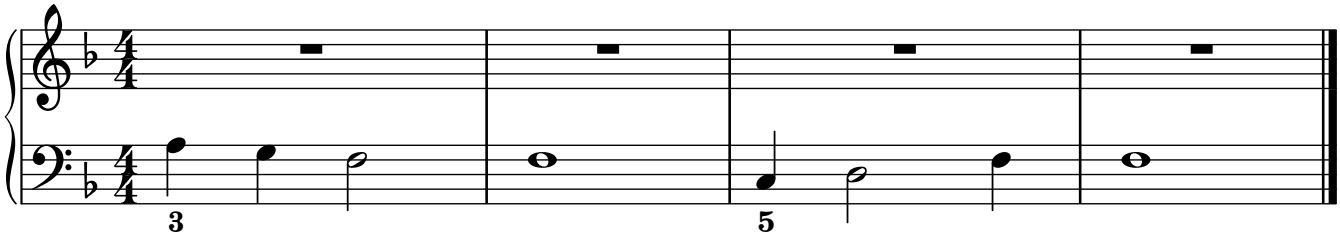
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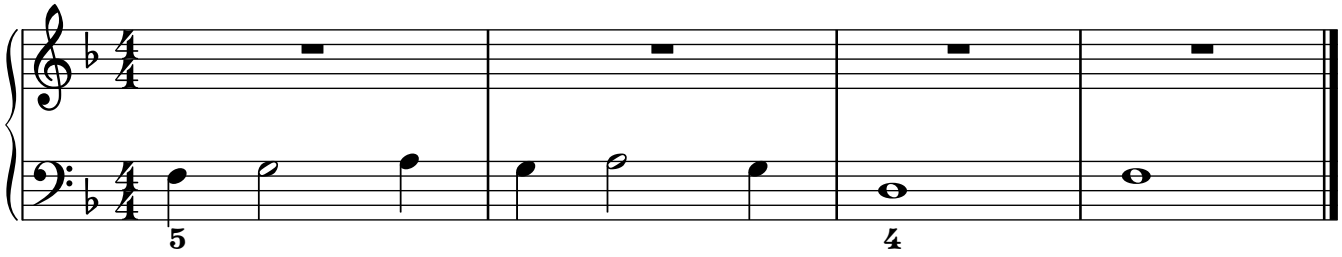
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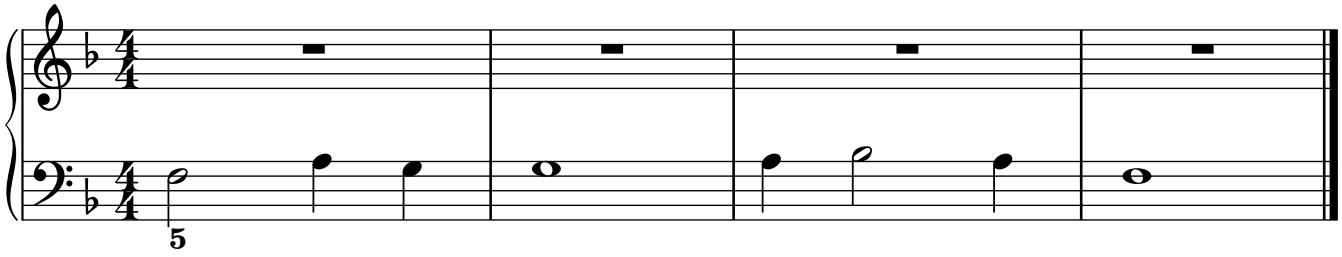
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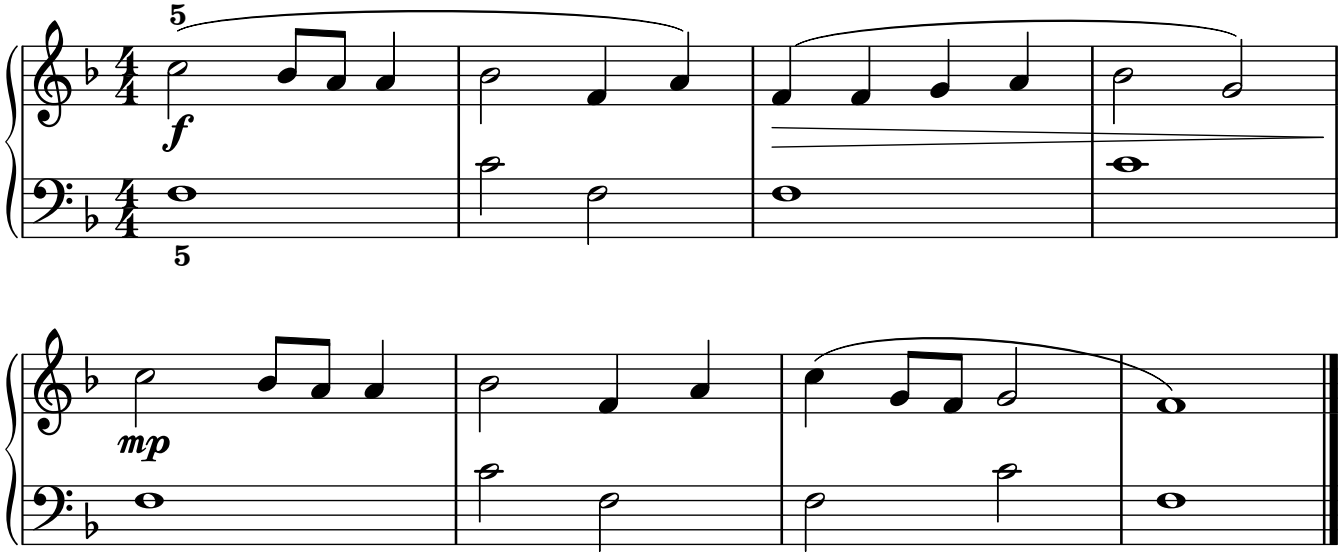


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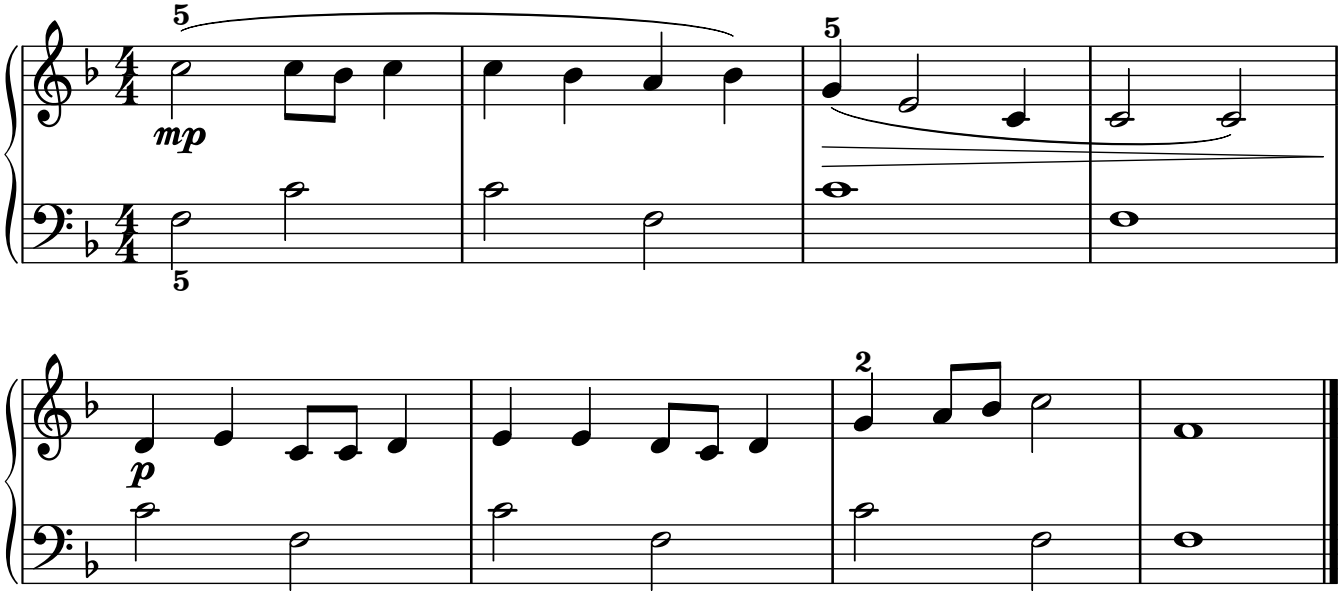
Part C: F major, hands together ♩= 66

Hands together in F major, with dynamics and articulation.

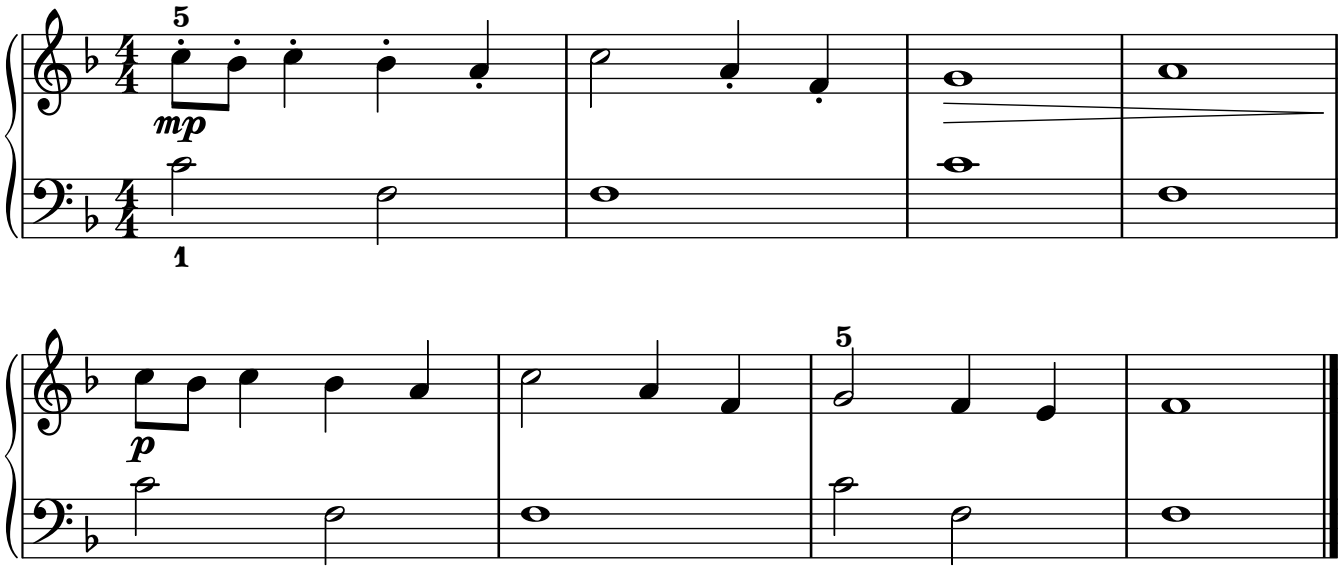
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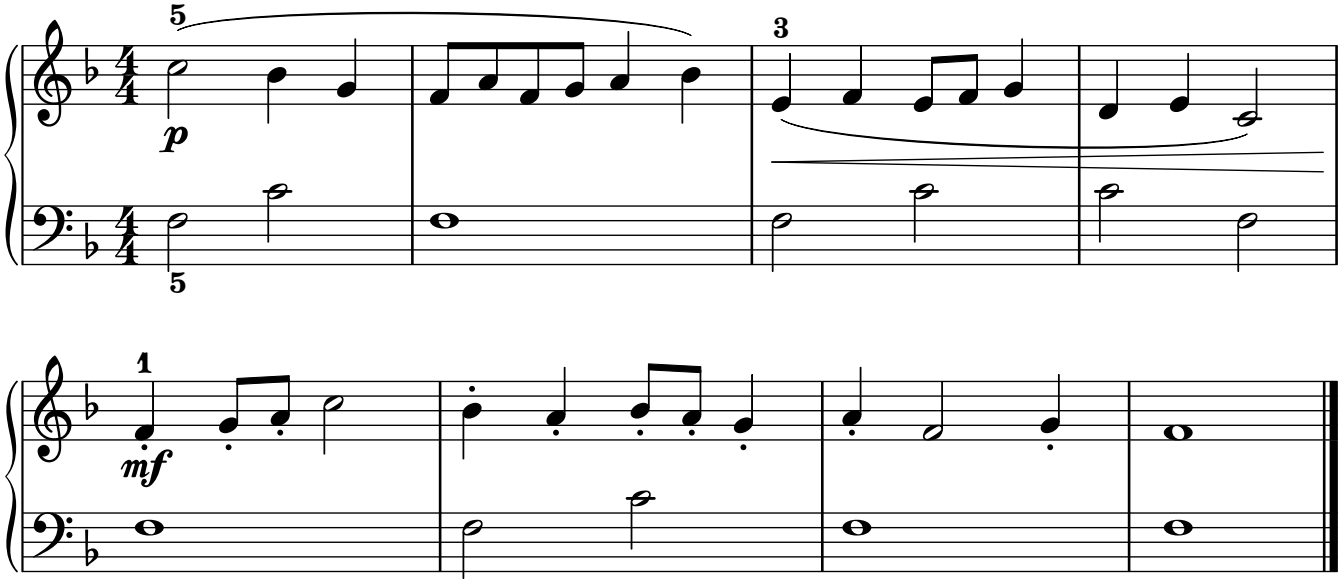


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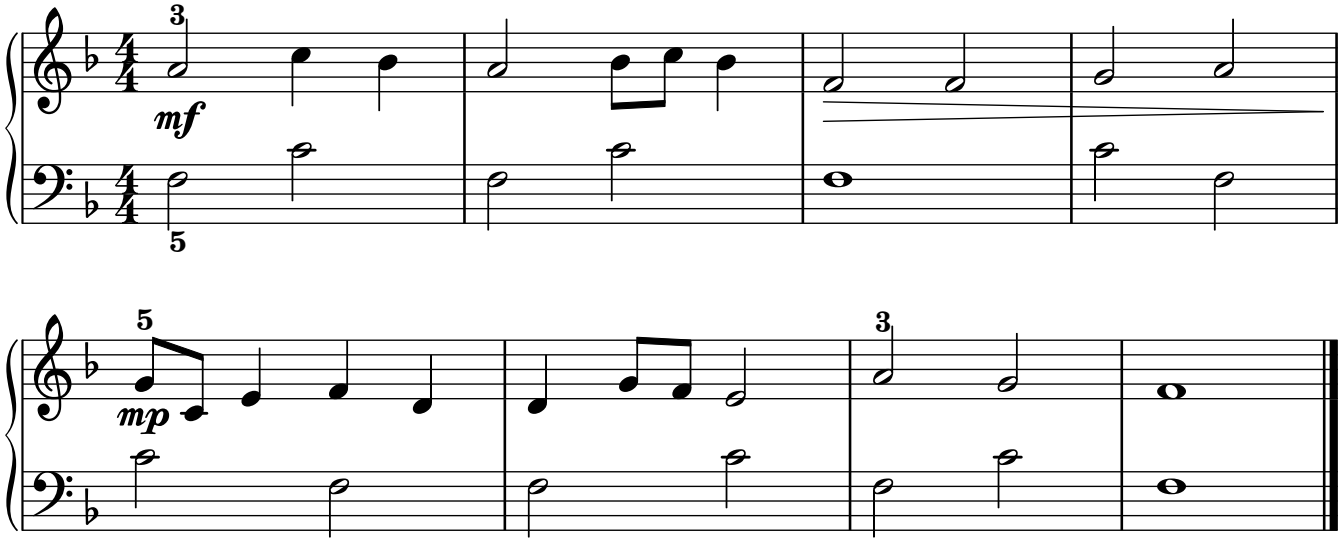


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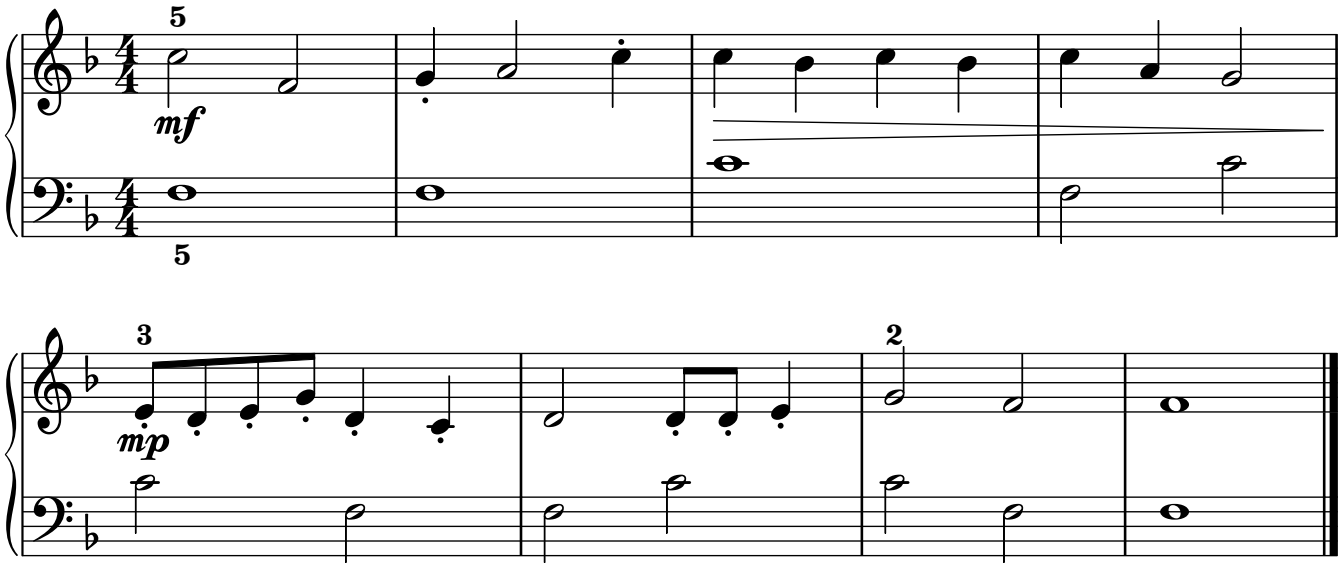


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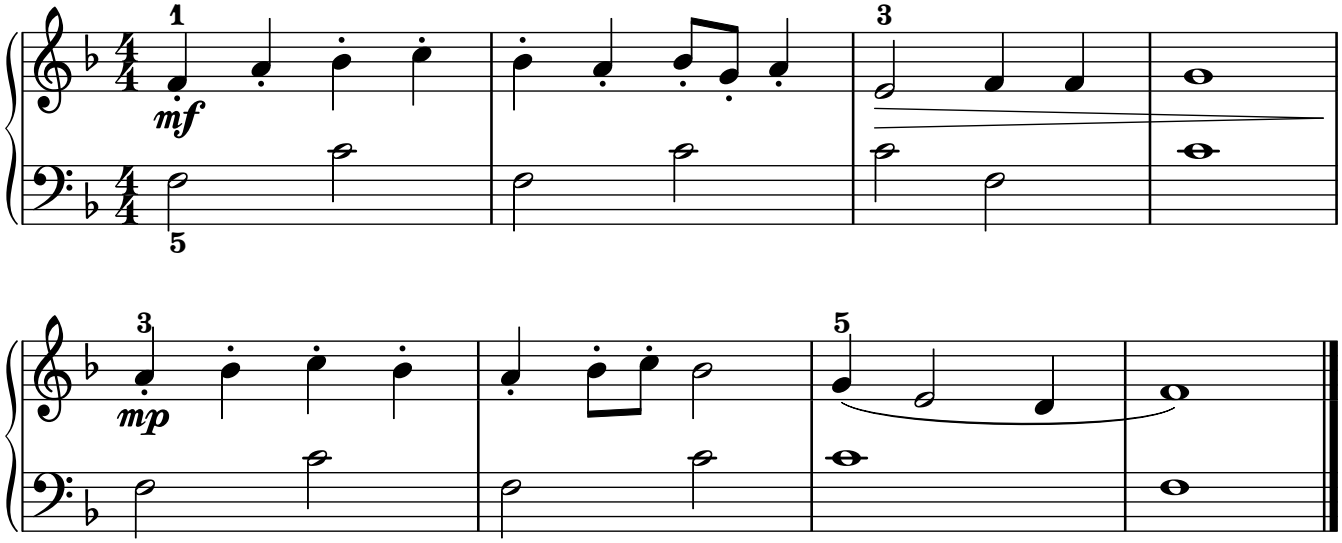


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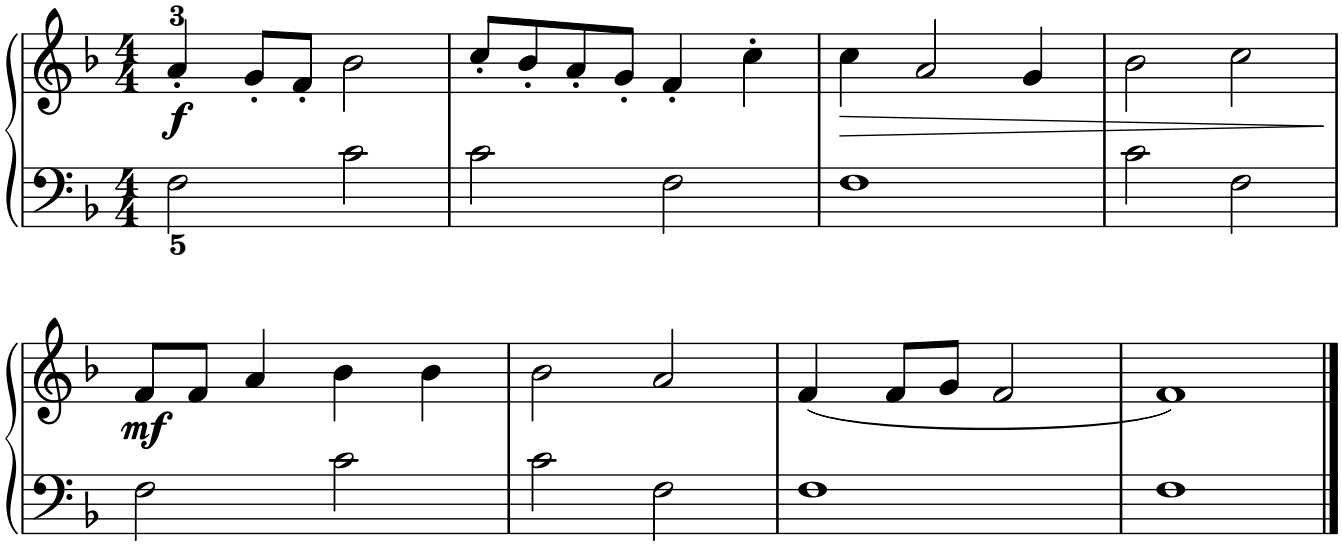


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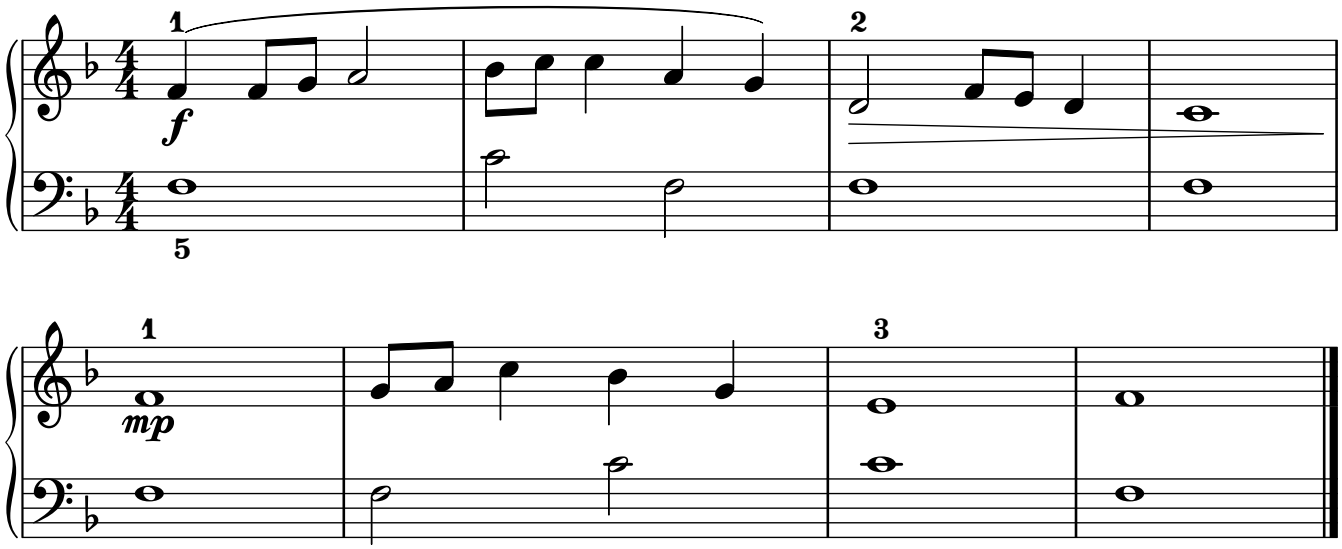
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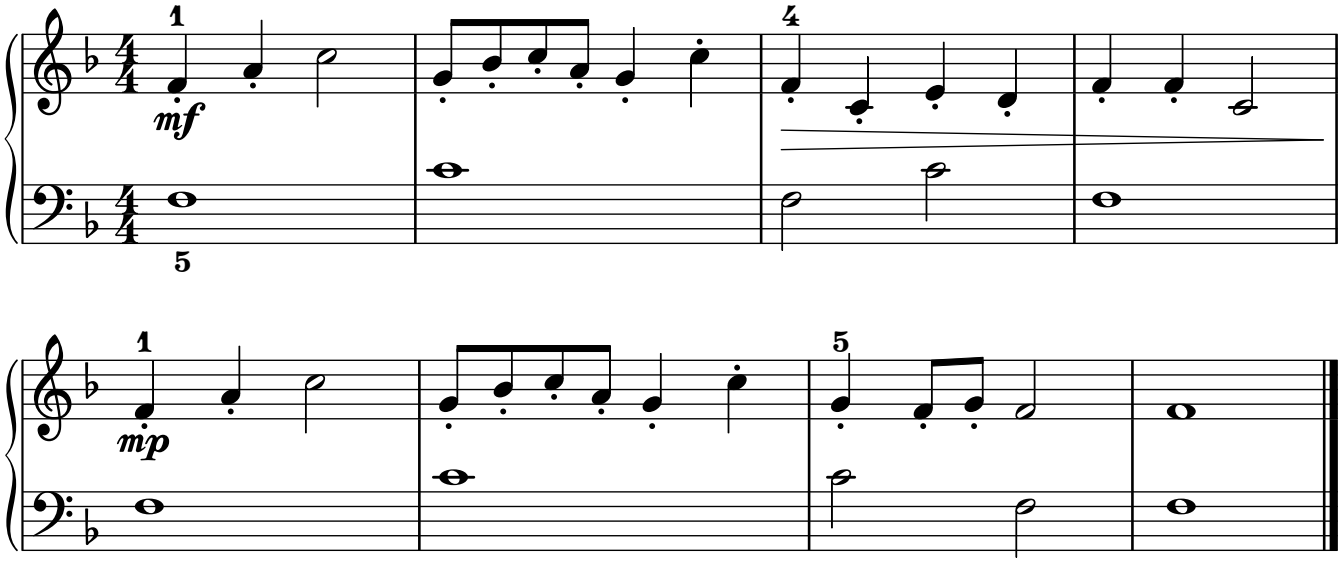


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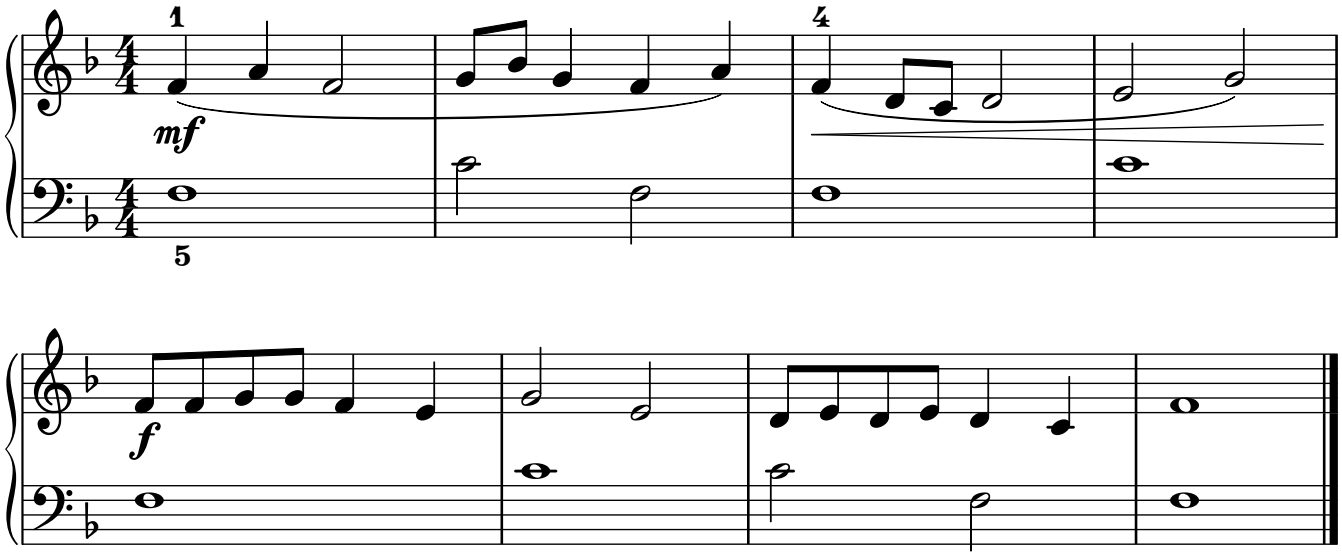


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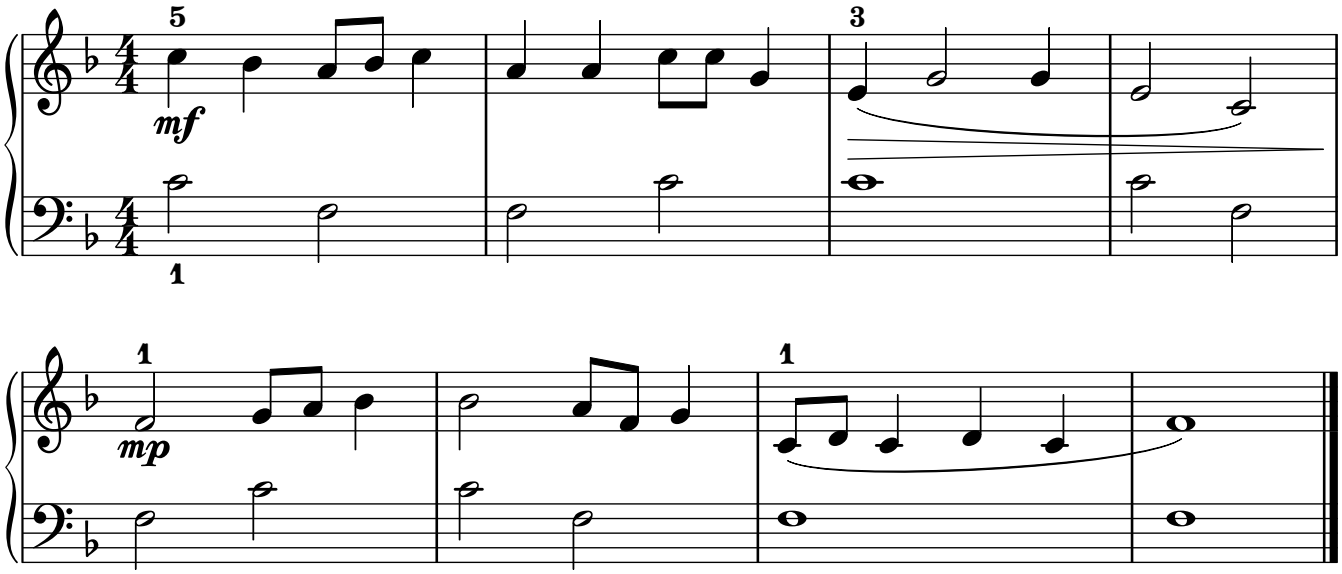
7.28



7.29



7.30
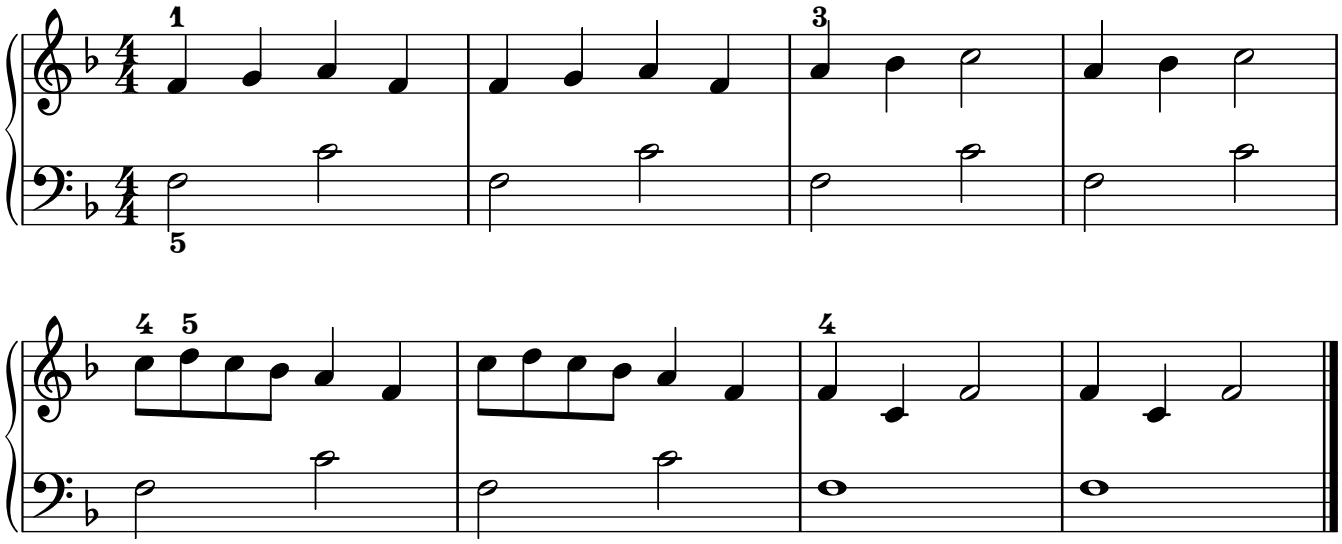


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Frere Jacques in F ♩ = 84

Traditional French round
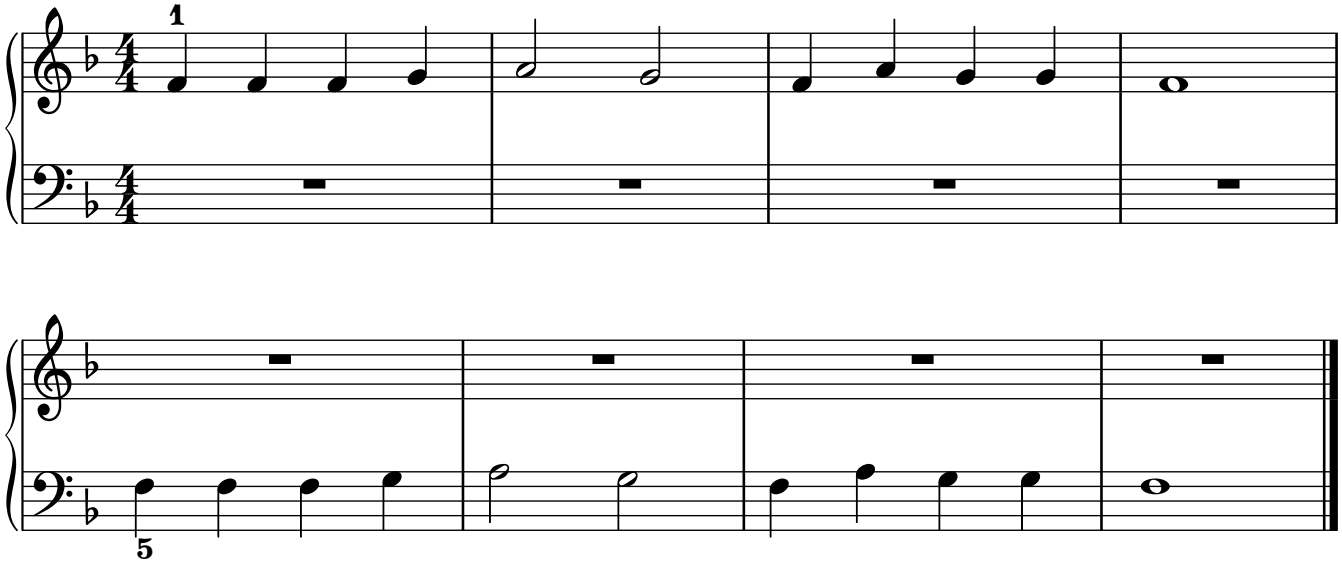
A round: several voices can sing it, starting two bars apart. Bars 5-6 stretch up to D; in bar 7 the hand shifts down to C position for the low C. The bass drones F and C.



Au clair de la lune in F ♩ = 76

Traditional French song (opening)
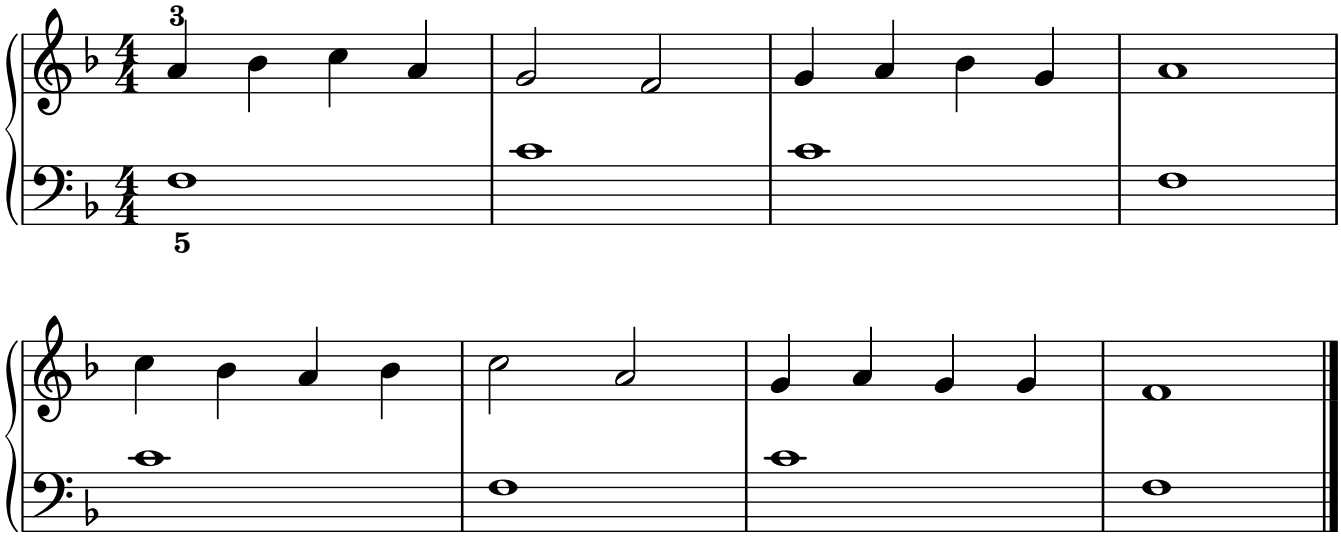
The right hand plays the phrase in F position, then the left hand repeats it in its own F position.



Evening in F ♩ = 72

Original

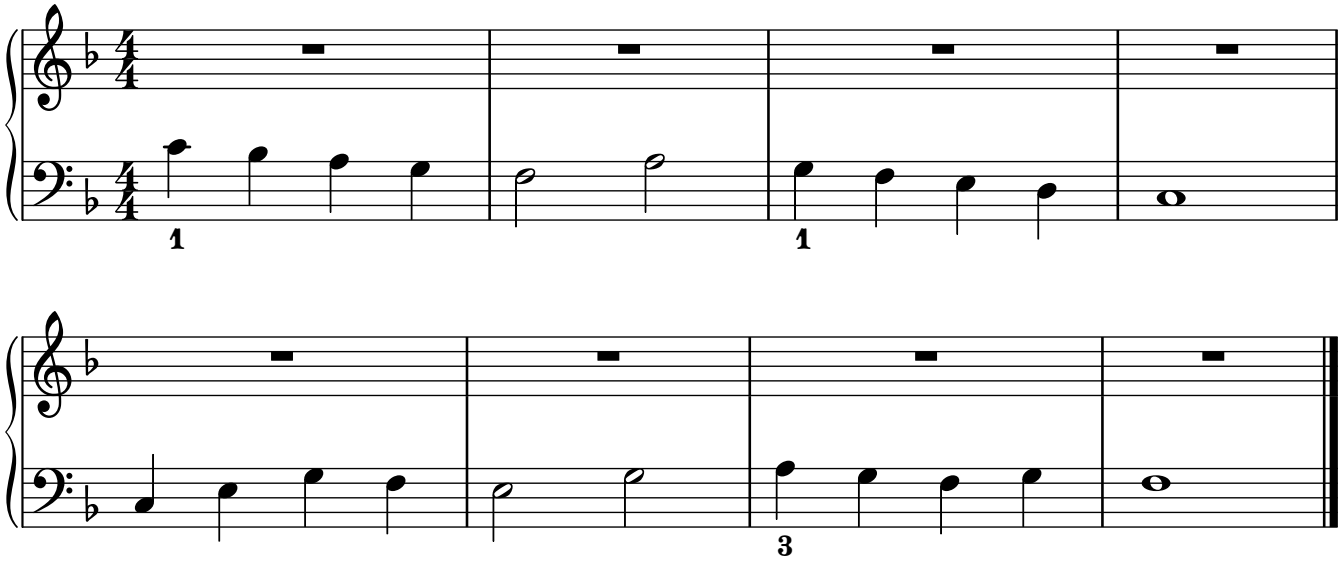
Hands together. Finger 4 plays every B-flat; the bass moves between F (finger 5) and middle C (finger 1).



Low Bells in F ♩ = 72

Original

For the left hand alone: F position, then C position from bar 3 (thumb on G), then back to F position in bar 7.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 8?

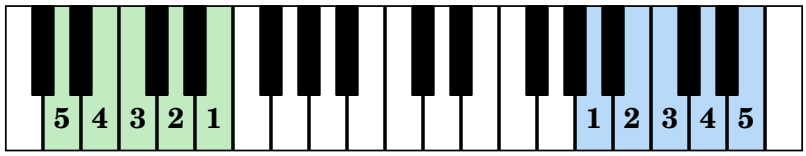
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if every B is played as B-flat without hesitation.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 8.

Unit 8

A Minor

New: Minor keys; A minor, the relative minor of C major

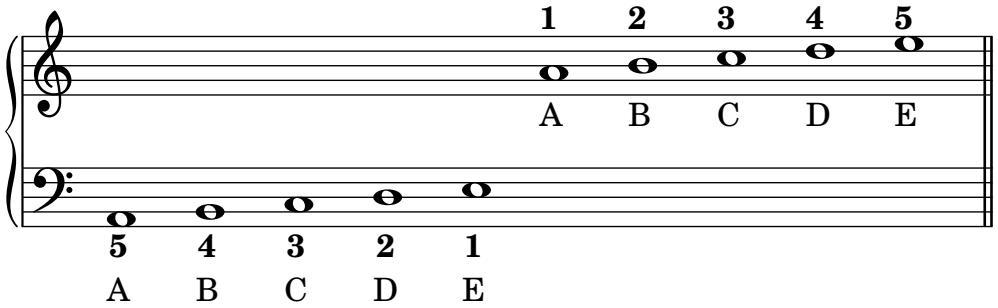
Minor keys have a darker, more serious sound. A minor uses the same notes as C major, with no sharps or flats in the key signature, but its home note is A. Pieces in A minor usually end on A, and the bass often plays A and E.



Middle C

Left hand A position and Right hand A position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Major and minor

In a major key the third note above home is four half-steps up (C to E). In a minor key it is three half-steps up (A to C). That one note changes the whole mood.

Relative keys

A minor and C major share a key signature; they are called relative keys. To tell them apart, look at the last note and the bass: A means A minor, C means C major.

A position

Right hand: thumb on the A above middle C (A B C D E). Left hand: finger 5 on the A in the bottom space of the bass staff (A B C D E).

E position

In Part C the right hand also moves down to E position: E F G A B, thumb on the E above middle C.

Reading tips

1. No sharps or flats? Check the last note and the bass to see whether the key is C major or A minor.

2. Let minor music sing: aim for a smooth, legato tone in slurred phrases.

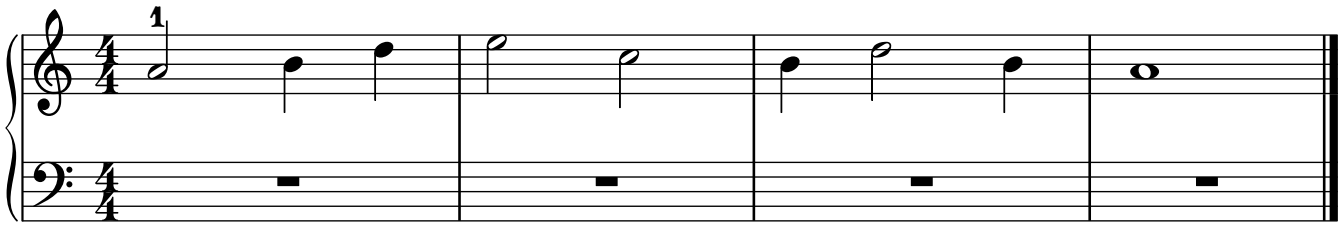
3. Treble A position sits in the upper half of the staff; bass A position starts in the bottom space.

4. Keep going even if a note goes wrong.

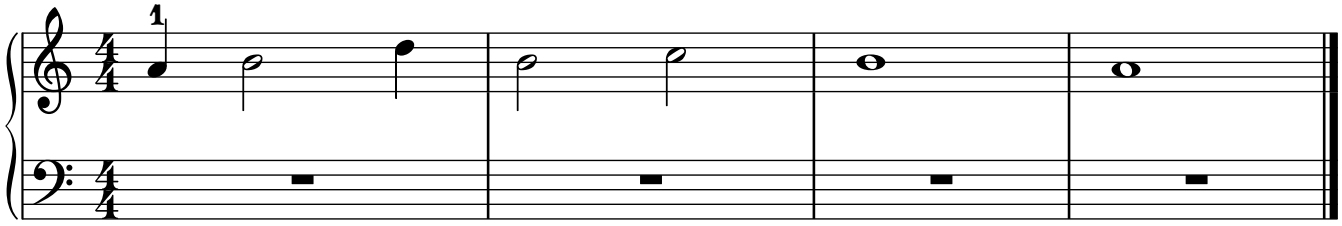
Part A: Right hand in A minor ♩ = 60

Right hand in A position, A minor. Metronome 60.

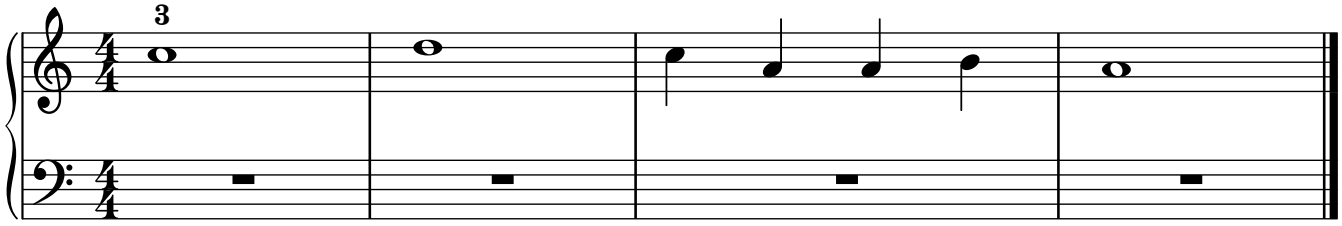
☐ **8.1**



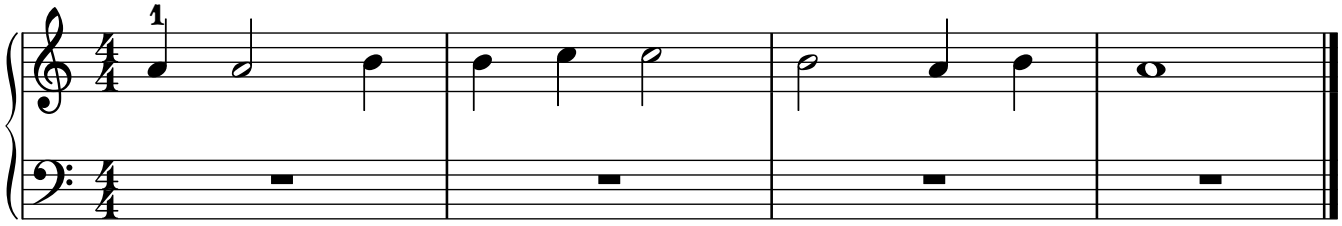
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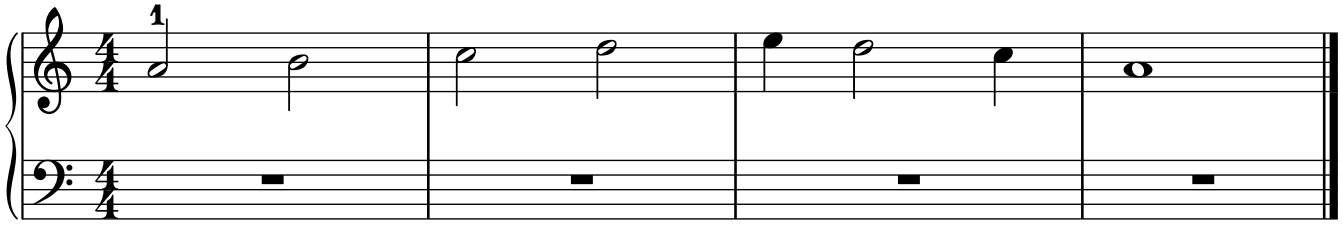


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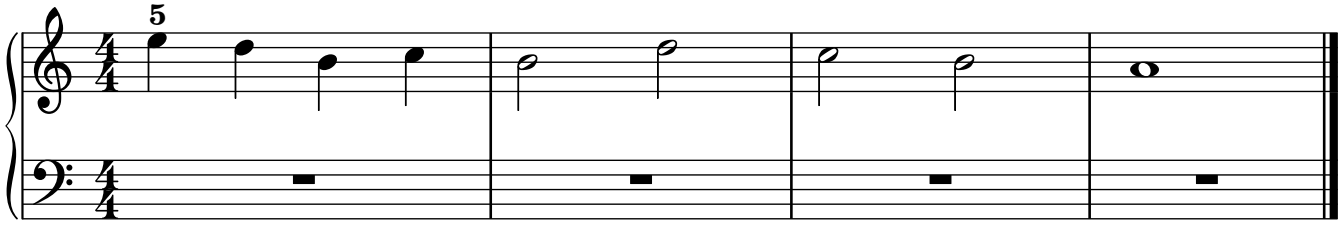
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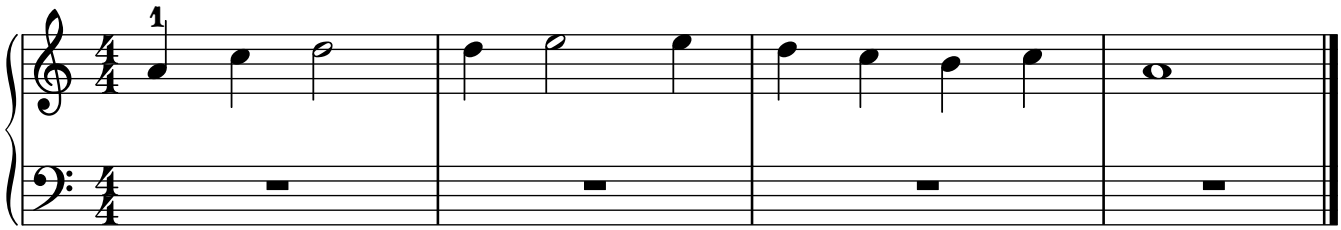


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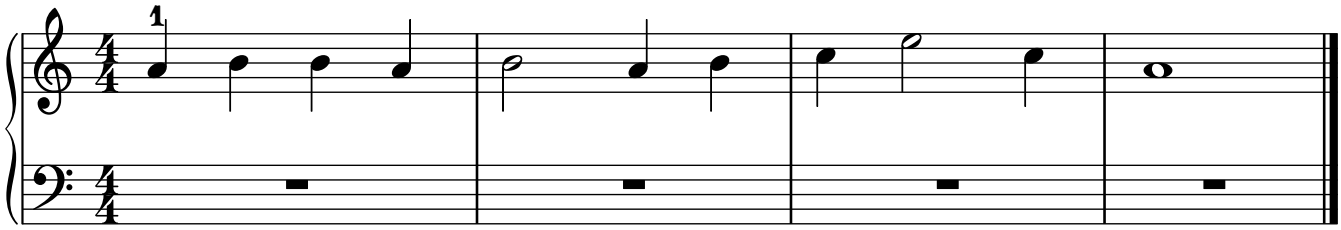
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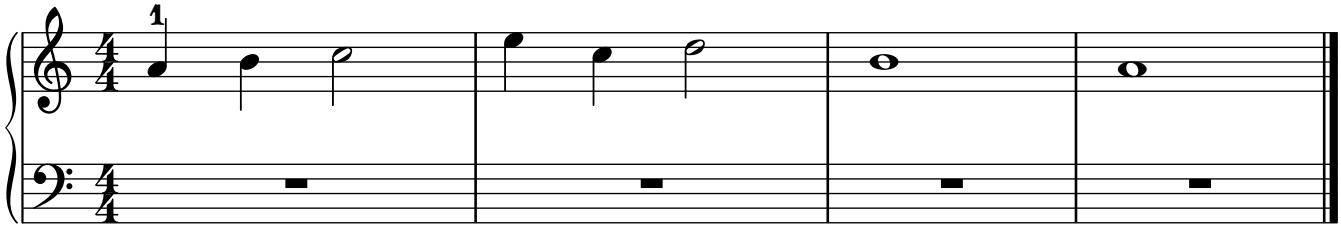
☐ **8.7**



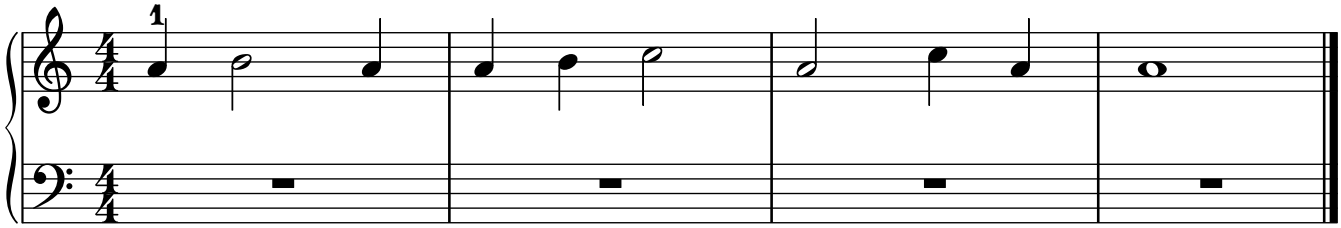
☐ **8.8**



☐ **8.9**



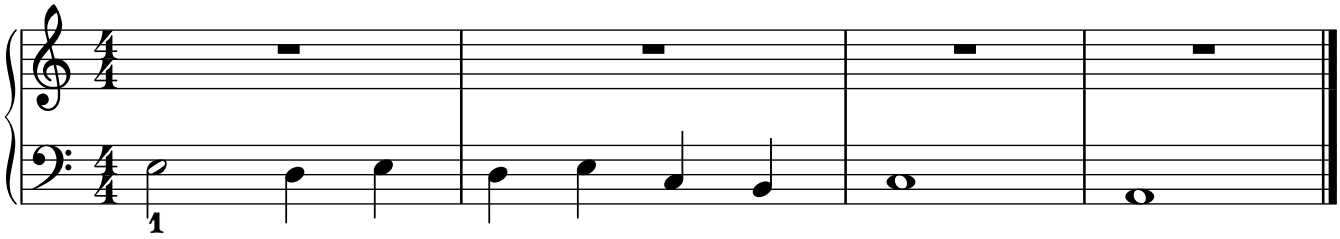
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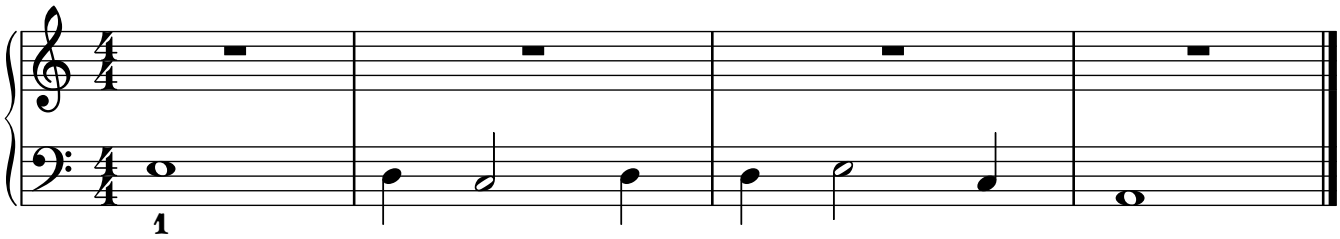
Part B: Left hand in A minor ♩ = 60

Left hand in A position, A minor.

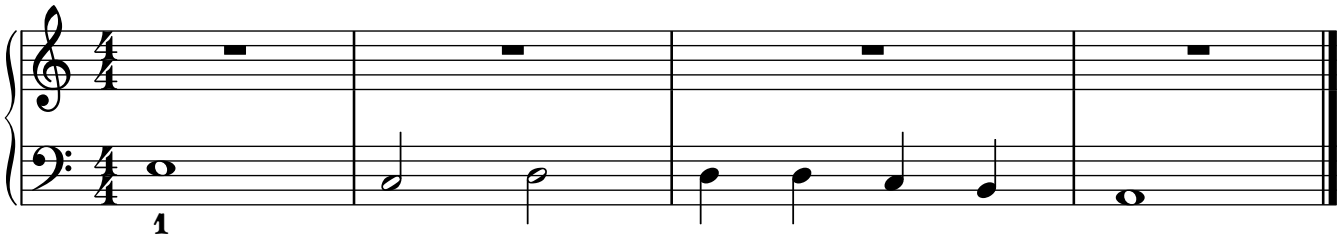
☐ **8.11**



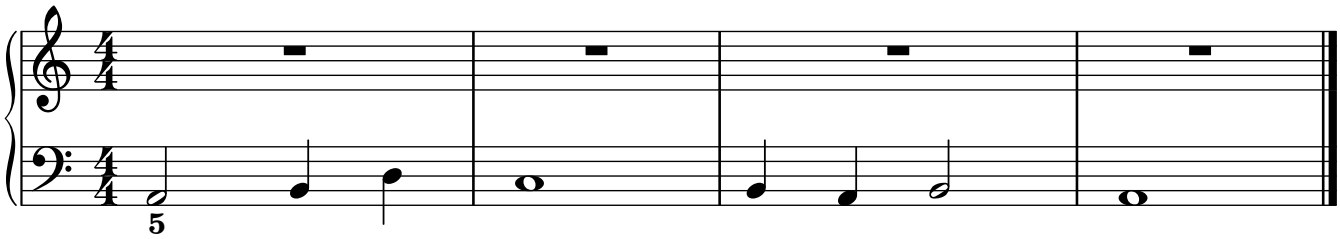
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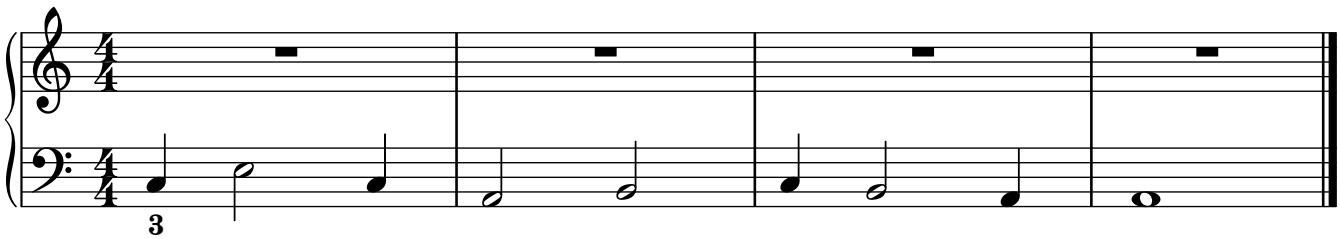
☐ **8.13**



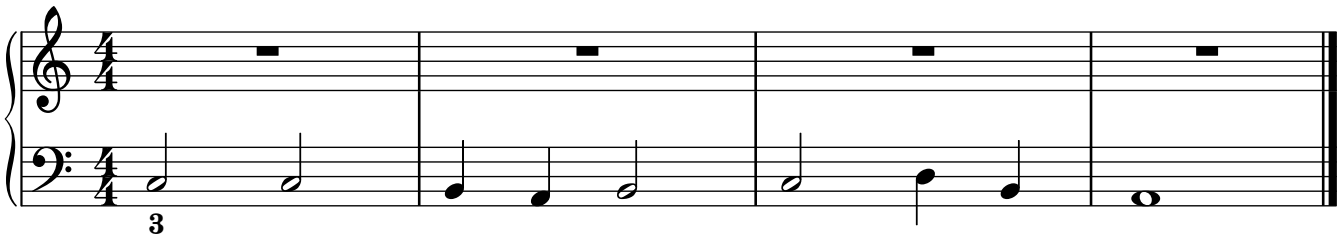
☐ **8.14**



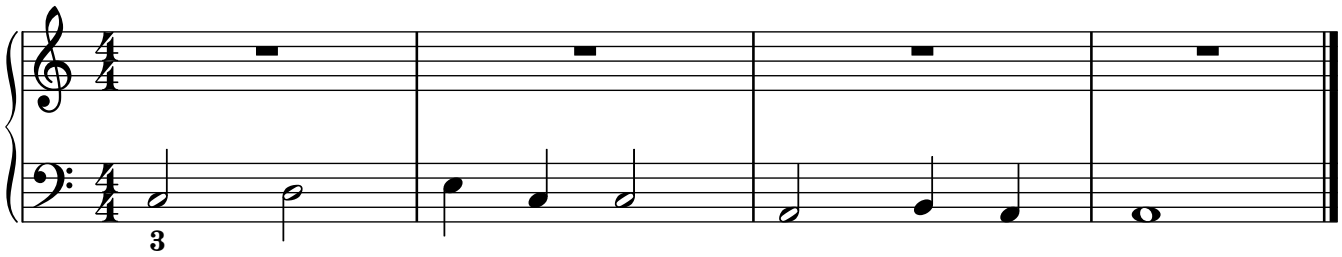
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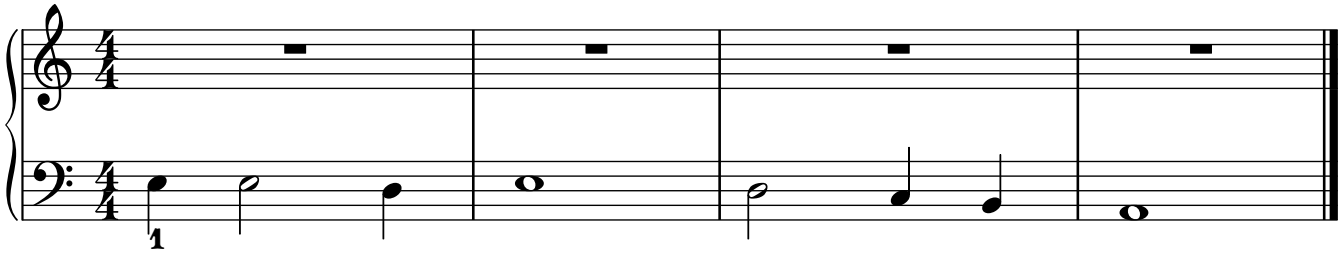
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8.17



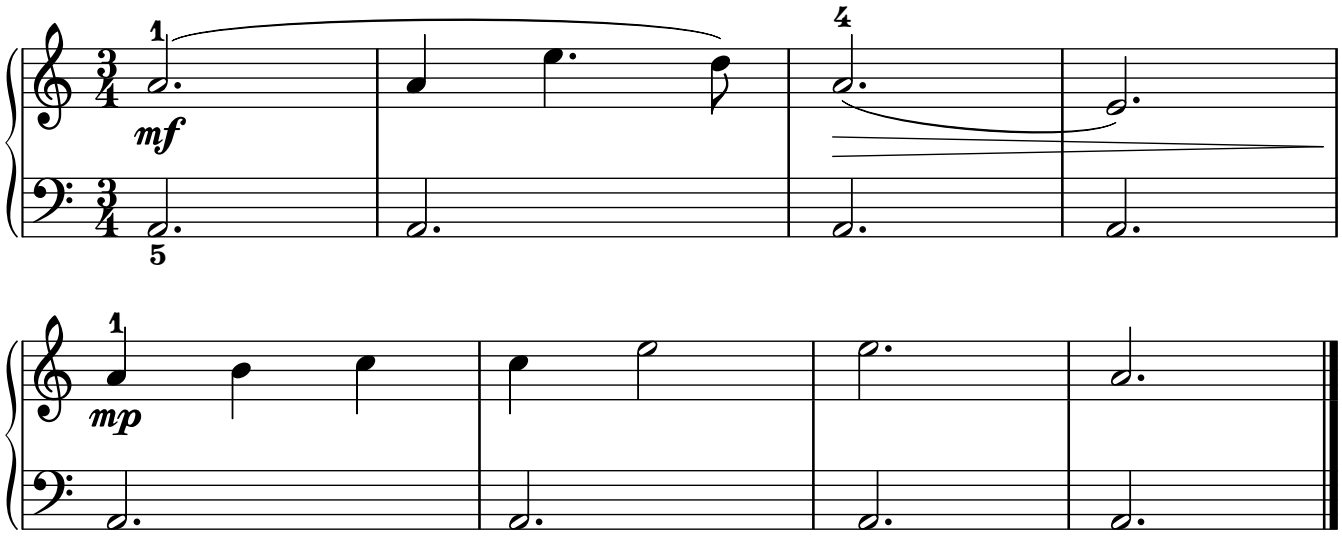
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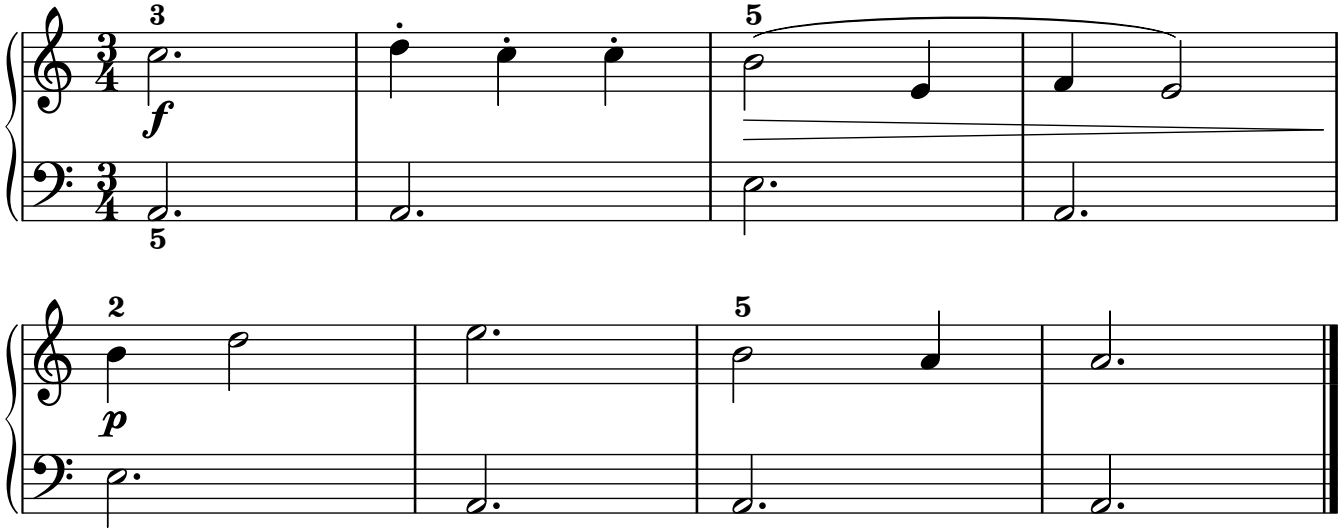


Part C: A minor, hands together in 3/4 ♩ = 72

Hands together in 3/4; the right hand also moves to E position.

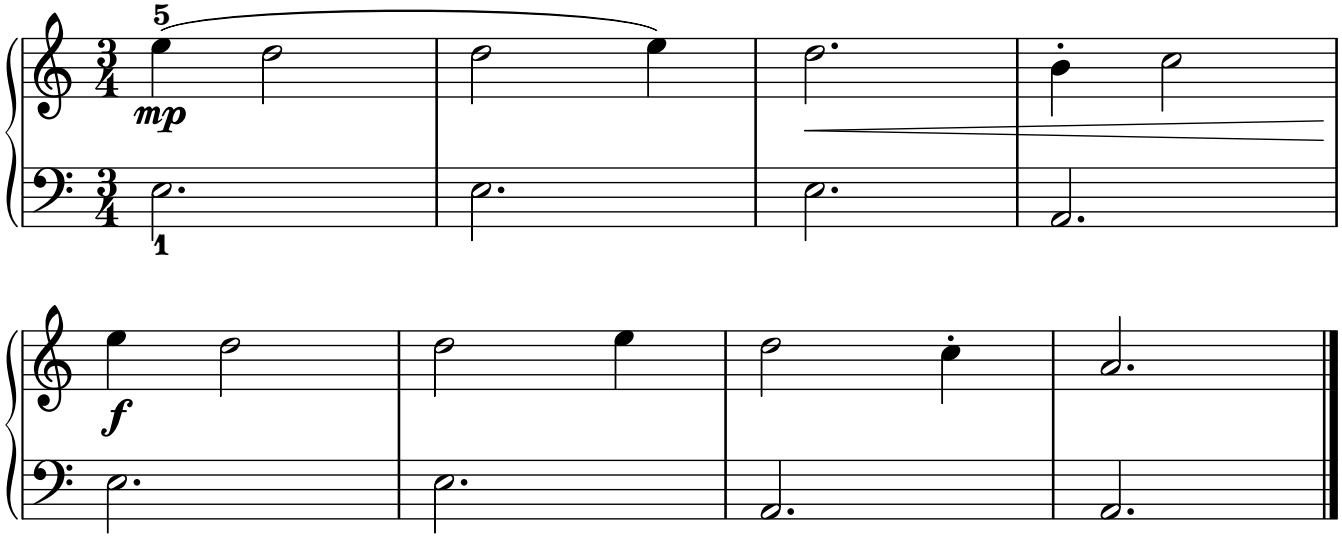
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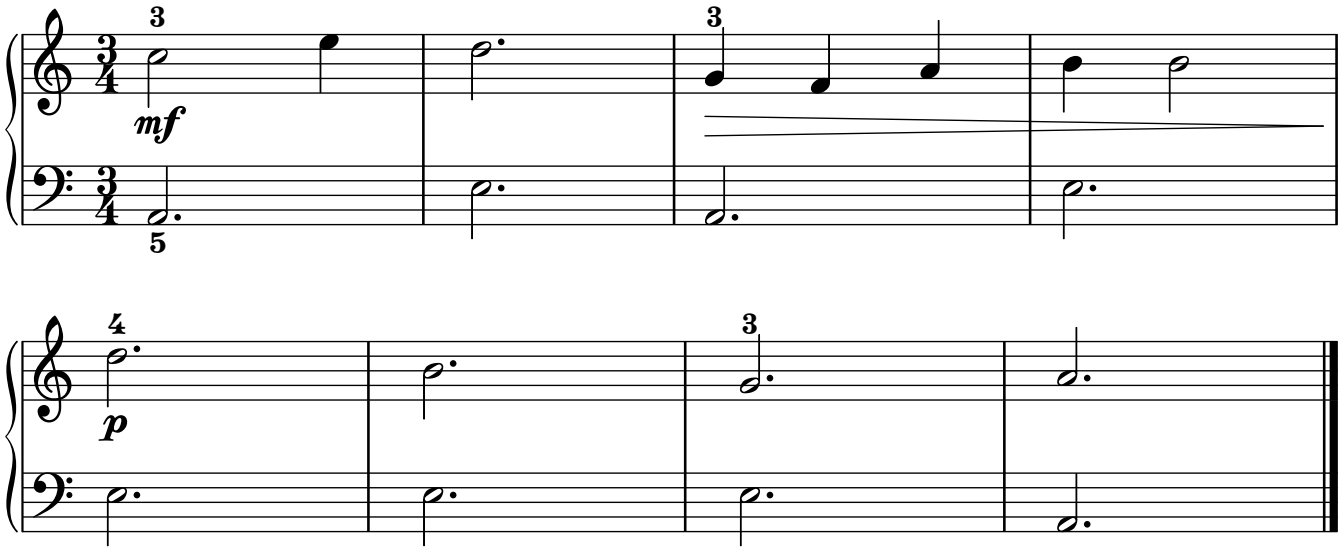


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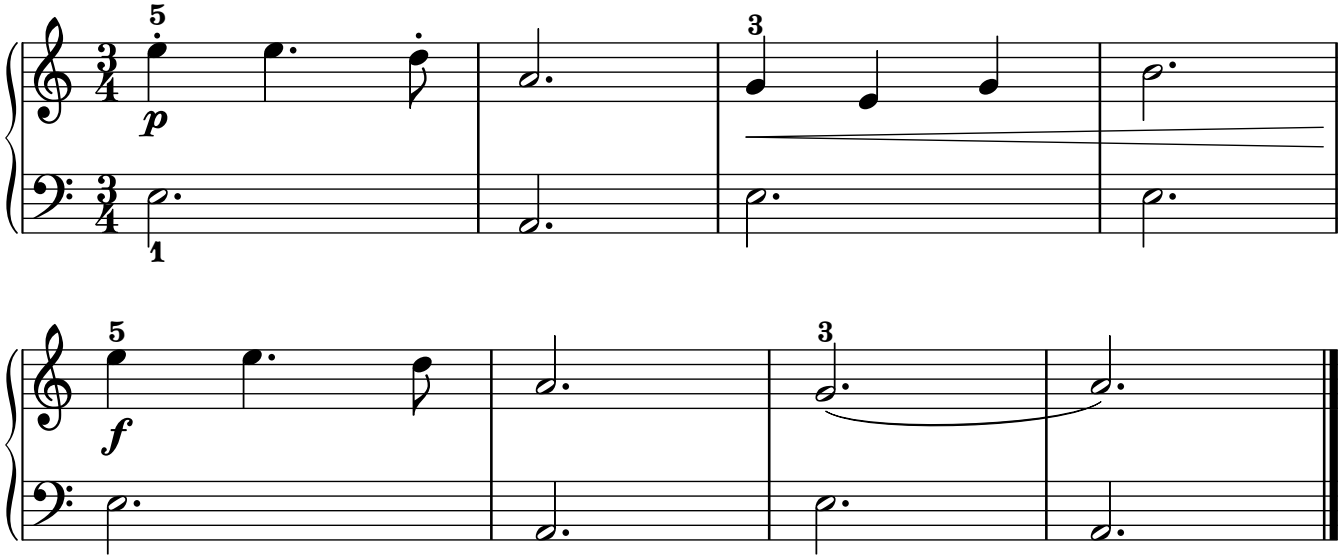


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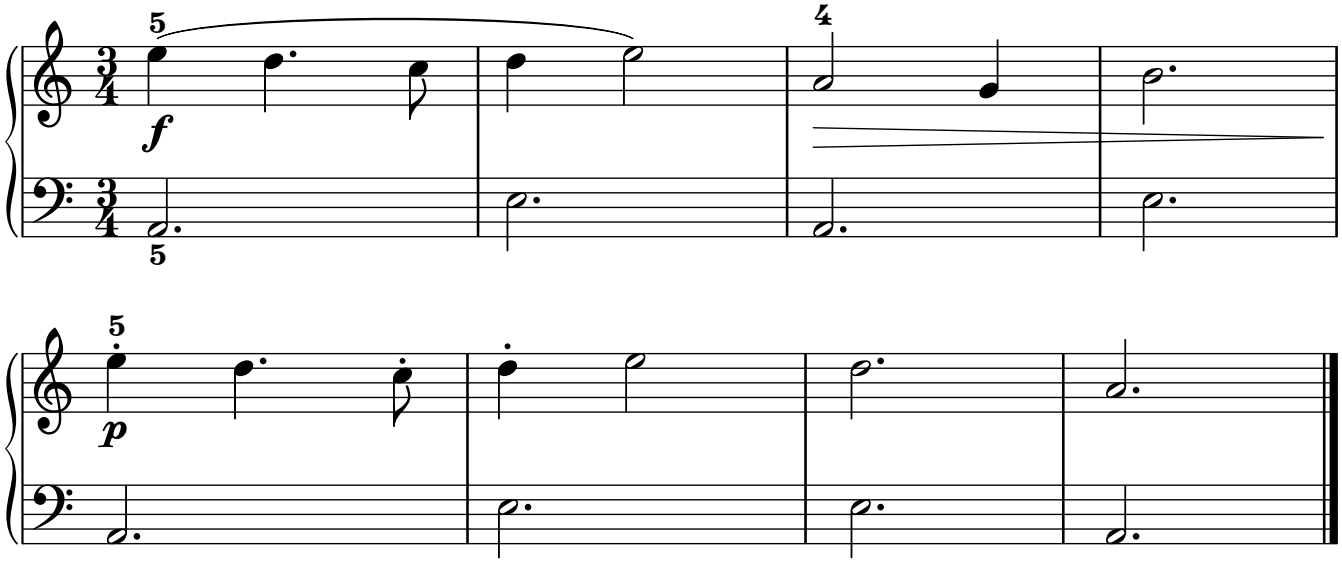


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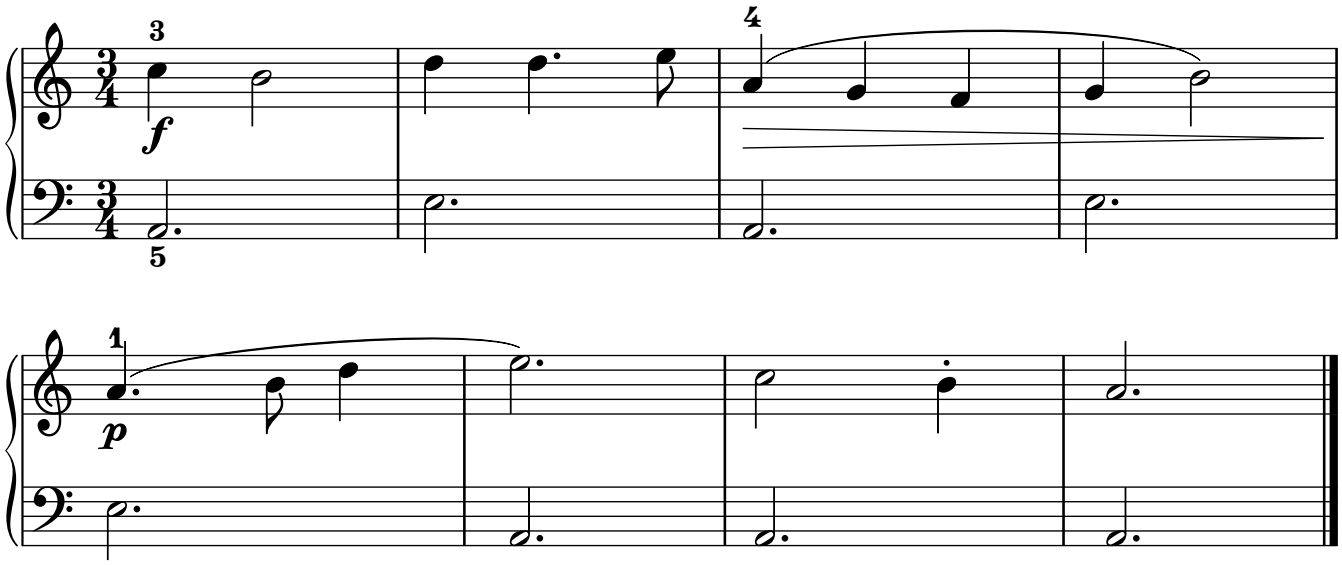


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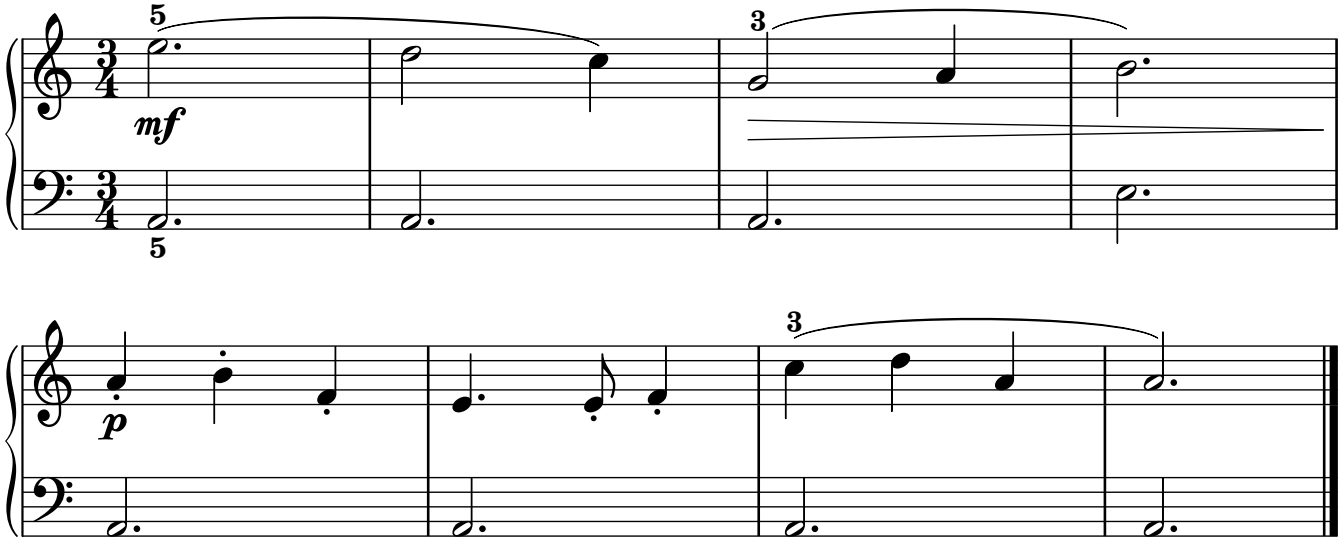
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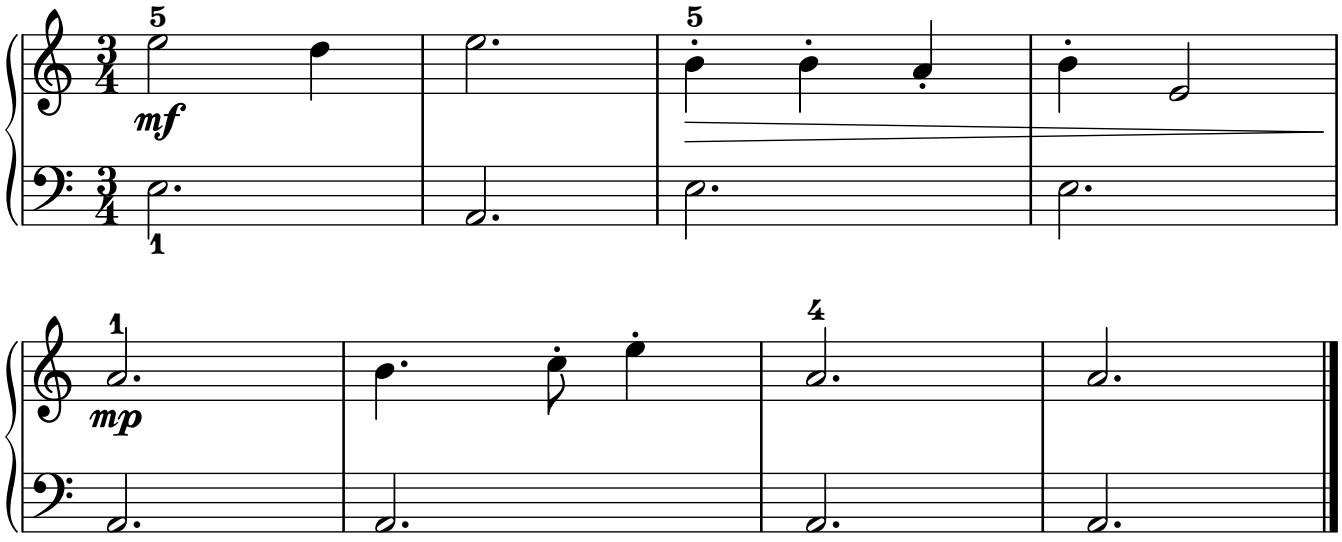


8.25



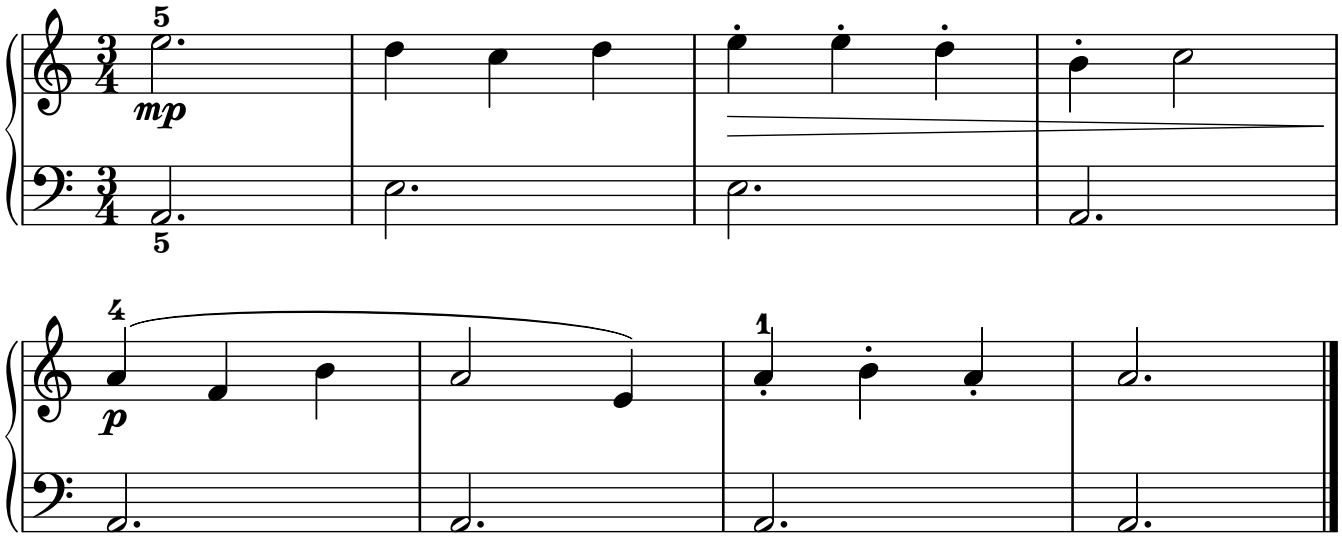
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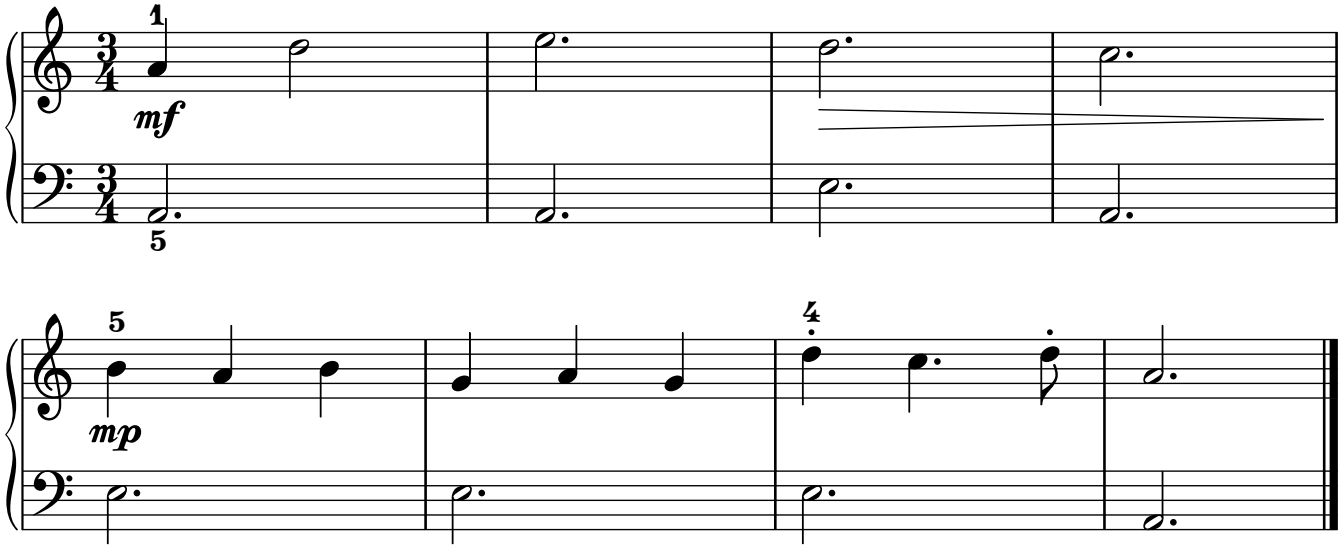


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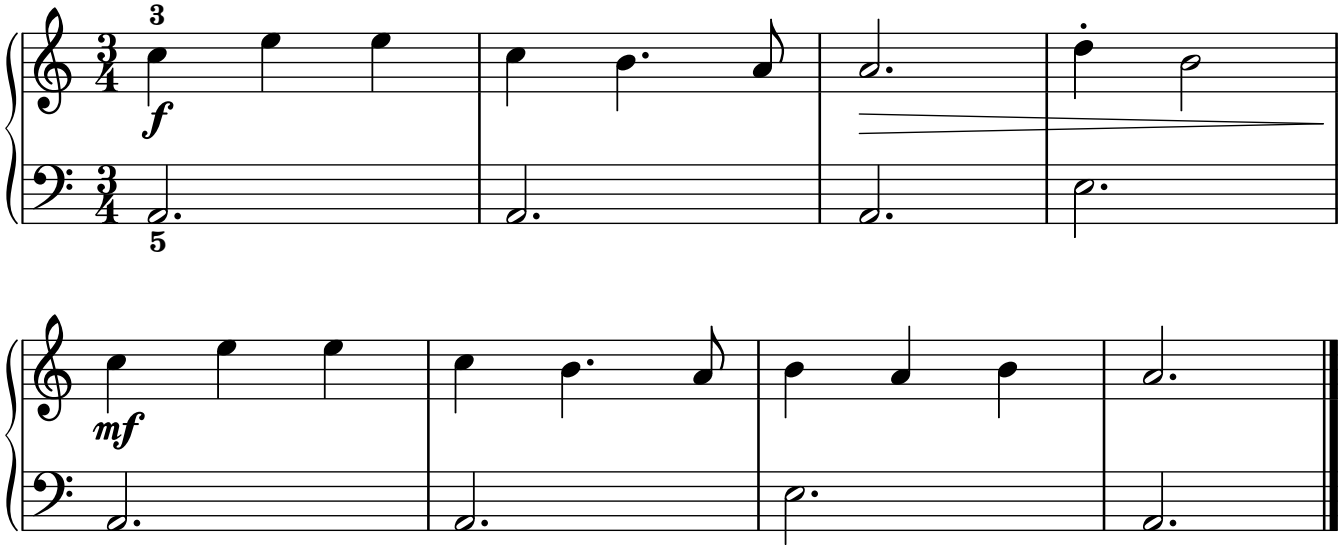


8.28



8.29



8.30



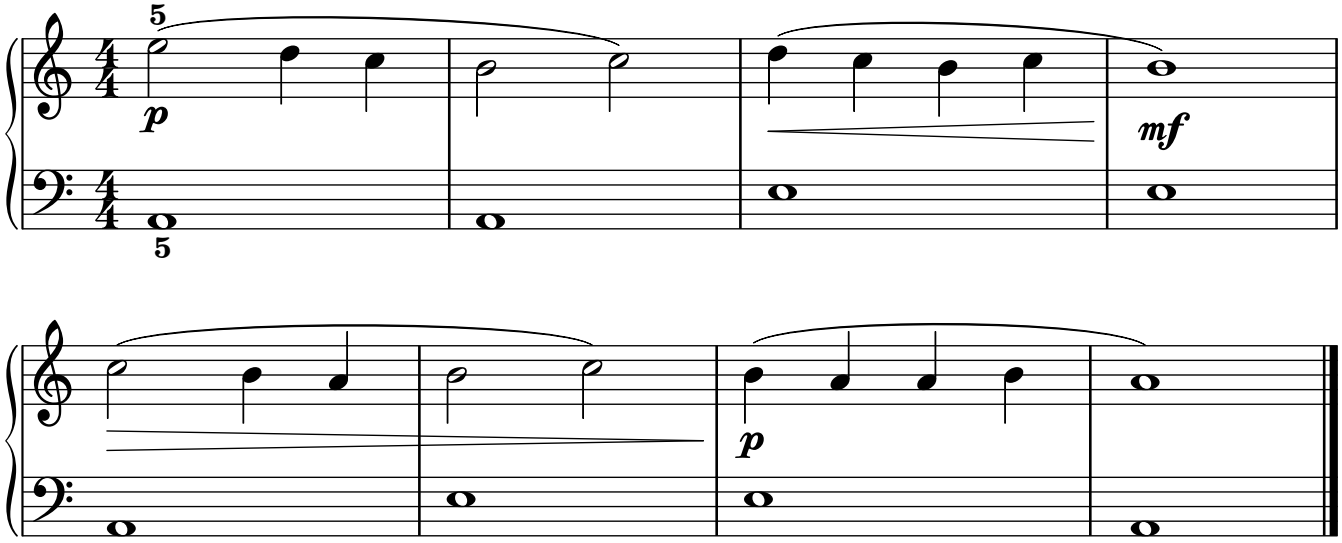
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Lament ♩ = 66

Original
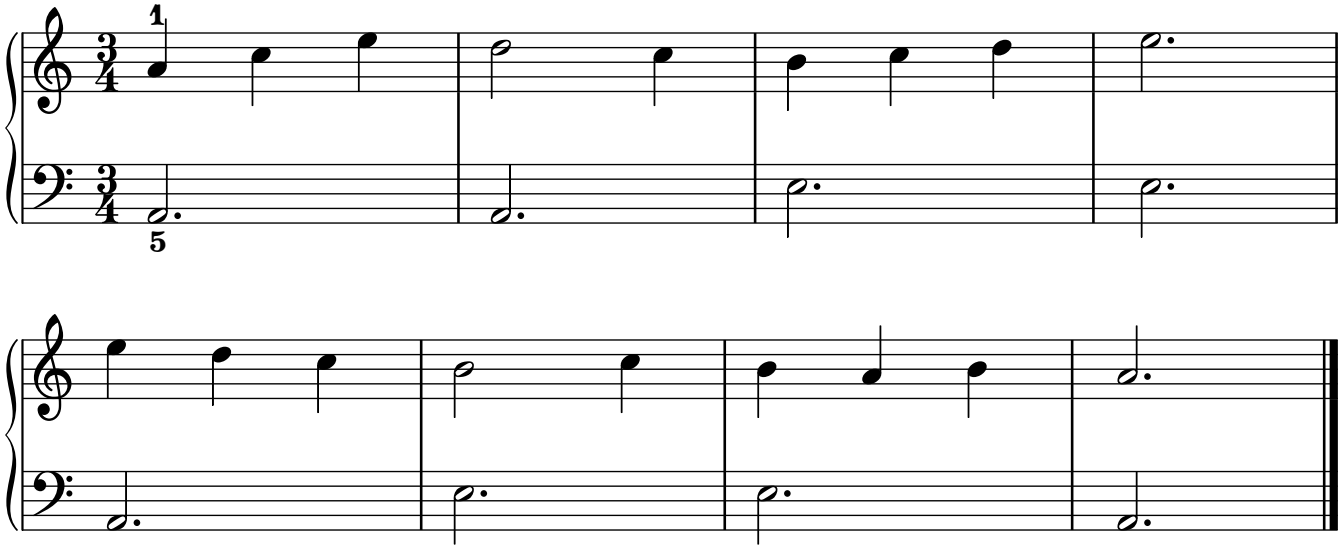
A slow, singing tune. Each two-bar slur is one breath; let the crescendo in bar 3 lead to mezzo forte.



Shadow Dance ♩ = 84

Original
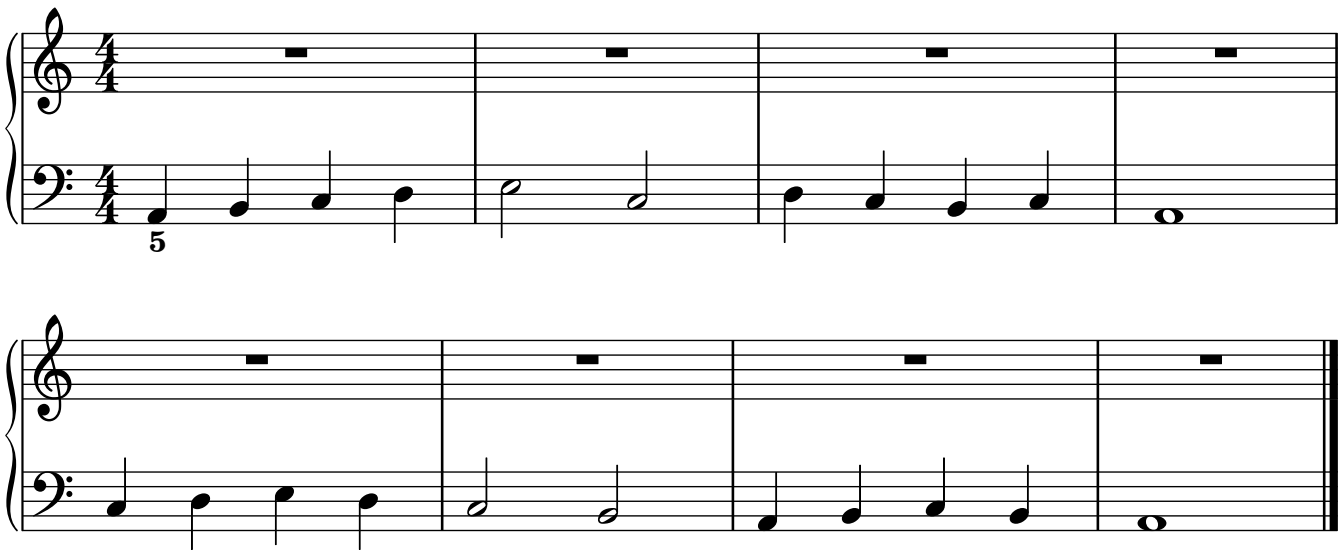
A minor waltz that climbs the chain A-C-E in the first bar.



Low Road in A Minor ♩ = 72

Original

For the left hand alone, in A position from the bottom space of the bass staff.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 9?

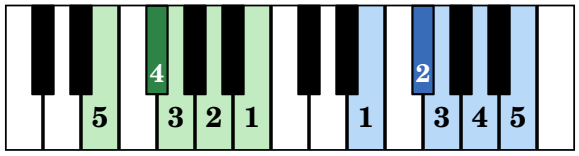
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 72 beats per minute.
- Pass if you name the key (A minor) before you start, and the shifts to E position land on time.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 9.

Unit 9

E Minor and D Minor

New: The relative minors of G major (E minor) and F major (D minor)

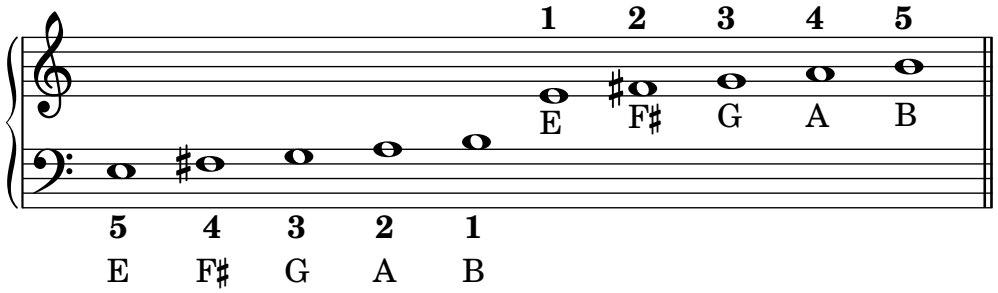
Two more minor keys. E minor is the relative minor of G major: the same key signature (one sharp, F-sharp), with home note E. D minor is the relative minor of F major: the same key signature (one flat, B-flat), with home note D.

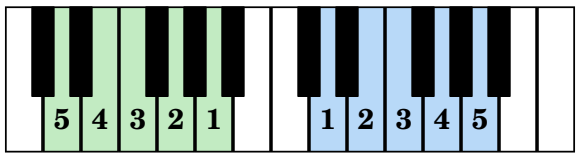


Middle C

Left hand E position and Right hand E position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

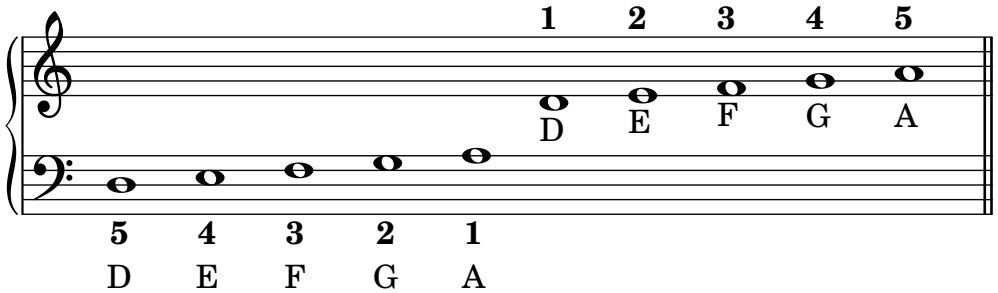




Middle C

Left hand D position and Right hand D position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

E minor

One sharp in the key signature, ending on E. In E position (E F-sharp G A B), the black key F-sharp is finger 2 in the right hand and finger 4 in the left.

D minor

One flat in the key signature, ending on D. D position (D E F G A) contains no B, so every note is a white key.

Which key?

One sharp: G major or E minor. One flat: F major or D minor. The last note and the lowest bass note tell you which.

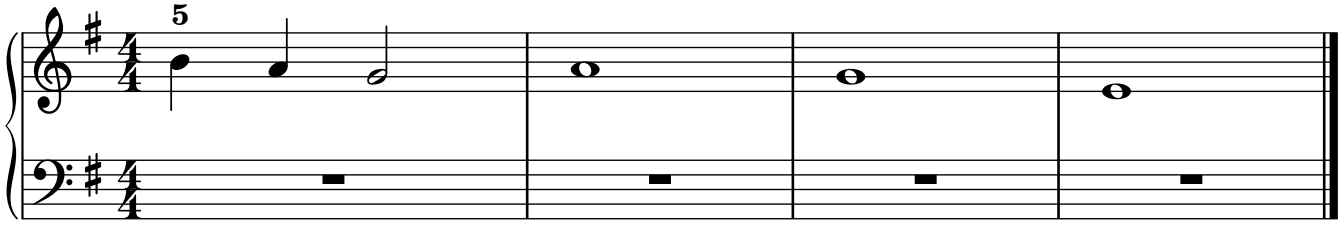
Reading tips

1. Scan the key signature, then the last bass note, and name the key before you start.
2. In E position, put finger 2 (right hand) or finger 4 (left hand) on F-sharp first.
3. D minor's position uses only white keys, even though there is a flat in the key signature.
4. Keep going even if a note goes wrong.

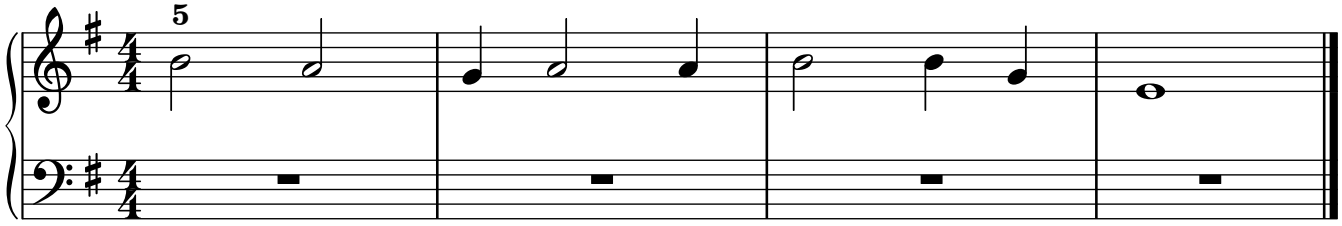
Part A: E minor, right hand ♩ = 60

E minor in the right hand. Metronome 60.

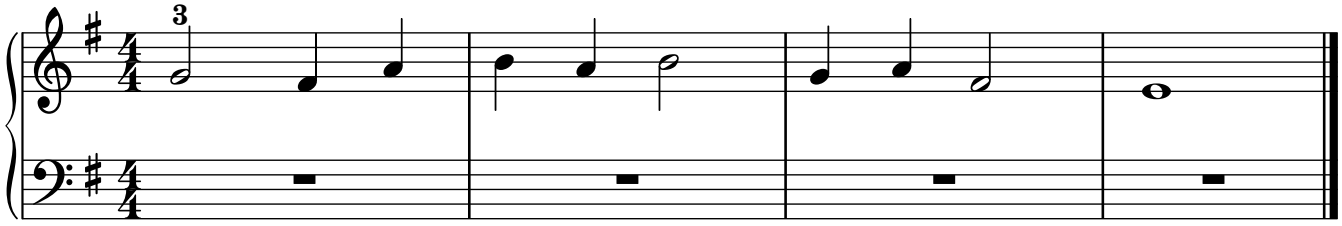
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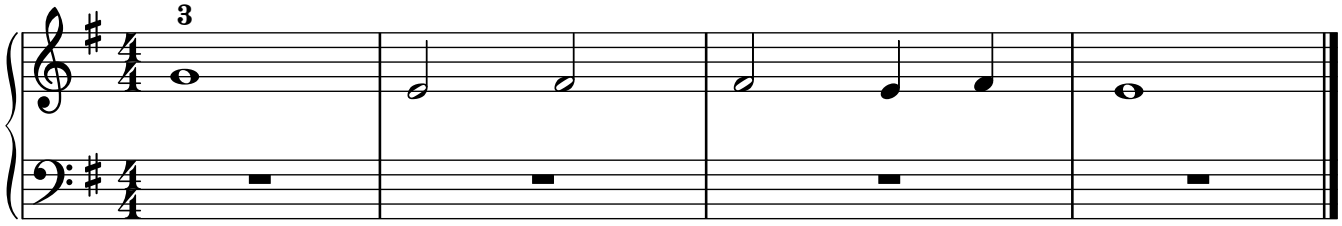


☐ **9.2**



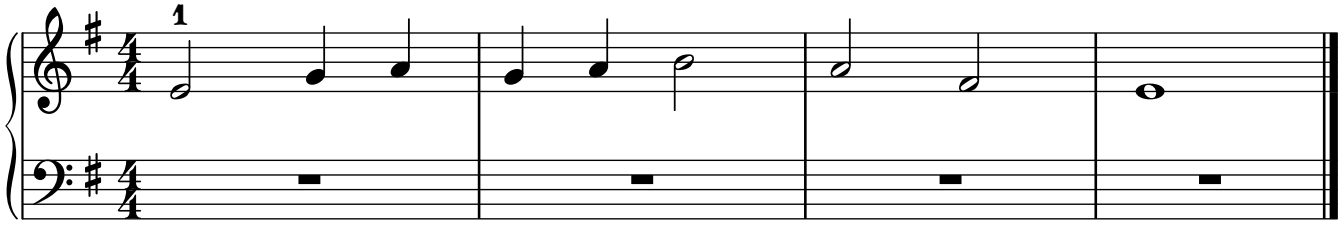
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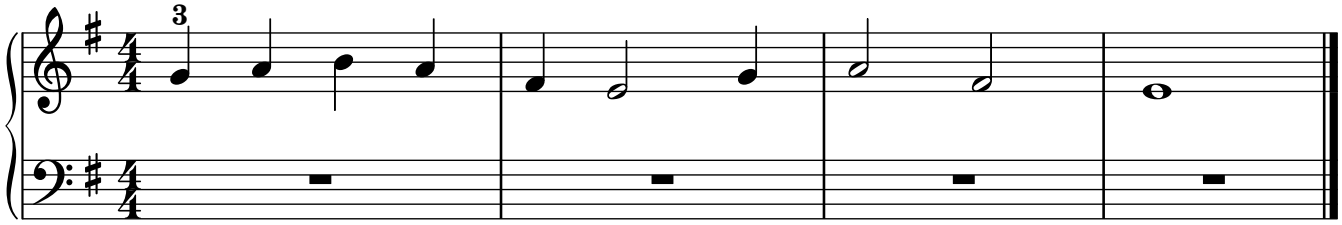


☐ **9.4**



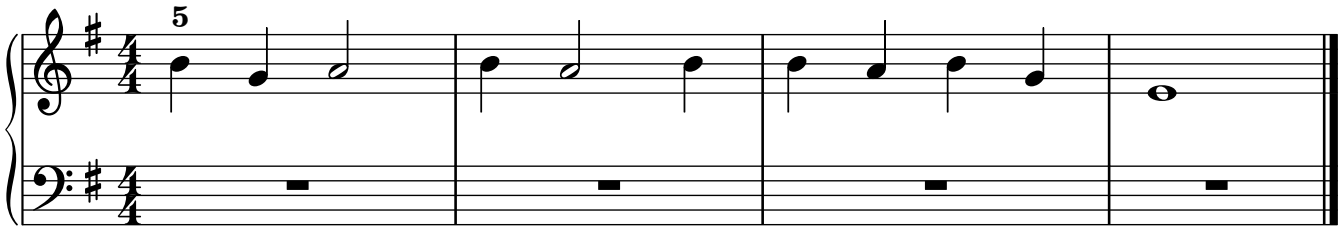
☐ **9.5**



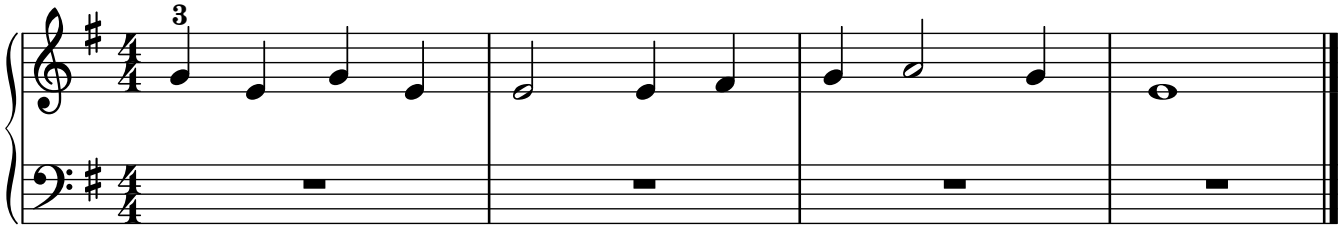
☐ **9.6**



☐ **9.7**
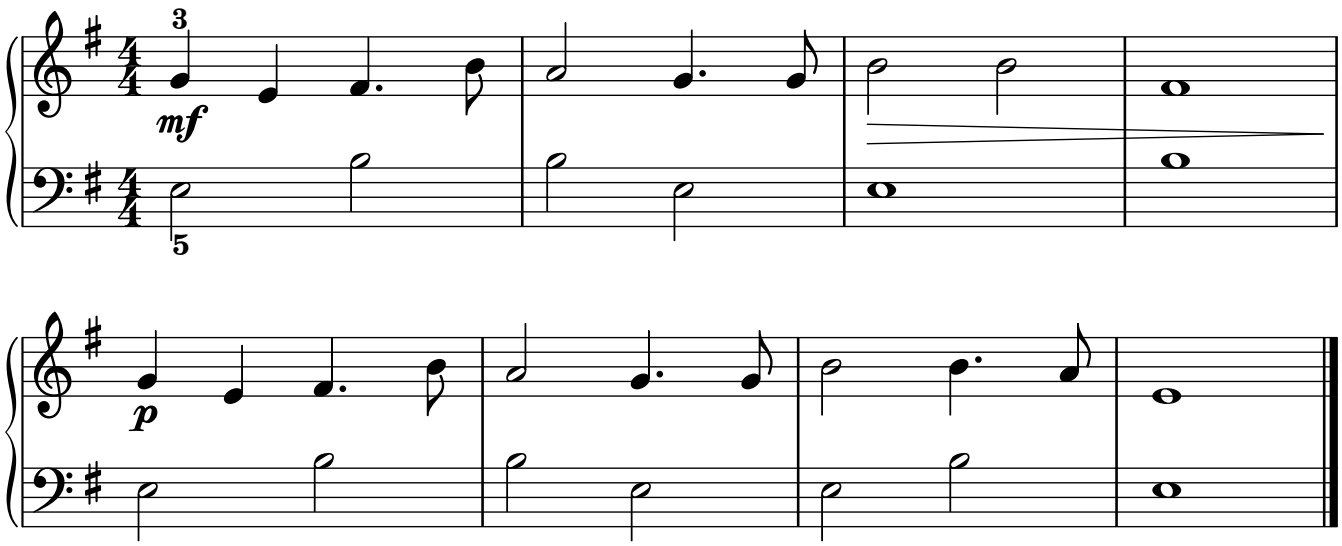


☐ **9.8**
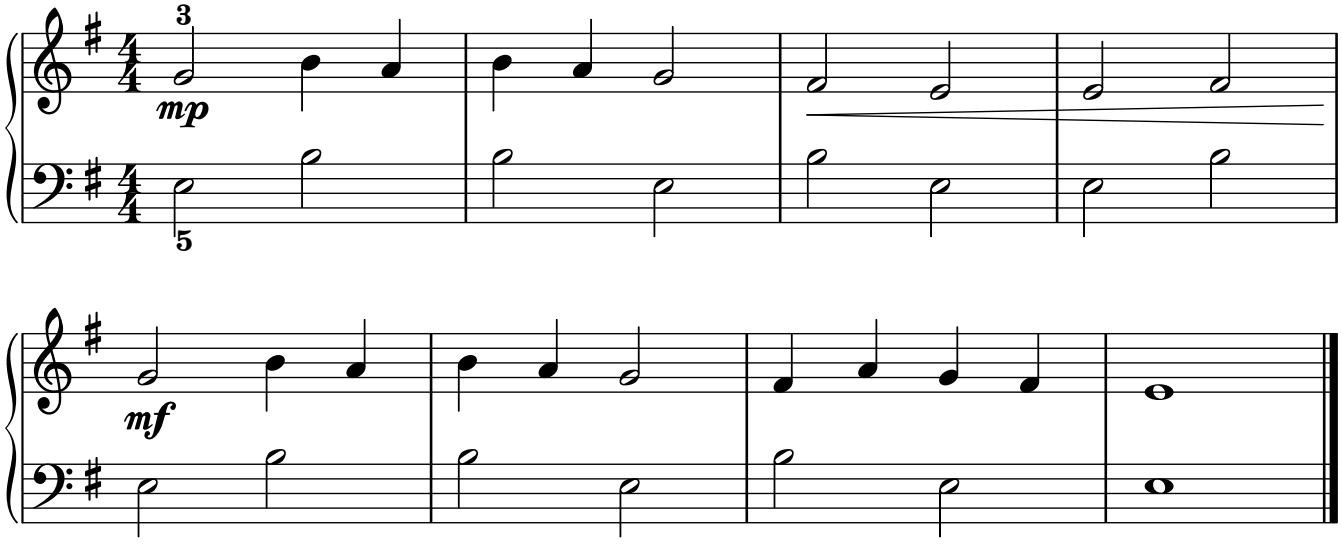


Part B: E minor, hands together ♩ = 66

E minor, hands together.

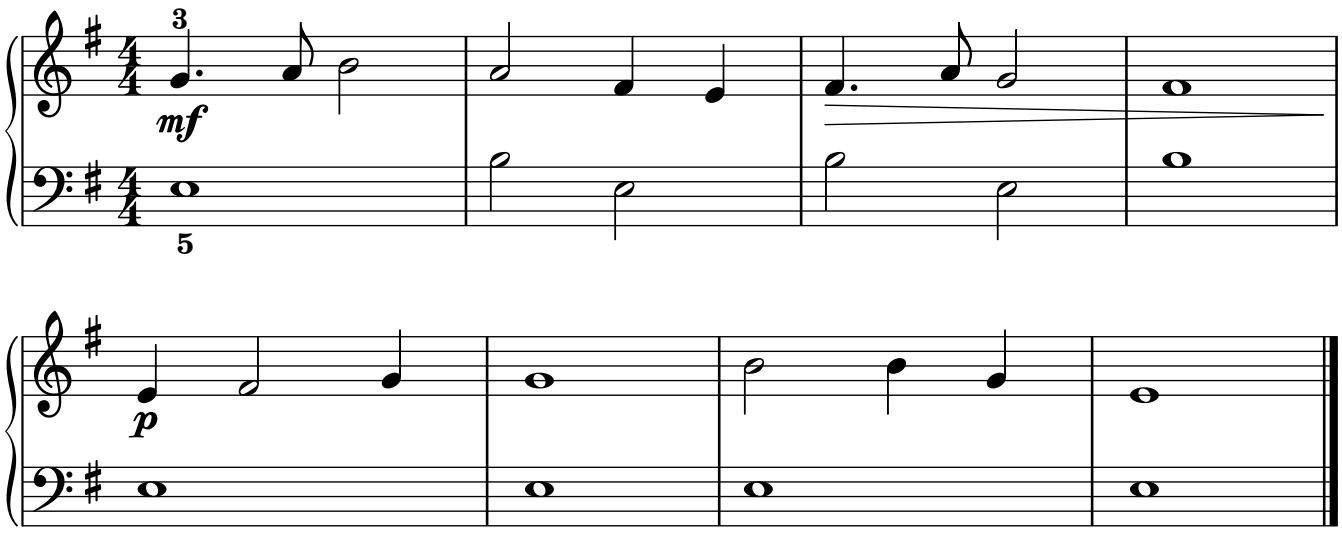
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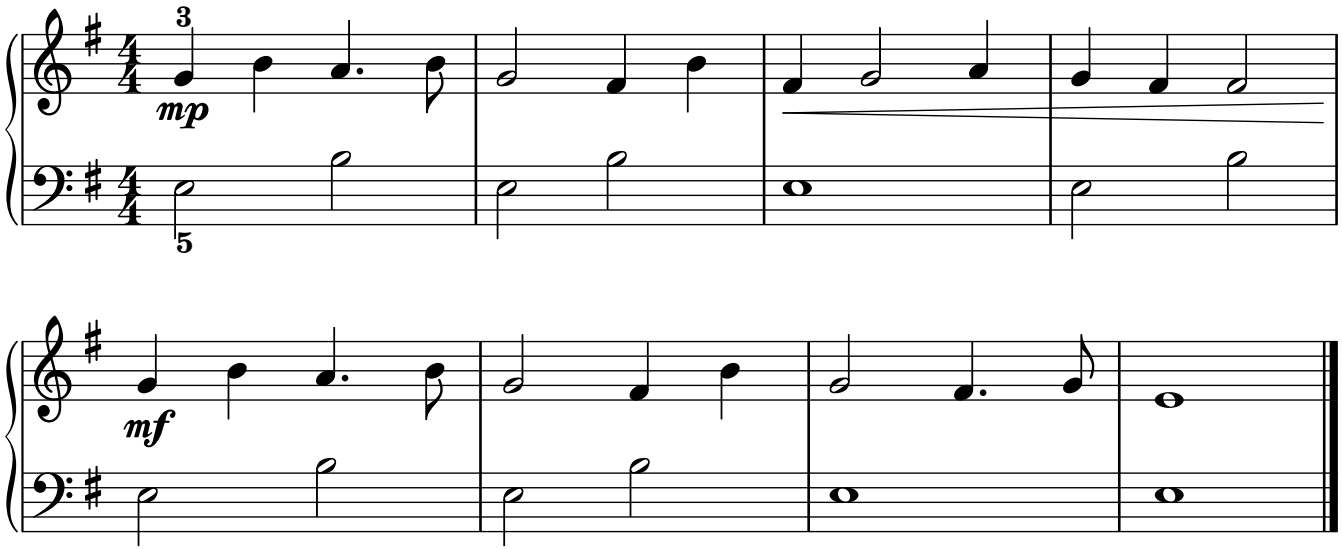


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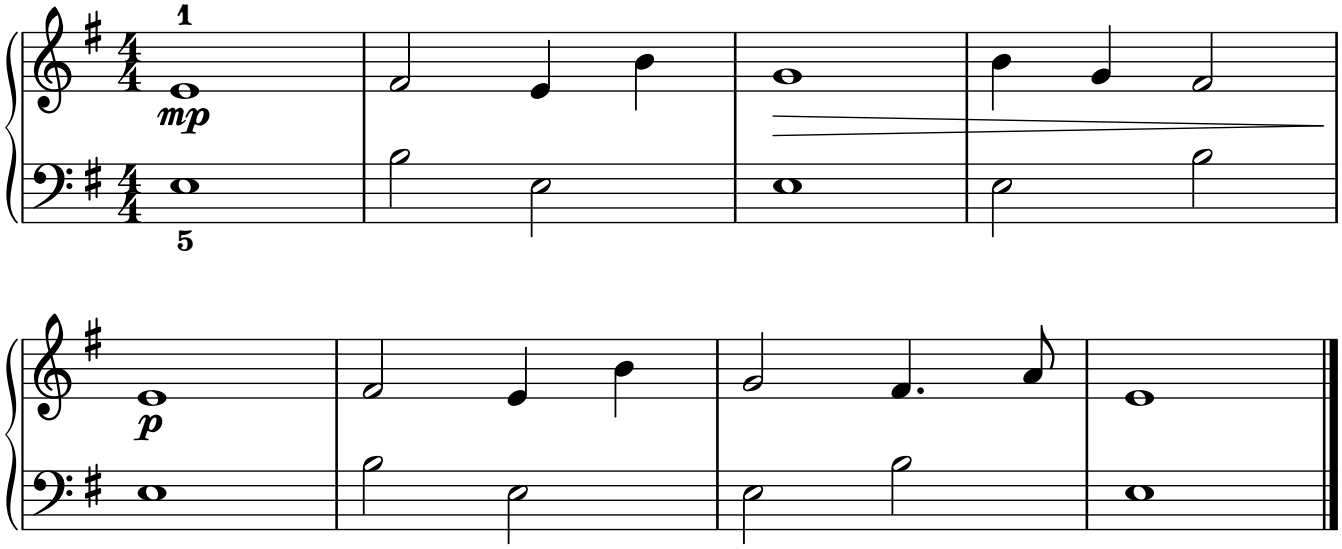


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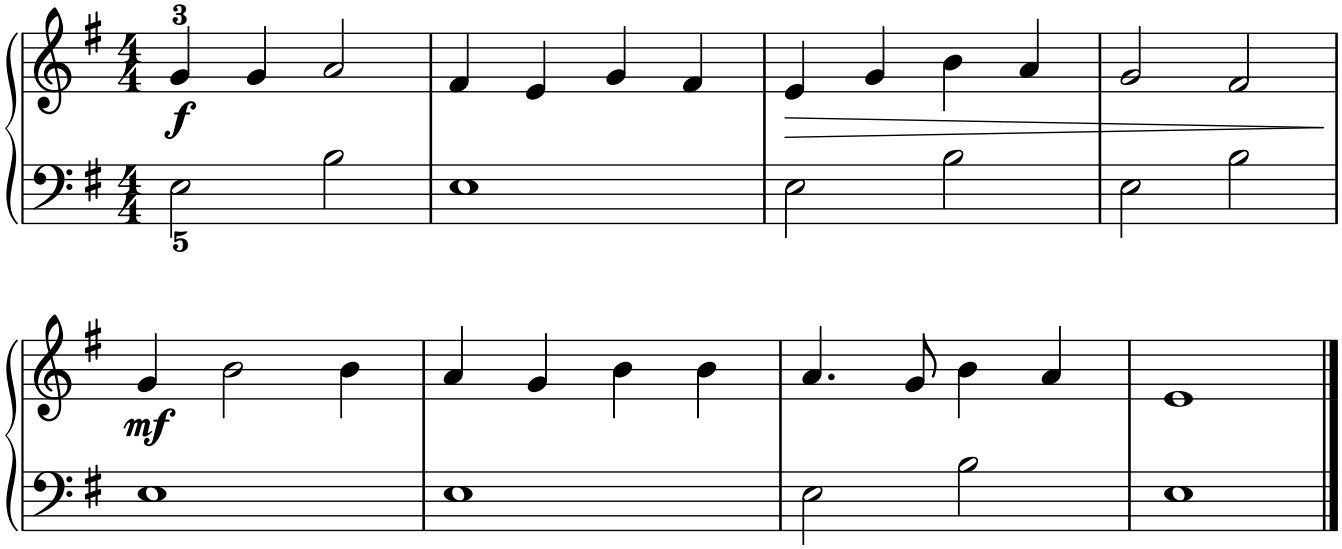


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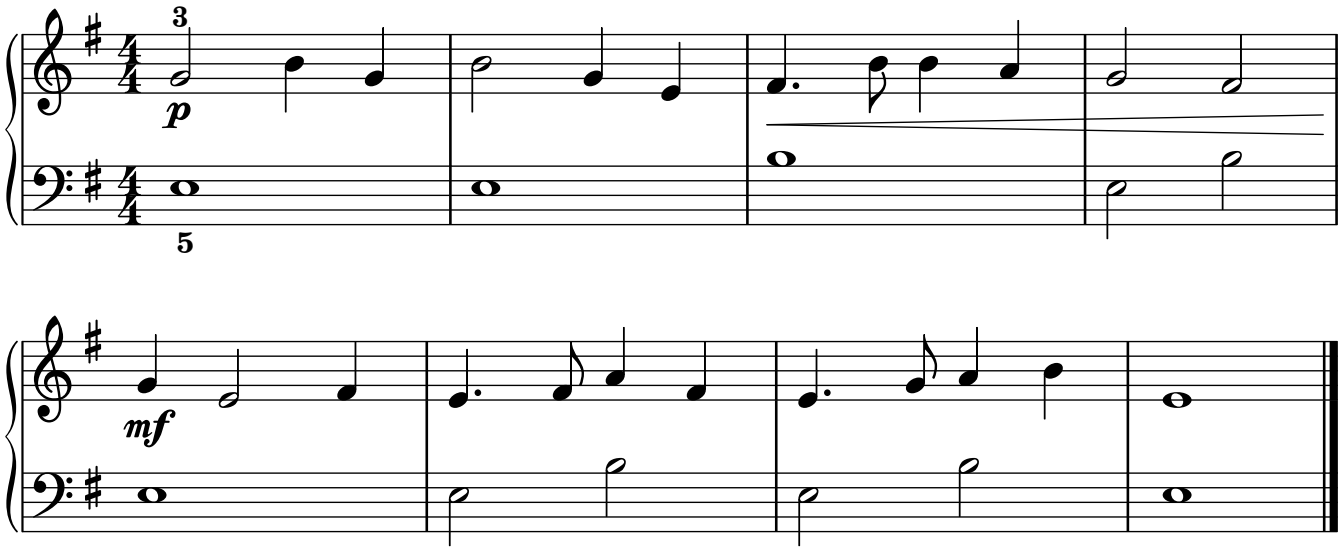


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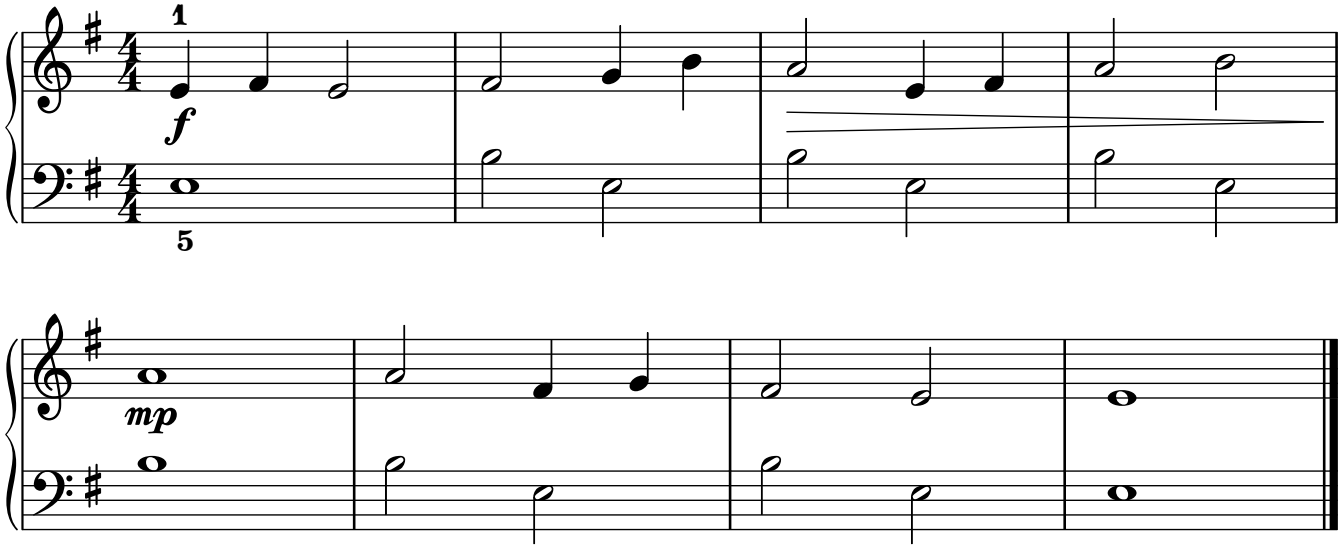


9.14



9.15



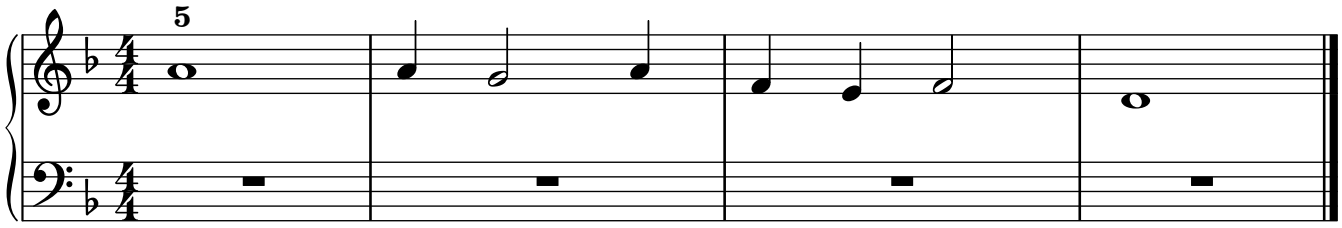
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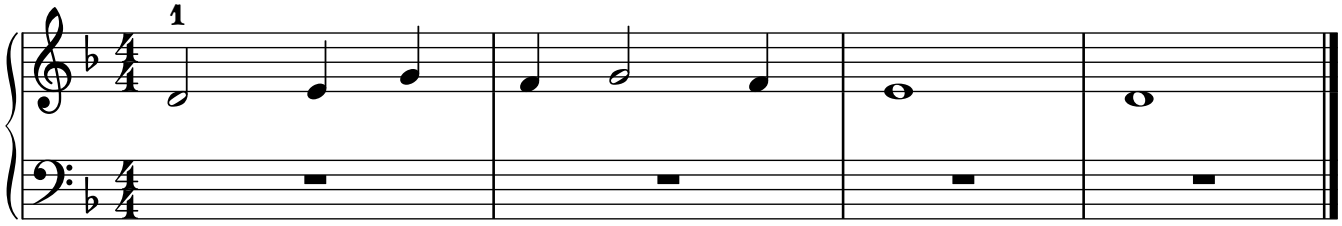
Part C: D minor, right hand ♩ = 60

D minor in the right hand.
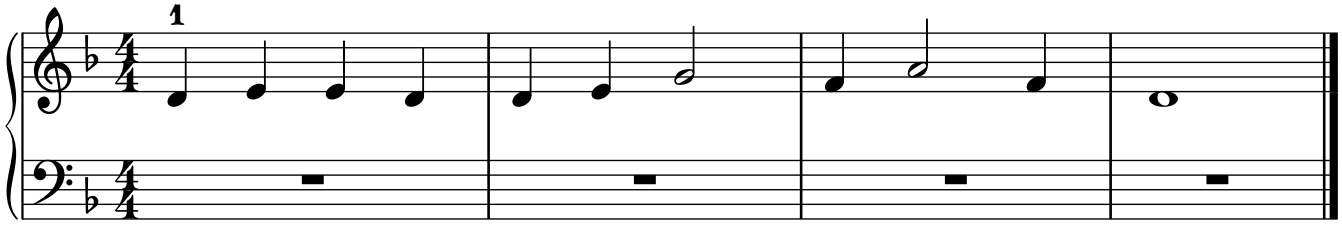
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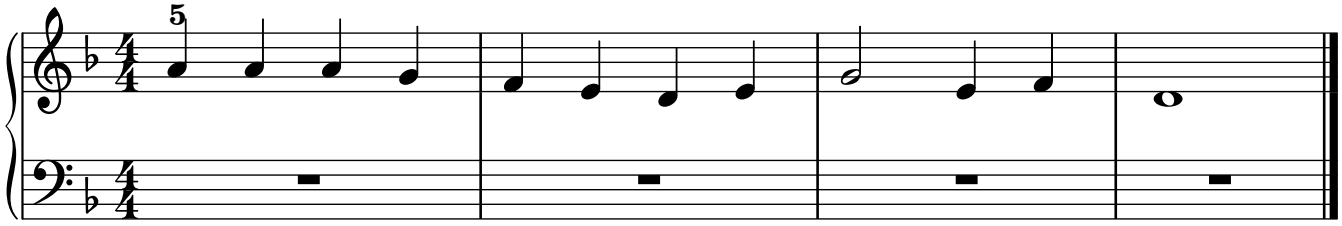
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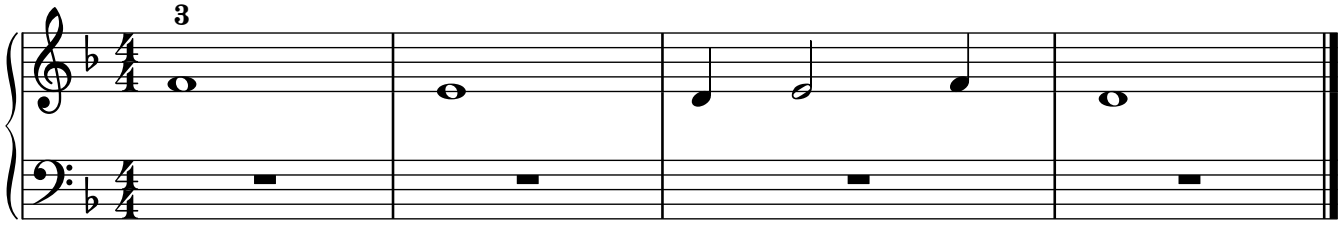
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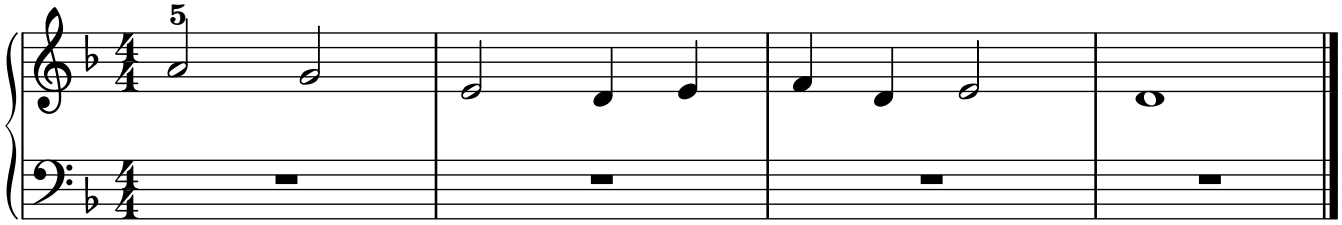


☐ **9.20**



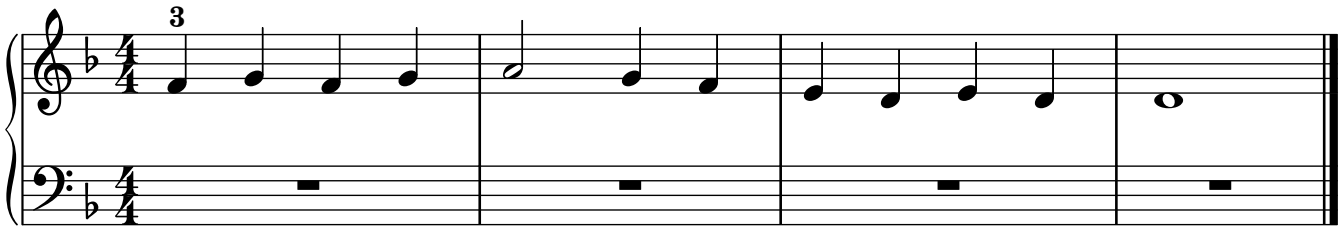
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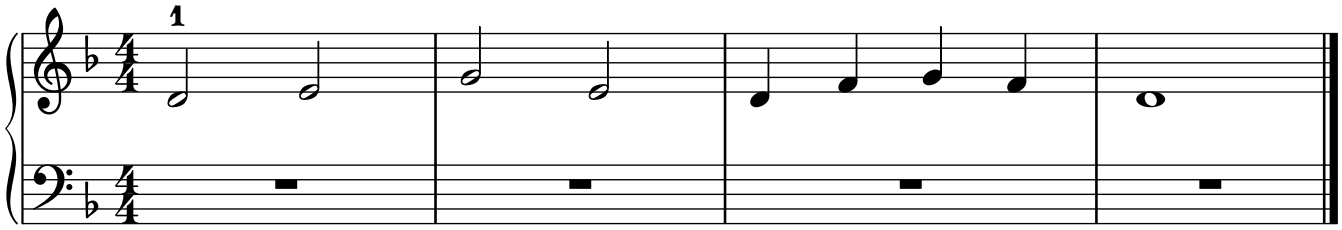


☐ **9.22**



9.23
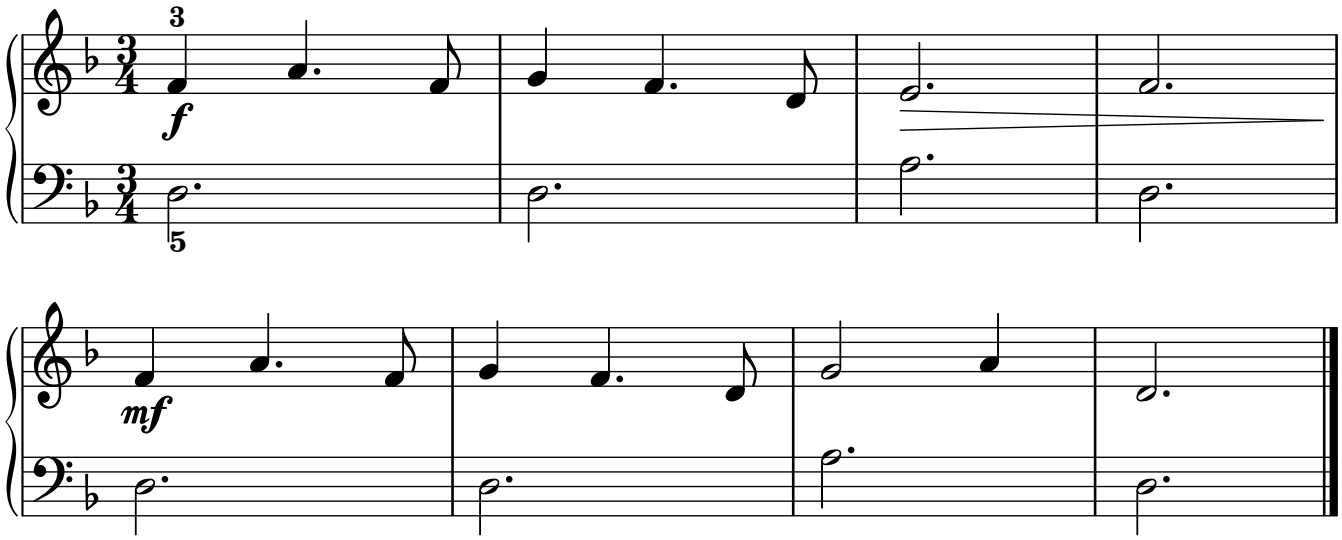


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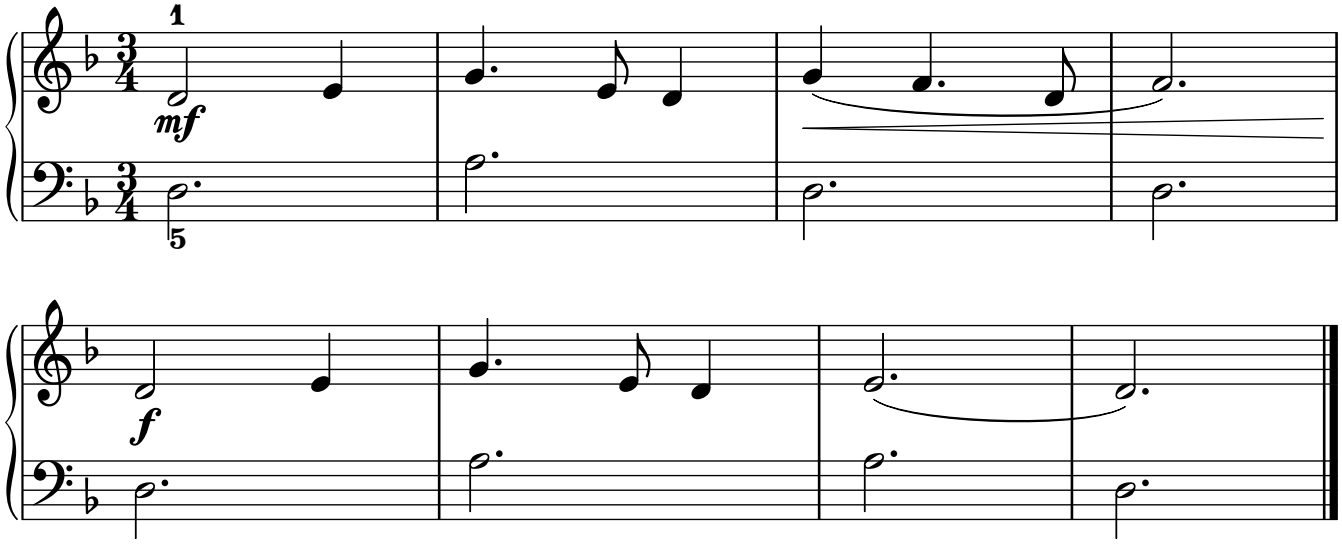


Part D: D minor, hands together ♩= 72

D minor, hands together in 3/4.

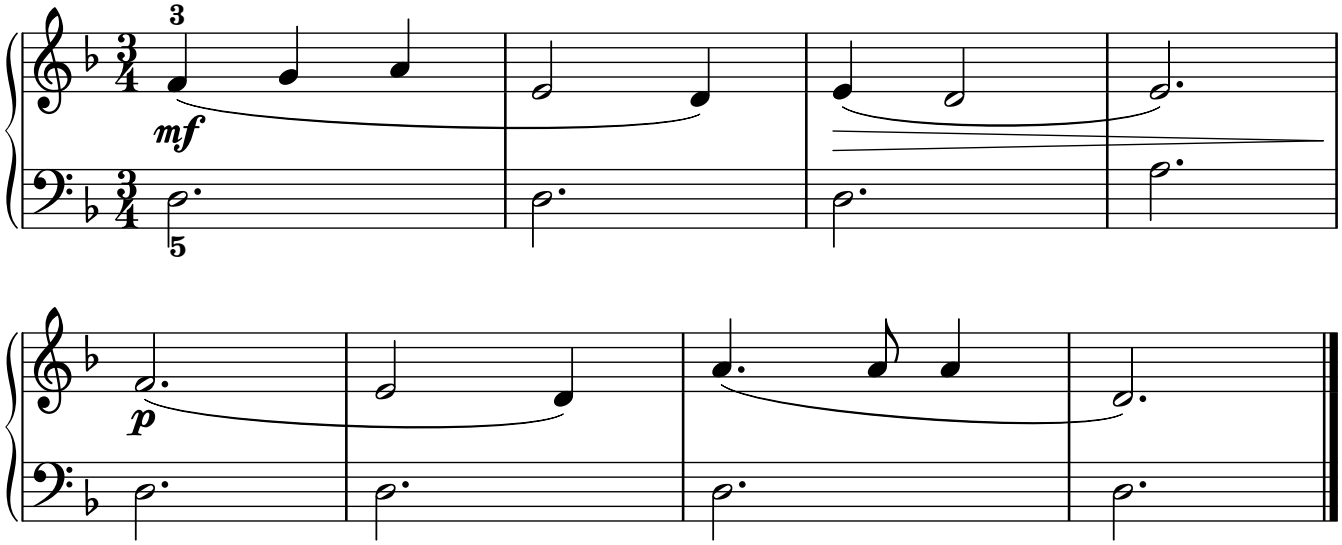
☐ **9.25**



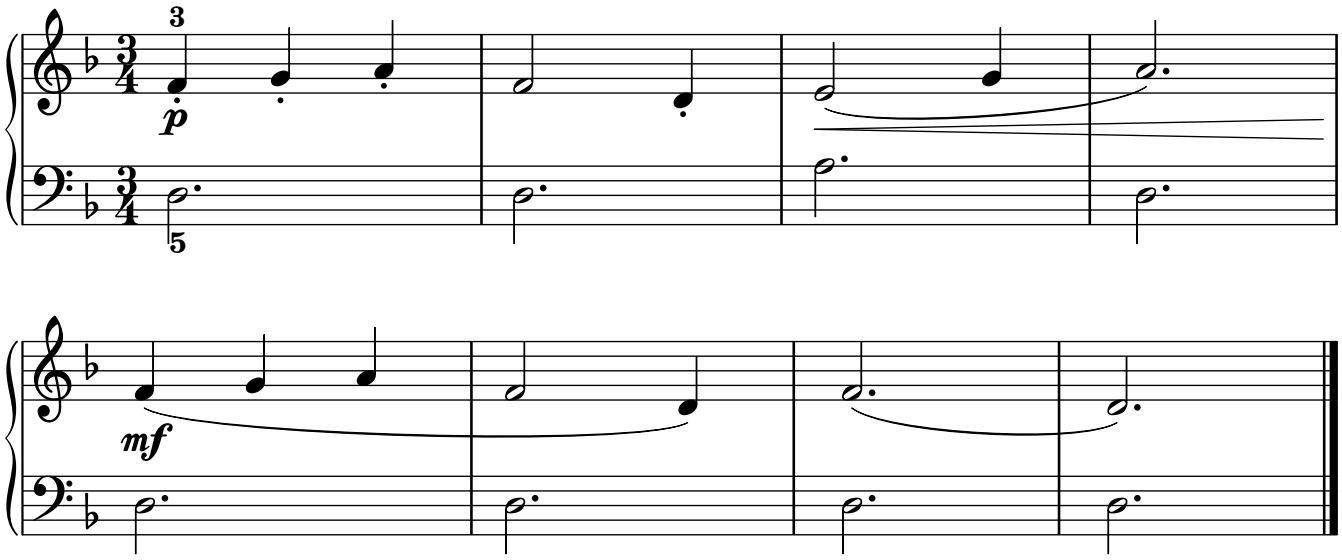
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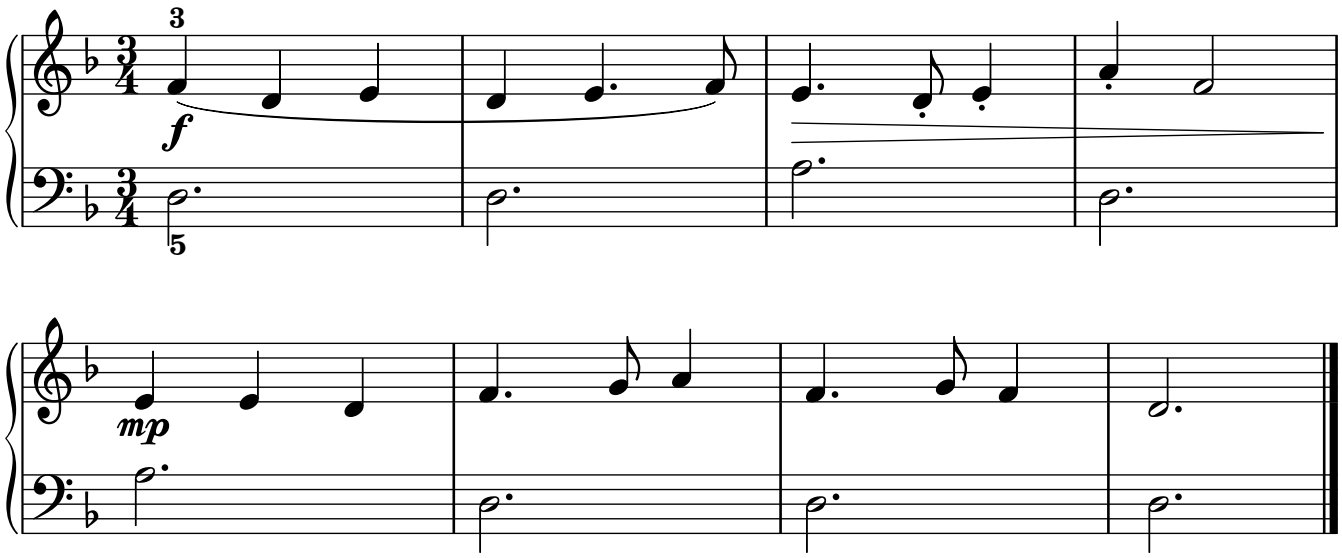


☐ **9.27**
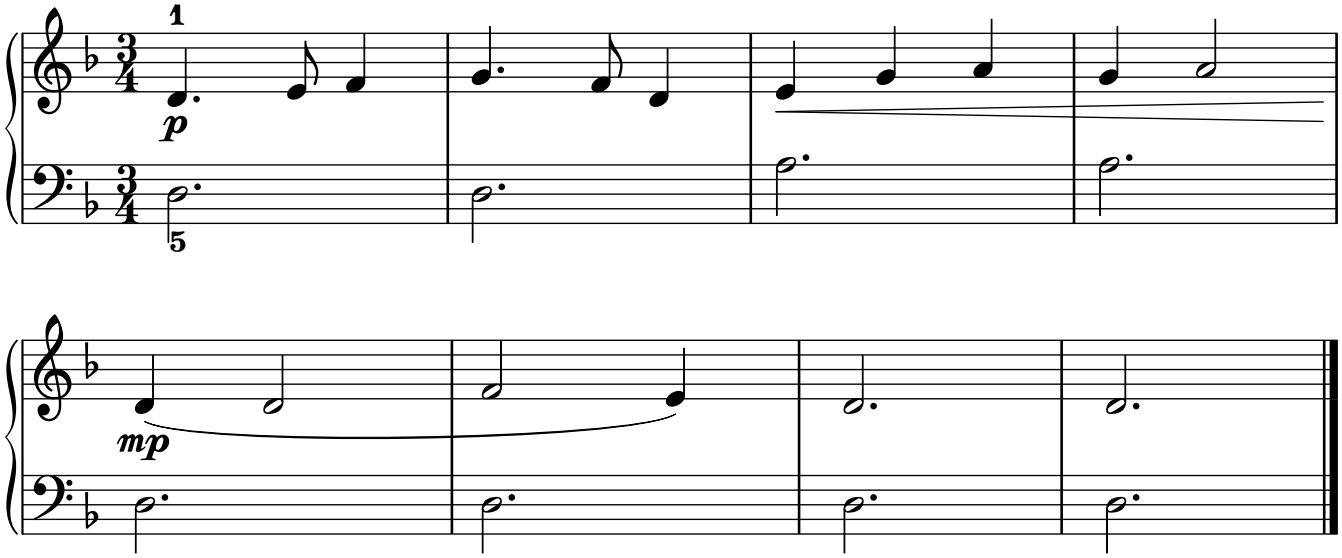


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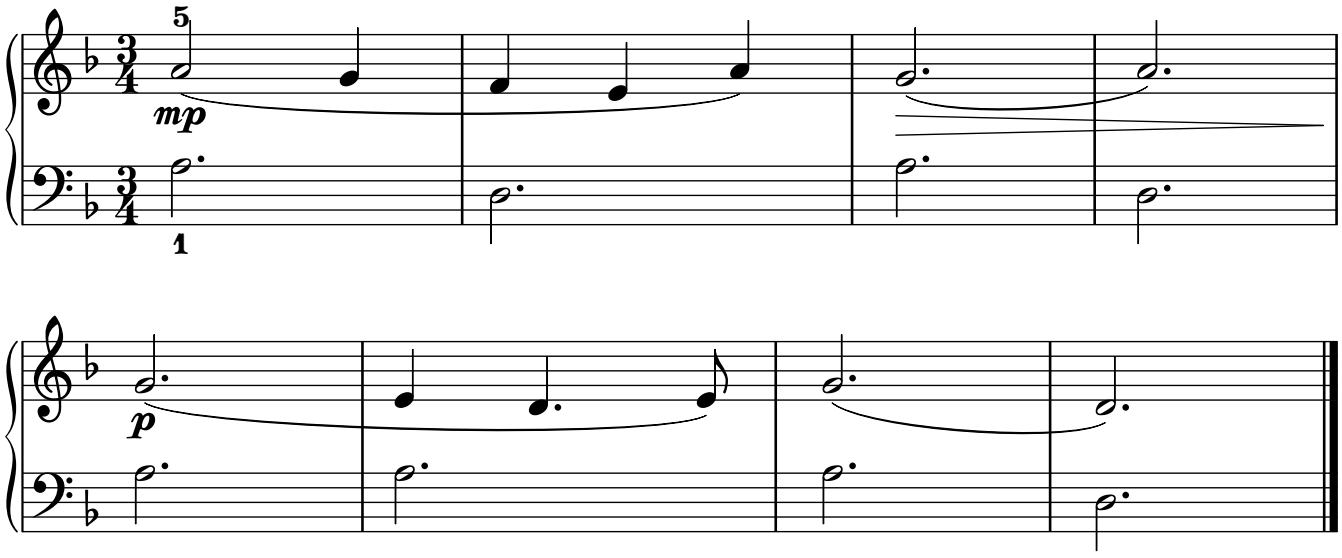


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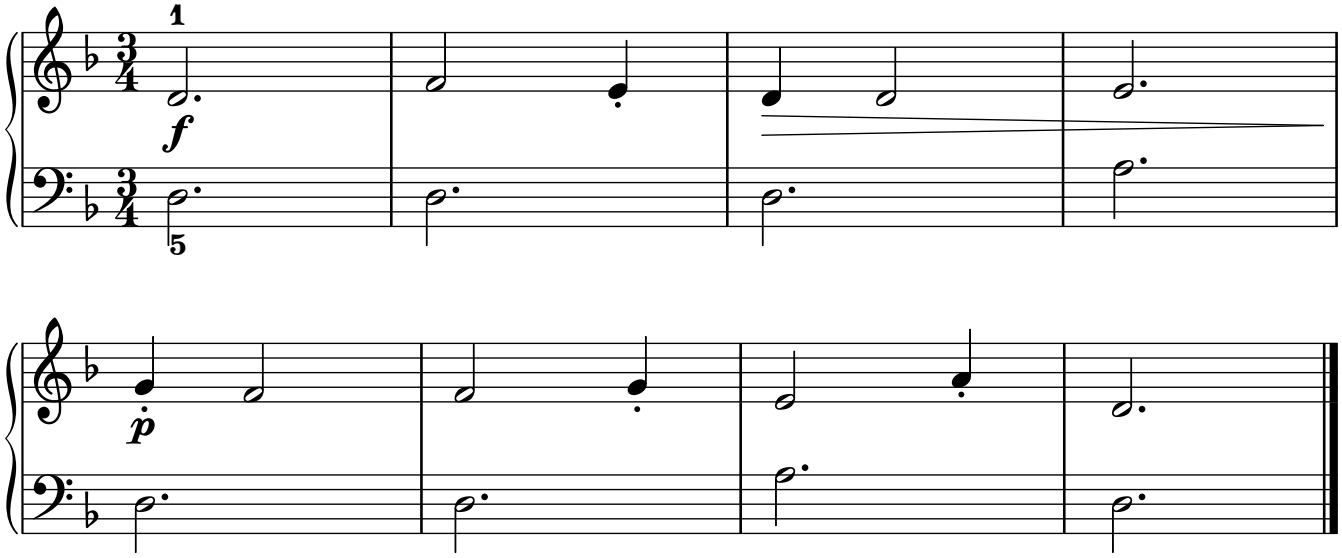


9.30



9.31



9.32
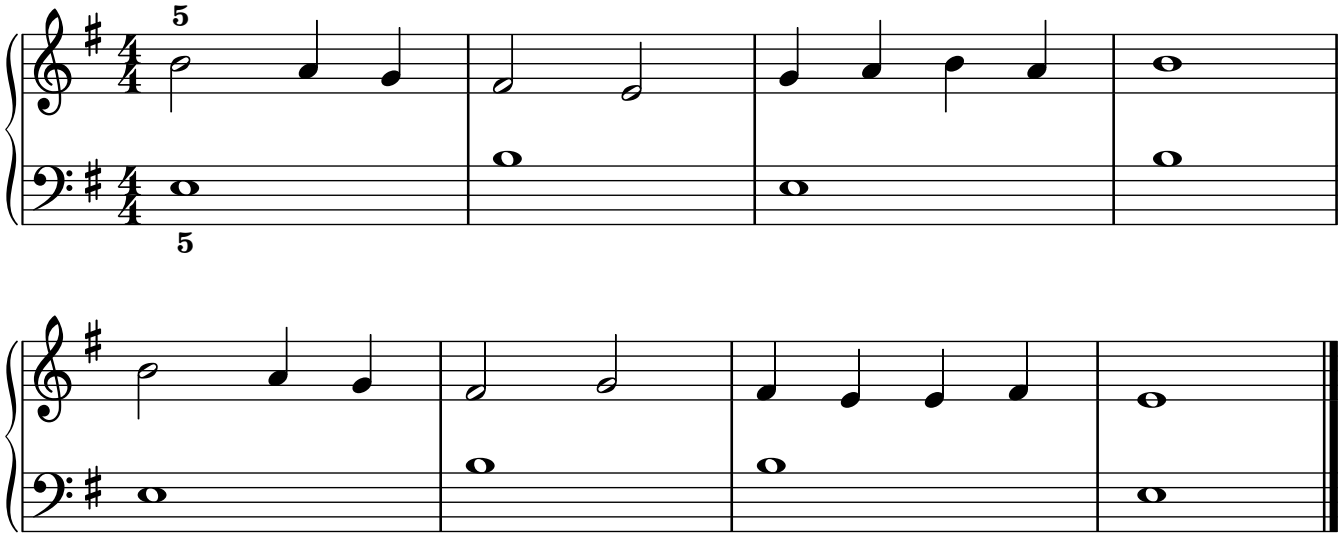


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Song in E Minor ♩ = 72

Original
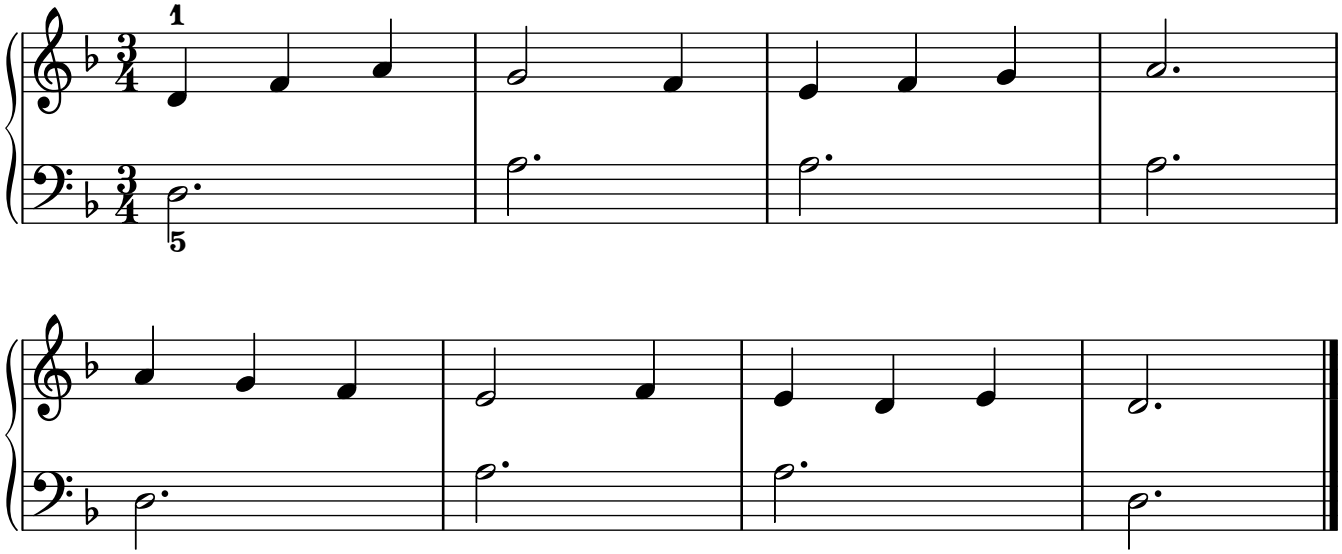
The tune starts with the little finger on B. Finger 2 plays F-sharp; the bass alternates E (finger 5) and B (finger 1).



D Minor Waltz ♩ = 84

Original
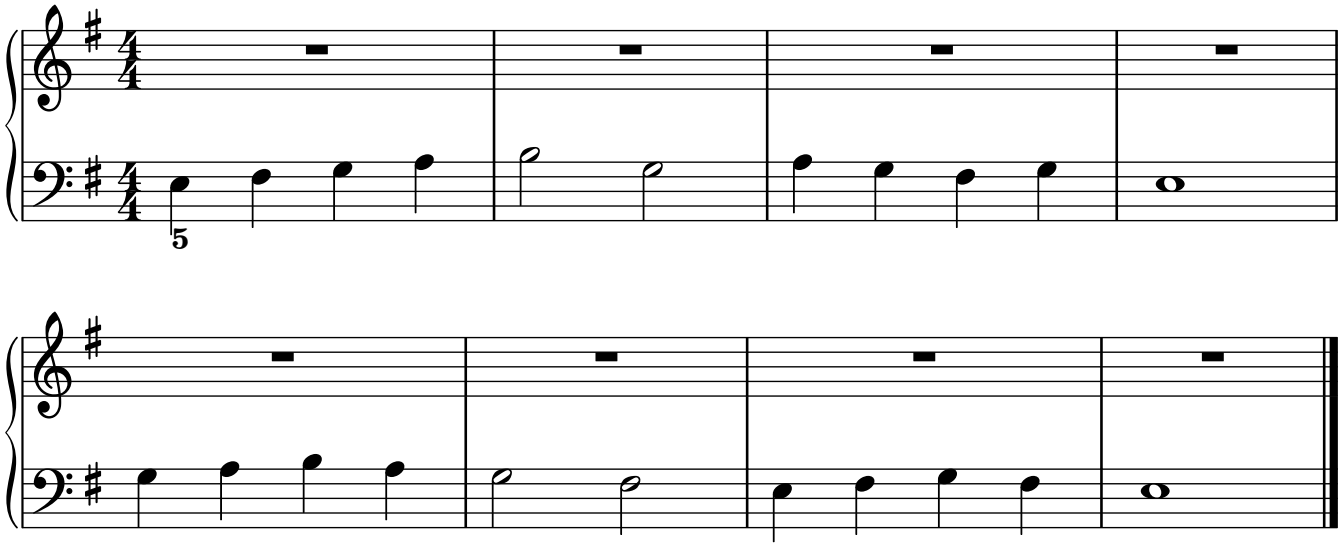
D position, all white keys. The bass alternates D (finger 5) and A (finger 1).



E Minor Walk ♩= 72

Original

For the left hand alone, in E position; finger 4 plays F-sharp.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 10?

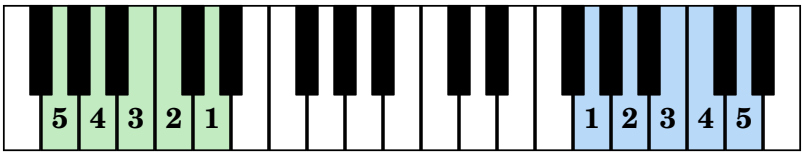
- Play three Part B and three Part D exercises you have not played before, at the speeds shown.
- Pass if you name each key correctly before you start.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 10, the review.

Unit 10

Review

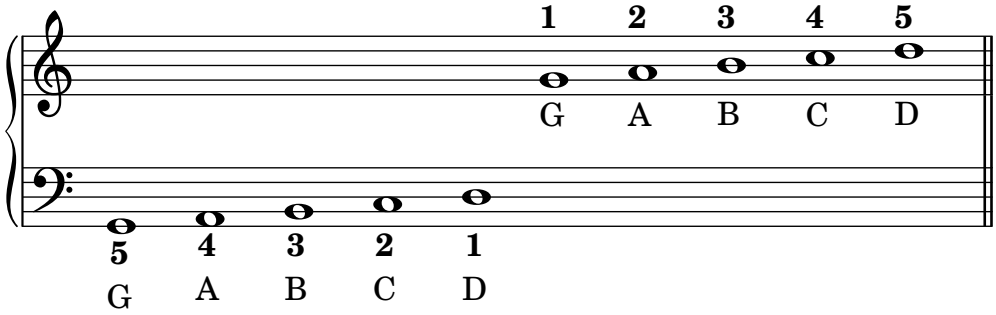
New: Everything in Volume 2 together

This unit mixes everything in Volume 2: shifts, stretches, dotted rhythms, legato and staccato, dynamics, and the keys of C, G and F major and A, E and D minor. The last piece, a famous minuet, is a challenge that uses four hand positions.



Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

1. Key

Key signature and last note: which key is it, and which black keys does it use?

2. Positions

The first finger number, and every later one: each is a shift or a stretch.

3. Rhythm

Dotted quarters, eighths, rests and ties.

4. Sound

Dynamics, hairpins, slurs and staccato dots.

Reading tips

1. Use this four-point scan before every review exercise: key, positions, rhythm, sound.

2. Read in phrases of two or four bars, not note by note.
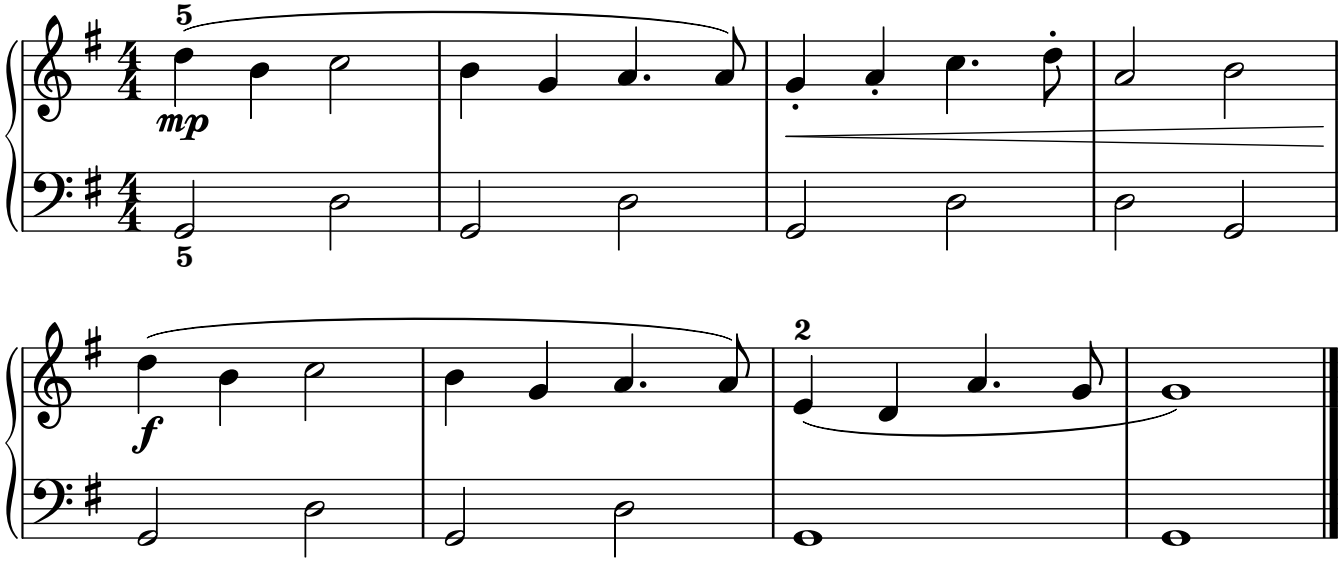
3. If something goes wrong, keep the beat and rejoin at the next bar line.

4. This is Level 2 reading. Enjoy how far you have come.

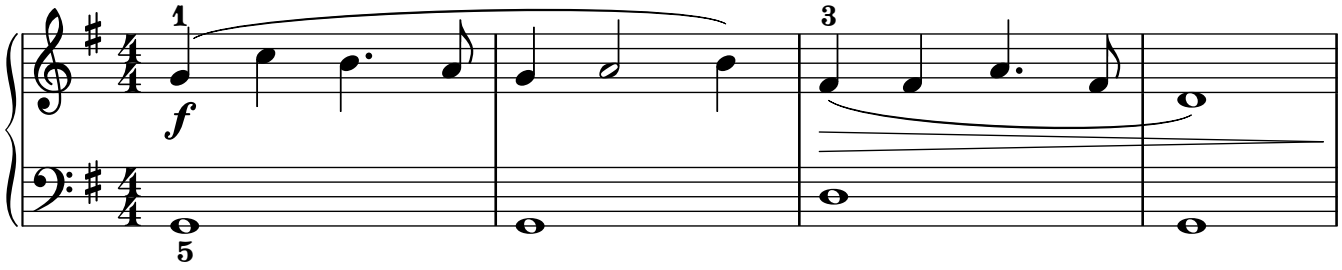
Part A: G major: shifts, dots and dynamics ♩ = 66

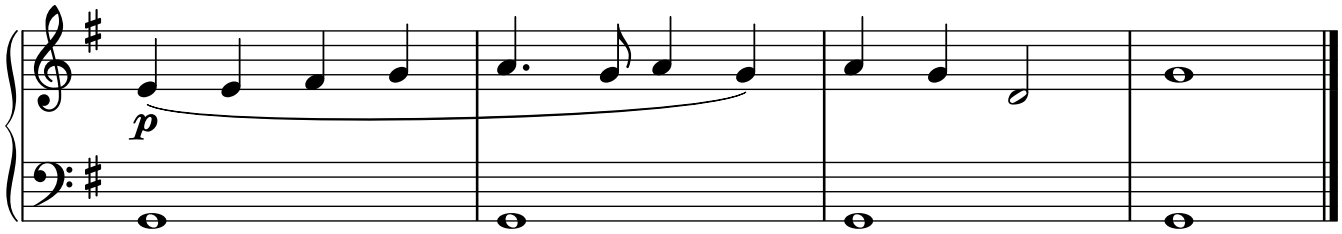
G major, hands together, with shifts, dotted rhythms, articulation and dynamics.

☐ **10.1**
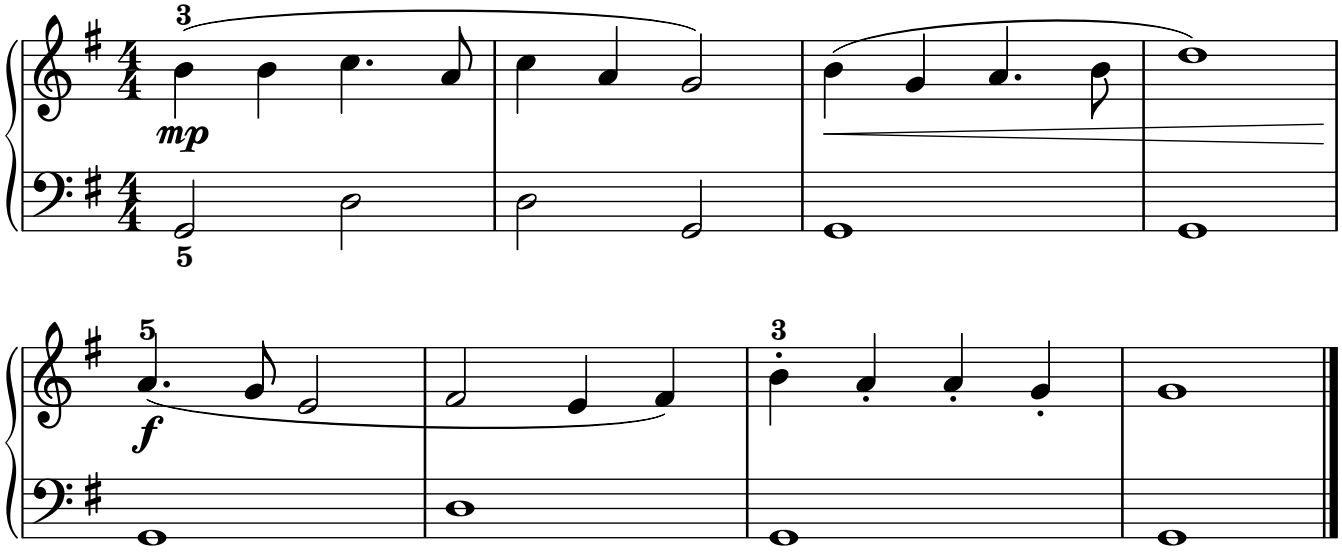


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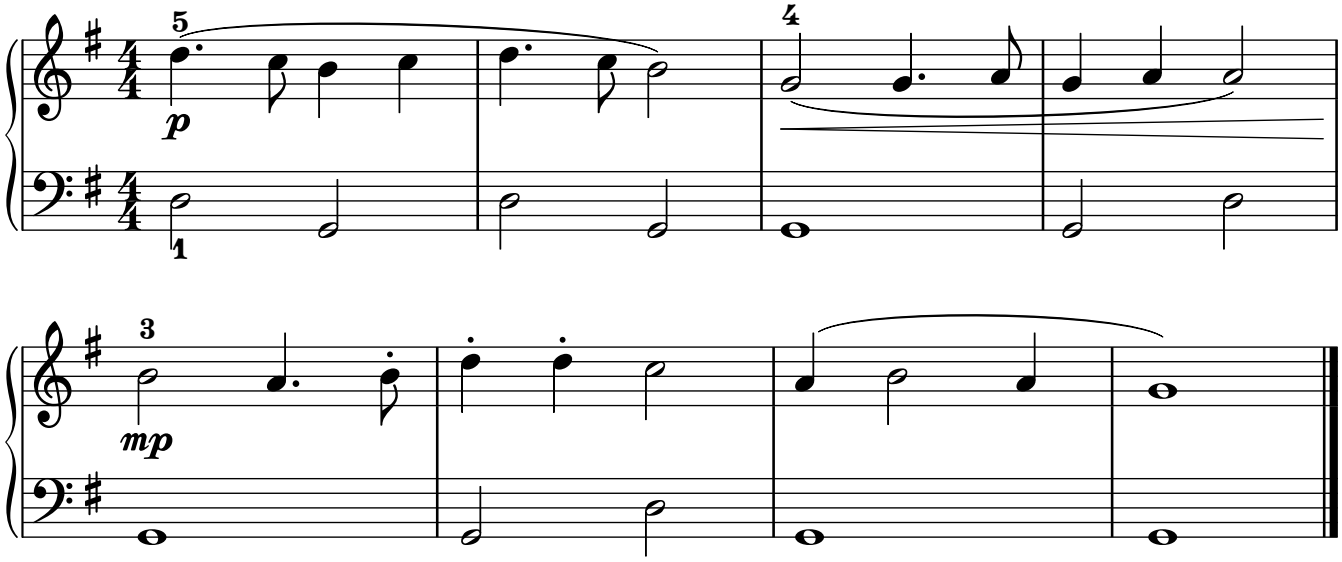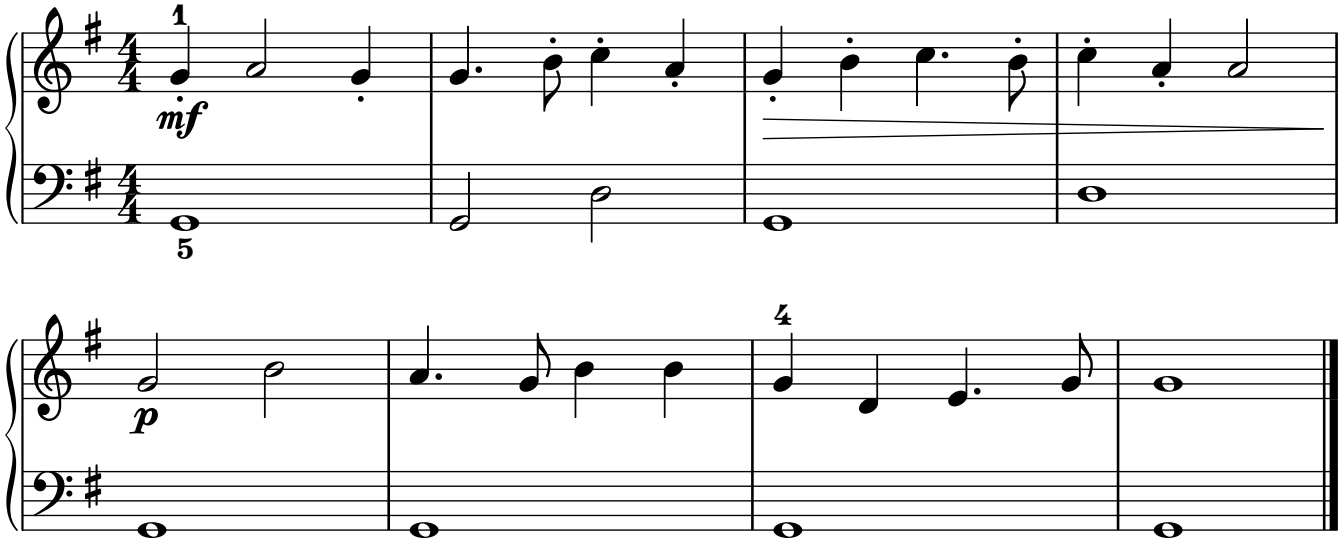




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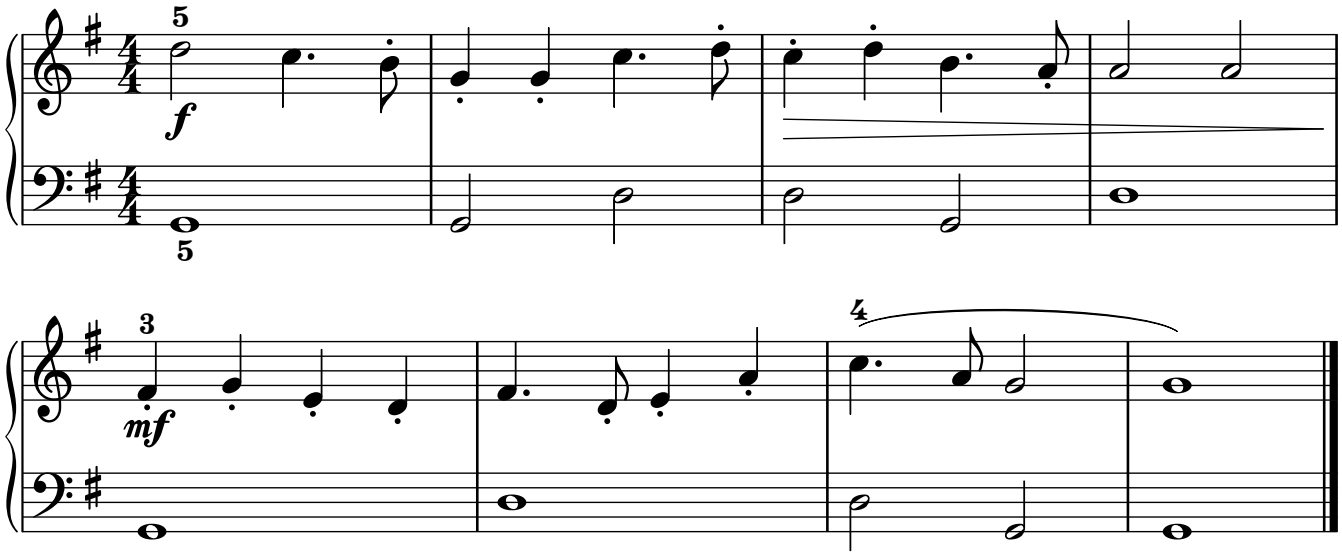


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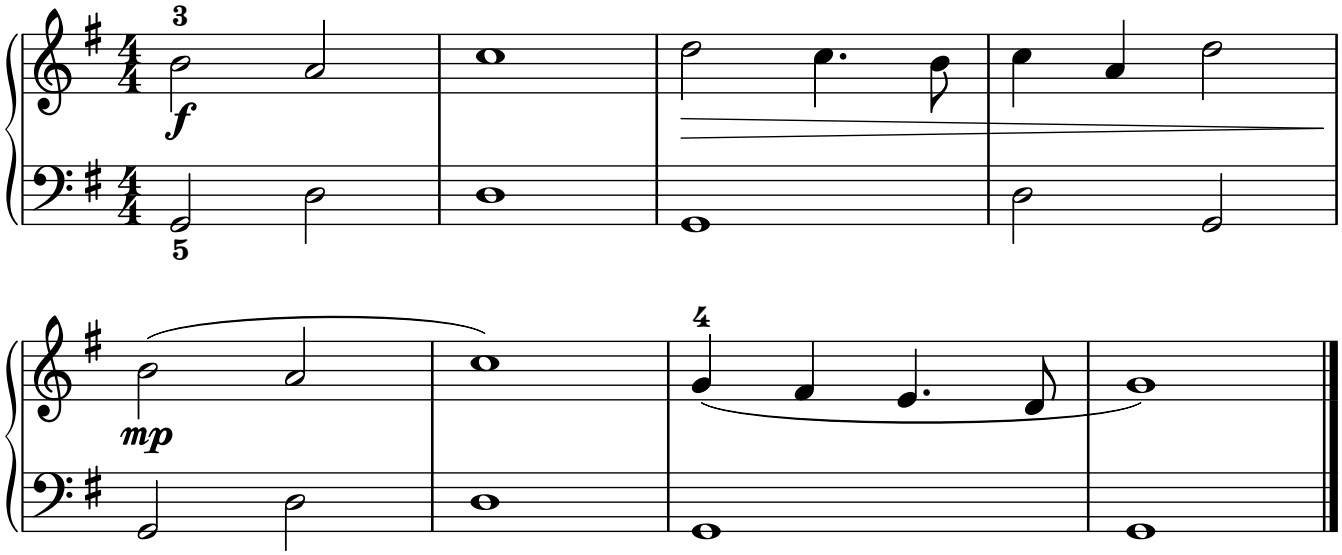
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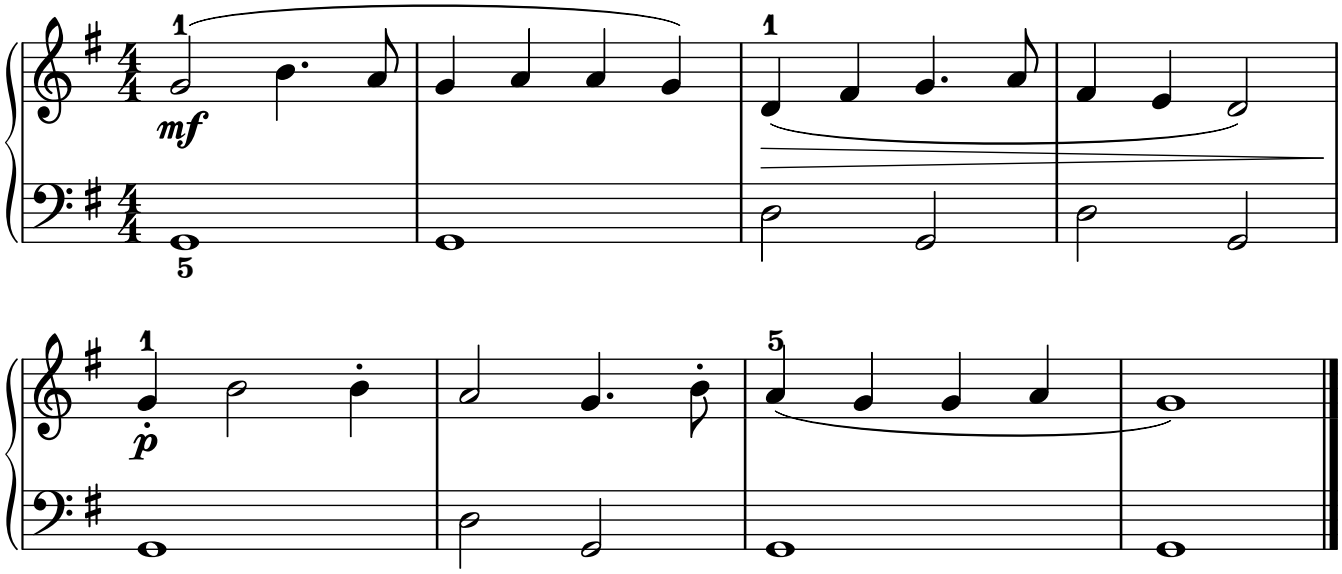
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10.7



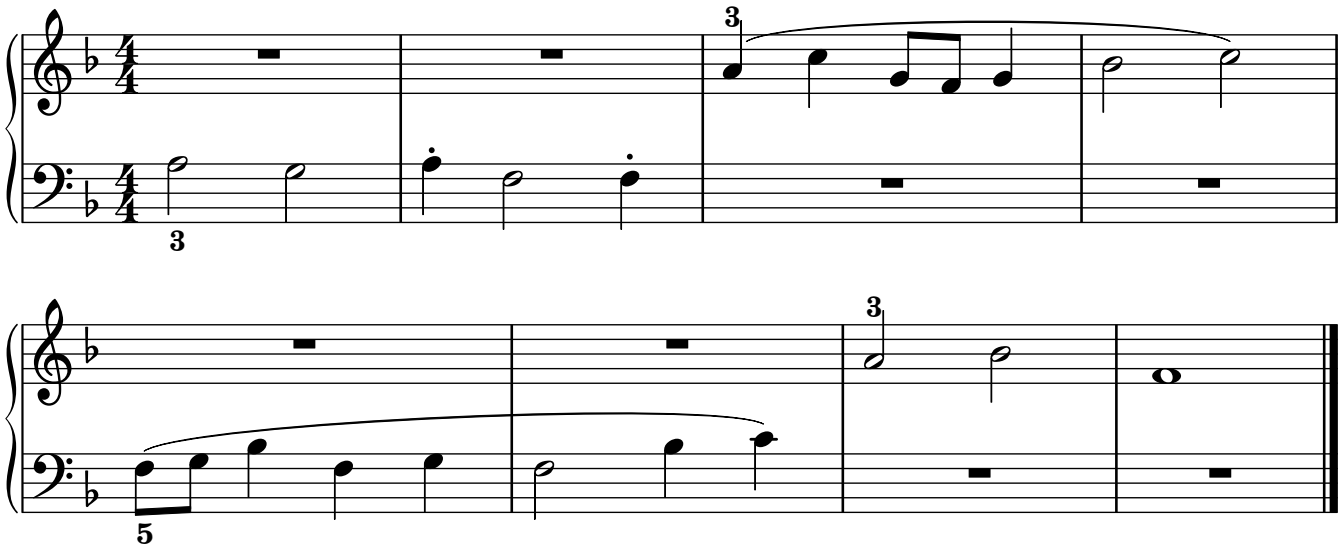
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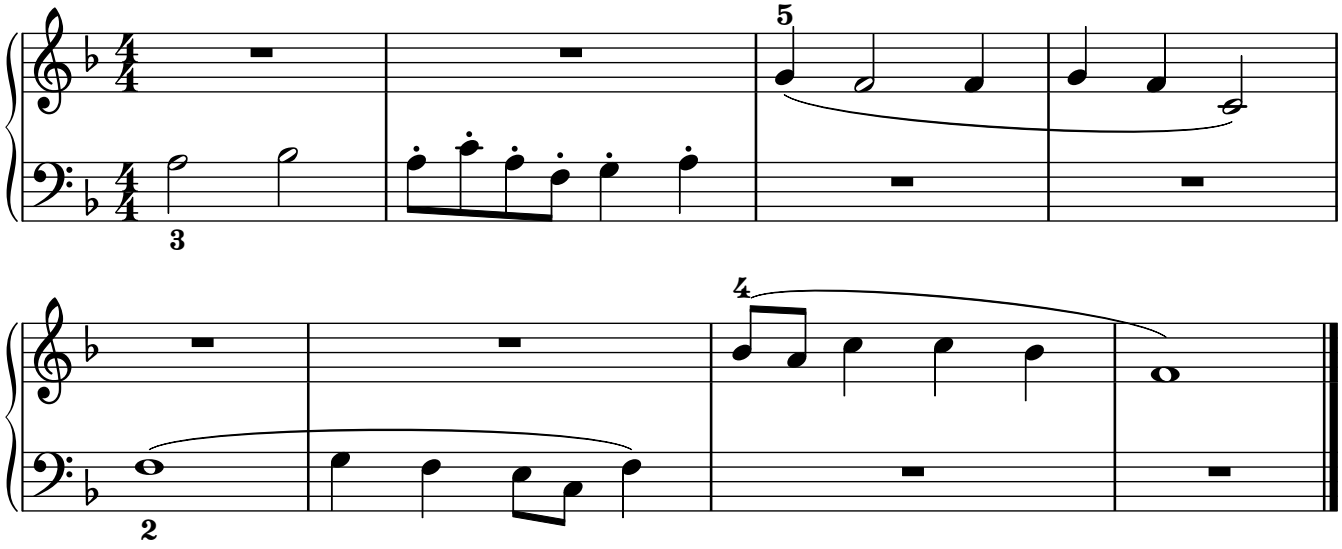


Part B: F major: hands taking turns ♩ = 66

F major, hands taking turns and moving between positions.

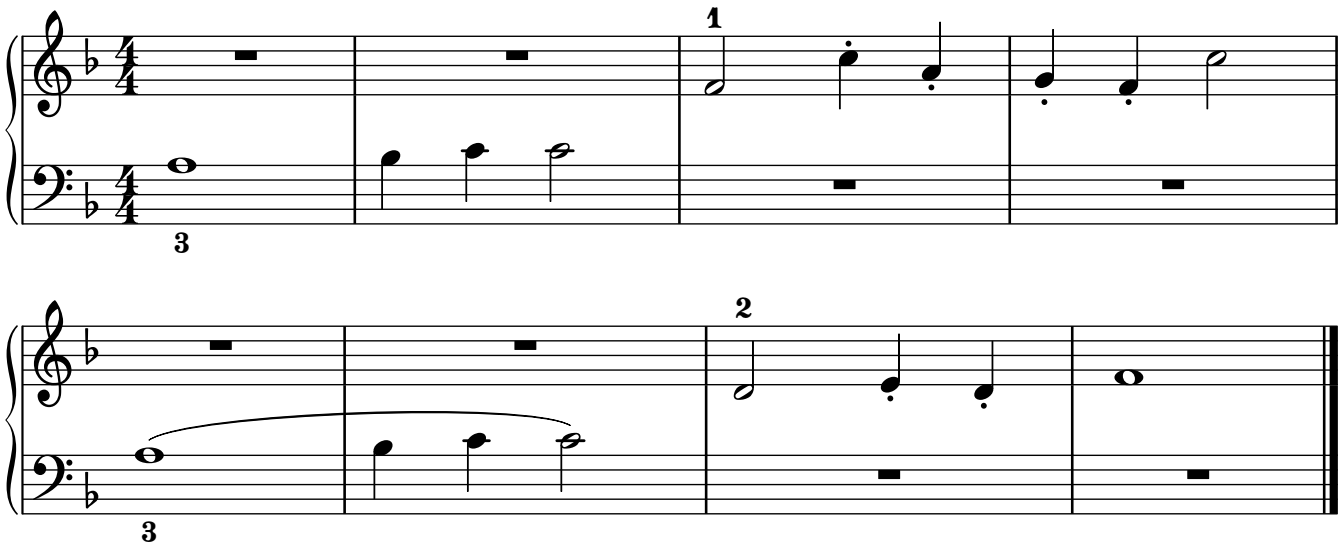
☐ **10.9**



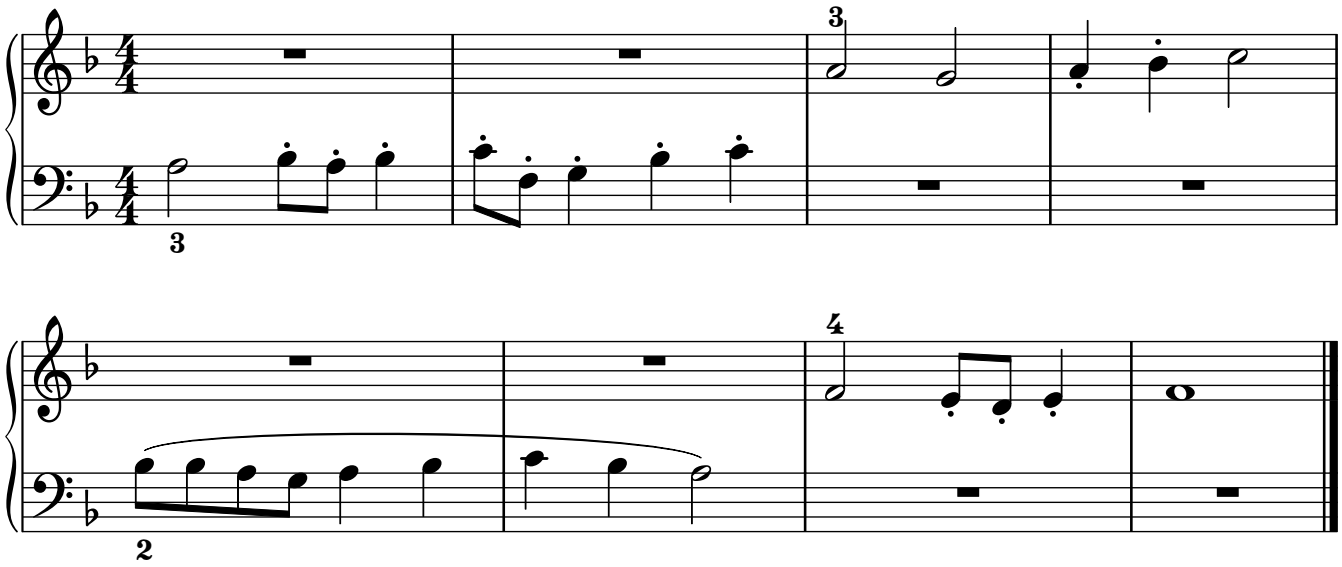
☐ **10.10**



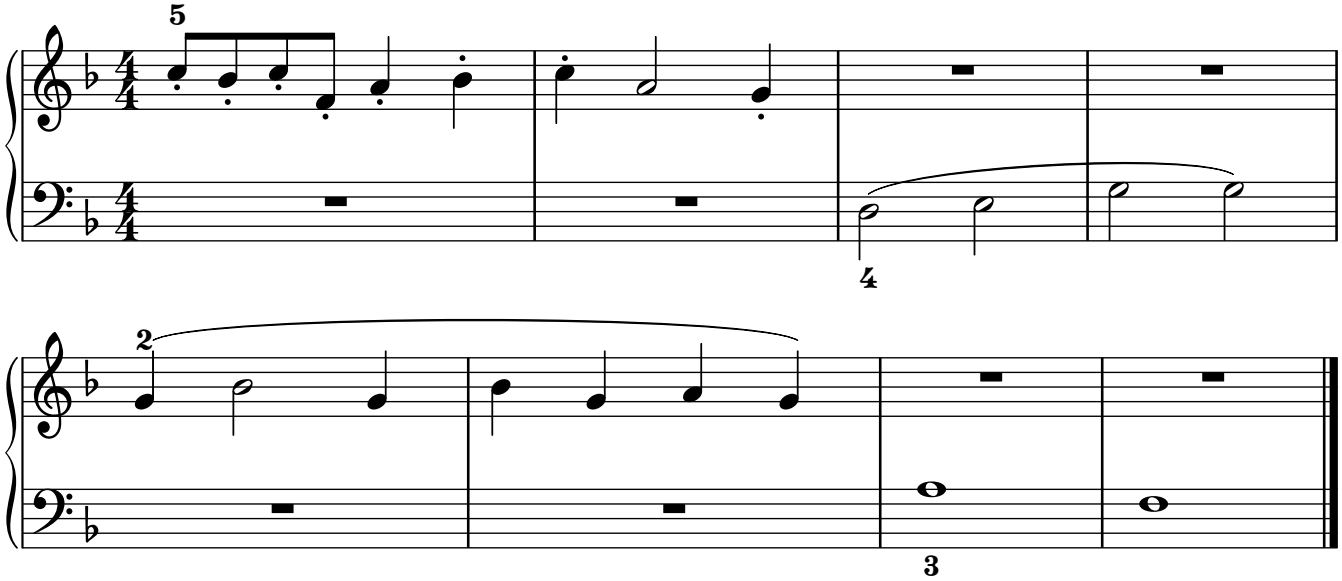
☐ **10.11**



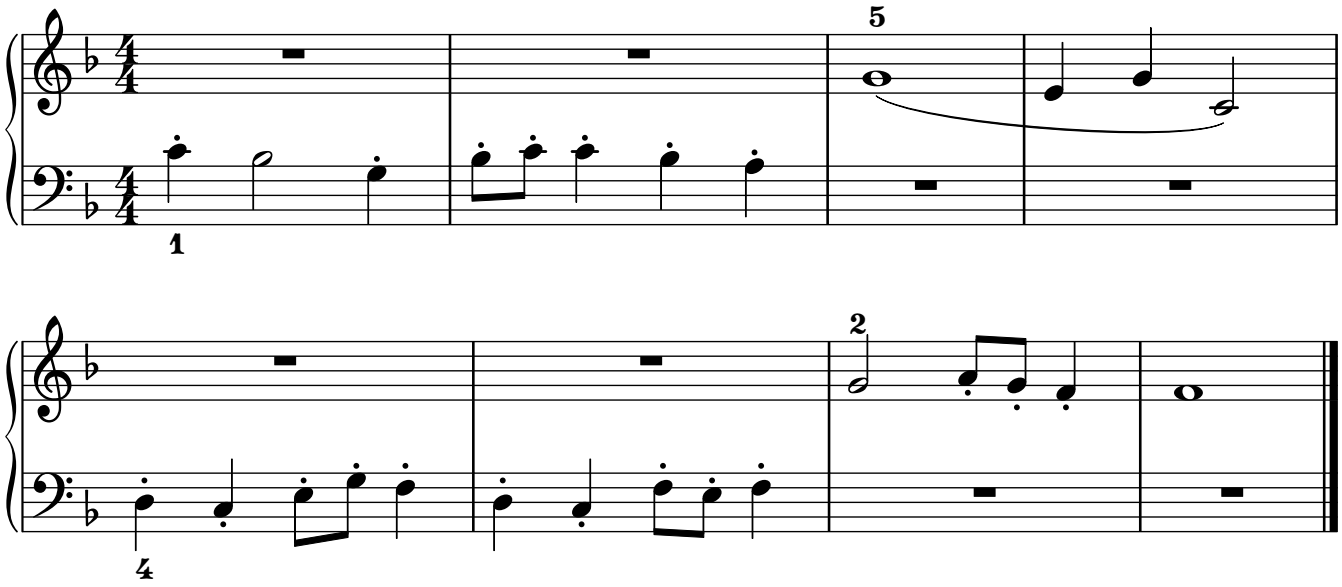
☐ **10.12**



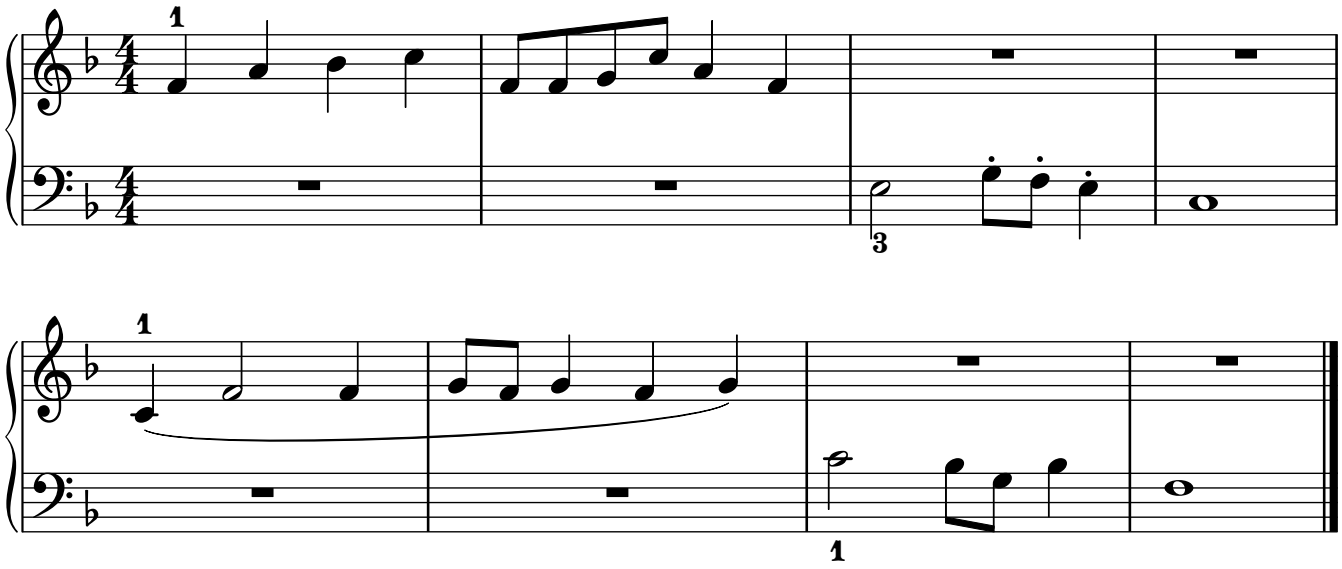
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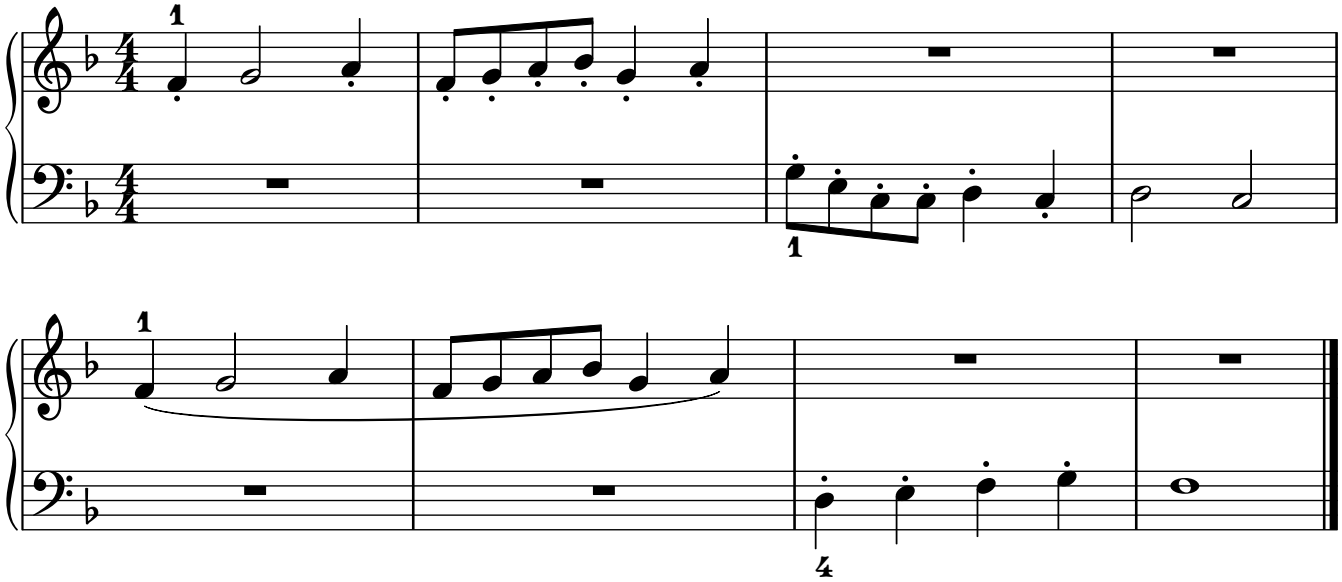


☐ **10.14**



10.15
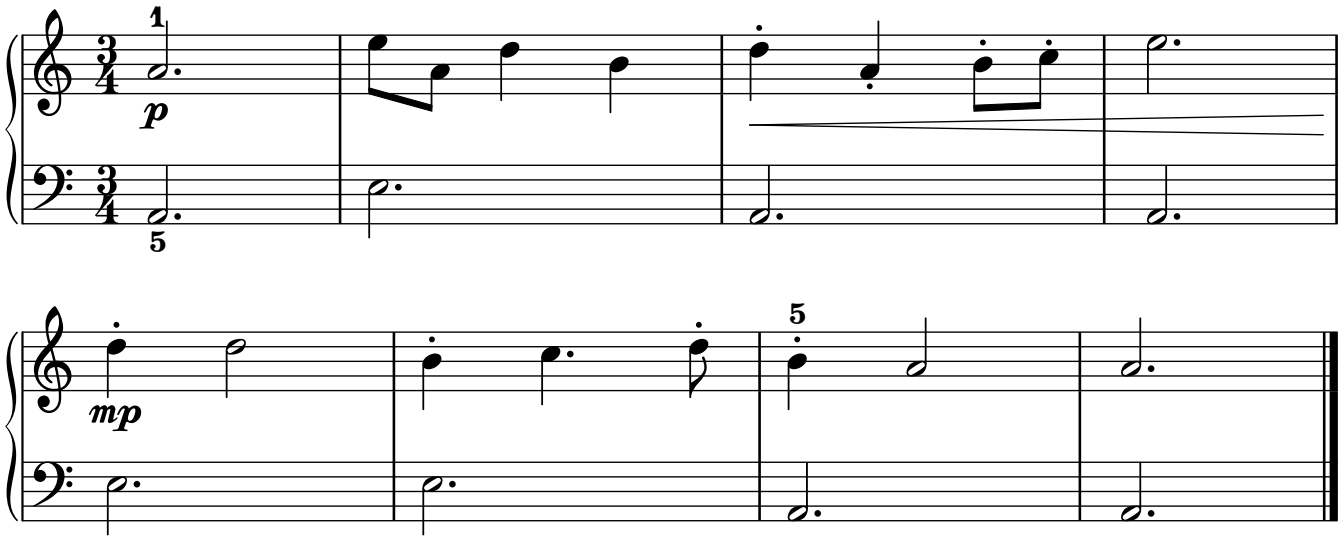


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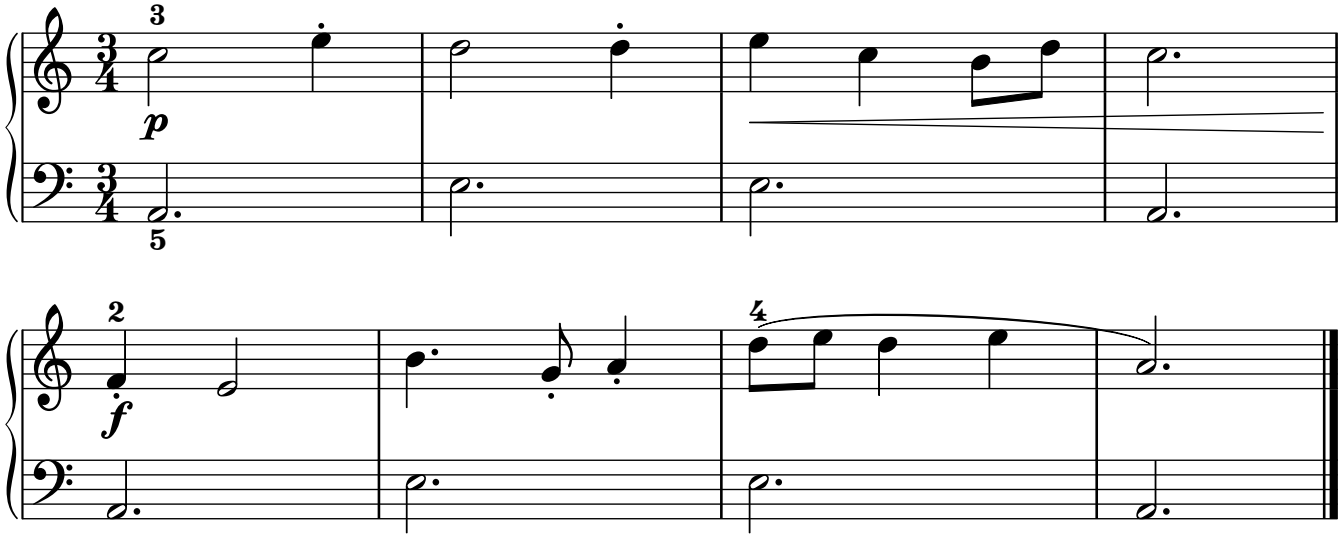


Part C: A minor waltzes ♩ = 72

A minor waltzes with dynamics.
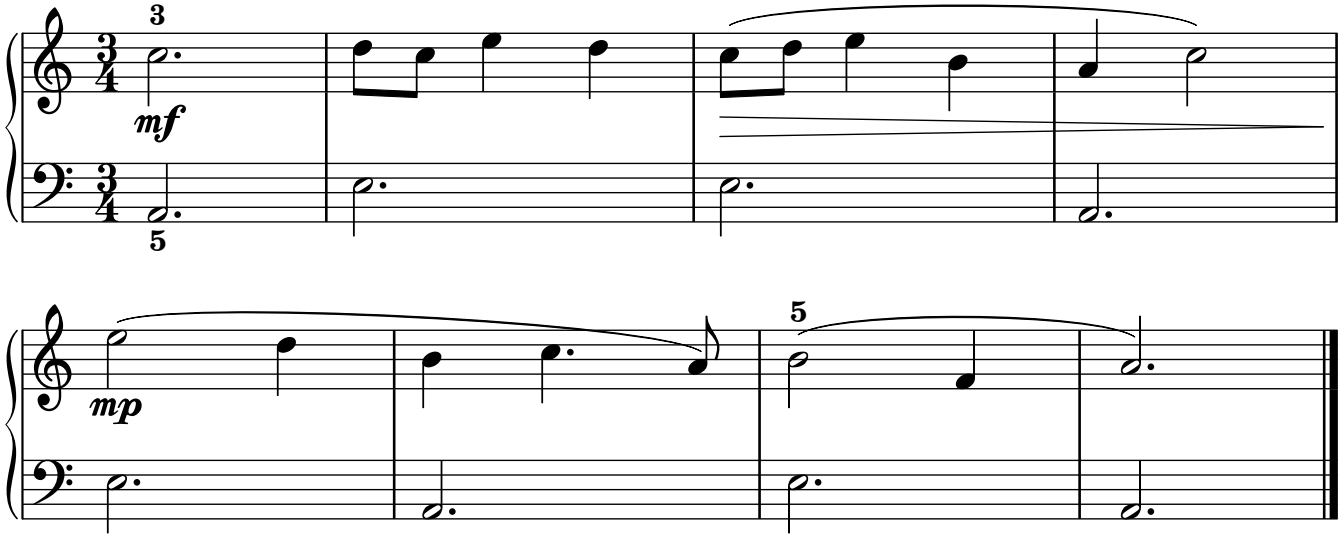
☐ **10.17**
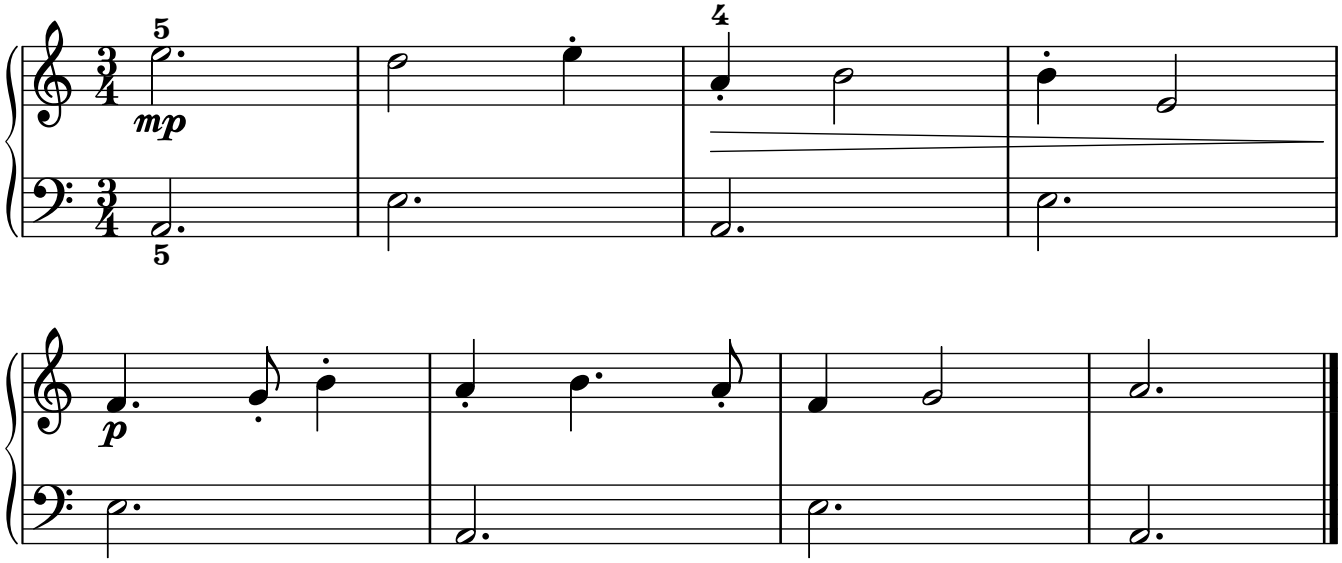


☐ **10.18**
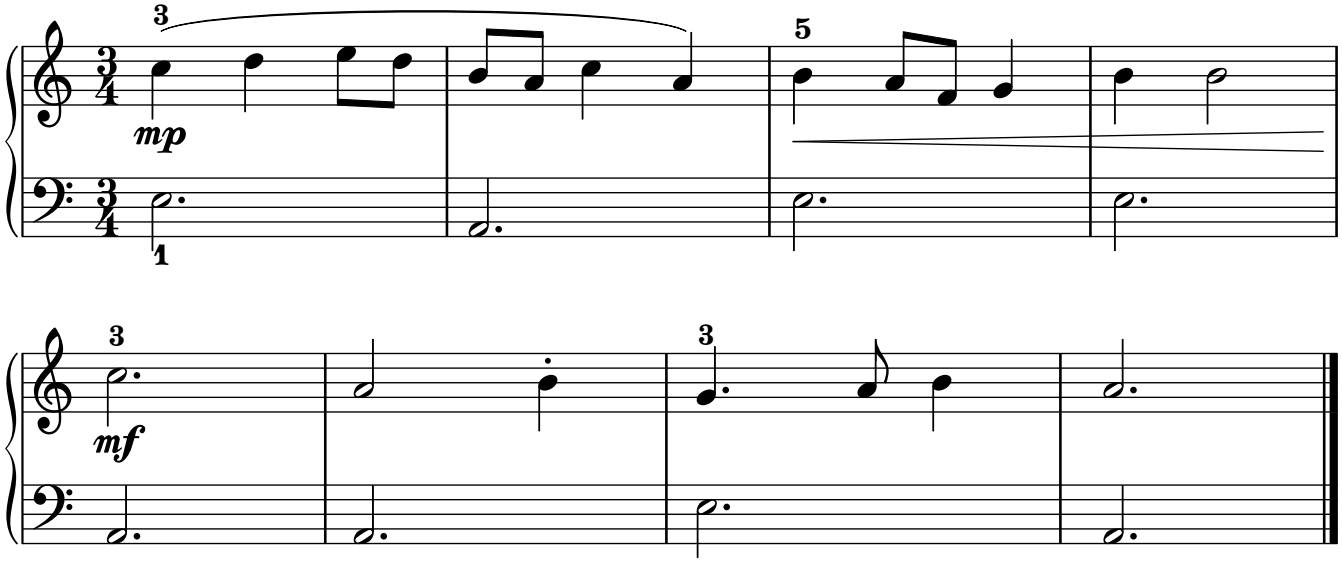


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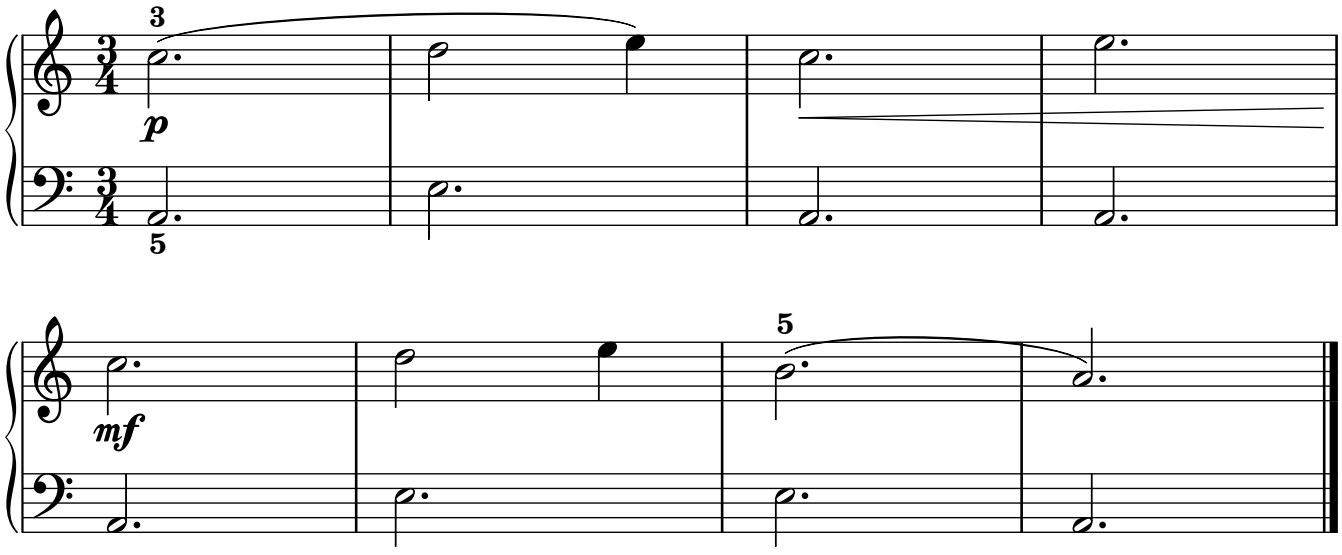


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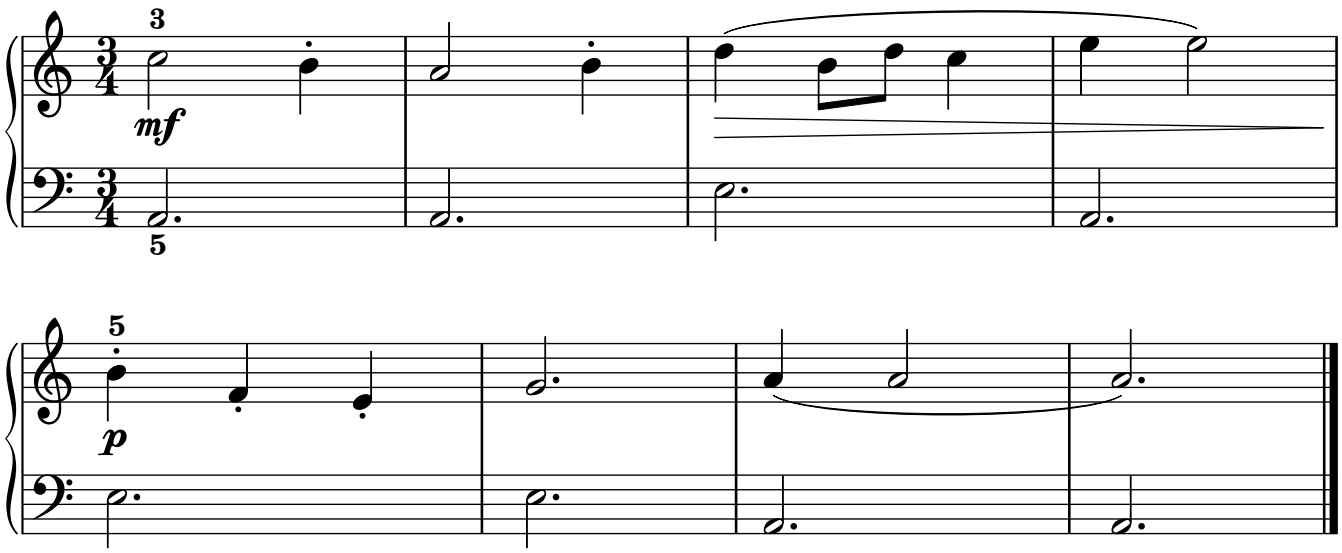


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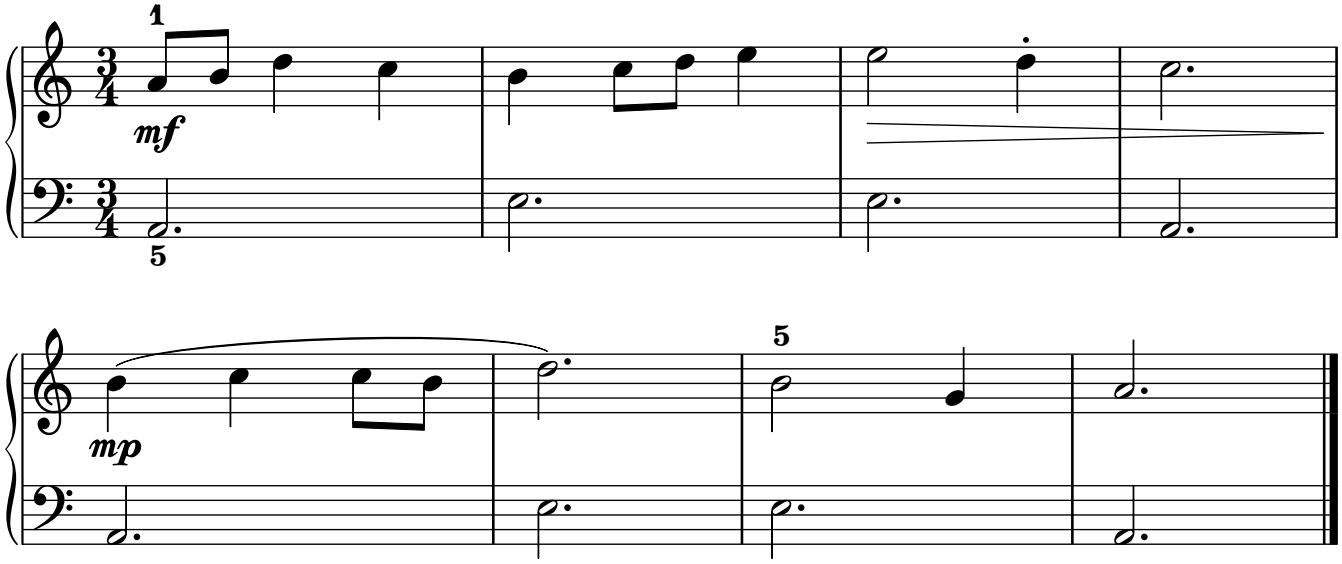


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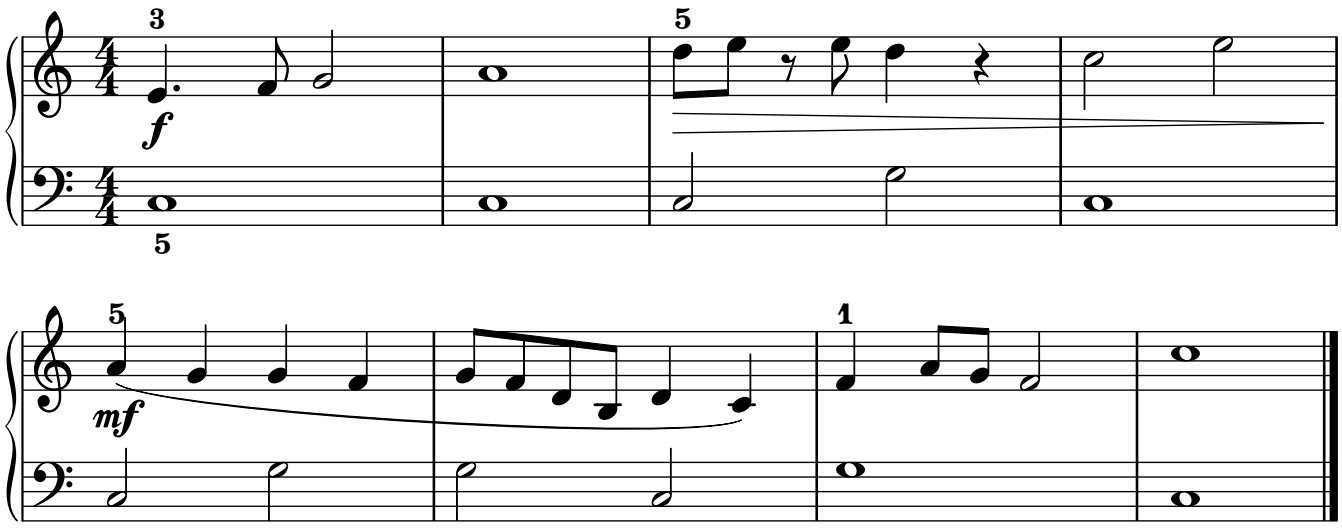


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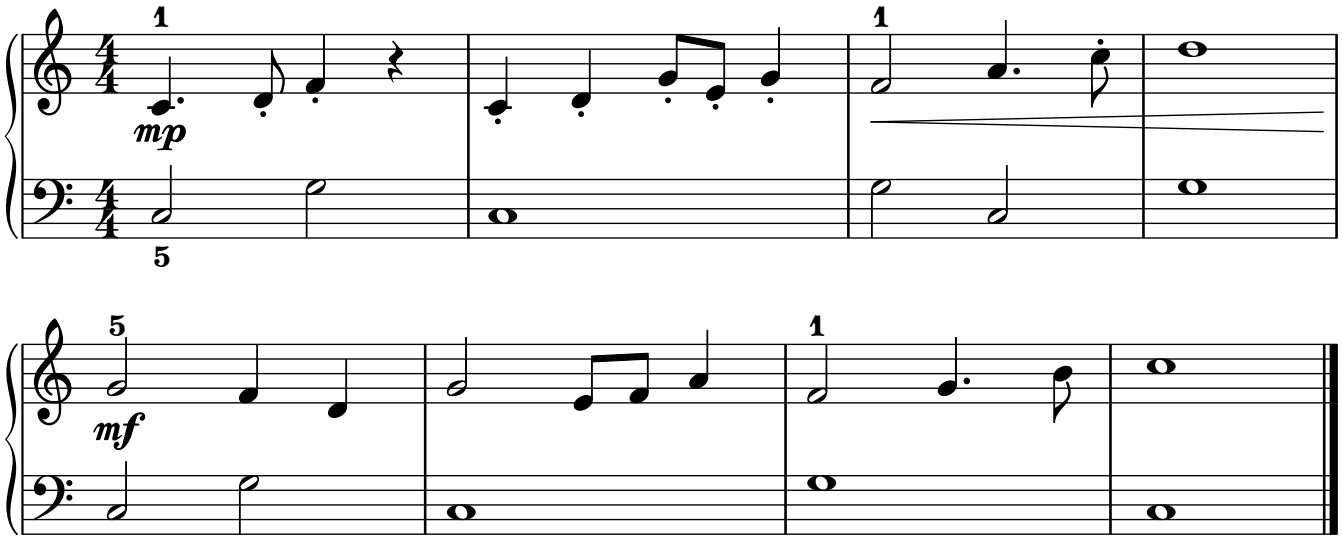


Part D: C major: everything ♩ = 66

C major with everything: stretches, shifts, eighths, dots, ties and rests.
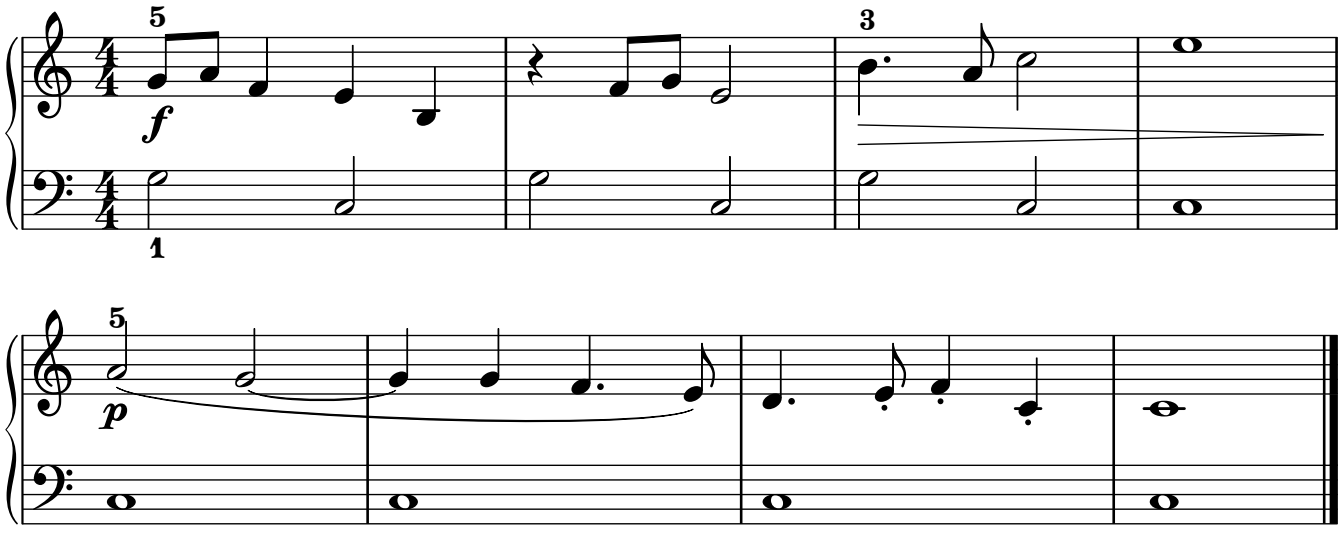
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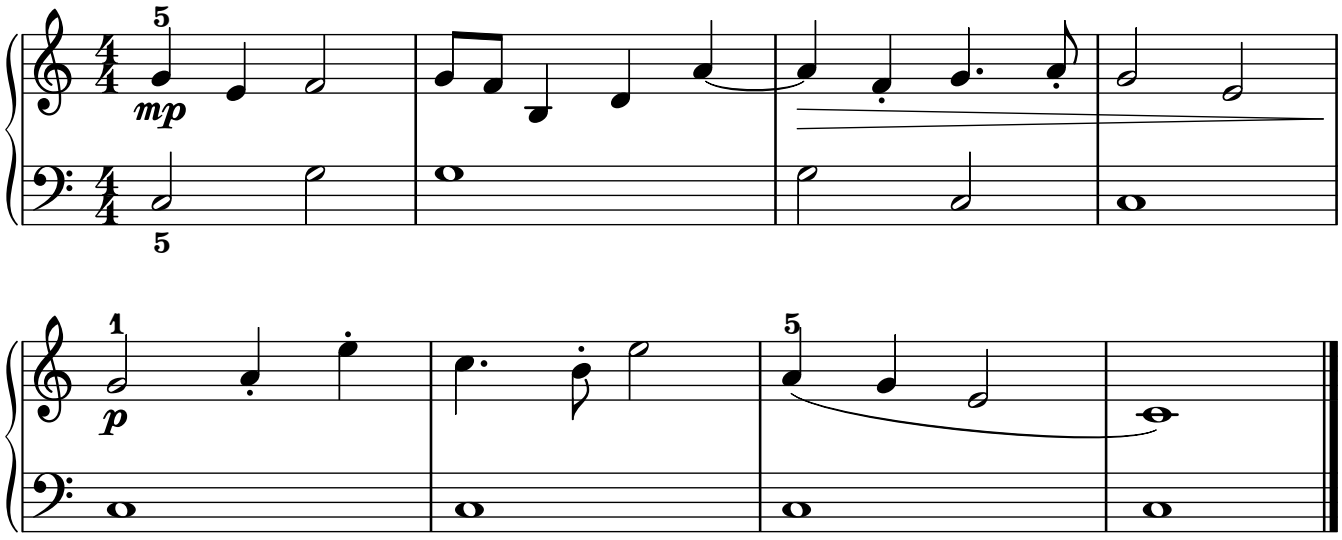


☐ **10.26**
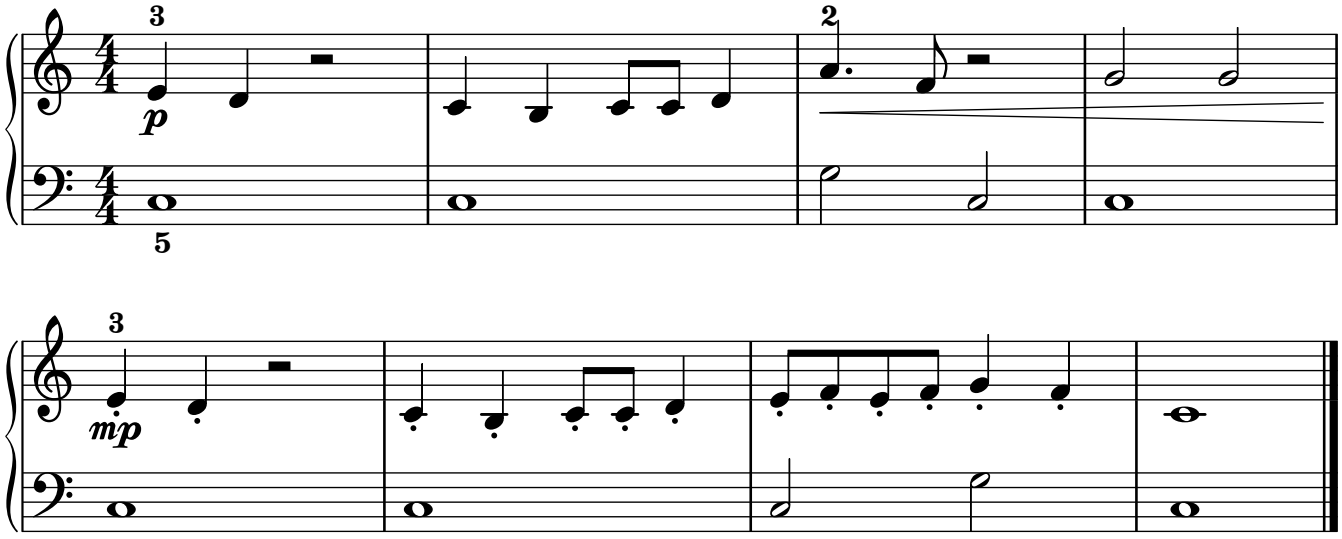


☐ **10.27**



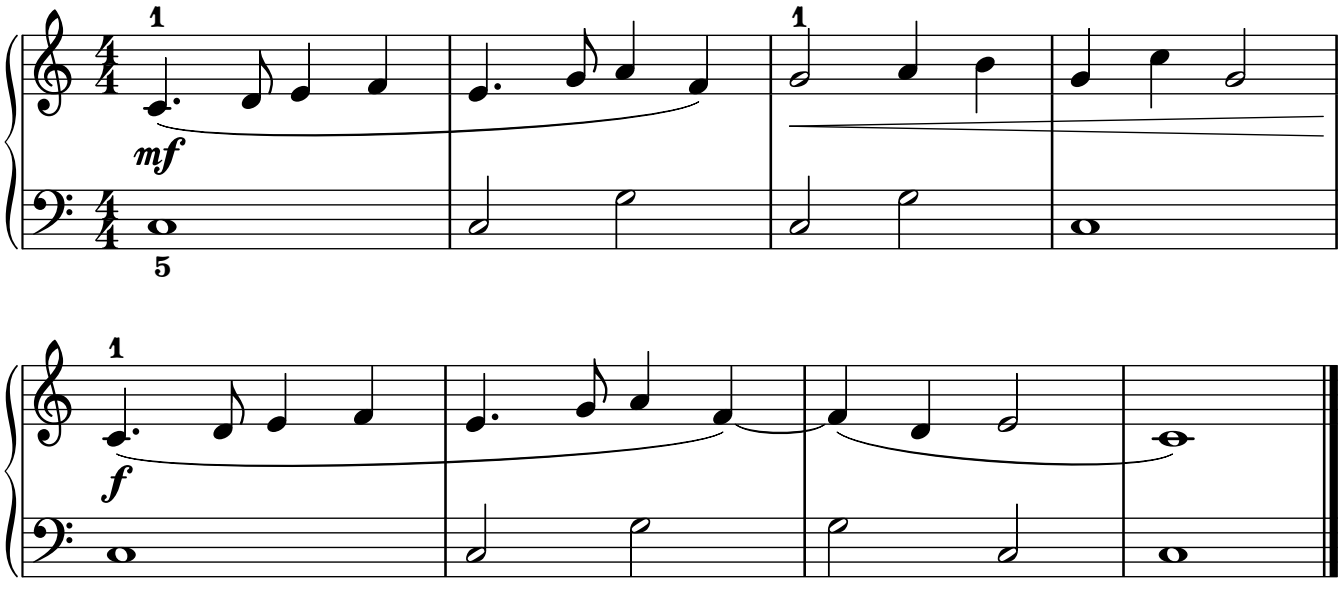
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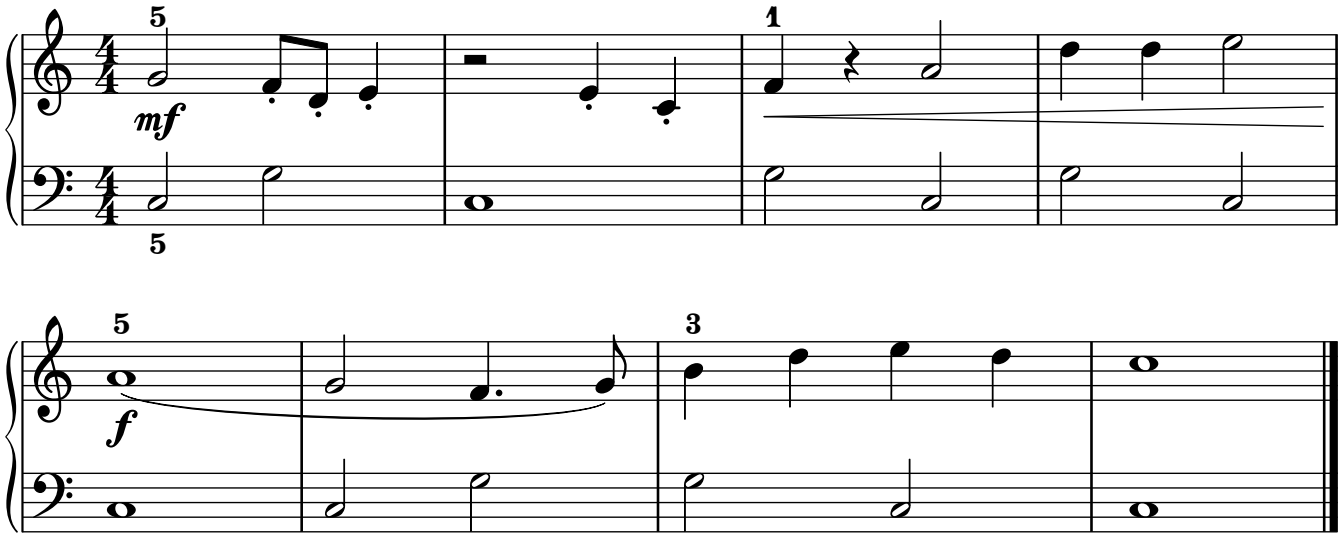


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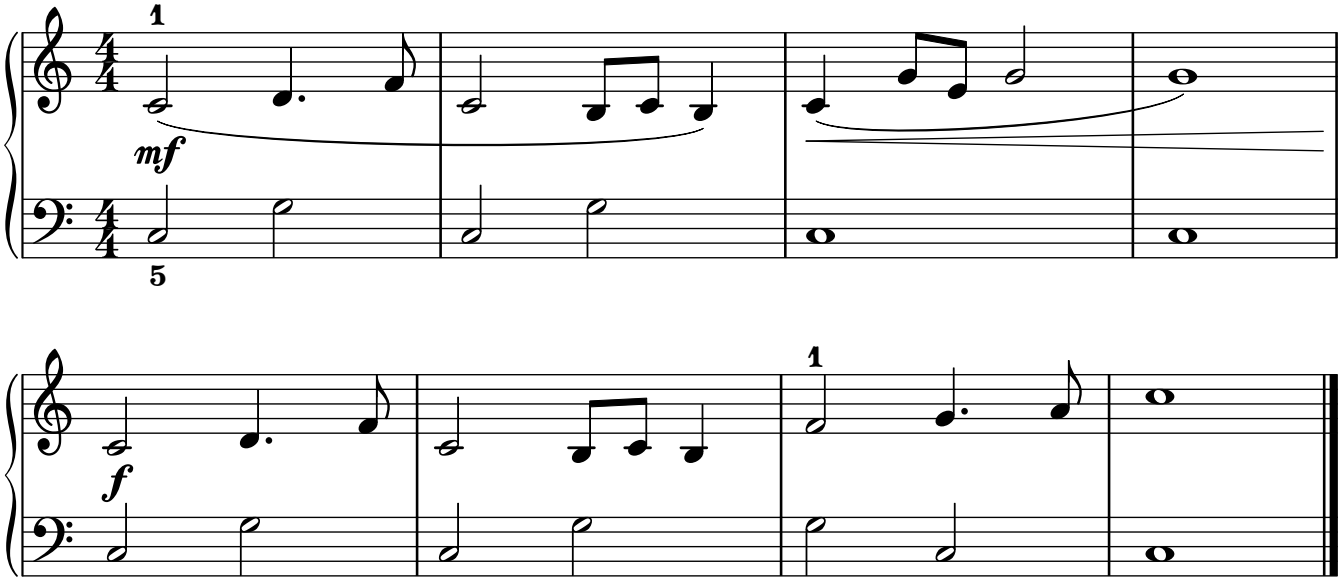


10.30



10.31



10.32
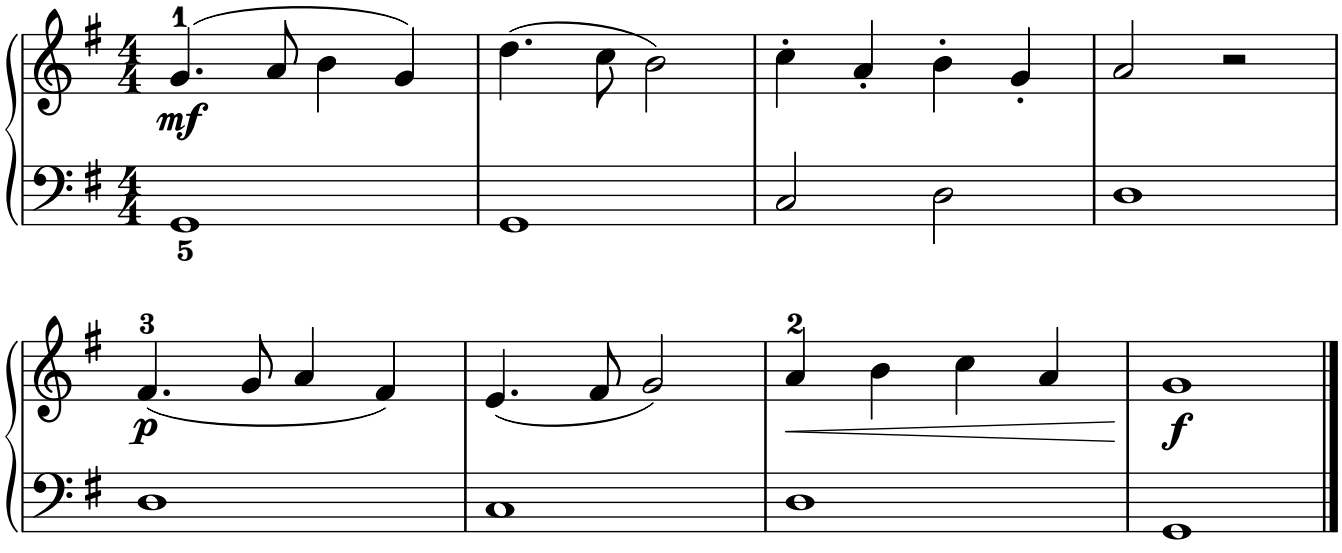


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Farewell March ♩ = 76

Original

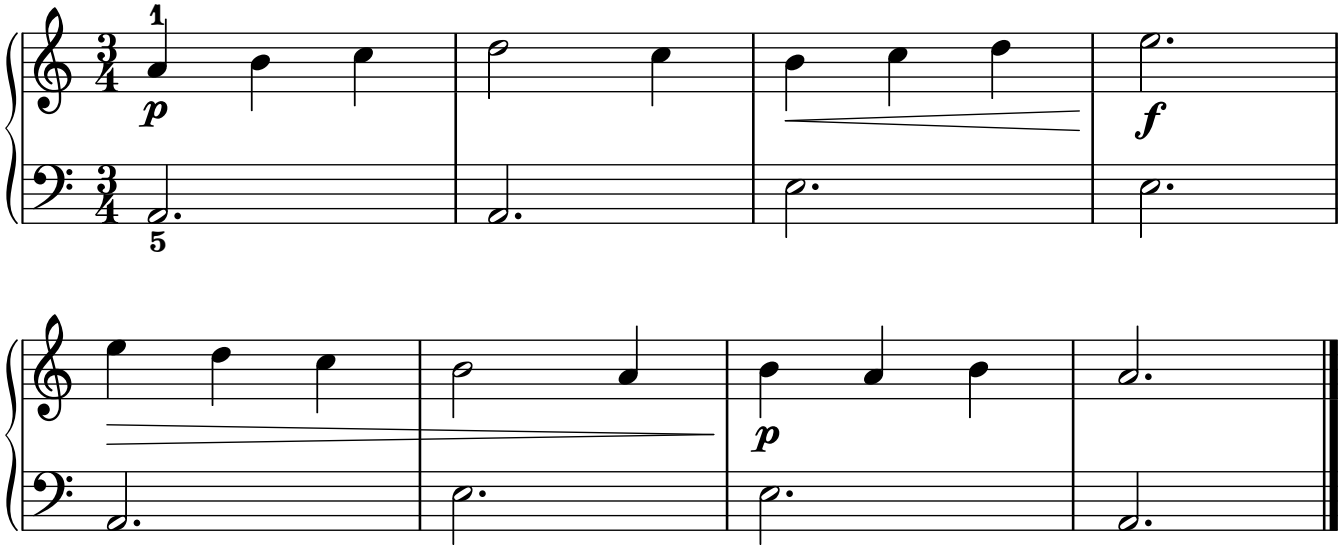
Dotted rhythms, slurs, staccato and dynamics. The right hand shifts to D position in bar 5 and back to G position in bar 7.



Minor Farewell ♩ = 84

Original
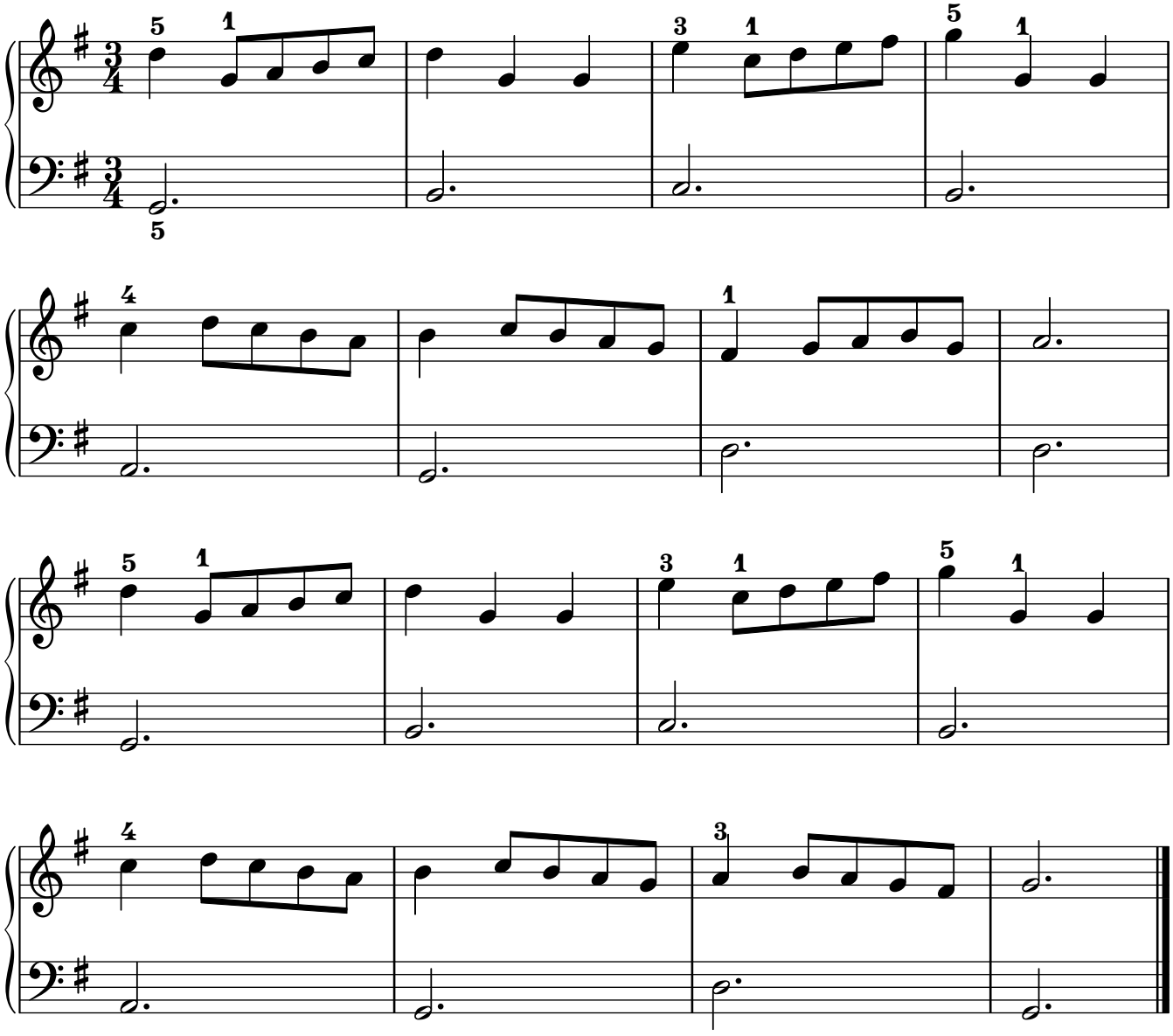
An A minor waltz that grows to forte in bar 4 and fades back to piano.



Minuet in G ♩= 92

Christian Petzold (1725), BWV Anh. 114 - melody with a simplified bass

A challenge: one of the best-known pieces for students, once thought to be by J. S. Bach. The right hand moves through four positions; the finger numbers show each move. Learn it a line at a time.



Checkpoint: ready for Volume 3?

- Play two exercises from each part (A to D) that you have not played before, at the speeds shown.
- Pass if you keep the beat with no more than one stop per exercise, and name the key of each before you start.
- Pass if at least 9 notes out of 10 are right, and the dynamics and articulation can be heard.
- When you pass, you have finished Volume 2. If one skill keeps tripping you up, go back to its unit for a week.